Collection des grands traités

Partie alchimique du site d'Hervé Delboy — 4 pièces

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B I B L I O T H E C A C H Y M I C A revu le 15 novembre 2015 Plan : préambule - introduction à l'alchimie [§I - CHEMISTRY] - liste des ouvrages - notes de la Bibliotheca Chemica [John Ferguson] - Préambule

: Nous donnons ces catalogues, afin que chacun puisse se faire une idée du fonds inépuisable que constituent les traités de philosophie hermétique.

Ces recueils rendent compte en fait du fléchissement de la création littéraire en alchimie ; celui-ci s'observe dans la tendance qui s'instaure à réunir les traités connus jusqu'alors sous forme de compendium

. Il en existait déjà à l'état de manuscrits, mais c'est au XVI e

siècle que débuta la vogue des recueils systématiquement conçus.

Le premier ouvrage appartenant à cette catégorie fut constitué en 1561 par Gratarole [Verae Alchemiae Doctrina

]. Il contient cinquante-trois textes. Le poète et théologien Benedictus Figulus [Thesaurinella olympica aurea tripartita , Francfort, 1608 ; Rosarium novum olympicum et benedictum , Bâle, 1608

] réunit et publia une autre série de textes. Mais les recueils les plus complets sont le Theatrum chemicum comprenant deux cent neuf traités [

Strasbourg, 6 tomes, 1659-1661 ; éditions antérieures : Ursel 1602, Strasbourg 1613, Strasbourg 1622] et la Bibliotheca chemica curiosa

qu'édita Jean-Jacques Manget, avec cent quarante traités disposés dans l'ordre chronologique [Genève, 2 tomes, 1702

]. Ce ne sont pas seulement les textes, mais aussi les images qui sont rassemblés. Les trois plus importants recueils de cette espèce parurent entre 1617 et 1625. L' Atalanta fugiens

de Michel Maier contient cinquante emblèmes respectivement accompagnés d'une fugue, d'une épigramme et d'un bref exposé [1 ère

édition, Oppenheim 1617 ; réedition récente, Bâle 1964]. Le Jardinet chymique

de Stoltzius von Stoltzenberg comporte cent sept gravures provenant de divers ouvrages, comme les Douze clefs de Basile Valentin, les Symbola aureae mensae et le Rosaire , chacune accompagnée d'un sizain [

Francfort 1624 ; réedition récente : Darmstadt 1964]. Le recueil le plus riche est le Jardinet hermetico - spagyrique

comprenant cent soixante médaillons se rapportant chacun à un alchimiste et à une citation tirée de ses oeuvres [Francfort, 1625].

En même temps que l'on tâche de conserver les textes alchimiques, on a tendance à les considérer de façon plus critique que précédemment, ce qui fait qu'ils perdent beaucoup de leur mystérieuse aura. L'appareil critique est d'une part historique, c'est-à-dire que l'on rassemble des faits sur l'histoire de l'alchimie et la vie des auteurs. D'autre part, on se

livre à une étude critique des textes proprement dits, en en comparant les diverses versions et en leur adjoignant des notes. On voit également apparaître les premiers lexiques alchimiques : le Compendium alchimiae de Jean de Garlande [Bâle 1560] contient un index de synonymes, le Compendium de Gratarole [tome II, Bâle 1561], une « Lapidis philosophici nomenclatura

». Le premier dictionnaire latin-allemand est celui de Hieronymus Reussner [dans Pandora..., bâle 1582]. Au XVII e siècle, Martin Ruland [Lexicon alchemiae , Francfurt 1612, réed. Hildesheim 1964

] et William Johnson font paraître des lexiques très exhaustifs. Des nomenclatures de signes alchimiques figurent déjà dans quelques manuscrits du XV e

siècle. Beaucoup d'imprimés consacrent un ou deux feuillets à l'interprétation des principaux symboles. Il en parait une collection plus importante au XVIII e siècle, dans le

Medicinisch- Chymischund Alchemistisches Oraculum [

Ulm et Memmingen 1755 ; réed., Wolfgang Scneider, Weinheim 1962].

Nous allons à présent donner une courte introduction à l'alchimie, suivie du catalogue des plus grands traités dont certains sont disponibles sous forme numérisée sur internet. Cette introduction est tirée de William Thomas Brande : a Manuel of Chemistry [

containing the principal facts of the science, arranged in the order in which they are discussed and illustrated in the lectures at the Royal Institution of Great Britain. Vol. I, London, John Murray, 1821] dont voici le §I. [on trouvera les autres § dans l 'introduction à l'alchimie -] Introduction :

§I - CHEMISTRY cannot be said to have existed, as a science, previous to the commencement of the seventeenth century; for, although we find, in the writings of the earlier chemists, many curious and important facts and discoveries, these remained useless and unapplied, so long as the minds of men were exclusively directed to the transmutation of the

metals, the fabrication of an universal elixir, and the production of the Alcahest, or general solvent Although, therefore, it may often be amusing, and sometimes profitable, to revert to the crude speculations and waking dreams of the voluminous writers upon these subjects, who were eminent in the fourteenth and two successive centuries, the time. of the student will be more usefully occupied in tracing the labours of those, who, discarding visionary hypotheses, proceeded to the investigation of truth; and who were led on, not by the vague glimmering of speculative notions, bat by the I steady day-light of real philosophy. It is, I think, among our own countrymen that we discover the fathers of chemical philosophy: for BACON, BOYLE, HOOKE, MAYOW, and NEWTON, present unequivocal claims to that distinctive title. As induction from experiment is exclusively the basis of chemical science, little progress could be made in it till the futility of the ancient philosophical systems had been: shewn, and their influence annihilated ; till the true end of science was rightly defined, and the road to it rendered straight and passable; till the necessity of well-digested experiment had been established, which "

first procures the light, then shews the way by its means

." It may seem trite to quote Lord BACON; but, as experience is constantly showing the neglect of the invaluable doctrines inculcated in his works, and as students, especially, are too apt to throw off the burthen and responsibility of thinking for themselves by adopting the notions of others, without either weighing their merit or appreciating their correctness, and often only because they are new, I shall beg leave to call their attention to one of the many relevant passages of this author.

Sir Francis Bacon (1651-1626) par Cecil Thomas in Sylva Sylvarum... "

He who would come duly prepared, and fitted to the business of interpretation, must neither be a follower of novelty, custom, nor antiquity; nor indulge himself in a liberty of contradicting; nor servilely follow authority. He must neither be hasty in affirming, nor loose and sceptical in doubting; but raise up particulars to the places assigned

them by their degree of evidence and proof. His hope must encourage him to labour, and not to rest; he must not judge of things by their uncommon nature, their difficulty, or their high character; bat by their just weight and use. He must, in his own particular, carry on his view with. concealment, and yet have a due regard for posterity. He must prudently observe the first entrance of errors into truths, and of truths into errors, without despising or admiring any thing. He must understand his own talents and' abilities, or the advantages of his own nature. He must comply with the nature

of others. He must, as with one eye, survey the natures of things, arid have the other turned towards human uses. He must distinctly understand the mixed nature of words; which is extremely capable both of prejudicing and assisting. He must lay it

down to himself, that the art of discovering will grow up, and improve, along with discoveries themselves. He must not be vain either

in delivering or concealing the knowledge he has acquired; but ingenuous and prudent, and communicate his in-ventions without pride or ill-nature : and this in a

strong and lively manner, well defended against the injuries of time, and fit for the propagation of knowledge, without occasioning errors; and, which is the principal thing of all, it must be such as may select and choose for itself a prepared and suitable reader. " [Prefatory Aphorisms of the Novum Organum Scientiarum , No. XI. Cf. 1 , 2 , 3]

The following observations from the same source, will bring me back to my subject: "

And again; if any one should condescend to regard such things as are accounted rather curious than useful; and take a thorough view of the works of the alchymists, or the followers of natural magic; he might, perhaps, be at a difficulty which he

should withhold, his tears, or his laughter. For the alchymist goes on with an eternal hope; and where his matters succeed not, lays the

blame upon his own errors; and accuses himself as not having sufficiently understood either the terms of his art, or his author: whence he either hearkens out for traditions and auricular whispers, or else fancies he made some mistake as to the exact quantity of the ingredients, or nicety of the experiment; and thus repeats the operation without end. And if, in the mean time, among all the chances of experiments, he throws any which appear either new or useful, he feeds his mind with these as so many earnests; boasts and extols them above measure; and conceives great hopes of what is behind. It must, indeed, be allowed that the alchymists have made many discoveries, and obliged mankind with useful inventions; but they are well represented in that fable of the old man, who left an estate to his children, buried somewhere or other, he told them, in his vineyard; which they, therefore, fell to dig for with great diligence; whereby, though they found no gold in substance, yet they received a better vintage for their labour ." "

But such as apply to natural magic, and explain every thing by sympathies and antipathies, have, by supine and indolent conjectures, placed strange virtues and operations in things, and if, at. any time, they have produced works, they are rather

suited to admiration and strangeness, than to fruit and advantage ." [Novum Organum . Section V]

It is my intention, in this introductory chapter, after a, brief allusion to the style, and views of the alchymical writers, to notice the principal researches of the chemists of the fifteenth and two following centuries; and thus to give an historical sketch of be very little doubt that the writings attributed to him are entirely spurious. The Tractatus Aureus

, or Golden Work is evidently a farrago of occult philosophy belonging to a much later period. HERMES, at the outset, is made to apologize for divulging the secrets of the black art. "

I should never have revealed them," says he, " had not the fear of eternal judgment, or the hazard of the perdition of my soul, prevailed

with me, for such a concealment It is a debt I am willing to pay to the just, even

as the Father of the just has liberally bestowed it upon me.

" After this prelude, we might expect to be let into some of the mysteries of alchymy, but our curiosity is quickly disappointed, by finding that they are only revealed to the eyes and ears of the sons of art; "

not to the profane, the unworthy, and the scoffers, who, being as greedy dogs, wolves, and foxes, are not to feed at our divine repast

." The reader is then conducted into what is termed the innermost chamber, and regaled with a history and explication of various matters relating to the philosopher's stone, by means of which, "

through the permission of the Omnipotent, the greatest disease is cured, and sorrow, distress, evil, and every hurtful thing evaded; by help of which

we pass from darkness to light, from a desert and wilderness to a habitation and home, and from straightness and necessities to a large and ample estate. " We are then directed to " catch the flying bird , " by which is meant quicksilver; " and drown it so that it may fly no more

, " this is what is afterwards termed the fixation of mercury, by uniting it to gold. It is then to be plunged into the " well of the philosophers, " or aqua regia "

by which its soul will be dissipated, and its corporeal particles united to the red eagle

," or muriate of gold. We may, however, at once cut short these observations by remarking, that all the details bear upon increasing the weight of gold by the influence of mercury, and this imaginary document of HERMES will suffice as an example of all the earliest alchymical authors. [sur les écrits hermétiques, cf. Table d'Émeraude , Sept chapitres Dorés , Epître de Marie à Aros , Livre de Crates

] GEBER is another great name in the history of alchymy; though the exact period at which he lived is unknown, it was probably not later than the seventh century. His three books of alchymy were published at Strasburgh, in 1520

, and, if genuine, of which there is much doubt, contain matter that well justifies the praise of BOERHAAVE, who considers him as a first-rate philosopher of his age. In bis chapter On the Alchemie of Sol,

after descanting upon the different means of refining and dissolving gold, he describes several solar medicines in language which is tolerably intelligible; they are all solutions of gold in nitre-muriatic acid, with the addition of quicksilver, nitre, common salt, and some other saline matters, and the student is directed to prepare his mind for their performance by suitable acts of piety and charity, which, if earnestly and perseveringly carried on, may, after due time, enable him, in the language of his translator. Dr. SALMON , "

to change argent vive into an infinite solific and lunific, without the help of any thing more than its multiplication.

" Alembics, crucibles, and various furnaces are so fully described, and, if -we may believe the MSS., depicted by GEBER, that he deserves to be mentioned also as the inventor of much useful apparatus. ARTEPHIUS

in 1130 published several alchymical tracts; we are told by ROGER BACON

and others, that he died at the advanced age of 1025, having prolonged his life by the miraculous virtues of his medicines; but his name, and that of JOHN DE RUPESCISSA, are now deservedly buried in oblivion. The alchymical annals of the thirteenth century are adorned by the name of ROGER BACON, a native of Ilchester in Somersetshire, and descended from an ancient and honourable family. In 1240, he returned from Paris, and became celebrated among the learned of the University of Oxford. At that time, however, the exposition of ignorance, and attempts to overthrow the dogmas of the schools, was a service of risk

and danger; and to this Friar BACON, for he was a monk of the Franciscan order, laid himself fully open; he was accused of practising witchcraft, thrown into prison, and nearly starved, for exposing the prevalent immorality of the clergy; and, according to some, stood a chance of being burned as a magician. Roger Bacon (ca. 1214 -1294)

I know of no work that strikes one with more surprise and admiration, than the Opus Majus of ROGER BACON ; he stands alone like a beacon upon a waste; his expressions are perspicuous and comprehensive, such as betoken a rare and unclouded intellect; and they are full of anticipations of the advantages likely to be derived from that mode of investigation insisted upon by his great successor, Chancellor BACON. This resemblance between ROGER BACON and his illustrious namesake, has scarcely been noticed by the historians of his period; it has, however, not escaped Mr. HALLAM'S observation, who adverts to it in his History of the Middle Ages . Whether Lord BACON, he says, "

ever read the Opus Majus I know not, but it is singular, that his favourite quaint expression, prae-rogativae scientiarum, should be found in that work; and whoever reads the sixth part of the Opus Majus, upon experimental science, must be struck by it as the prototype in spirit of the Novum Organum. The same sanguine, and sometimes rash confidence in the effect of physical discoveries; the same fondness for experiment; the same preference of inductive to abstract reasoning, pervade both works. "

The alchymical work of ROGER BACON, that has been most prized, is the Mirror of Alchymy

, but there is little either of interest or entertainment to be extracted from it. ROGER BACON has by some been spoken of as a benefactor to mankind, by others as an enemy to the human race, inasmuch as he is plausibly considered to have invented gunpowder, an invention by which the personal barbarity of warfare has certainly been diminished, "

but which, considered as an instrument of human destruction, by far more powerful than any that skill had devised, or accident presented, before; acquiring, as experience

shews us, a more sanguinary dominion in every succeeding age, and borrowing all the progressive resources of science and civilization for the extermination of mankind, appals us," says Mr. HALLAM, " at the future prospects of the species, and makes us feel perhaps more than in any other instance, a difficulty in reconciling the mysterious dispensation with the benevolent order of Providence. "

This discovery has sometimes been given to BARTHOLOMEW SCHWARTZ, a German monk, and the date of 1320 annexed to it, a date posterior to that which may be justly claimed for Friar BACON. Upon the authority, however, of an Arabic writer in the Escurial collection referred to by Mr. HALLAM, there seems little reason to doubt that gunpowder was introduced, through the means of the Saracens, into Europe, before the middle of the fifteenth century, though its use in engines of war was probably more like that of fire-works than artillery. Many authorities might be adduced to prove the common use of gunpowder early in the fourteenth century. EDWARD III. employed artillery with memorable effect, at the battle of Cressy, and in the fifteenth century hand-cannons and muskets came into use, and gun-powder was in common employ. ALBERT OF COLOGNE, surnamed THE GREAT, was a contemporary of ROGER BACON ; he is celebrated as the inventor of the brazen head which was demolished by the pious zeal of his pupil, the angelical Dr. AQUINAS

, in consequence of his suspecting it to be an agent of the devil. ALBERTUS MAGNUS

was what in our days is termed an universal genius. He is chiefly celebrated as the commentator of ARISTOTLE ; but, if we give credit to contemporary writers, he was deeply skilled in all the higher departments of alchymical philosophy. The names of RAYMOND LULLY of Majorca, and ARNOLD of Villanova

, occur in this page of the history of chemical science. Their merit, however, consists rather in the quantity than quality of their writings. LULLY died on his passage from Africa in 1315, whither he had been to preach the truths of the Gospel; his body was carried to Majorca, where he was honoured as a martyr. BRUCKER says, " he was more ingenious than honest

." His chemical opinions are scarcely worth quotation or abstract. He is said to have converted iron into gold in the presence of EDWARD I. in London, which was coined into rose-nobels. [BERGMAN Histor. Chem

.] ARNOLD shines as a magician and astrologer. He was a renowned prophet, and predicted that the world would come to an end in the year 1376. He was shipwrecked on the coast of Genoa, in 1313. About the year 1560, a Treatise of Alchymy was published at Paris, attributed to NICHOLAS FLAMMEL

. The work, however, is spurious, and was merely ascribed to him from his becoming suddenly, as it is said, very rich. The use he made of his wealth does his memory much credit: he founded hospitals, repaired churches, and endowed several charitable institutions; proceedings which ly no means savour of alchymy. Dr. SALMON

, who in 1692 published one of the above-mentioned tracts, says, "

FLAMMEL was originally a poor scrivener, yet left so great monuments behind him, as must convince the most incredulous that he knew the secret, and performed such mighty works at his own proper cost and charges, as the most opulent prince in Europe can never do the like. I know, " says he, " a gentleman who went to view those mighty buildings and their records. The archives and governors of those places, he told me, own the matter of fact but deny the means, saying, that FLAMMEL was a very pious man, and went a pilgrimage to St. James of Gallicia, for a reward of which piety the holy saint bestowed that vast treasure upon him by way of miracle, thereby denying the power of art by which it was certainly effected, to establish a miracle performed by the Romish Saint. "

portrait idéalisé de Nicolas Flamel (ca. 1330 - 1418) He was moreover celebrated for his hieroglyphics , of which fac-similes are given in SALMON'S edition

. They are much of the same cast as those that now adorn MOORE'S Almanack, and quite as edifying. In SALMON'S collection we find the Marrow of Alchymy

by GEORGE RIPLEY, Chanon of Bridlington in Yorkshire, who was a chemist perhaps less deserving of the reputation he acquired than most of his compeers. He may be quoted as a chemical poet. His Compound of Alchemic

, dedicated to EDWARD IV, is rugged enough, but not unintelligible. The following stanzas from the preface of this piece, given in ASHMOLE'S Theatrun Chemicum Britannicum

, will afford a fair idea of RIPLEY'S merits as a poet and philosopher: [... Cf. Douze Portes

] The degree of faith placed in alchymy was of course much shaken by the multiplied experiments that were undertaken during the seventeenth century; in general, however, those who failed attributed their ill success to any rather than the real cause. SALMON'S creed is that of most of his contemporaries. "

As to the great and philosophic work," says he, (meaning transmutation,) " it is my opinion and belief that there is such a thing in nature. I know the matter of fact to be true, though the way and manner of doing it is as yet hid from me. I have been eye-witness of so much as is able to convince any man endued with rational faculties, that there is a possibility of the transmutation of metals; yet, for all these things, will not advise any man, ignorant of the power of nature and the way of operation, to attempt the work, lest, erring in the foundation, he should suffer loss and blame me. Without doubt it is a gift of God from above, and he that attains it must patiently wait the moving of the waters; when the destined angel moves the waters of the pool, then is the time to immerge the leprous metal, and cleanse it from all impurities. " VAN

HELMONT says, "

I am constrained to believe in the making of gold and silver, though I know many exquisite chemists to have consumed their own and other men's goods in search of this mystery; and to this day we see these unworthy and simple labourers cunningly deluded by a diabolical crew of gold and silver sucking-flies and leeches. But I know that many will contradict this truth; one says it is the work of the devil, and another, that the sauce is dearer than the meat. " BERGMAN

, in summing up the evidence for and against the possibility and probability of transmutation, and founding his opinion upon the multitude of relations that have been handed down to us by different writers of apparent veracity, one or two of which I shall presently quote, observes, that "

although most of them are deceptive, and many uncertain, some bear such character and testimony that unless we reject all historical evidence we must allow them entitled to confidence ." [Opuscula , IV. 127]

For my own part, the perusal of the histories of transmutation appears to me to furnish solid grounds for a diametrically opposite opinion. They are all of a most suspicious character; sometimes the fraud was open and intentional, seconded by juggang dexterity; at other times the performers deceived themselves; they purchased what was termed a powder of projection, prepared by the adepts, containing a portion of gold, and when they threw it into the fire with mercury, and found that portion of gold remaining in their crucible, they had not wit enough to detect its source; but the cases which are quoted as least exceptionable are often exactly those which are really impossible ; I mean, where the weight of the powder of projection, and of the lead or other base metal taken conjointly, was exceeded by that of the gold produced. Such is HIERNES' history of PAYKUL'S transmutation, who, with six drachms of lead and one of powder, produced an ingot that was coined into 147 ducats; and many others. But the most celebrated history of

transmutation is that given by HELVETIUS in his Brief of the Golden Calf :

discovering the rarest Miracle in Nature, how by the smallest portion of the Philosophers Stone a great Piece of Common Lead was totally transmuted into the purest transplendent Gold,

at the Hague in 1666: and, as it is a luminous epitome of all that has been done on this subject, I shall briefly abridge the proceedings:

portrait de Iohannes Fridericus Helvetius (1629-1709) "

The 27th day of December 1666, in the afternoon, came a stranger to my house at the Hague, in a plebeick habit, of honest gravity and serious authority, of a mean stature and a little long face, black hair not at all curled, a beardless chin, and about 44 years (as I guess,) of age, find born in North Holland. After salutation he beseeched me with great reverence to pardon his rude accesses, for he was a lover of the Pyrotechnian art, and having read my treatise against the sympathetic powder of Sir KENELM DIGBY, and observed my doubt about the philosophic mystery, induced him to ask me if I really was a disbeliever as to the existence of an universal medicine which would cure all diseases, unless the principal parts were perished or the

predestinated time of death come, I replied, I never met with an adept, or saw such a medicine, though I had fervently prayed for it. Then I said, surely you are a learned physician. No, said be, I am a brass-founder, and a lover of chymistry. He then took from his bosom-pouch a neat ivory box, and out of it three ponderous lumps of stone, each about the bigness of a walnut. I greedily saw and handled for a quarter of an hour this most noble substance, the value of which might be somewhere about twenty tons of gold; and having drawn from the owner many rare secrets of its admirable effects, I returned him this treasure of treasures with a most sorrowful mind, humbly beseeching him to bestow a fragment of it upon me in perpetual memory of him, though but the size of a coriander seed. No, no, said he, that is not lawful: though thou wouldst give me as many golden

ducats as would fill this room; for it would have particular consequences, and if fire could be burned of fire, I would at this instant rather cast it all into the fiercest flames. He then asked if I had a private chamber whose prospect was from the public

street; so I presently conducted him to my best furnished room backwards, which he entered," says HELVETIUS, (in the true spirit of Dutch cleanliness,) " without wiping his shoes, which were full of snow and dirt. I now expected he would bestow some great secret upon me, but in vain. He asked for a piece of gold, and opening his doublet showed me five pieces of that precious metal which he wore upon a green riband, and which very much excelled mine in flexibility and colour, each being the size of a small trencher. I now earnestly again craved a crumb of the stone, and at last, out of his philosophical commiseration, he gave me a morsel as large as a rape-seed; but I said, this scanty portion will scarcely transmute four grains of lead. Then, said he, deliver it me hack: which I did, in hopes of a greater parcel; but he, cutting off half with his nail, said, even this is sufficient for thee. Sir, said I, -with a dejected countenance, what means this? And he said, even that will transmute half an ounce of lead. So I gave him great thanks, and said I would try it, and reveal it to no one. He then took his leave, and said he would call again next morning at nine. I then confessed that while the mass of his medicine was in my hand the day before, I had secretly scraped off a bit with flay nail, which I projected on lead, but it caused no transmutation, for the whole flew away in fumes. Friend, said he, thou art more dexterous in committing theft than in applying medicine; hadst thou wrapt up thy stolen prey in yellow wax, it would have penetrated and transmuted the lead into gold. I then asked if the philosophic work cost much or required long time, for philosophers say that nine or ten months are required for it. He answered, their writings are only to be understood by the adepts, without whom no student can prepare this magistery.

Fling not away, therefore, thy money and goods in hunting out this art, for thou shall never find it. To which I replied. As thy master showed it

thee, so mayest thou perchance discover something there of to me, who know the rudiments, and therefore it may be easier to add to a foundation than begin anew. In this art, said he, it is quite otherwise; for unless thou knowest the thing from bead to heel, thou canst not break open the glassy seal of HERMES, But enough; to-morrow, at the ninth hour, I will show thee the manner of projection. But Elias never came again; so my wife, who was curious in the art whereof the worthy man had discoursed, teazed me to make the experiment with the little spark of bounty the artist had left me; so I melted half an ounce of lead, upon which my wife put in the said medicine; it hissed and bubbled, and in a quarter of an hour the mass of lead was transmuted into fine gold, at which we were exceedingly amazed. I took it to the goldsmith, who judged it most excellent, and willingly offered fifty florins for each ounce ."

Such is the celebrated history of ELIAS THE ARTIST and Dr. HELVETIUS. SIR KENELM DIGBY

, whose name is mentioned in this narrative, was a renowned dabbler in the mysterious art. Under the date of 7th November, 1651, in EVELYN'S Diary [BRAY'S Memoirs of John Evelyn], "

he gave me," says Mr. EVELYN, " a certain powder with which he affirmed that he had fixed mercury before the late king. He advised me to try and digest a little better, and me a water which he said was only rain water, the autumnal equinox, exceedingly rectified and very volatile; it had a taste of strong vitriolic, and smelt like aquafortis. He intended it for a dissolvent of calx of gold; but the truth is, Sir KENELM was an arrant mountebank. "

Nearly all the alchymists attributed the power of prolonging life either to the philosopher's stone, or to certain preparations of gold, imagining possibly that the permanence of that metal might he transferred to the human system. The celebrated DESCARTES is said to have supported such opinions; he told Sir KENELM DIGBY that although he would not venture to promise immortality, he was certain that life might he

lengthened to the period of that of the Patriarchs. His plan, however, seems to have been the very rational one of limiting all excess of diet, and enjoining punctual and frugal meals [See Life of Descartes. CHALMERS'S.Biographical Dictionary]. The history of alchymy has been greatly enriched by the labours of the celebrated ELIAS ASHMOLE, who in 1652 published his Theatrum Chemicum Brittannicum ,

containing several Poeticall Pieces of our famous English Philosophers, who have written the Hermetique Mysteries in their owne ancient Language .

The most remarkable piece in this collection is the Ordinall of Alchimy, by THOMAS NORTON, illustrated by several comical cuts. It treats in separate chapters, of the objects of the occult science; of the difficulties of attaining them; of the different methods of pursuing them; of the characters of the elements; and of the five concords, of which the first is Patience, the second Assistance, the third Instruments, the fourth Situation, and the fifth Planetary Influence. It is difficult to select from this production any specimen capable of conveying an idea of its merits, that can come within the limits of a quotation. [...] In later times we have had two or three believers in transmutation. In the year 1782, Dr. PRICE, of Guildford, by means of awhile and a red powder, professed to convert mercury into silver and gold, and is said to have convinced many disbelievers of the possibility of such change; his experiments were to have been repeated before an adequate tribunal, but he put a period to his existence by swallowing laurel-water. Another true believer in the mysteries of this art was PETER WOULFF, of whom it is to be regretted that no biographical memoir has been preserved. I have picked up a few anecdotes respecting him from two or three friends who were his acquaintance. He occupied chambers in Bamard's Inn while residing in London, and usually spent the summer in Paris. His rooms which were extensive, were so filled with furnaces and apparatus that it was difficult to reach his fire-side. A friend told me that he once put down his hat, and never could find it again, such was the confusion of

boxes, packages, and parcels, that lay about the chamber. His breakfast-hour was four in the morning; a few of his select friends were occasionally invited to this repast, to whom a secret signal was given by which they gained entrance, knocking a certain number of times at the inner door of his apartment. He had long vainly searched for the elixir, and attributed his repeated failures to the want of due preparation by pious and charitable acts. I understand that some of his apparatus is still extant, upon which are supplications for success, and for the welfare of the adepts. Whenever he wished to break an acquaintance, or felt himself offended, he resented the supposed injury by sending a present to the offender and never seeing him afterwards. These presents were sometimes of a curious description, and consisted usually of some expensive chemical product or preparation. He had an heroic remedy for illness: when he felt himself seriously indisposed, he took a place in the Edinburgh mail, and having reached that city, immediately came back in the returning coach to London. A cold taken on one of these expeditions terminated in an inflammation of the lungs, of which he died in 1805. He is the author of several papers in the Philosophical Transactions. A few other persons of leap note wight be quoted as believers in transmutation, but the history of one is that of all; and, in the emphatic language of Spenser, they were doomed "

To lose good days that might be better spent,

To waste long nights in pensive discontent;

To speed to-day, to be put back to-morrow,

To feed on hope, to pine with fear and sorrow;

To fret their souls with crosses and with cares,

To eat their hearts through comfortless despairs:

Unhappy wights I born to disastrous end,

That do their lives in tedious tendance spend ."

But although the alchymists have given us little in the way of useful facts or applicable discoveries, their reign was fruitful in the invention of

apparatus. Alembics, stills, retorts, receivers, and a variety of whimsical and complex vessels, in glass and porcelain, are described and depicted in their works ; and they not only possessed all the furnaces with which our modem laboratories are necessarily supplied, but were particularly expert m their construction, and often surprisingly happy in their application. peinture extraite du Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum , Ordinall of Alchemy

Cette peinture montre un jeune homme instruit par un vieillard : il s'agit d'Adolphus et de Senior vus dans l'une des gravures de l' Azoth

, du pseudo Basile Valentin, en frontispice. Le vieillard représente le Mercurius senex de Jung ou Cronos qui doit laisser place, dans la suite de l'oeuvre, à plus jeune que lui. En haut, la colombe symbolise l'Esprit qui distille la substance du Mercure ; quant aux anges musiciens, ils constituent les ordonnateurs de l'oeuvre et sont à l'image de ceux que nous voyons sur la Scala Philosophorum du Mutus Liber . liste des ouvrages : 1. Bibliothèque des philosophes chimiques [G. Salmon, Richebourg] : I - II - III - IV - 2. De Alchimiae Gebri Arabis [Petreus, version 1545 et 1541

] = Practica vera alkimia [Ortholanus ou Hortulanus] - 3. Theatrum Chemicum [Zetzner] : I - II - III - IV - V - VI - 4. Musaeum Hermeticum , 1625 [Jennis] - 5. Musaeum Hermeticum , 1678 - 6. Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa [Manget] : I - II - 7. Anatomia Auri [Mylius] - 8. De alchimia libri tres [pseudo-Geber] - 9.

Alchemiae, quam vocant, artisque metallicae doctrina [Gratarole] : I - II - Verae Alchimiae - 10. Theatricum Chemicum Britannicum [Ashmole] - 11. Pretiosa margarita novella [Janus Lacinius, Petrus Bonus] - 12. Bibliotheca chemica [Ferguson] : introduction - 13. Sceptical chymist [Boyle] - 14. Artis Auriferae [Perna] : I - II - III - 15. Hermetisches A.B.C : I - II - III - IV - 16. Dreyfaches Hermetisches Kleeblat [Vigilantius de Monte Cubiti] : a. Traité du Sel de Nuisement - b. Mercurius Redivivus [8 traités de Samuel Norton] - c. Büchlein vom Stein der Weisen [Marsile Ficin

] - d. Warfferstein der Weissen, Francfort, 1656. - 17. Deutsches Theatrum Chemicum [Friederich Roth-Scholtzen .] : I - II - III - 18. Ars Chemica [Samuel Emmel] - 19 . Ginaeceum Chimicum [Io de Treuis] - 20 . De Alchimia Opuscula complura [Cyriacus Iacobus] - 21. Medicina Practica [William Salmon] - 22. Thesaurinella olympica aurea tripartita , Francfort, 1608 - 23. Rosarium novum olympicum et benedictum , Bâle, 1608 - 24. Pandora Magnalium Naturalium [Benedictus Figulus] 24bis . Pandora [Hyeronimus Reusner , Faustius (Johannes Michael)] - 25. Hermetisches Museum [Albrecht] : I - II - III - IV - 26.

Divers Traitez de la Philosophie Naturelle - 27 . Aurae Occultae Philosophicum [alias Azoth] - 28 . Collectanea Chymica [William Cooper] - 29 . Aurifontina Chymica [William Cooper] - 30 .

Eröffnete Geheimnisse des Steins der Weisen [Christian Liebezeit] - - mss alchimiques d'Isaac Newton -

mss alchimiques du Musaeum d'Histoire Naturelle [fonds Chevreul] - mss alchimiques de la bnf - extraits de la Bibliotheca Chemica de John Ferguson sur : G. Salmon - Grasshoff - Geber - De Alchimia - Theatrum Chemicum - Dorneus - Du Chesne - Richard l'Anglais - Vogelius - Barnaud - Villeneuve - Alphonse X - Museum Hermeticum - Manget - Turba - Mutus Liber - Montanor - Zadith - D'Espagnet - Stolcius - Gratarolle - Ashmole - Lacinius - Petrus Bonus - Artis Auriferae - Hermetisches ABC - Eleazar - Fictuld - S. Norton - Rosarium - W. Salmon - Figulus - Drebbel - Crasselame - 1)- Bibliothèque des philosophes chimiques.

Nouvelle edition, revûë, corrigée et augmentée de plusieurs philosophes, avec des Figures & des Notes pour faciliter l'intelligence de leur Doctrine. Par Monseiur J.M.D.R., Jean Maugin de Richebourg republié par

André Cailleau, Paris. 1740-54. 4 volumes.

Bibliothèque des Philosophes Chymiques, Charles Angot, 1742 Ferguson

: There is no account of this person, which I have

seen. The compilation was not originally of his

making, for there to the edition with the same title

which appeared In 1672-78 and bean as the editor's name : le Sieur S. Docteur en Medecine.

Of this edition I have seen two volumes only, and

I do not know if there were any more, though from

the list of works detailed in the Privilege; which

were proposed to be reprinted, there was material enough for at least other two volumes.

The writings contained la this first edition are the following:

In Tome I, A long preface; Hermes, La Table

d'Emeraude. La Tourbe des Philosophes; Flamel,

Bernard le Trévisan ; Zachaire, L'Opuscule; Wen

ceslas Lavinius.Traité du Ciel terrestre, Philalèthe,

l'Entrée ouverte; Vocabulary of Chemical words.

In Tome II. A long preface, Hermes, Les Sept

Chapitres; Le Dialogue de Marie et d'Aros;

l'Entretien de Calid et du Philosophe Morien; Artephius; Geber, La Somme de la Perfection, and at the end an Epistle to Claude Germain about his work Icon Philosophiae Occultae. The authors mentioned In the Privilege in addition to these are: Synesius, Ficinus, Arnaldus de Villanova, Lullius, Bacon, Ripley, Haly, Basilius Valentinus, Jean de Meun, Augurellus; Le grand et petit Paysant, la Fontaine des Amoureux de Sciences, la Complainte ou Remonstrance de la Nature et la responce de l'Alchimiste. Comparison of these lists will show that the present edition contains everything included in the early one, except the Epistola to Germain, and, besides, several of tbose mentioned in the

Privilege. The editor ban been called sometimes le Sieur Salmon, and has been identified with Dr. William Salmon, who in 1692 also made a collection of alchemical writers. See the note under SALMON (William) . sources : Lenglet Dufresnoy, Histoire de la Philosophie , 1742, iii, p. 45 - Gmelin, Geschichte der Chemie . 1798, ii, p. 300. - Schmieder. Geschichte der Alchemie , 1832, p. 545 - Ladrague, Bibliothèque Ouvaroff

, Sciences Secrètes, 1870, Nos. 630, 631. - Billings, Index. Catalogue

, 1881, ii. p. 40; 1891. xii. p. 189 (calls him Maugin). - Kopp, Die Alchemie 1886, ii. p. 340 (calls him Mauguin). [

on relèvera pour les impétrants une confusion à éviter avec Manget, auteur de la compilation intitulée Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa

; notez que le Livre Secret d'Artephius (7

), le Livre des Figures Hiéroglyphiques (9) et le Livre de Synesius (8

) ont été publiés conjointement en français - latin - 1612, 1659 et 1682 - sous le titre générique :

Philosophie Naturelle de Troiz Anciens Philosophes Renommez , etc. - cf. Chevreul critique d'Artephius - et en anglais en 1624.]

frontispice de la Bibliothèque des Philosophes Chimiques, tome I, Cailleau, 1741 Volume I. Avertissement et préface [

which contains a section on the Truth of the Science, and another on the Obscurity of the Philosophers .] 1. Hermès: La Table d' Emeraude , avec le Commentaire de l'Hortulain. p. 1 2. Hermès: Les Sept Chapitres . p. 16 3. Le Dialogue de Marie & d' Aros , sur le Magistére d'Hermès. p. 77

4. Geber, La Somme de la Perfection. p. 85 Volume II. 5. La Tourbe des Philosophes . p. 1 6.

Entretien du Roi Calid et du Philosophe Morien , sur le Magistere d'Hermès. p. 56 7. Artephius, Le Livre . p. 112 8. Synesius, Le Livre . p. 175 9.

Flamel, L'explication des Figures Hyérogliphiques . p. 195 10. Flamel, Le Sommaire philosophique. p. 263 11. Flamel, Le Désir désiré . p. 285 12. Trévisan, Le

Livre de la Philosophie Naturelle des Métaux . p. 325 13. La parole délaissée . p. 400 14. Le Songe Verd . p. 437 Volume III. 15.

Basile Valentin, Les douze clefs de Philosophie . p. 1

16. Basile Valentin, L'Azoth, ou le Moyen de faire l'or caché des Philosophes. p. 84 [

le traité est apocryphe et le titre exact est : Aureliae Occultae Philosophorum , cf. Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa , vol. II, p. 198]

17. L'Ancienne Guerre des Chevaliers, ou le Triomphe Hermétique [Limojon de Saint Didier.] p. 181 18. La Lumiere sortant par soi-meme des

Ténèbres, poème sur la Composition de la Pierre des Philosophes, traduit de l'Italien, avec un Commentaire. p. 322 [

Ferguson : The original Italian poem is in three Canzoni of 7, 8, and 10 stanzas respectively, and the title runs:

" A i veri Sapienti si discorre teoricamente sopra la compositione della pietra de Philosophi: di Fra Marc-Antonio Crassellame Chinese. I do not know if it was published separately, but it was printed face to face with the French translation. The commentator, describing his long continued labour in trying to understand the writings of the

philosophers, says that an anonymous MS. in Italian fell into his hands and, finding it skilfully written, he translated it and added an exposition so that its light should be diffused as widely as possible. Of the author he knew nothing except his anagram, so that the name appears to be a made up one. The Commentary was apparently written in Latin, but this version I have not seen. It was translated into French, with the Italian poem included, and was published with the title: La Lumiere sortant par soy meme des Tenebres ou veritable theorie de la Pierre des Philosophes . . . Paris. L. d'Houry, 1687. » 12°. The second edition "

reveue et augmentee de CLIII. aphorismes chymiques," was published by d'Houry at Paris in 1692, 12°. I have not seen it. The translator says that he knows nothing about the author. The translation and commentary, but not the Italian, were reprinted by Richebourg (q.v.). The treatise is referred to by Tollius with grate. ful thanks to the learned translator, and the author is called by him Frater Antonius Crasselamius.

The present German version is from the French, but seemingly not from the edition of 1687. For instead of giving the assigned author's name as it appears there, the German translator, C. F. K., quotes it from Tollius and at the same time transcribes it incorrectly as " Marcus Antoninus Crastalamius." Both translations are included by Kopp among

alchemical books with ' light' for their title, but he has not noticed that one is translated from the other, and he makes no allusion either to the Italian verses or the reputed author.] Volume IV. 19.

Philalèthe, Traité de l'Entrée Ouverte du Palais fermé du roi. p. 1

20. Philalèthe, Explication de ce Traité. p. 121 21. Philalèthe (Irénée),

Expériences sur l'Opération du Mercure philosophique . p. 138

22. Philalèthe (Irénée), Explication de la lettre de Georges Riplée, à Edouard IV. p. 148

23. Philalèthe, principes, pour la Conduite de l'Oeuvre hermétique. p. 174 24.

L'Arche ouverte, ou la Cassette du petit Paysan . p. 186 [

ce traité est de Grasseus ou Grasshoff. Voici des notes de Ferguson :

Johann Grasshoff, a native of Pomerania, doctor of laws, Syndic of Stralsund, and afterwards councillor of Ernest, archbishop and elector of Cologne, wrote partly anonymously, but also under the names Grassaeus (Crasseus, Grossaeus), Chortolasseus and Hermannus Condeesyanus. Of his chief work, " Der kleineBauer

," a good many editions are mentioned, Franckfurt, 1617, 1623, Breslau, 1658, Leipzig, 1658, Halle, 1705, Hamburg, 1705, in addition to the above. Other works ascribed to him are: Dyas chymica tripartita , Franckfurt, 1625, 4°;

Harmoniae imperscrutabilis chemico-philosophica

. Ibid. 1625, 8°, but the Harmonia is also assigned to Rhenanus. Latterly he lived privately in Livona. and died at Riga, according to Witte's conjecture. - on trouvera ce traité dans la Bibliotheca Chemica curiosa , vol. I, p. 585 et dans le Theatrum Chemicum , vol VI, p. 294 .]

25. Philippe Rouillac, Abrégé du grand Oeuvre des Philosophes. p. 234

frontispice de la Bibliothèque des Philosophes Chimiques, seconde partie, Cailleau, 1754 PARTIE ii 26. Raymund Lull, L' Elucidation ou l'Eclaircissement du Testament. p. 297 27.

Esprit Gobineau de Montluisant, Explication des Enigmes et Figures hierogliphiques, qui sont au grand Portail de l'Eglise . . . de Notre Dame de Paris. p. 307 28. Le Pseautier d'Hermophile , envoyé a Philalèthe. p. 394

29. Traité d'un Philosophe inconnu, sur l'oeuvre Hermétique, revu & élucidé par le Disciple Sophisée. p. 461

30. Lettre Philosophique de Philovite à Héliodore. p. 511

31. Préceptes et instructions du Pere Abraham à son fils contenant la vraie Sagesse hermétique traduits de l'Arabe. p. 552 32.

Wenceslaus Lavinius: Traité du Ciel terrestre . p. 566

33. Dictionnaire Abrégé des Termes de l'Art & des anciens Mots. p. 570 2)- De alchemia . Petreus, Nurnberg. 1545 frontispice de l' Alchemiae Gebri

, Excusum Bernae Helveticae per Mathiam Apiarium, sumptu & expensis honesti viri, Joannis Petrei, Norimbergensis typographi (Berna), 1545 Ferguson

sur le personnage demi-chimérique de Geber : Hitherto it has been the custom, though not a universal one, to identify Geber with the Arabian alchemist Dschabir Ben Hayyan. If this be correct all that is necessary if to produce proof of the identity by exhibiting the connection of their respective writings. Then what is known of the biography of the Arabian will of course serve for that of Geber. The results of investigation so far have not led to say satisfactory result, for there are several different notices of Dschabir which do not agree, and which have caused Hammer-Purgstall to say that his biography is overshadowed by considerable contradiction and obscurity, and have led Steinschneider to call him an almost mythical personage. There seems, however, to be no reason for doubting that he lived and wrote the alchemical treatises enumerated in some Ambic book; of reference. According to the Kilab-al-Fihrist

(10th century) he was born at Tarsus, lived at Damascus and as Kufa, and died A.H. 160, that is A.D. 776 - 777. Other accounts which make him a native of Harran and flourishing in the third century of the Hegira, or an apostate Greek, or a native of Spain, have not the authority of the narrative in the Fihrist which is adopted by Hammer-Purgstall. According to native accounts he was a voluminous writer, and did not confine himself by any means to alchemy. His writings on this subject have been long known by MSS. in Arabic preserved at Leyden and Paris, and probably in other libraries. The contents of these MSS. however were not readily accessible until they were published by Berthelot in 1893. [cf. Idée alchimique I , II et VI . Cf. Origines de l'Alchimie et Chimie des Anciens .

] As a result of his examination of them Berthetot has come to the conclusion that the Latin works of Geber have nothing really to do with the Arabic works of Dschabir, but that they are considerably later. If this view be correct it opens up an entirely new question, for if we know but little about Dschabir, of Geber we know nothing at all, except that he cannot be later than the fourteenth century, seeing that his raffle occurs in MSS. of that date. But to his nationality, to his exact date, to the origin

of his name, there is no clue, and a still more difficult thing to account for is the clearness of the writings ascribed to him as compared with those of afs presumed contemporaries and of many of those in succeeding centuries. The earliest printed work with a date bearing Geber's name is entitled Flos Naturarum

. There was a copy in the Pinelli collection, exemplar nitidissimum

, as it is called, but the date is misprinted ; 'III. Nonas Augusti.

' A copy is mentioned in the catalogue of the Musco Borbonico, and there was one in Count Mac-Carthy's sale which brought 51 fr. There was formerly one in the Ste Geneviève Library at Paris, but it has been missing for a long time. The description given by Ham is merely copied from that in the Pinelli Catalogue, for he repeats the mistake in the date. He never saw a copy, and the book is passed over by Copinger, so that neither has ho come across a copy anywhere. It is quoted by Denis, Maittaire, Panzer, Brunet, And Graesse but they give no definite information about it. The book is a small 4°, without place or printer's name, but printed in Italy. It is in Roman letter, 24 lines to the page. and the copy before me has 16 leaves. The book has no signatures, catchwords, or numbers. The colophon, printed in capitals, runs thus:

Opus Maximi Philosophi | Ac Regis Indiae Ge| beri Foeliciter | Hic Comple | tum Est Ac | Impres | sum | Anno lesu Christi. M.CCCC | LXXIII. IIII. Nonas Augusti. |

Two or three of the paragraphs refer to alchemy, but the bulk of the book consists of 'secrets' based on the 'occult' properties of certain substances, and it closely resembles the style of the 'Magic of Kiranus.' There can be no doubt that this is one of the very rarest of books. The chemical writing's of Geber, with which the preceding has nothing to do, passed through a number of editions. Besides those in the present collection there are the following. The first is in Roman letter, printed between 1470 - 1480 (B. M. says Rome, 1473), without number or mark of any kind. It contains ff. 122, 25 - 26 lines to the page. It is called a 4°, but the copy before me has the original manuscript signatures, and they

are in eights; Rome, printed from a MS. in the Vatican by Marcellus Silber, no date, 1490 - 1520, in small square 8°, of which there were two issues at least; Strasburg, 1528, 1529, 1530 (?), 1531, all in folio; Nuremberg, 1541

, 4° (with other works); Venice, 1542, 8°; Nuremberg, 1545, 4° (with Other works); (1562 ?); Basel, 1572, 8°; Strasburg, 1598. 8° (1649, i2°); (1670 ?). These are in Latin. The German translation primed in the same style, and with the same illustrations as in the Latin, Strasburg. 1529, 1530, folio; (1581 ?); 1625, 8°; Frankfurt, 1710, 8°; Vienna, 1753, 8°. There are two translations in. English, that by Richard Russell, London, 1678, and with a new title-page, 1686; Salmon's version, 1692 (as above). The French version was not printed by itself, but in the Bibliothèque

, 1672, 1678, 1741. Besides these printed editions I have met with several us. copies both on paper and vellum, of various dates, some of them as early as the fourteenth century. They are all in Latin, except one in Italian, in which language, so far as I am aware, there is no printed edition. Numbers of mss. are preserved in the large libraries. illustrations tirées de cet ouvrage (p. xx) : 1 (84) - 2 (88 -

De Sublimatione Mercurii sine Argenti vivi) - 3 (95 -

De Sublimatione Magnesiae & Tutiae, item corporum imperfectorum, & de additione materiae sublevantis ea) - 4 (99) - 5 (104) - 6 (111 - De Solutione) - 7 (114 -

De coagulatione & eius causis ... divertis modis coagulandi Mercurii, & medicinarum solutarum.) - 8 (120) - 9 (122) - 10 (231 - De furno sublimatorio

) - 11 (231 - l'image est identique à celle de la page 111, image 6) - 12 (232 - idem pour la page 84, image 1) - 13 (233 - De Furno distillatorio - idem pour la page 104, image 5) - 14 (235 - De Furno fusorio) -

1. Geber. De investigatione perfectionis metallorum, Liber I. p. 1

2. Geber. Summæ perfectionis metallorum, sive perfecti magisterij, Libri II. p. 16

3. Geber. De inventione veritatis seu perfectionis metallorum. Liber I. p. 165

4. Geber. De fornacibus construendis. Liber I. p. 184 5. Speculum alchemi, Rogerij Bachonis . p. 208

6. Correctorium alchemiæ Richardi Anglici. p. 220

7. Rosarius minor, de alchemia, incerti authoris. p. 250

8. Liber secretorum alchemiæ Calidis filij Iazichi Iudæi. p. 274 9. Tabula smaragdina de alchemia , Hermetis Trismeg. p. 294 10. Hortulani philosophi

, super Tabulam smaragdinam Hermetis commentarius. p. 295 2 bis : Practica vera alkimia -

In hoc volumine de alchemia continentur haec .

Gebri Arabis philosophi solertissimi, rerumq[ue] naturallum, praecipue metallicarum peritissimi.

frontispice du De Alchemia Gebri, Nuremberg, 1541

On lira avec intérêt ces notes de Ferguson concernant ces deux traités, semblables pour le fond, datant de 1541 et de 1545 et surtout, les controverses autour de l'origine du mystérieux auteur du Commentaire à la Table d'Emeraude . Ferguson : The present edition of 1541

is of importance, for it was the first both of the Tabula Smaragdina of Hermes and of the Commentariolus written by Hortulanus to elucidate it, The whole book appeared again in 1545

with a new title: Alchemiae Gebri Arabis philosophi solertissimi, Libri, cum Reliquis, ut uersa pagella indicabit. Ioan: Petreius Nurembergett. denuo Bernae excudi faciebat. Anno M.D.XLV., 4°, pp. [16] 302 [2]. It has an elaborate ornamental title-page.. It was printed at Berne by Mathias Apiarius at the expense of Petreius, and is a reprint of the previous edition. The Commentariolus begins on p. 295. So far as I

have observed hardly anyone who has discussed the question in connection either with Hortulanus or Garland has taken notice of these two earliest editions of the commentary, but has quoted only those of 1560 and 1571. These may now be described. The 1560 edition has this title:

Compendium Alchemiae. loannis Garlandii Angli philosophi doctissimi: cum Dictionario eiusdem artis, atque de metallorum tinctura praeparatio neq: eorundem Libello, ante annos DXX. [A.D. 1040] eodem authore conscripto. Adiecimus eiusdem compendij per Arnoldum de Villanova

explicationem. Cum tractatu de Salium Aluminumque varietate, compositione & usu, Scriptoris incerti. Omnia nunc primum in lucem edita. Basileae Anno M.D.LX. The contents are as follows:

1- Praefacio to Melchior, Bishop of Basel, by Basilius Joannes Herold. : loannis Garlandii Angli Philosophi doctissimi

2- Compendium Alchimie sive in tabulam Smaragdinam Hermetis Trismegisti peri chmeiaV Commentarij, p. 1 - Praecatio, p. 1 - Tabula Smaragdina, p. 2. - Commentarij. p. 5.

3- Arnoldus de Villanova, in commentarios Hortulani expositio, p. 33.

4- Joannes Garlandius, Synonymorum in arte alchimistica expositio, p. 53.

5- Joannes Garlandius, De praeparatione Elixir libellus, p. 72.

6- Joannes Garlandius, De Mineralibus liber, p. 93. 7- Joannis Garlandij vita, p. 172.

At the end of the life is a list of Garland's works taken from Bostonus Buriensis, in which appears the title: Ortolanus, Lib. i., followed by the words: ' Laus, honor, virtus & gloria.' This is merely the present commentary to which Boston has erroneously given the name of the author, and the four words fonn the opening of Hortulanus' 'Praecatio' with which the commentary begins. The 1571 edition is a reprint of that of 1560, but differs from it in the title and other particulars;

Laurentii Venturae Veneti, Artium et Medicinae Doct .De Ratione conficiendi Lapidis philosophici, liber unus. Ad Othonem Henricum Principem

Palatinum. Huic accesserunt eiusdem argumenti loan. Garlandij Angli liber unus. Et ex speculo magno Vinccntij libri duo. Cum Privilegio Caesar. Maiest. Basileae M.D.LXXI.

8 vo. pp. [16] 203 [19, 2 blank]; 121 [7. 2 blank]; 173 [1 blank]. The contents of Part I. are as follows:

- Epistle to Count Otho Heinrich, dated: Venet. Idibus Maij, 1557. The printer to the reader. The contents, - Liber de Alchimia, p. 1.

- AEnigma della pietra phisica di Lorenzo Ventura, &c., p. 200. - Index. Part II. contains the following:

- Joannis Garlendii Angli Philosophi doctissimi Compendium Alchimiae, siue in tabulam Smaragdinam Hermetis Trismegisti peri chmeiaV Commentarij, p. i.

- Arnoldus de Villanova, In Commentarios Hortulani Expositio, p. 23.

- Joannes Garlandius Anglus, Synonymorum in arte Alchimistica expositio, p. 36.

- Garlandius: De preparatione Elixir libellus, Garlandius: De Mineralibus liber, p. 67,

- Jonnnis Garlandij philosophi excellentissimi Vita, p.120.

- Leonardi Proebstelij Carmen, p. [122]. - Summa Capitum, pp. [124-128].

The ' Summa' is new, but Herold's ' Praefatio' is omitted.

Part III. consists of articles taken from the Speculum majus of Vincentus and others.

Except Mansi, those who have quoted this reprint refer to it as if it were a separate publication and had not appeared under the title of another work. If there be a separate edition of 1571, which is quite possible, I

have not seen it. The commentary is the same in both these editions, so that the distinction drawn between them by Dom Rivet, namely that the edition of 1560 is an abridgement of that of 1571, made by the author himself or by some other person subsequently, has not only no foundation in fact, leaving the dates out of the question, but has not even any support from the actual titles. Dom Rivet, however, took his description not from copies of the books, but from the entries in Lipenius and the Bibliotheca Barberiana, 1681, p. 453, 2. The only difference is in the first chapter, which in the 1560 edition Is lengthened by the insertion of the 'Tabula Smaragdina,' omitted in the 1571 edition. In every other respect the two issues are identical. So far as I know these books also are rare. When the 1541

and 1560 editions are compared with each other there are several points of difference to be observed. 1. The title. 2. The introduction of Garland's name. 3. The additional tracts.

4. The statement that the edition of 1560 is the first. 5. The differences in the two versions.

1 and 2. It will be noticed that the phrase ' Compendium Alchymiae' and Garland's name do not occur in the titles of the earlier editions, but were introduced by Herold either of his own initiative, or, more probably, front the manuscript he used, while that of Hortulanus has disappeared from the 1560 and 1571 editions.

3. As to the additional tracts they do not occur in the editiom of 1541 and 1545

, and they are assigned not to Hortulanus, but to Garland. That they are by him is a question of evidence, but their authenticity has been categorically denied by Haureau.

4. The statement that the edition of 1560 is the first, signifies: either that Herold did not know the editions of 1541 and 1545, which seems unlikely, or that be meant that the version of Hortulanus' Commentary, which he was giving, as well as the other tracts were now printing for the first time, and in this sense he may have been correct, as will be seen

from the following.

5. The differences between the earlier and later editions are well marked. There are thirteen chapters in the editions of 1541 and 1545 as against twenty-one in those of 1560 and 1571. There are different readings throughout and different arrangement of words, and in the 1560 and 1571 editions chapter v. has an introductory part which is not contained In the previous editions. As an illustration of the differences the opening words, of Hortulanus' 'Praefatio' may be given. In the 1541 edition they are: Ego dictus Hortulanus, ab hortis maritimis nuncupatus, pelle Jacobina inuolutus, indignus uocari discipulus philosophiae' . . . In the 1560 edition: Ego quidem Hortulanus, ab horto, vel ab arce maritima dictus, Jacobina pelle inuolutus, nouissimus philosophorum, indignus vocari discipulus philosophiae' . . . It may be inferred, therefore, that the editors of the two editions drew from different manuscript sources, and this is confirmed by Herold giving on the margin of his edition a few various readings which happen with one exception to be those of the edition of 1541

. The existence of these two different printed versions has not, so far as I am aware, been noticed or mentioned before. The authorship of the 'Commentariolus' has given rise to some diversity of opinion. Most of the older writers have accepted toe identity of Garlandia and Hortulanus without criticism, though they are not unanimous as to the date at which he flourished. Recent researches have settled that John de Garlandia, a native of England, resident in France, poet, musician, mathematician, grammarian, was born in the latter half of the twelfth and lived on to the middle of the thirteenth century, and was thus a senior contemporary of the scholars who have made this period conspicuous in the annals of learning. On the ground of identity this would be the date also of Hortulanus. Fabricius, however, did not admit it and Kopp has made the remark that the question was not to be so readily answered as Morhof appeared to think. More recently still, Haureau, who in 1879 corrected the patent misconceptions of Dom Rivet about the editions, alluded to above, has denied altogether that Garland had anything to do with

alchemy, and has rejected the works on the subject attributed to him. Influenced by certain manuscripts he is of opinion that Hortulanus is the same as a person called in them Martinus Ortholanus, who wrote a treatise which is contained in the Theatrum Chemicum (see ORTHOLANUS) and is dated 1358. If there be doubt about the connexion of Hortulanus and Garlandia, there is equal if not more about the existence of Marlinus Ortholanus. That the name occurs in manuscripts is hardly sufficient to establish the existence of the person. For, in a manuscript at St. Gallen of the fourteenth century, referred to by Kopp (Beitrage, 1860. p. 381), the opening of the 'Praefatio' runs thus: Ego a. dictus Ortulanus ab ortis Martini nuncupatus, &c., instead of 'ab hortis maritimis.' That one of these leadings is an error of transcription is pretty obvious. The meaning in either case is somewhat obscure, but it would not take much effort on the part of a possibly puzzled scribe to convert Ortulanus, ab ortis Martini' into 'Martinus Ortulanus.' All this is a matter for investigation, and anyhow it would be premature to assign the 'Commentariolus' of Hortulanus to a Martin Ortolan or Lortholain, about whom Haureau admits that he had no lasting fame, or, it would be more correct to say, had none at all. While something has been said in support of the various opinions, no argument sufficiently cogent and conclusive has been put forward to induce belief that the problem of authorship hits been solved. As to the 'expositio' assigned to Arnoldus de Villanova, its authenticity, other things being equal, must obviously depend on the date fixed for Hortulanus. If he be identical with Garlandia the exposition could quite well be by Arnoldus, who flourished in the latter part of the thirteenth century. But if he be the same as Ortholanus and lived in the fourteenth century or later, the exposition could not be by Arnoldus, and Haureau in his dissertation on Arnoldus, quite logically considers it not to be by him. Kopp, too, has pointed out that this 'expositio' does not appear in any list of Amoldus' writings, so that apart from the date, it is possibly not a genuine writing of Arnoldus. Dom Rivet speaks of a treatise: La clef de l'abrégé, of which there is a manuscript 'à l'abbaie des Dunes.' Can this be a translation of the 'expositio' ? The Commentary was often

printed and it was translated into English, French, and German. The translation into English was made from the 1541 text [

notons que le texte anglais ne reproduit pas l'erreur du texte français, c'est-à-dire de reproduire meditatione mais bien mediatione

ce qui change tout, puisque « méditation » devient « médiation ». Il est remarquable d'observer que Hoefer et Fulcanelli donnent la version « médiation » là où Chevreul donne « méditation » , cf. Table d'Emeraude

], and was printed along with Roger Bachon's The Mirror of Alchimy, London, 1597, pp. 17-27. The French translation was also made from the 1541 text, and was published alone with Le Miroir d'Alquimie de Rogier Bacon, Lyons, 1557, pp. 30-56. The German version by Johann Schauberdt is appended to Pantheus' Vorarchadumia (sic), Magdeburg, 1600, 1608. As it is somewhat difficult to disjoin Hortulanus and Garland some of the following references apply to both and some to the two individually. Reference may be made also to ORTHOLANUS, where the connection with Hortulanus is further considered.

1. De inuestigatio[n]e p[er]fectionis metallor[um]. Liber I. f. 1

2. Summae perfectionis metallorum, siue perfecti magisterij. Libri II... f. 20 [Libro Primo] - f. 126 [Libro Secundo]

3. Eiusdem de inuentione ueritatis seu perfectionis metalloru. Liber I. f. 206

4. De fornacibus construendis. Liber I. f. 229 Item. 5. Speculum alchemiae ... Rogerij Bachonis. f. 257

6. Correctorium alchemiae... Richardi Anglici. f. 272

7. Rosarius minor, de alchemia, incerti authoris. f. 309

8. Liber secretorum alchemiae Calidis filij Iazichi Iudaei. f. 336 9. Tabula smaragdina de alchemia, Hermetis Trismeg. f. 363 10. Hortulani philosophi, super tabulam smaragdinam Hermetis commentarius. f. 364 3)- Theatrum Chemicum

Theatrum chemicum, præcipuos selectorum auctorum tractatus de chemiæ et lapidis philosophici antiquitate, veritate, jure, præstantia et operationibus, continens In gratiam Verae Chemiae, & medicinae Chemicae studiosorum (ut qui uberrimam inde optimorum remediorum messem facere poterunt) congestum, & in Sex partes seu volumina digestum; Singulis voluminibus, suo Auctorum et Librorum Catalogo primis pagellis: rerum vero & verborum Indice postremis annexo. Heredum Eberh. Zetzneri M.DC.LIX. . . . Volumen Primum . Argentorati Sumptibus Heredum Eberh. Zetzneri M.DC.LIX.

8°. Pp.794. Index [30]. Woodcuts in the text. . . . Volumen Secundum .

8°. Pp. 549. Index [7]. 1 folding table. Woodcuts to the text. . . . Volumen Tertium .

8°. Pp. 859. Index [13]. 1 folding table. Woodcuts in the text. . . . Volumen Quartum .

8°. Pp. [8] 1014. Index [33] [1 blank]. 4 folding tables. Woodcuts in the text. . . . Volumen Quintum , M.DC.LX.

8°. Pp. [8] 912. Index [29, 3 blank]. A woodcut in the text. Theatri Chemici Volumen Sextum

, Theologis, Medicis, et tam Vulgaribus quam Hermeticae, Chemiae Studiosis utilissimum, Praecipuos Selectorum Auctorum huius Seculi Tractatus de Chemia & Lapidis Philosophici Antiquitate, veritate Jure praestantia & operationibus continens, ex Germanica & Gallica lingua io Latinam translatum per Johannem Jacobum Heilmannum Bipontino-Palatinum M.D. Argentorati, Sumptib. Haeredum Eberhardi Zetzneri , M.DC.LXI.

8°. Pp. [18] 773 [25, 1 blank]. Woodcuts in the text. Volumes I - II - III - IV

:- Zetzner, Ursel. 1602. (Reprinted in 1659 by Zetzner in Strasburg). -Volume V :- Zetzner, Strassburg, 1622. -Volume VI :- Zetzner, Strassburg, 1661. Ferguson :The THEATRUM CHEMICUM

made its first appearance at Ursel, 1602, in four volumes. Just a century before the collection of Manget. It was reissued at Strasburg in 1613, in four volumes; a fifth volume was added in 1622, after which came the present edition of 1659 -1661. A list of the tracts to the first four volumes of the ' Theatrum Chemicum

,' arranged alphabetically with those in Manget's ' Bibliotheca

' in parallel columns, was published by Fabricius. It is thus possible to ascertain easily the writings which occur in both collections, as well as those to be found in only one of them. To complete the survey the contents of the fifth and sixth volumes of the ' Theatrum

' would require to be incorporated with Fabridus' list. Collections of alchemical tracts by various authors were made at a comparatively early period, for the Greek manuscripts which remain consist of treatises by different persons, varying in number from four to forty-three. A similar fashion seems to have been followed in the fourteenth century, when works translated from Eastern originals were gathered together. A manuscript of such a collection to referred to by Wood Brown, and it is quite possible, as he suggests, that such manuscripts were laid under contribution by the editors of the printed collections which we now possess. There is, therefore, some ground for believing that, while the greater part of the ' Theatrum Chemicum

' is recent, a tract here and there may belong to the time when alchemy was first introduced into Europe. The earliest of the quite modem collections is probably that entitled: ' De Alchemia

.' Norimbergae, 1541, containing the tracts of Geber and others, of which a new edition appeared in 1545. Then came another; ' De Alchemia Opuscula ,' Francoforti, 1550, after which was Gratarolo

's big gathering in 1561, reprinted in part by Perna at Basel, in 1573. This same year Perna published another volume called ' Auriferae Artis . . .Authores

,' which was reprinted by Waldkirch at Basel in 1593, a new edition appearing there in 1610 (q.v.). The Ars Aurifera

was translated into German by Morgenstern, and printed at Basel in 1613. The French collection, by Sieur S., appeared in 1672 - 1678; Salmon's, of half-a-dozen tracts, in English, in 1692; Manget's ' Bibliotheca

' in 1702, followed by Horlacher's abridgement In 1707; a new French collection by Richebourg in 1740, and a reprint of the German in 1750. These are the most comprehensive collections, but there were a good many others containing from two to seven or more tracts. An enumeration of these is made by Kopp.

Zetzner Lazarus : A printer at Strasburg In the first half of the seventeenth century, who printed many books, but I cannot say that those which I have seen impress me favourably as specimens of the typographic art. Still he is commended as a craftsman who deserves to be kept in remembrance. The present collection is a monument of his belief in the ' great work,' or in the literature of it. rather than of his taste as a printer. Perhaps one ought to admire his courage in collecting, reprinting and editing the tracts in this collection, instead of complaining of the undoubtedly shabby and unattractive appearance of the volumes. sources : Borel, Bibliotheca Chimica

, 1654, p. 217 (1613 edition in five volumes). - Fabricius, Bibliotheca Graeca , Hamburgl, 1724, xii. pp. 714-723. -

Beytrag zur Geschichte der höhern Chemie

, 1785, pp. 585 (edition of 1602), 596 (editions of 1613 - 1622, 1658 - 1661). - Ladrague, Bibliothèque Ouvaroff

, Sciences Secrètes, 1870, No. 603. - Kopp, Die Alchemie , 1886, ii. p. 341. J. Wood Brown,

An Enquiry into the Life and Legend of Michael Scot , 1897, pp. 76 - 77. Theatrum Chemicum , volumen primum, 1659 Volume I.

1. Robertus Vallensis. De veritate & antiquitate artis Chemicæ & pulveris sive Medicinæ philosophorum vel auri potabilis, testimonia & theoremata ex variis auctoribus, p.1

2. Libellus qui Testamentum Arnaldi a Villa Nova inscribitur, p. 28

3. Johannes Chrysippus Fanianus, De Arte metallicæ metamorphoseos, p. 31

4. Johannes Chrysippus Fanianus, De Jure Artis Alchemiæ, hoc est, variorum authorum & præsertim Iuris consultorum judicia & responsa ad quæstionem quotidianam p. 48

5. Thomas Mufett. Dialogus Apologeticus de jure et præstantia Chemicorum Medicamentorum, p.70.

6. Thomas Mufett. Epistolæ quinque medicinales. p. 89

7. Theobaldus de Hoghelande Mittelburgensis. De Alchemiae difficultatibus. p. 109

8. Gerardus Dorneus. Clavis totius philosophiæ chemisticæ per quam potissima philosophorum dicta reserantur. p. 192

9. Gerardus Dorneus. Liber Naturæ luce physica, ex Genesi desumta in quo continetur, Physica Genesis (p. 333) ; Physica Hermetis Trismegisti, Tabula Smaragdina (p. 362) ; Physica Trithemii (p. 388) ; Philosophia Meditativa (p. 399) ; Philosophia Chemica. (p. 418) p. 326

10. Gerardus Dorneus. Tractatus Alter. De Tenebris contra naturam et vita brevis (p. 457) - De Duello animi cum corpore (p. 472) - De Lapidum preciosorum structura - p. 485.

11. Gerardus Dorneus. Congeries Paracelsicæ Chemiae de transmutationibus metallorum. p. 491

12. Gerardus Dorneus. De genealogia Mineralium atque metallorum omnium. p. 568 Ferguson : Trevisanus de Chymico Miraculo

quod Lapidem Philosophiae appellant. Dionys. Zecharius Gallus de eodem. Auctoritatibus varijs Principum huius artis, Democriti, Gebri, Lullii, Villanovani, confirmati & illustrati per Gerardum Dorneum. Cum

Gratia & Priuilegio Caes. Maiest. Basileae, Typis Conradi Waldkirchii. Anno clc lcc.

frontispice du Trevisanus de Chymico Miraculo, Basilae, 1583

8°. Pp. [5, i blank] 198 [4 blank]The tracts in this collection are the following:

- BernhardusTrevisanus, De Alchimia Liber, p. 1. - Dionysius Zecharius,

Opusculum Philosophiae Naturalis Metallorum , p. 49.

- Annotate quaedam ex Nicolao Flamello, p. 117.

- Testamentum Arnaldi Villanovani, p. 126.

- Aliae quaedam Annotationes ex variis authoribus, p. 127.

- Collectanea quaedam ex antiquis Scriptoribus, p. 152. - Collectanea ex Democrito, p. 167.

- Summaria Declaratio eorum, quae dicta sunt hactenus ex Democrito, per aenigmata, p. 194.

The first edition is that of Basel, 1583, 8°. This collection was reprinted in the Theatrum Chemicum

, 1602, i. pp. 773-901, and again in 1659, i. pp. 683-794

; but although in the table of contents they are run together inaccurately, the mistake is not made in the book itself of deliber-ately describing the Annotata ex Flamello as if they formed a commentary on Denis Zachaire's tract. Gmelin (Geschichte der Chemie

, 1799, i. pp. 60-61) seems to have misunderstood the title of the tract as given both in this Collection (p. 117) and in the Theatrum Chemicum

, i. p. 748. The error was apparently introduced by Manget, of entering Flamels Annotata as if they were written upon Denis Zachaire. See note on Zachaire. Gerard Dorn flourished in the latter half of the XVI. century at Frankfurt a. M. He was a devoted adherent of Paracelsus and defended him from the attacks of Erastus and others, while he himself had a controversy with Jacques Gohory. He translated several of the

works of Paracelsus into Latin, wad besides those in the present collection wrote a good many others. [Dans son Histoire de la Médecine

, vol. III, p. 341, Kurt Sprengel dit ceci de Dorneus : «

Gérard Dorn, médecin à Francfort sur le Mein, s'est fait beaucoup conaître par son atachement à Paracelse. Il était entièrement animé de l'esprit de son maître : la cabale passait à ses yeux pour la source de toutes les connaissances humaines, et il préférait Trithemius à tous les philosophes. Sa grossièreté nele cédait en rien à celle de Paracelse, et il accablait d'injures tous ses antagonistes. En sa qualité d'adepte, il ne lui fallait que quinze mois pour préparer la pierre philosophale, tandis que tous les autres consacraient deux années à ce travail - Lapis metaphysicus aut philosophicus, in-8°, 1570 -. Il dérivait la chimie entière des premiers chapitres du premier livre de Moïse, dont il expliquait alchimiquement les mots. Ces paroles surtout : Dieu sépara l'eau qui est sur la terre de celle qui est au-dessous, et nomma la première Firmament, lui paraissaient renfermer l'idée du grand oeuvre. En même temps il accumulait des explications tirées de la philosophie des nouveaux platoniciens, ce qui donne à son livre un aspect si bizarre, qu'il serait difficile d'imaginer un galimatias plus savant - De naturae luce physicâ ex Gensi desumtâ, in-8°, Francof. 1583, p. 47. Il publia aussi contre Thomas Eraste, le plus ardent ennemi de Paracelse, un écrit polémique, qui n'est autre chose qu'un extrait des invectives auxquelles son maître lui-même s'était abandonné - Ad Thom. Erastum admonitio modesta satis, in-8°, 1583 »]

13. Bernardus G. Penotus. De vera praeparatione & usu Medicamentorum Chemicorum, Tractatus varii. p. 592

- Precatio Raymundi Lullii ante medicinarum exhibitionem, p. 682.

14. Bernardus Trevisanus, De Chemico miraculo, quod lapidem philosophiae appellant [sive De Alchemia Liber], p. 683. 15. Dionysius Zacharias.

Opusculum philosophiæ naturalis metallorum . p. 710

16. Annotata quædam ex Nicolao Flamello (Summarium philosophicum). p. 748

- Aliae quaedam annotationes ex variis auctoribus, p. 754. - Collectanea ex Democrito, p. 776.

- Summaria Declaratio eorum, quaa dicta sunt hactenus ex Democrito, per aenigmata, p. 792. Theatrum Chemicum , volumen secundum, 1613 Volume II.

17. Bernardus G. Penotus. Præfatio, p. 4.

18. Gaston Claveus. Apologia Chrysopæia & Argyropoeiæ adversus Thomam Erastum, p. 6.

19. Bernardus G. Penotus. Præfatio p. 81.

20. Ægidius de Vadis. Dialogus inter naturam et filium Philosophiæ, p. 85.

21. Tabula, diversorum Metallorum vocabula, quibus usi sunt veteres ad artem celandam, explicans. Inserted after p. 109. 22. Georgius Ripleus. Duodecim portarum Epitome

, duobus modis concinnata (Axiomata Philosophica), p. 109.

23. Albertus Magnus. Compendium, De ortu & metallorum materia, supra quam Spagyricus radicalia principia fundet, p. 123.

24. Isaac Hollandus. Fragmentum de opere philosophorum, p. 126.

29. Bernardus G. Penotus. Quæstiones tres de corporali Mercurio, An arte ex corporibus perfectis extractus, suo corpori commixtus faciat ad generationem lapidis physici, sicut est quorundam firma opinio, p. 129.

30. Bernardus G. Penotus. Quinquaginta septem Canones de opere Physico, quibus ars dilucidior fit, p. 133.

31. Vera Mercurii ex auro extractio cum sua historia, p. 137.

32. Chrysorrhoas, sive de Arte Chemica Dialogus, p. 139.

33. Josephus Quercetanus. Ad Jacobi Auberti Vendonis de ortu & causis metallorum Epistolam conviciatoriam responsio, p. 150. [

Quercetanus, alias Joseph Du Chesne mérite une attention particulière parce que Fulcanelli assure que c'est le seul Adepte qui ait, avec Nicolas de Valois

, donné le nom vulgaire du Soufre rouge ou teinture... Cf. en outre ce qu'en dit Kurt Sprengel dans son Histoire de la Médecine , vol. 3 dans le commentaire à l' Aureum Seculum Redivivum d e Mynsicht]

frontispice du Ad Jacobi, etc., Quercetanus, Lugduni, 1625 - cliquez pour un portrait de Joseph Du Chesne [gravure de C. Ammon, 1652] Ferguson

: Joseph Du Chesne, or Duchesne, Latinized into Quercetanus, was born at l''Esture, or Esturre, in Armagnac, in Gascony, about 1544. Like Quattrami, he affords an instance of a person out of whose names two individuals have been constituted. He was styled Sieur da la Violelte, even Patin allows that, and Baron de Morence et d'lserable (Senebier), or Lyserable (Du Maine). Zedler, however, has drawn a distinction between Sieur de la Violelle, the chemist, who was a protestant, and had quarrels with his contemporaries, from the Baron de Morence, who lived in the sixteenth century, was the author of a surgical treatise [on gunshot wounds

, Lyons, 1576, 8°], and believed that he could discover stolen articles by the divining rod. This distinction was repeated by Gundling, but there is no authority for it from La Croix du Maine, on whom apparently Zedler relies. Of his early life there is nothing recorded, but he is said to have spent a long time in Germany, engaged especially with chemistry. But in one of the many epigrams upon him, his stay is made out to have been much shorter, Quercetanus, 'faiseur de vinaigre,' is made to give a pupil the following advice how 'to get on';

Dedans trols mois en soufflant l'AlchimIe Tu deuiendras gran docteur medicin E si pourras pour ceste soufflerie D'or e d'argent remplir un magazin.

Dehet bon cueur, sachant faire l'or fin, Autant en droit, comme en Theologie Te faut uaquer: e uerras à la fin Tes biens, ton corps, e ton

ame perie,

which presumably sums up the charges against Quercetanus, and defines we estimate which his opponent had formed of him. Du Maine is the authority for the statement that Quercetanus was physician of François de France, Duke d'Alençon, but he gives no date. He graduated at Basel about 1573, and in 1575 published his reply to Aubertus ' criticism of the chemists' theory of the origin of metals. By this work he drew upon himself both rage and ridicule. Among these attacks may be mentioned that of Fenotus:

Alexipharmacum, sive Antidotus Apologetica, ad virulentias losephi cuiusdam Quercetani Armeniaci, euomitas in libellum Jacobi Auberti, de ortu & causis Metallorum contra Chymistas. lo. Antonio Fenoto Autore, In quo, praeter quorundam

Paracelsicorum medicamentorum discussionem, omnia fere argumeta refelluntur, quibus Chymistae probare conantur, aurum argentumq; arte fieri posse. Addita est in fine Epistola M, Antiti de Cressonieres, ad eundem Quercetanum. Desinant

maledicere, malefacta ne noscant sua. Basilae»

; no date, but about 1575, 8°, pp. [10] 101 [1 blank].

Fenotus' tract is a discussion on the theory of transmutation, and is of historical interest as showing what could be said against it at the time when perhaps it was most in vogue. The epistle of Antitus de Cressonieres is written in the macaronic style, and in It Quercetanus and his alchemical views are simply laughed at. A number of epigrams follow in the same vein in Latin, French, Italian, Greek. Quercetanus was, therefore, not in favour with certain of his contemporaries. He took up his residence at Geneva, the citizenship of which was conferred upon him in 1584. Then in 1587 he was received into the Council of the Two Hundred, and, in 1589, was sent along with De Sillery and De Sancy, ambassadors from France to Switzerland, to ask assistance and to prevent the peace which the Bernese wished to conclude separately with Emmanuel Philibert, Duke of Savoy. In 1592 he helped to bring

about the terms of the peace which the Republic of Geneva made with its neighbours. Apparently, therefore, he was a person of considerable standing and influence. The year following. 1593, he went to Paris, and was appointed physician in ordinary to Henry IV and Du Verdier says that he was councillor and physician to Monseigneur, the king's only brother. As the result he acquired a wide connection, and an enhanced reputation. On the other hand it is said that his vanity and contempt of other physicians made him disliked and brought on disputes. Perhaps his attitude was not altogether without justification, when one remembers how very humble the Galenic physicians of the time were and how considerate and friendly towards the Spagyrists and Paracelsists ! Quercetanus was not prevented by criticism or controversy from advocating his views and throwing off the shackles of routine and the mere authority of names. As a chemist who had had a training which none of' the school physicians obtained, he did his best to upset the Galenic physic in France and to substitute chemical remedies. He did not succeed in introducing Paracelsus' doctrines, but he was one who helped to overthrow the ' old colossus of humorism' and to inaugurate the new epoch of iatro-chemistry. All this was, of course, obnoxious to the Paris faculty, which ' persecuted him as its most mortal foe and forbade its members to have any professional dealings with him'; he had violent controversies with Riolanus and others, and he did not hesitate to return without stint the injuries which were showered upon him. The embers of these heated discussions look a long time to cool. Years after his death he was exhumed and reviled by Gui Patin, who was a mere child of seven years of age when Quercetanus died. The whole is so characteristic that it may be quoted for Patin's benefit;

Cette meme annee (1609) Il mourut ici un mechant pendard de Charlatan, qui en a bien tue durant sa vie et apres sa mort par les malheureux ecrits qu'il nous a laisses sous son nom, qu'il a fait faire par d'autres Medeclns et Chymistes deça et de

dela. C'est Josephus Quercetanus, qui se faisoit nommer à Paris le Sieur de la Violette lequel étoit un grand Charlatan, un grand yvrogne et

un franc Ignorant, qui ne savoit rien en Latin et qui n'étant de son premier Métier, que garçon Chirurgien [à

Journeyman-barber] du Païs d'Armagnac, passa à Paris et particulièrement à la Cour pour un grand Medecin, parce qu'il avoit appris quelque chose de la Chimie en Allemagne: je ne vous dirai rien de ce Monstre davantage. . . . (N. L. i. p. 269). Metzger, who quotes this, adds: '

May not one ask Tantae ne animis Galenici irae

?' Of this piece of coarse humour parts have been reproduced in other estimates. Boerhaave calls him ' indoctus homo, et alieno calamo usus

'; Eloy says that some of his works were written for him by hired writers; and so the reports spread. He was a protestant, and that may have been the reason, says another, of Bayle's favourable notice of him. But why should Bayle be denied the right of commending one whom he thought commendable even from the alleged motive, when Gui Patin is not challenged for condemning what his biliousness made condemnable? Quercetanus was not in advance of his time to many of his doctrines: he believed In signatures; he was one of the first to give an account of the notion of palingenesis, and he accepted the philosopher's stone and transmutatlon as a matter of course. It is said that he had some glimmering idea of uric acid, and may have come across phosphorus. In certain diseases he prescribed • Mercurius dulcis,' under the name of Panchimagogue,' made up in pills known as' Pillules de M. de la Violette.' His death took place in 1609, His wife was a grand-daughter of the celebrated scholar Gulielmus Budaeus. Quercetanus' efforts were not limited to diplomacy, medicine awl controversy, but he ventured on the construction of a tragi-comedy, and composed a good many poems. The following are mentioned: "

La Morocosmie ou de la folie, vanité et inconstance du Monde ,' Lyon, 1513, 1601; ' Le grand Miroir du Monde ,' Lyon, 1584; ' Poesies chrestiennes

,' Geneva, 1594, and his poetic talent has been reckoned as of no mean order by Chéreau. Possibly his poetry has stood Time's ordeal better than either his medicine or his chemistry. Several works on medicine came from his pen, of which the following may be mentioned in addition to the above:

- Sclopetarius, sive de curandis vulneribus quos sclopetorum ictibus acciderunt, Lugd.,1576, 8°, pp. [20] 209 [1 blank] [13. 1 blank}. This was translated into French, Lyon, 1576.

- Liber de priscorum Philosophorum verae medi-cinae materia, praeparationis modo, atque in curandis morbis, praestantia. Deque simplicium, & rerum signaturis . . . duo tractatus . . . de dogmaticorum medicorum legitima, & restitua medicamentorum praeparatione, libri duo . . . consilia medica, clarissimis medicis Europaeis dicata. S. Gervasii, M.DC.III. 8°, pp. [24] 432.

- Diaeteticon Polyhistoricon. Paris, 1606, 8°; Lipsiae, 1607; excudebat David Anastasius, 1607, 8°. pp. 418 [a], without place.

- Tetras gravissimorum totius capitis affectuum, Marburgi, 1606, 8°.

- Spagirica, . . . gründliche Beschreibung der Mineralischen, Animalischen und Vegetabilischen Artzneyen, derselben rechten Gebrauch und Spagirische Bereitung, . . , durch . . . lohannem Cupium Borussum, . . . ins Deutsche transferiret. Hall, M.DC. VIII. 8°. SIgs. A to H in eights, I4. This is different from Kessler's translation above.

- Pestis Alexicacus, Paris, 1608, 4°, Lips., 1609, 8°, pp. [16] 461 [1 blank] [25, 1 blank].

- Conseils de Medecine, dediez aux plus celebres Medecins de l'Europe, Paris, 1626, 8° pp. 316 [1, 3 blank].

- Quercetanus redivivus, seu Ars medica hermetica, ex Quercetani scrlptis dIgesta opera Johan. Schrodi, Francoft, 1648, 3 vols., 4°

- Recueil des plus curieux et rares Secrets touchant la Medecine Metallique & Minerale tirez des Manuscripts, de feu Mre loseph Du Chesne, Paris, 1648, 8°, pp. (8, including an engraved title-page and

portrait] 370 [13, 1 blank]. [

ce dernier titre est disponible sur le site hermétisme et alchimie , nouvelle collection]

Two or three of his books were translated into English:

- The Sciopetarie of J. Quercetanus . . . or his booke containing the cure of Wounds received by shot of gunne or such like engines of warre. Published into English by J. Hester. London, 1590, 8°; and the edition along with Paracelsus' 'A hundred and foureteene experiments and cures,' London, 1596, small 4°, pp. [16] 82; and with Penotus, London, 1642, small 410.

- A Breefe Aunswere of losephus Quercetanus Armeniacus, Doctor of Phisick to the exposition of lacobus Aubertus Vindonis, concerning the original, and causes of metalles, set foorth against chimists. Another exquisite and plaine Treatise of the same Josephus, concerning the Spagericall preparations, and vse of minerall, animall and vegitable Medicines. Whereunto is added divers rare secretes not heeretofore knowne of many. By John Hester, practitioner in the Spagericall Arte, London, 1591, small 8*, ff. [3] 61 [5]. The second tract has a separate title-page, but the folio numbers run on consecutively.

- The Practise of Chymicall and Hermeticall Physicke for the preservation of health . . . translated by Thomas Timme. 2 parts. London, 1605, 4° ff. [5] [97].

- The method of preparing certain of big remedies is given by GREIFF (Friederich) (q.v.).

voyez encore sur Quercetanus l'introduction - sous l'angle R+C - à l' Aureum Seculum Redivivum

; il faut se garder de confondre Joseph Du Chesne, alias Quercetanus, avec Andreas Quercetanus (1584-1640) - 34. Joannes Dee. Monas Hieroglyphica , p. 192.

35. Laurentius Ventura. De Ratione conficiendi Lapidis philosophici Liber, p. 215.

36. Joannes Franc. Picus Mirandulanus. Opus Aureum de Auro, p. 312.

37. Rogerius Bacho. De Alchemia Libellus cui titulum fecit speculum Alchemiæ, p. 377.

38. Richardus Anglicus. Libellus utilissimus Peri ChmeiaV

, Cui titulum fecit Correctorium, p. 385. Ferguson

: Of Ricardus Anglicus Bale can say no more than that he is mentioned by Symphorianus Champerius as a notable physician, distinguished by his learning, skill and success; that he wrote various works on medicine and alchemy, but that the time at which he flourished was unknown to him. Gmelin places him doubtfully in the thirteenth century, Lenglet Dufresnoy says he died in 1336, which date is given by Fuchs as that at which be flourished, both borrowing from Justus. Schmieder, untrammelled by facts, has constructed a. pretty and plausible biography for him; but, as far as I know, it is purely Imaginary. Unfortunately some of it has been quoted by Kopp, and It has thereby got currency which it does not merit. Matthias's account to quite dear and succinct: Richardus Anglicus de Wendoure, Canonicus S. Pauli Londinensis, Professor Medicinae Parisinus, Archiater Gregorii IX, PP. † a. 1252.

So far as it goes this seems correct. He was the same as Richard of Wendover, who was a physician and a canon of St. Paul's, in which he held the prebend of Ealdland, about 1229. Matthew Paris says he was physician of Gregory IX., who at his death gave Richardus a crucifix with relics, which he in turn bequeathed to St. Albans. He died in 1252, leaving various bequests. There are several persons of similar name, from whom he is to be distinguished. One is Richard of Wendover, bishop of Rochester; another is Richardus Anglicus, the jurist, and still another is Richardus, a physician of Montpellier, at the beginning of the thirteenth century. He is identical with another famous physician,

Richardus Anglicanus, or Salernitanus, author of a work, ' Practica sive medicamenta ,' and ' Tractatus da Urinis

,' quoted by Gilbertus Anglicus. The chief work of Richard of Wendover is called ' Micrologus

,' a cyclopaedia. of medicine, of which parts or sections apparently exist under their special names. Numerous manuscripts of his

various works are extant in the Bibliothèque Nationale, the Bodleian, Cambridge University, and in college libraries at Oxford, and Cambridge. These are enumerated by Kingsford in his article in the Dictionary of National Biography.

As the present work is not included by him or by Littré among the works of the physician one may doubt if it be by him stall. On the other hand, Jöcher, who says be flourished to 1230, and had studied at Paris and Oxford, assigns to him De Urinis , De crisi , and other medical works, and also the Correctorium Alchymiae

. Borel ascribes to him besides the present, Rosarius minor and Speculum Alchimiae . But this seems a mistake, for the Rosarius minor is by an unknown author add the Speculum Alchimiae is by Roger Baron. The ' Correctorium ' is practically the same as the ' Correctio Fatuorum ' (g.v). 39. Libellus Alius Peri ChmeiaV

ultissimus, et rerum metallicarum cognitione refertissimus,

Rosarius Minor inscriptus, incerti quidem sed harum tamen rerum non imperiti Auctoris, p. 406.

40. Albertus Magnus. De Alchemia, p. 423.

41. Joannes Augustinus Pantheus. Ars & Theoria transmutationis metallicæ, cum Voarchadumia, numeris & iconibus rei accommodis illustrata, p. 459. Theatrum chemicum , volumen tertium, 1659 Volume III.

42. De magni lapidis compositione & operatione liber, also called De Alchemia Incerti Authoris, p. 5.

43. De eadem Materia Capita aliquot, [De Lapide Philosophico], p. 53.

44. Aristoteles. De Perfecto Magisterio, p. 76.

45. Arnaldus de Villanova. Liber Perfecti Magisterii, qui lumen luminum nuncupatur. Vocatur etiam Flos florum, p. 128.

46. Arnaldus de Villanova. Practica, ex libro dicto Breviarius librorum Alchemiæ, p. 137.

47. Arnaldus de Villanova. De Decoctione Lapidis Philosophorum, et de regimine ignis, p. 137.

48. Efferarius. De Lapide Philosophorum secundum verum modum formando, p. 143.

49. Efferarius. Thesaurus Philosophiæ, p. 151. Raymundus Lullius. Praxis universalis magni operis, p. 165. 50. Odomar. Practica, p. 166. 51. De Argento in Aurum verso, p. 170. 52. De Marchasita, p. 173. 53. De Arsenico, p. 177.

54. Præparatio salis Armoniaci secundum Rasim, p. 179. 55. De Sale Alkali, p. 180.

56. Quæstio an lapis Philosophorum valeat contra pestem, p. 181.

57. Vetus epistola de metallorum materia & artis imitatione, p. 187.

58. Practica Caravantis Hispani, p. 188.

59. Joannes de Rupescissa. Liber de confectione veri lapidis philosophorum, p. 189.

60. Joannes Aurelius Augurellus. Chrysopæia carmine conscripta, p. 197.

61. Thomas Aquinas. Secreta Alchemiæ Magnalia: de corporibus supercælestibus, quod in rebus inferioribus inveniantur, quoque modo extrahantur, p. 267.

62. Thomas Aquinas. De Lapide Minerali, animali & plantali, tractatus, p. 276.

63. Thomas Aquinas. Thesaurus Alchemiæ secretissimus ad fratrem Reinaldum, p. 278.

64. Joannes de Rupescissa. Liber Lucis, p. 284.

Ioannis De Rupescissa - Sequitur descriptio et forma furni physici (pp. 292-295) [cf. aussi Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa , vol. II, p. 87] 65. Raymundus Lullius. Clavicula & Apertorium, p. 295.

66. Joannes Isaac Hollandus. Opera Mineralia, sive de Lapide Philosophico omnia, p. 304.

67. Ewaldus Vogelius. Liber de Lapidis physici conditionibus; quo abditissimorum Auctorum Gebri & Raymundi Lullii methodica continetur explicatio, p. 515. Ferguson

: The statements about this person are rather conflicting, due to the fact that some regard him as identical with Hoghelande, while others consider him distinct. Even among those who take the former view there is want of unanimity. The earliest allusion to the question which I have seen is by Conring in the second edition of his Hermetica Medicina

, 1669. He there speaks of Vogel ' who was in the habit of calling himself at one time Theobaldus, and at another de Hogelande, with an unpraiseworthy lack of decision, a man specially devoted to chemistry.' Conring, who found any stick good enough to beat the chemists with, here falls foul of the pseudonym, — which, by the way, with an unpraiseworthy lack of accuracy be divides into two — as if Vogel was the only author who bad ever used another name. He assigns to Vogel the present treatise: he could hardly do otherwise; but be credits the ' Historiae transmutationis

' to 'Ewaldus,' without specifying the surname. From this it would appear that Conring considered that Hogelande was the pseudonym, and Vogel the orthonym. Morhof, who wrote his Epistle

in 1673, says just exactly the opposite of Conring: Theobaldus ab Hogelande qui se ficto nomine appellat Ewaldum Vogelium. König followed in 1678:

Theob. ab Hogeland ficto nomine Ewaldum Vogelium sese vocare solet

, he says under Hogelande, but does not quote a single book by him. Under the heading Vogelius, however, he makes no allusion whatever

to this statement, and deals with him as a distinct person: ' Brabantus, Medicus,' and as the genuine and independent author of the present work, and mentions none of Hoghelande's writings. Now though Conring might be justified in the use of the word ' solet,' it was certainly not correct for König to employ it. For while Vogel under the pseudonym of Theobaldus or Ewaldus de Hoghelande wrote two books, Hoghelande under that of Vogel wrote only one, and one instance does not constitute a custom. The following year, 1670, Lipenius brought out his Bibliotheca realis Medica

, and the problem is not simplified by his treatment of it. To Vogel is correctly assigned the present work; to Theob. de Hoghelande, the treatise ' De Alchemiae Difficultatibus

,' 1594, and in the Theatrum Chemicum [vol. I, p.]; but the tract '

Historiae aliquot transmutationis Metallicae pro Defensione Alchymiae

,' Coloniae Agr., 1604, is said to be by ' Ewaldus Vogelande s. Theob. Hogelande.' The name Vogelande is a piece of confusion, and the author of this tract calls himself Ewald von Hohelande and not Theobaldus, unless these two be identical, which I doubt. König was quoted as the authority for the pseudonymity by de la Rue in 1734. and so it filtered down to Baumer, who in 1782 puts the present work under Theobaldus von Hogeland with the ' nomine ficto Ewaldi Vogel,' and ultimately to Van der Aa. On the other hand there if no evidence in the case of a large number of authorities that identification was ever thought of. Van der Linden in 1637 keeps them entirely apart, Borel in 1654 does the same, and these, are followed by Mercklin and Manget. Andreas in 1643 makes no allusion to Vogel at all, but only to Theobaldus de Hoghelande. Eloy, so far from identifying them, has taken some trouble to distinguish them, and he seems also to doubt the identity of Theobaldus and Ewald von Hoghelande. He quotes Paquot's analysis of Vogel's book. Later writers have almost forgotten them. Gmelin treats them as distinct, and Schmieder does not mention Vogel or this book, and says nothing about the name Ewald as an alternative

of Theobaldus. Kopp does not include any of these names or the books in his history of Alchemy. In the note to HOGHELANDE (i., pp. 411, 412) I referred to this question of identity. So far as the evidence goes there is no reason for believing that Hoghelande and Vogel were identical. When the statements of Conring and Morhof are reconciled and established, it will be time to speak of identification. They cannot both be right.

68. Justus à Balbian. Tractatus Septem de Lapide Philosophico, p. 649.

69. Jodocus Greverus (Grewer). Secretum, p. 699.

70. Alanus. Dicta de Lapide Philosophico, p. 722.

71. Conclusio summaria ad intelligentiam Testamenti seu Codicilli Raymundi Lullij, et aliorum librorum ejus; nec non argenti vivi, in quo pendet intentio tota intentiva, qua aliter Repertorium Raymundi appellatur, p. 730. 72. Joannes Pontanus. Epistola

in qua de lapide quem Philosophorum vocant, agitur, p. 734. 73. Nicolaus Barnaud. Commentariolum in quoddam Epitaphium

[Ælia Lælia Crispis] Bononiæ studiorum, ante multa secula maæmoreo lapidi insculptum, p. 744. [Compare iv. p 805 . L'épitaphe de Bologne est :

D M ELIA LAELIA CRISPIS, NEC VIR , NEC MVLIER, NEC ANDROGINA , NEC PVLLLA , NEC IVVENIS, NEC ANVS.NEC MERETRIX, NEC PVDICA, SED OMNIA SVBLATA NEQVE FAME . NEC TERRO NEQVE VENENO SED OMNIBVS NEC COELO, NEC AQVIS NEC TERRIS SED VBIQVE lACET LVCIVS,.AGATHO, PRISCIVS, NEC MARITVS , NEC AMATOR , NEC NECESSARIVS , NEQVE MOERENS , NEQVE GAVDENS, NEQVE FLENS, HANC NE QVE QVE MOLEM, NEC PYRAMIDEM, NEC SEPVLCHRVM, SED OMNIA SCIT, ET NESCIT QVID CVI POSVERIT. HOC EST SEPVLCHRVM, INTVS CADAVER NON HABENS, HOC EST CADAVER, SEPVLCHRVM EXTRA NON HABENS, SED CADAVER IDEM EST , ET SEPVLCHRVM SIBI Ferguson

: This is an epitaph cut on a block of white and red marble, which existed at Bologna. As it is a complete enigma, it has exercised the wits of many persons for three hundred years to find out its meaning and application. Marius L. Michael Angelus published a 410 pamphlet on it at Venice, in 1548; Sir W. Scott alludes to it as a perennial antiquarian problem (The Antiquary, ch. xiv.). In 1683 Caesar Malvasia in his pamphlet enumerates forty-three attempted solutions of it. It has been thought to denote rain, the soul, Niobe, Lot's wife, a child promised in marriage that died before its birth, and so on. See the notices in Acta Bruditorum 1684, p. 263 ; 1706, p. 88; 1720, p, 6; in Christoph. August. Hermann's Potcile, Halae, 1726, ii. p. 306. Here of course it is applied to the philosopher's stone, for which interpretation we are indebted to Nicolaus Barnaud, who wrote a commentary on the inscription in this sense, reprinted in Theatrum Chemicum, iii. p. 744

(q.v.), and in Manget, Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa, ii. p. 713

(q.v.). The epitaph with its puzztling antitheses was too choice a morsel to escape the alchemists, who were fascinated by obscurities like those of the Tabula Smaragdina and delighted in ascribing to the great Arcanum the most contradictory properties, so as to display its infinite perfections, and at the same time to baffle the uninitiated. Borel (Bibl. Chem. 1654, P. 3) must have considered the inscription to be alchemical; he quotes the explanation of it by Richardus Basinstockius, Dordrecht, 1618, in verses prefixed to the Mataotechnia Medicinae Praxeos of Noah Biggs, Lond, 1651, "Elia Lelia's Art" is referred to.

Jung consacre un chapitre de son Mysterium conjunctionis, t. I à l'énigme de Bologne.]

74. Nicolaus Barnaud. Processus Chemici aliquot, p. 755. 75. Lambspringk. De Lapide Philosophico libellus, p. 765.

76. Philosophus Gallus Delphinas Anonymus. Liber secreti maximi totius mundane gloriæ, p. 774.

77. Extractum ex Cimbalo Aureo, antiquissimo libro manuscripto, ad rem nostram faciens, p. 780. 78. Arcanum Philosophorum, p. 783.

79. Nicolaus Barnaud. Brevis Elucidatio illius Arcani Philosophorum, p. 784. [

The tracts from Lambspringk's constitute the work called Triga chemica , edited by Barnaud .]. frontispice du Triga Chemica , Paris, 1599 [

de lapide philosophico tractatus tres, editore et commentatore Nicolao Barnaudo,... Ejusdem Barnaudi brevis elucidatio arcani philosophorum

[Contient : Lambspringk, nobilis Germani philosophi antiqui, libellus de lapide philosophico

, e germanico versu latine redditus per Nicolaum Barnaudum. - Antiqui philosophi galli delphinatis anonymi liber secreti maximi totius mundanae gloriae. - Extractum ex Cimbalo aureo, antiquissimo libro manuscripto. ex Officina Plantiniana, apud Christophorum Raphelengium (París). - une note particulière doit être ici faite au sujet du petit traité de Lambsprinck De Lapide Philosophorum

, car, rappelons-le, il s'agit d'un des très rares écrits qui fut réédité dans un ouvrage de vulgarisation, publié par Georges Ranque - la Pierre Philosophale

, Robert Laffont, 1972 - dont nous parlons dans le commentaire du Triomphe Hermétique

de Limojon de saint-Didier. Malheureusement, G. Ranque ne donne pas les sources de l'édition originale : ce petit traité, constitué de 15 poèmes, fut édité pour la première fois par Nicolas Barnaud en 1599 et publié ensuite dans le Museum Hermeticum

, en 1677. Mais auparavant, il avait été réédité en 1602 dans le Theatrum Chemicum

. Ranque en donne la traduction sur l'édition du Museum Hermeticum

. Nicolas Barnaud, de Crest dans le Dauphiné, qui vécut à Genève et en Hollande, est un des plus célèbres alchimistes du XVIe siècle et il passe pour avoir fabriqué des masses énormes d'or. Nous lisons dans le troisième volume du Théâtre Chimique deux traités de lui sur une

inscription énigmatique trouvée à Bologne, et sur le grand oeuvre. Il a encore publié une collection d'ouvrages alchimiques : Quadrifera Aurifera, in 4°. Lugd. Bat. , 1599, cité in Histoire de la Médecine

, Kurt Sprengel, T. III, p. 270, Deterville, Desoer, Paris, 1815.] 80. Nicolaus Barnaud. Quadriga Aurifera , p. 790. [

The volume contains a dedication to Count Heinrich-Friedrich of Nassau, and a preface referring to the Triga .]

The four Tracts, called Rotae, or Wheels, are :

81. Tractatus de philosophia Metallorum, p. 791. 82. Ripleus. Liber Duodecim Portarum , p. 797.

83. Ripleus. Liber de Mercurio et lapide Philosophorum, p. 821.

84. Scriptum [anonymi]è Elixir Solis Theophrasti Paracelsi tractans, p. 828. 85. Coelum Philosophicum. p 832.

86. Auriga Chemicus sive Theosophiæ Palmarium, p. 834. 87. De Oculta Philosophia Epistola , p. 852. 88. Dicta Sapientum, p. 857. Theatrum chemicum , volumen quartum, 1659 Volume IV.

89. Raymundus Lullius. Theoria & Practica, pp. 1 and 135. Plates, pp. 150 and 156.

90. Raymundus Lullius. Compendium animæ transmutationis artis Metallorum Ruperto Anglorum Regi transmissum, p. 171. 91. Artefius. Clavis majoris sapientiæ , p. 198.

92. Heliophilus a Percis. Philochemicus Philochemicis, Nova Disquisitio de Helia Artista, p. 214.

93. Heliophilus a Percis. Nova disquisitio super metallorum transformatione, p. 220. [Compare p 300].

94. Hieronymus de Zanetinis. Conclusio & comprobatio Alchymiae, qua dispositioni & argumentis Angeli respondetur, p. 247.

95. Thomas Arsoncinus. De jure Alchymiæ responsum, p. 248. 96. Latin and German verses, p. 252.

97. Nicolaus Niger Happelius. Cheiragogia Heliana de Auro philosophico, nec dum cognito, p. 265. 98.

Wenceslaus Lavinus Moravus. Tractatus de Coelo terrestri , p. 288.

99. Nicolaus Niger Happelius. Disquisitio Heliana, p. 300. [cf. Nova Disquisitio p 220 .] 100. Nicolaus Niger Happelius. Aphorismi Basiliani

sive Canones Hermetici de Spiritu, Anima et Corpore medio Majoris & Minoris Mundi, p. 327.

101. Andreas Brentzius. Variarum Philosophorum Sententiarum perveniendi ad lapidem benedictum Collectanea, p. 333.

102. Bernardus G. Penotus. Epistola, p. 364.

103. Gaston Dulco. De triplici præparatione Auri et Argenti, p. 372.

104. Gaston Dulco. De recta et vera ratione progignendi lapidis Philosophici, seu salis Argentifici & Aurifici, Tractatus duo, p. 388.

105. Gaston Dulco. Canones seu Regulæ decem, de Lapide Philosophico, p. 414.

106. Divi Leschi Genus Amo (Sendivogius).

De Lapide Philosophico Tractatus duodecim , p. 420.

107. Divi Leschi Genus Amo (Sendivogius). Ænigma Philosophorum , p. 442.

108. Divi Leschi Genus Amo (Sendivogius). Dialogus Mercurii , Alchymistæ et Naturæ, p. 449.

109. Ænigma Philosophorum sive Symbolum Saturni, per Parabolas Azoth dilucide ostendens, p. 457.

110. Aureliæ Occultæ Philosophorum partes duz. M. Georgio Beato Interprete, p. 462. [

c'est dans ce traité que se trouve l'écrit attribué à Basile Valentin, appelé Azoth. Cf. aussi MANGET (J. J.), Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa, 1702, ii. p. 198 et OCCULTA PHILOSOPHIA, 1613. p. 47 : Ferguson

: This is ascribed by some to Basilius Valentinus

(q.v.). It is a dialogue between an old man, called

Senior, and a pupil or student, Adolphus. The

first part is in prose, the second is an interpretation

of some symbolic drawings, and in the German version is in verse. Other editions: " Azoth, sive Aureliae Occultae Philosophorum ,. . . , Francofurti, Joannes Bringer, 1613"; " Occulta Philosophia von

den verborgenen Philosophischen Geheimnussen der heimlichen Goldblumen , . . . Franckfurt, Johann Bringer, 1613" (q.v.); " Les Douze Clefs. . .

de. . . Basile Valentin. .. Plus l'Azoth . . . Paris, 1624, and Paris, 1659." In certain editions this tract is preceded by the Aenigma Philosophorum

,

which is also inserted sometimes among Sendi

vogius' writings. It does not seem, however, to belong strictly to either .] - gravures contenues dans ce recueil : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - 8 - 9 - 10 - 11 - 12 - 13 - 14 - 111. Tabula Smaragdina , p. 497.

112. Arnoldus de Vina Nova. Speculum Alchymiæ, p. 515.

113. Arnoldus de Villa Nova. Carmen, p. 542.

114. Arnoldus de Villa Nova. Quæstiones tam essentiales quam accidentales ad Bonifacium Octavum, p. 544.

115. Tractatus de secretissimo antiquorum philosophorum arcano, p. 554. Ferguson

: Under this title are included three tracts, with a Praefatio. Tractatus primus consists of excerpts from the following writers: 1. Rogerus Baco. 2. Raymundus Lullius. 3. Rosarius Arnoldi. 4. Clamor Buccinae. 5. Rosarius Minor. 6. Richardus Anglicus. 7. Calid Rex. 8. Avicenna. 9. Bernhardus Comes. 10. Turba Philosophorum.

XXII. Propositiones sive Maximae in quibus

veritas totius Artis Chemicae brevissime comprebenditur. Tractatus secundus aureus de Lapide Phiosoph

orum Joannis de Lasnioro, with a folding table. Tractatus tertius nobilis Joannis Trithemii Abbatis Spanheimensis.

The collection was published originally in Latin

in 1611, without place or printer's name, small 8°, pp. [95, 1 blank] . Appended to it is a tract in German:

Tractatus Chemicus des alten hocherleuchten

Philosophi, Theologi und Medici, Arnoldi de Nova Villa, s vor vierhundert Jahren gelebt. Vor niemals im druck gesehen, Jtzo aber durcb einen Liebhaber der Spagyrischen kunst den Fillis doc trinae zu gut an tag geben , pp. [60,4 blank].

116. Propositiones XXII. In quibus veritas totius artis Chemiæ brevissimè comprehenditur, p. 577.

117. Joannes de Lasnioro. Tractatus aureus de Lapide Philosophorum, p. 579. 118. figure, p. 584.

119. Joannes Trithemius Abbas Spanheimensis. Tractatus Chemicus nobilis, p. 585. 120. Hermes Trismegistus. Tractatus Aureus

de Lapidis Physici Secreto in cap. 7 divisus; Nunc vero à quodam Anonymo Scholiis illustratus (cum Epistola dedicatoria et præfatione), p. 587. [

ce traité est cité à de nombreuses reprises par Jung. Il s'agit des Sept Chapitres Dorés d'Hermès

avec une amplification anonyme.Voir Manget, I, p. 400]

121. David Lagneus. Harmonia seu Consensus Philosophorum Chemicorum, p. 718. 122. Table, p. 748.

123. Ænigmaticum quoddam Epitaphium [Ælia Lælia Crispis] Bononiæ Studiorum ante multa secula, marmoreo lapidi insculptum, p. 805.

124. Arcanum Philosophorum, per virum doctissimum olim versu hexametro conscriptum, p. 806

125. Albertus Magnus. De Concordantia Philosophorum in Lapide, p. 809. 126. Albertus Magnus. Compositum de Compositis , p. 825.

127. Albertus Magnus. Liber Octo Capitulorum de lapide philosophorum, p. 841.

128. Avicenna. Ad Hasen Regem Epistola de re recta, p. 863.

129. Avicenna. Declaratio Lapidis Physici Filio suo Aboali, p. 875.

130. Avicenna. De Congelatione et Conglutinatione lapidum, p. 883.

131. Guilhelmus Tecenensis. Lilium de Spinis evulsum, p. 887.

132. Ortholanus. Practica vera Alkimica Parisiis probata et experta sub Anno Domini 1358, p. 912.

133. Lumen Juvenis Experti Novum, p. 934.

134. Valentinus. Opus Præclarum ad utrumque. Quod pro testamento dedit filio suo adoptivo, qui etiam istum Cractatulum propria manu scripsit loanni Apot., p. 941.

135. Tractatulus super hæc verba: Studio namque florenti, p. 955 136. Opus ad Album, p. 957.

137. Thomas Aquinas. Liber lilii benedicti, p. 960.

138. Tractatulus super verba Mer fugi dum bibit, p. 974.

139. Opus breve ad Rubeum cum sole per aquas fortes, p. 984. 140. Petrus de Silento. Opus, p. 985.

141. Joachim Tanckius. Epistola, p. 998.

142. Tractatus Philosophicus ad Rubrum et Album, p. 1001.

143. Paulus Eck de Sultzbach. Clavis Philosophorum, p. 1007. Theatrum chemicum , volumen quintum, 1622 Volume V. 1. Turba Philosophorum . p. 1.

2. In turbam Philosophorum Sermo unus anonymi. p. 52.

3. Allegoria Sapientum, & Distinctiones XXIX. supra librum Turbæ. p. 57.

4. Tractatus Micreris suo discipulo Mirnefindo. p. 90.

5. Platonis libri Quartorum, seu Stellici, cum commento Hebuhabes Harned, explicati ab Hestole. p. 101.

7. Regis Calid, Liber trium verborum. p. 186.

8. Senioris Zadith, filii Hamuelis tabula chimica, marginalibus adaucta. p. 191. [

cette figure est littéralement emblématique : en effet, on la retrouve sous une forme absolument transfigurée dans le MS. Rhenoviensis 172 de Zurich où figure le texte de l' Aurora consurgens

- pseudo aquinate - avec de superbes aquarelles. La figure V

qui forme l'une des plus belles de la série, est appendue au texte : elle reproduit notamment pour ainsi dire trait pour trait

(voyez les aigles sagittaire) notre gravure, cf. Aurora consurgens I et II

- Cette image de Senior - Hermès se trouve encore reproduite sur un MS. de Nuremberg, rédigé entre 1577 et 1583, cf. Van Lennep, Alchimie , p. 109, ill. 152

et on trouve une autre image qui reproduit le f. 73 du Codex Vossianus

F. 29 que nous avons examiné dans l'Aurora consurgens, II -]

9. Guilielmi Menens Antuerpiani Aurei velleris libri tres. p. 240.

10. Consilium conjugii, seu de massa Solis & Lunæ libri tres, p. 429.

11. M. Petrus Bonus. Margarita Novella correctissima, p. 507.

12. Michael Scotus. Quæstio curiosa de Natura Solis et Lunae, p. 713.

13. Lucas Rodargirus. Pisces Zodiaci inferioris vel de Solutione Philosophica. Cum ænigmatica totius Lapidis Epitome. p. 723. 14. Alphonsi Regis Castellæ,

liber Philosophiae occultioris, præcipue metallorum, profundissimus, p. 766.

Ce traité attribué à Alphonse X a été pour Chevreul l'occasion ou l'amorce d'une série d'articles traitant de l'attribution dudit traité à Artephius. Cf. Chevreul, critique d'Artephius

. Chevreul, et c'est là le point le plus intéresant, a été amené à montrer l'identité remarquable entre la Clavis Majoris Sapientiae et les écrits des trois alchimistes de Flers : Nicolas Valois, Nicolas Grosparmy et Vicot, cf. Cinq Traités de Valois; le Trésor des Trésors de Grosparmy; Introïtus, VI

où on lira d'autres notes sur les Adeptes de Caen. Voici les notes de Ferguson sur Alphonse X - Ferguson

: Alphonso or Alfonso X., El Sabio, King of Castile and Leon (1221 - 1284) "caused this book to be translated from the Arabic into his own Castilian tongue." It would appear therefore that Alfonso was not himself the author. The Arabic book is supposed to be the Clavis majoris Sapientiae ascribed to Artephius (q.v.), of which there were numerous edition. Comparison of the two tracts shows that they are identical (though not verbally so), however the Identity is to be explained. This tract tracts 1°; of the Aristotelian elements or qualities; 2°, of the generation of minerals, and 3°, of the generation of plants from minerals, and of animals from plants. It is a short treatise on cosmogony, and not on transmutation. It is not the same as that attributed to" Alphonso. King of Portugall," included in Five Treatises of the Philosopher's Stone, London, 1652. Sources

: Hendreich, Pandecta Brandeniburgicae, 1699, p. 123. - Nicolas Antonio, Bibliotheca Hispana Vetus, 1788, ii. p. 78. - Gmelin, Geschichte der Chemie, 1797, i. 64. - Schmieder, Geschichte der Alchemiet, 1832, p. 141. - Hoefer, Histoire de la Chimie. 1842, i. 383; 1866, i. p. 407. - Fabricius, Bibliotheca Latina media et infimae Aetatis, 1858, i. p. 68. - Lucien Leclerc, Histoire de la Médecine Arabe. 1876, ii. p. 441. - Kopp, Die Alchemie, 1886, i. p. 101.

Cf. Bibliothèque des Philosophes Chimiques, II, p. 112 - Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa, I, p. 503 - Theatrum Chemicum, IV, p. 198 - Museum d'Histoire Naturelle : MS. 2026

extrait du Theatrum Chemicum, vol. IV, p. 198 - MS. 2027 (?) - MS. 2028 , ex-libris d'Étienne Clavier - MS. 2029 , de Claude Alexandre Séguier - MS. 2030

de J.B. Léonard Dion de Saint-Jory. Dans l'étude de Chevreul sur la Clavis Majoris Sapientiae

, on se reportera aux correspondances que nous avons dressées entre les MS. du Museum et les manuscrits ou traductions A, B, C et D.

15. Aristoteles. Tractatus ad Alexandrum Magnum, De lapide Philosophico, p. 787.

Epistola Monachi cujusdam Benedictini ordinis, de Lapide Philosophico, opuscula Platonis & Arnoldi Villauovani recensens, p. 799.

16. Thomas Aquinas. Tractatus sextus de esse et essentia mineralium tractans, p. 806.

17. Cornelius Alvetanus Arnsrodius, de conficiendo divino Elixire, sive lapide philosophico, p. 815.

18. Animadversiones Chimicæ quatuor quibus ars universa, tam practice quam theorice enudatur, p. 821.

19. Epistola Fr. Rogerii Baconis, de secretis operibus artis & naturæ, & nullitate magiæ, cum notis, p. 834.

20. De auro medico philosophorum Dialogus Scholasticus Christophori Hornii, p. 869. Theatrum Chemicum , volumen sextum, 1661 Volume VI.

1. Blasii Vigenerii Tractatus de Igne et Sale. p. 1.

2. Johannes Collesson. Idea Perfecta Philosophiæ Hermeticae, seu Abbreviatio Theoriae & Praxeos Lapidis Philosophici observationibus aucta, p. 143.

3. Anonymi Philosophi Galli, Instructio Patris ad filium de Arbore Solari. p. 163.

4. Christophori Parisiensis Elucidarius seu Artis transmutatoriæ summa major cum appendice. p.195. 5. Johannis Grassei Chortalassei dicti Arca arcani artificiosissimi

de Summis naturæ mysteriis, ex Rustico majore et minore ejus constructa. p. 294. 6. Lilium inter Spinas. p. 323. 7. Cabala Chemica. p. 344.

8. Admonitio. De Via ad Aurum Potabile. p. 382.

9. Responsiones duæ F. R. C. ad quosdam suos Clientes, p. 393.

10. Orthelius Commentarius in novum Lumen Chymicum Michaelis Sendivogii Poloni, XII. figuris in Germania repertis illustratum. p. 397. [cf. Orthelius in Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa , t. II, p. 516] - gravures du recueil : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - 8 - 9 - 10 - 11 - 12 - 13 -

11. Orthelius Epilogus et Recapitulatio in Novum Lumen Chymicum Sendivogii. p. 430.

12. Epistola Andreæ de Blavven scripta ad Petrum Andream Matthiolum in qua agitur de multiplici auri potabilis parandi ratione. p. 458.

13. Discursus Orthelii de præcedente Epistola Andrez de Blawen, p. 470.

14. Epistola Anonymi de principiis artis Hermeticæ. p. 474.

15. Expositio & Practica Lapidis Adrop, Collecta ex Plinii Philosophi Libro qui intitulatur; Aromaticum Philosophorum Thesaurus & Secretum Secretorum. p. 477.

16. Excerpta ex interlocutione Mariæ Prophetissæ, è habita cum aliquo Philosopho dicto Aros de excellentissimo opere trium horarum. p. 479.

17. Orthelii Explicatio Verborum Mariæ Prophetiæ. p. 480. 18. Epistola

Joannis Pontani in qua de Lapide quem Philosophorum vocant agitur. p. 487.

19. Orthelii Commentatio in Epistolam Pontani. p. 489.

20. Epistola Haimonis de quatuor Lapidibus Philosophicis materiam suam ex minori mundo desumentibus. p. 497.

21. Epistola Cornelii Alvetani de conficiendo Divino Elixire sive Lapide Philosophico. p. 501.

22. Astronomia inferior seu Planetarum terrestrium motus & variatio. p. 507.

23. Summa rhytmorum Germanicorum de Opere Universali ex coelo soloque prodeunte. p. 511.

24. Summa Libri qui vocatur Gloria mundi, seu tabula Paradisi. p. 513.

25. Opus singulare procedens ex Sale quodam Centrali aethereo, resoluto in igne minerali terreno, seu oleo vitrioli, quod cum Tinctura Solis extracta fermentatur, & externo igne Solympico aut igne radiorum Solis invisibili coquitur & maturatur. Ex Theophrasto redivivo Michaelis Pezelii circa finem. p. 518.

26. Sententia aut Compositio Litis Spiritus et Judicis Mercurii. Ex vetusto scripto Bellum seu Duellum equestre vocato, ad accusationem & responsionem Solis & Martis, per picturas repræsenta. p. 519. [

traduction du Urtheil oder Vergleichung dans Sendivogius, Lumen Chymicum Novum ; Epilogus Orthelii, 1624, p. 227.]

27. Summa rhytmorum parvorum Germanicorum, qui sunt ejusdem tenoris & sensus cum præcedentibus picturis, ad verbum expressa. p. 521.

28. Mysterium occultæ naturæ Anonymi Discipuli Johannis Grassei Chortalassei dicti. p. 523.

29. Guidonis Magni de Monte Philosophi Græci Discipuli Anonymi tractatulus, seu descriptio Philosophici Adrop, ejusque præparatio. p. 543. 30. De Ovo Philosophorum, p. 565.

31. Johannes Isaac Hollandus. Tractatus de Urina quomodo per spiritum ejus omnes Tincturæ sint extrahendæ. p. 566.

32. Johannis Chartier Scientia Plumbi sacri Sapientum seu cognitio, rararum potestatum & virtutum Antimonii. p. 569

33. Joachimi Polemanni Novum Lumen Medicum de Mysterio Sulphuris Philosophorum. p. 600.

34. Solini Saltzthal Regiemontani, de potentissima Philosophorum medicina Universali Discursus. p. 675.

35. Solini Saltzthal Brevis descriptio admirandæ Virtutis et Operationis summæ Medicinæ Lapis Philosophorum dictæ. p. 694.

36. Solini Saltzthal Discursus de philosophico fonte salino. p. 704. 37. Tabula Smaragdina seu verba Secretorum Hermetis. p. 705.

38. Henrici de Rochas tractatus de observationibus novis et vera cognitione aquarum mineralium et de illarum qualitatibus & virtutibus antehac incognitis. Et de Spiritu Universali. p. 716. 4)- Musaeum Hermeticum 1625 edition

Musæum Hermeticum, omnes sopho-spagyricæ artis discipulos fidelissime erudiens, quo pacto summa illa veraque Medicina, qua res omne, qualemcumque defectum patientes, instaurari possunt (quæ alias Benedictus Lapis Sapientum appellatur) inveniri ac haberi queat inveniri ac haberi queat. Continens tractatus chymicos novem præatantissimos, quorum nomina et seriem versa pagella indicabit. In gratiam filiorum doctrinæ, quibus Germanicum Idioma ignotum, in Latinum conversum ac juris publici factum. Jennis, Frankfurt. 1625. 1. Tractatus aureus de Lapide Philosophico . 2. Henricus Madathanus, Aureum Seculum Redivivum .

3. Hydrolithus Sophicus, seu Aquarium sapientum.

4. Joannes de Mehung, Demonstratio Naturae.

5. Nicolas Flamel, Summarium Philosophicum. 6. Via Veritatis Unicæ. 7. Gloria Mundi, seu Tabula Paradisi. 8. Tractatus de Generatione Metallorum. 9. Liber, cuius nomen Alze . 10. Lambspring,

de lapide Philosophorum Figuræ et Emblemata . 5)- Musaeum Hermeticum 1678 edition

Musæum Hermeticum reformatum et amplificatum, omnes sopho-spagyricæ artis discipulos fidelissimè erudiens, quo pacto summa illa veraque lapidis philosophici medicina, qua res omnes qualemcunque defectum patientes, instaurantur, inventiri et haberi queat. Continens tractatus chimicos XXI. Præstantissimos, quorum Nomina & Seriem versa pagella indicabit. In gratiam filiorum doctrinæ, quibus Germanicum idioma ignotum est, Latina lingua ornatum. Sand, Frankfurt. 1678, 1749. frontispice du Musaeum Reformatum et Amplificatum , 1678 - cliquez pour l'Incipit Ferguson : This collection was first published: Francofurti, Sumptibus Lucae Jennisii

, 1625, 4°, pp. [16] 445 [2 with engravings, 1 blank], Lambspring

, pp. 35 [1 blank]. The general title-page has an engraved border, representing the four elements, the sun and moon (gold and silver) and some emblematical designs. Each tract has an engraved title-page included in the pagination. Lambsping's tract, though dated 1625 and printed uniform with the rest of the book, has separate signatures and pagination. Of the tracts above enumerated this first edition contains only the first ten, namely from the ' Tractatus Aureus

' to Lambspring's verses, inclusive. A revised and much enlarged edition appeared fifty years later :

Musaeum Hermeticum Reformatum et Amplificatum

, Francofurti, Apud Hermannum à Sande. 1678, f, pp. [12, including the engraved title and a plate] 863 [i]. Four folding plates. The general title has an engraved border similar to that in the first edition, and it is dated 1677. The tracts have each a title-page included in the pagination. The engraved title-pages of the previous edition are repeated in this but of the added tracts some have only printed titles, This edition contains all the tracts above enumerated, the present edition of 1749 being merely a reprint of that of 1677-78. The Hermetic Museum was translated into English by Arthur Edward Waite, and published at London by James

Elliott & Co., 1893, 2 vols., 4°; vol. 1. pp. xi. [1 blank] 357 [3 blank]; il, pp. [8] 322 [2 blank]. Only 250 copies were printed. [

On notera que le cartouche central, en bas, est analogue à l' emblème LXII de l' Atalanta fugiens ; que le 2 ème

médaillon, en haut et à gauche, rappelle le Zeus qui figure à l' emblème I . Le Soleil et la Lune rappellent l' emblème XXX

; les trois autres médaillons doivent être cherchés dans d'autres traités. A gauche, nous avons le phénix

; à droite, l'aigle et sa portée, cf. l'une des peintures de l' Aurora Consurgens .

Dans ce recueil figurent les planches des Duodecim claves de Basile Valentin ; le frontispice du Tractatus Aureus ; les quinze emblèmes du De Lapide de Lambsprinck ; le frontispice du Crede mihi de Norton ; la médaille alchimique du Vitulus aureus

d'Helvetius et les magnifiques planches du Janitor Pansophus

. À noter que toutes ces planches se retrouvent dans le Dyas Chymica Tripartita , compilation attribuée à Grasseus .] 1. Tractatus aureus de Lapide Philosophico . p. 1 2. Henricus Madathanus, Aureum Seculum Redivivum . p. 53

3. Hydrolithus Sophicus, seu Aquarium sapientum. p. 73

4. Joannes de Mehung, Demonstratio Naturae. p. 145

5. Nicolas Flamel, Summarium Philosophicum. p. 172 6. Via Veritatis Unicæ. p. 181

7. Gloria Mundi, seu Tabula Paradisi. p. 203

8. Tractatus de Generatione Metallorum. p. 305 9. Author Liber, cuius nomen Alze . p. 323 10. Lambspring,

de lapide Philosophorum Figuræ et Emblemata . p. 337 11. Michael Maier, Tripus Aureus

, hoc est tres tractatus chimici selectissimi: nempe, Basilii Valentini

... Practica una cum XII Clavibus et Appendice. p. 373

12. Thomae Nortoni Crede mihi seu Ordinale ex anglicano manuscripto in latinum translatum. p. 433

[According to the author's concluding lines, this poem was begun in 1477. The first publication of it was in the Latin translation by Michael Maier in 1618, above mentioned. For in his book Symbols Auras Mensae

, printed the previous year, he speaks of it as being still ' uneditus,' but ' to be published shortly by us,' and it appeared of course in the subsequent reprints of the Tripus aureus

. The English poem was first printed In Ashmole's Theatrum

from a fine manuscript. He says (p. 455): ' In the search I have made after Authentique Manuscripts to compleate this worke, a private Gentleman lent me a very faire one of Norton's Ordinall

, which I chiefly followed; yet not omitting to compare it with fourteen other copies. It was written in Velame and in an auntient sett hand, very exact and exceeding neate.' This, Ashmole thinks from various circumstances, may have been the dedication copy to George Novell, Archbishop of York, whose magnificent entertainment of Edward IV. with lavish display of plate and other treasure was so thoroughly appreciated by the king that he took possession of the whole ' and made of the Arch-Bishop's Mitre (get with precious stones) a Crowne for himself. ' The poem appears to be anonymous, but as Ashmole has pointed out in language, worthy almost of Sir Thomas Urquhart, the author's name is contained in the poem itself. He says (p. 437) : '

From the first word of this Proeme, and the Initiall letters of the six following Chapters (discovered by Acromonosyllabiques and Sillabic Acrostiques) we may collect the authors Name and place of Residence: For those letters (together with the first line of the seventh chapter) speaks thus, Tomas Norton of Briseto, A parfet Master ye maie him trowe. Such like Fancies were the results of the wisdome and humility of

the Auncient Philosophers, (who when they intended not an absolute concealement of Persons, Names, Misteries, &c.) were wont to hide them by Transpositions, Acrostiques. Isogrammatiques, Symphoniaques, and the lyke. (which the searching Sons of Art might possibly unriddle, but) with designs to continue them to others, as concealed things; And that upon the Question no other Answer should be returned, then the like of the Angell's to Manoah. [His name was Peli, to wit, admirable and secret]. ' The author of the Ordinall

was the son of Thomas Norton, and was born at Bristol towards the end of the fourteenth century. He was member of Parliament for the borough of Bristol in 1436, member of privy chamber of Edward IV., acted on embassies and accompanied the king when he fled to Burgundy. At the age of 28 he is said to have visited George Ripley

and to have asked to be instructed in the preparation of the red stone. His master, whether Ripley or another, seeing him to be a suitable person, ultimately put him on the right road and at the end of forty days (the appropriate period of a ' philosophic month') the pupil bad acquired the secret. In the Ordinall, chap. ii., he refers to his master in terms of the greatest admiration and affection. He describes (chap. vi.) a furnace of his invention by which he could get ' threescore degrees,' and carry on as many operations simultaneously, each with its own heat. He complains of the troubles which beset the adept; his perfected work was stolen by servants, and he says: ' I made also the Elixer of life Which me bereft a Merchaunt's wife: The Quintessens I made also, With other secrets many moe, Which sinfull people took me fro, To my great paine and much more woe .'

The lady here referred to is said to have been Mrs. Canynges, the wife of William Canynges, who rebuilt the church of St. Mary Redcliffe at Bristol. His master mason was called Norton, and it has been sought to Identify him with the alchemist. The poem contains a number of interesting details and throws light on the beliefs of the period. Manuscripts of the work exist in the British Museum, the Bodleian, in Trinity College, Dublin, and in the library of the Marquis of Bath. Other

works are ascribed to him, or bear his name: De transmutatione Metallorum ; and De Lapide Philosophorum . They have not been printed. Cf. Theatrum Britannicum , p.1 et Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa , vol. 2, p. 285] 13. Cremeri Testamentum

... figuris cupro affabre incisis ornati. p. 533 14. Michael Sendivogius, Novum Lumen Chemicum

e Naturæ Fonte & manuali Experientia depromptum. p. 545 Ænigma Philosophicum. Dialogus Mercurii, Alchymistæ et Naturæ .

15. Michael Sendivogius, Novi Luminis Tractatus alter de Sulphure. p. 601 16. Philaletha,

Introitus Apertus ad occlusum Regis Palatium . p. 647 17. Michael Maier, Subtilis Allegoria super Secreta Chymiæ . p. 701

18. Philaletha, Metallorum Metamorphosis. p. 741

Brevis Manuductio ad Rubinum Coelestem. p. 775

19. Philaletha, Fons Chymicæ Veritatis. p. 799

20. Joannes Fridericus Helvetius, Vitulus Aureus quem Mundus adorat et orat. p. 815 [cf. Bibliotheca Curiosa Chemica , Manget, vol I., 9, p. 200 pour l'image d'une médaille alchimique p. 828]

21. Janitor Pansophus, seu Figura Ænea quadripartita cunctis Museum hoc introeuntibus, superiorum ac inferiorum scientiam Mosaico-Hermeticam, analytice exhibens. p. 864 6)- Bibliotheca chemica curiosa , Jean-Jacques Manget.

Bibliotheca chemica curiosa, seu rerum ad alchemiam pertinentium thesaurus instructissimus: quo non tantum Artis Auriferæ, ac scriptorum in ea nobiliorum historia traditur; lapidis veritas argumentis & experimentis innumeris, immo & juris consultorum judiciis evincitur; termini obscuriores explicantur; cautiones contra impostores, & difficultates in tinctura universali conficienda occurrentes, declarantur: Verum etiam tractatus omnes virorum celebriorum, qui in magno sudarunt elixyre, quique ab ipso Hermete, ut dicitur, Trismegisto, ad

nostra usque tempora de Chrysopoæ scripserunt, cum præcipuis suis commentariis, concinno ordine dispositi exhibentur. Ad quorum omnium illustrationem additæ sunt quamplurimæ figuræ æneæ. Chouet, Geneva, 1702. 2 volumes. frontispice du tome I de la Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa de Mangetus Ferguson

: Manget was born at Geneva, 19 June, 1652. His father was a wealthy merchant, and his uncle a physician of the King of Poland. To gratify his parents his studies were at first directed to divinity, bat afterwards be taught himsetf medicine by private study and reading, graduated as doctor in 1678 at Valence, in Dauphiné. and practised in his native place with great acceptance and success. He became dean of the Medical Faculty there, in 1699 the Elector of Brandenburg made him his first physician, and when he became king of Prussia, Manget still continued to hold the position until his death. His literary work, in which he is said to have been helped by Daniel Leclerc, consisted chiefly in collecting and reprinting in large volumes treatises on medicine and surgery, and these are valuable as works of reference to books which either are now difficult to obtain or which have disappeared. They are : Messis Medico-spagyrica , Colon. (? Genevae). 1683. fol. - Bibliotheca anatomica

, Genevae, 1685, 2 vols., fol.; 1699. 2 vols., fol. ; London, 1711, 3 vols., 4°. - Bibliotheca pharmaceutlco - medica , Genev., 1704, 2 vols., fol. - Bibliotheca chirurgica , Genev., 1721, 4 vols., fol. - Bibliotheca scriptorum medicorum

, 1731, 4- vols., fol. (This contains the whole of Mercklin's Lindenius renovatus

, with reprints of biographical notices and renews from a variety of sources, and additional authors subsequent to Mercklin's time. This last section, however, to not so full as it might have been.) - Bibliotheca medlco-practica

, Genev., 1695 - 98, 4 vols., fol. ; Ib. 1739, 4 vols., fol. - Theatrum anatomicum , Genev., 1716-1717, 2 vols., fol.

He edited the works of some other writers on medical subjects. The present work is the largest of the collections of chemial authors, and though it contains a number of works which had already been printed in Zetzner's Theatrum chemicum

, It contains a great number of others which Zetzner did not reprint. The originals of many of the treatises are now extremely scarce, so that for historical reference Manget's collection is indispensable. The only drawback under which it labours is that the text as printed differs sometimes from that of other editions. Manget died at Geneva, 15 (25) Augt., 1743, in his 91st year, without having had a day's illness during his lifetime. Jean-Jacques Manget (1652 - 1743) sources : Journal des Savans , 1703, pp. 499-504. - Stolle,

Anleintung zur Historie der Medicinischeit Gelahrheit

, 1731, pp. 343, 465, 494. 497,540. - Manget, Bibliotheca Scriptorum Medicorum

. 1731, II. i. pp. 217 - 257 (biography, and contents of Jacob Leupolds Prodromus Bibliothecae metallicae , 1732, P. 97. (' Bibliotheca chemica curiosa

,' iv. vols. fol., Gen(e)uae-, 1695, 1702. It is in two volumes, and I have seen no other mention of a 1695 edition.) - Lenglet Dufresnoy, Histoire de la Philosophie Hermétique

, 1742, iii. pp. 2 (Bibl. Scriptorum Medicorum), 60 (' Bibl. Chemica Curiosa ,' with a reprint of the contents). -

Mémoires pour l'Histoire des Sciences & des beaux Arts

(Memoires de Trévoux), 1743, Mars 1743, pp. 549 - 551. - Jöcher, Allgemeines Gelehrlen-Lexicon , 1751, iii. col. 110; Rotermund's Fortsetzung und Ergänzungen , 1813, iv. col. 570. - Fictuld, Probier-Stein

, 1753, Th. ii. p. 93. (Horlacher's abstract; Fictuld condemns both, and laments the loss of time in compiling them.) - Moréri, Le Grand Dictionnaire historique , 1759, vii. p. 159. - Osmont, Dictionnaire

typographique , 1768, i. - Haller, Bibbliotheca Botanica , 1772, ii. p. 72. - Haller, Bibliotheca Anatomica , 1774, i. p. 803. - Haller, Bibliotheca Chirurgica

, 1774,1. p. 520. - Eloy, Dictionnaire historique de la Médecine, - Haller, Bibliotheca Medicinae practicae

, 1779. iii.p. 603 ('aliqua mecum adfinitate conjunctus, magnus collector'). - Baumer, Bibliotheca Chemica , 1782, p. 2 - Jean Senebier, Histoire littéraire de Genève

, Genève, 1786. ii. pp. 316-18. - Gmelin, Geschichte der Chemie

1798, ii. pp. 255, 300, 371, 480 - Hutchinson, Biographia Medica , 1799, ii. p. 122. - Chalmers, The General Biographical Dictionary , 1815, xxi. p. 236. - Biographie Médicale

, Paris, Panckoucke (1820-25), vi. p. 173. - Biographie Universelle

, 1820, xxvi. p. 486; n.d. xxvii p. 340 (article by Weiss). - Schmieder, Geschichte der Alchemie , 1832, p. 513. - Querard. La France littéraire , 1833, v. p. 488. - Dezeimeris, Dictionnaire historique de la Médecine

, 1837, III. ii. p. 509. - Bayle & Thillaye, Biographie Médicale . 1855, ii. p. 51, Phillippe & Ludwig, Geschichte der Apotheker , 1855, p. 588 - Nouvelle Biographie Générale , 1863, xxxiii. col. 301. - Ladrague, Bibliothèque Ouvaroff

, Sciences Secrètes, 1870, No. 538. (Horlacher's abstract; there is no copy of the original work.) -

Dictionnaire Encyclopédique des Sciences Médicales

, 2ème Série, 1871, iv. p. 505. - Hirsch,

Biographisches Lexicon der hervorragen den Aerzte aller Zeiten und Völker

. 1886, iv. p. 115 (article by Pagel). - Kopp. Die Alchemie

. 1886. i. p. 88; ii. p. 326, 340. - Billings, Index-Catalogue , 1887, viii. P. 578. illustrations tirées de l'ouvrage (p. xx) : t. I : 1

(p. 87 : Arcanum II. Chymicum) - 2 (p. 200 : cf. ref. 9, Helvetius) - 3

(p. 540 : divers appareils qui paraissent dans des traités, tirés sans doute de Summa Perfectionis Magisterii) - t. II : 4 - 5 (p. 521 et 525 :

14 figures d'Orthelius tirées du Commentaire de la Nouvelle Lumière Chymique

; nous noterons que ces gravures sont différentes de celles publiées dans le Theatrum Chemicum , cf. vol. VI, p. 397

. Elles ont été publiées par Van Lennep dans son Alchimie

, chap. I, pp. 37-39 et pour les gravures de l'édition du Theatrum , complément, p. 436) - 6 (p. 565) - 7 - 8 (p. 416 et 421 : Douze Clefs de Philosophie

, dans une version beaucoup moins soignée que celles présentées dans le Tripus Aureus - cf. Musaeum Hermeticum , p. 373 ou que la version, fort rare, des Chymische Schrifften , cf. gravures) - 9 (p. 87, Liber Lucis

avec une image de fourneau, moins complète que celle donnée dans le vol. III, p. 292 du Theatrum Chemicum) - 10 (p. 218 - il s'agit de l' Azoth attribué au pseudo Basile Valentin

: selon E. Canseliet, Fulcanelli tient Senior Zadith pour l'auteur du traité. Il y a là matière à recherche, cf. Bibliothèque des Philosophes chymiques de Richebourg, vol. III, n° 16 .

Notez que la fig. 2 apparaît dans l'une des deux éditions françaises des Douze Clefs de Philosophie

. Certaines de ces gravures sont moins connues, telles les n° 8 - 12.) - 11 - 12 - 13 - 14 - 15 - 16 - 17 (série de 160 médaillons du Jardinet Hermético-spagyrique de Soltzenberg, cf. infra vol. II, p. 895) - 18 (p. 275 : Douze Portes de Ripley, cf. vol. II, p. 275) - 19 (p. 287 : reproduction d'une gravure célèbre du Crede Mihi de Thomas Norton, cf. Tripus Aureus in Musaeum Hermeticum, 1678, p. 373) - Volume I.

1. Olaus Borrichius. De Ortu et Progressu Chemiæ Dissertatio (contient Aelia Lelia Crispis, p. 26), p. 1.

2. Olaus Borrichius. Conspectus Scriptorum Chemicorum Celebriorum, p. 38.

3. Athanasius Kircher. De Lapide Philosophorum Dissertatio p 54.

4. Athanasius Kircher. De Alchymia Sophistica, p. 82.

5. Salomon de Blauvenstein. Interpellatio brevis ad Philosophos pro Lapide Philosophorum contra Antichimisticum Mundum Subterraneum Athanasii Kircheri Jesuitæ, p. 113.

6. Gabriel Clauder. Tractatus de Tinctura Vniversali, ubi in specie contra R. P. Athanasium Kircherum pro existentia Lapidis Philosophici disputatur, p. 119.

7. Daniel Georg, Morhof. De Metallorum Transmutatione ad . . . Joelem Langelottum Epistola, p. 168.

8. Philippus Jacobus Sachs a Levvenheimb. Aurum Chymicum, p. 192.

9. Joh. Fridericus Helvetius. Vitulus aureus quem mundus adorat et orat, in quo tractatur de rarissimô Naturæ Miraculô Transmutandi Metalla, nempe quomodo tota Plumbi Substantia, vel intra momentum, ex quavis minima Lapidis veri Philosophici particula in Aurum obryzum commutata fuerit Hagæ Comitis, p. 196.

médaille de transmutation de Ferdinand III, 1648, figurant dans le Vitulus Aureus de Helvetius, p. 200 de la Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa , tome I, de Manget - [

cliquez sur l'image pour visualiser la version du Vitulus Aureus contenue dans le Musaeum Hermeticum]

[Johann Friedrich Schweitzer, latinized Helvetius,

great grandfather of the philosopher, was born at

Köthen, in the Duchy of Anhalt, in 1625 (Roth-

Scholtz says 1631), studied medicine, went to the

Hague, and became physician to the Prince of

Orange. He was the author of one or two medical

and botanical books, and also of some on alchemy, as:

De Alchymia opuscula complura veterum philo sophorum , Francof 1650, which I have not seen,

and which seems to me to be too curiously like a

book with the same title printed at Frankfurt in

1550. He is now remembered by the present work,

in which he gives an account of the transmutation

of which he was witness In 1666. The book passed

through several editions, and the case excited a

great deal of discussion. By some it was looked

on as conclusive proof of the actuality of trans

mutation ; by others it was considered too puerile for comment. [

on s'en est fait l'écho dans les sections consacrées à Alexandre Sethon et dans chimie et alchimie] Kopp, however, asks if a man like

Helvetius could have narrated such an occurrence

either erroneously or untruthfully: and he thinks

that it would not be reasonable to assume either.

On the strength of this cautious view more energetic

believers in the occult have brought it forward at

the present moment as historically incontestable. See Dr. G. H. Berendt, Das Buch der Wunder

(1901, the book is not dated, but it came out this year), ii. p. 700.

Helvetius died at the Hague, 29 Augt., 1709. His portrait is given in Roth-Scholtz's Bibliotheca Chemica , 1727, frontispiece to Stück iv.

The book was first published in Latin at

Amsterdam, in 1667; at the Hague, 1702, 8*, pp.

[1-6] 7-72, folding plate; and, it is said, also in

1705. The German version was published at

Nürnberg, 1668; other editions quoted are 1675, 1727; Frankf. a- M. 1705,1726. Dutch:

Gouden Kaff, waar in aangetoond wordt hoe door middel van den philosophischen Sleen het Lood in Goud is veranderd

, Amsterdam, 1749. Kopp has made a curious statement which deserves notice, otherwise it may lead to mistakes. When describing Helvetius' " Vitulus Aureus

," he adds in a parenthesis that he is not to be confusfed with a contemporary physician in Köthen of exactly the same name, who, in 1655, at Leyden. published iin alchemical writing " Ichts ausnichts." Now below Helvetius' portrait, as given by Roth. Scholtz, is the inscription: Johannes Fridericus Helvetius, Anhaltinus Göthönensis, Medicinae Doctor, et Practicus ab A. 1661.

Hagae comitis, denique ab A. 1676. Amstelodamensis, verus de transmutatione Plumbi In Aurum testis ejus denique fabricator

. Nat. A. 1631. On the Other Band, in the

Beytrag zur Geschichte der höhern Chemie

, 1785, p. 617, occurs the following: "214. lo. Frider.

Helvetii Ichts aus nichts, leiden 1655. 12, — Von einem Manne, der sich getrauete, ein goldnes Kalb zu zengen

kann man schon erwarten, das er etwas aus nichts hervorbringen konnte.

(he did not, but that does not affect the present argument !) " There is not the slightest doubt in these passages as to the identity of Helvetius of Köthen with the author of the Golden calf, and of the identity of the

author of " Icbts aus nichts " also with the author of the Golden Calf

. I am not aware of any ground for the distinction Kopp draws. He is so very accurate that one hesitates to believe that he has here been in some son of misapprehension, but it seems to be the case.

Au sujet de cette médaille, nous avons trouvé cet extrait dans l' Alchimie

de Van Lennep - Dervy, 1985 - à propos de Ferdinand III :

« En 1648, alors qu'il se trouvait a Vienne, Richthausen reçut un mot de son ami l'alchimiste Labujardière qui, à Prague se sentait à l'article de la mort. II l'enjoignait de venir chercher le plus rapidement possible une poudre de projection qu'il avait fabriquée et qu'il conservait dans un coffret. Richthausen arriva lorsque son ami était mort. II découvrit cependant le coffret. Le comte Schlick, qui s'était assuré les services de Labujardière, le réclama — mais Richthausen préféra lui en faire parvenir une réplique et remettre la poudre à l'empereur Ferdinand III. Celui ci, qui se méfiait des subterfuges, préféra opérer seul, se faisant assister du comte von Rutz, directeur des mines. Avec un grain de la poudre, l'empereur changea deux livres et demie de mercure en or pur, le 15 janvier 1648. La médaille commémorant cette réussite était ornée d'un Apollon héliocéphale avec cette inscription « Divine transmutation réalisée à Prague le XV janvier de l'an 1648 en présence de sa majesté l'empereur Ferdinand III » (

Divina metamorphosis exhibita Pragae XV lan A° MDCXLIII in praesentia sac maiest Ferdinandi tertu

). Sur l'autre face, on pouvait lire « Cet art appartient autant aux hommes remarquables qu'il apparaît rarement au jour — Dieu soit loué éternellement, lui qui confère une partie de sa puissance infime a nous ses humbles créatures » (

Raris haec hominibus est ars ita raro in lucem prodit. Laudetur deus in aeternum qui partem suae infinitae potentiae nobis suis abiectissimis creaturis communicat). »

Van Lennep, en notes, donne des sources où le Vitulus Aureus

de Helvetius n'est pas cité. Cette médaille est citée par Bernard Husson dans ses Transmutations alchimiques

(J'ai Lu, 1974), p. 158-160. Cf. aussi Kopp, Die Alchemie , p. 89.]

10. Joannes Chrysippus Fanianus. De Iure Artis Alchemiæ, hoc est variorum Autorum & praesertim Jurisconsultorum Judicia & Responsa ad Quæstionem An Alchemia sit Ars Legitima, p. 210.

11. Gulielmus Johnsonus. Lexicon Chymicum, p. 217.

12. Gulielmus lohnsonus. Lexicon Chymicum. Liber Secundus, p. 275.

13. Petrus Joannes Faber. Manuscriptum . . . Res Alchymicorum obscuras extraordinaria perspicuitate explanans, p. 291.

14. Petrus Joannes Faber. Epistolæ aliquot, p. 304.

15. Joannes Joachim Becher. Oedipus Chymicus, obscuriorum Terminorum & Principiorum Chymicorum Mysteria aperiens et resolvens, p. 306.

16. Theobaldus de Hoghelande. De Alchimiæ Difficultatibus Liber, in quo docetur, quid scire quidque vitare debeat vere Chemiæ studiosus ad perfectionem aspirans, p. 336.

17. Cato Chemicus, Tractatus quo veræ ac genuinæ Philosophiæ Hermeticæ & fucatæ ac sophisticæ Pseudo-Chemiæ, & utriusque Magistrorum Characterismi accurate delineantur p. 368. 18. Hermes Trismegistus. Tabula Smaragdina

. Cui titulus Verba Secretorum Hermetis Trismegisti W. Chr. Kriegsmanni & Gerardi Dornei Commentariis illustrata, p. 380.

19. Arnoldus de Villa Nova. Testamentum, p. 389.

20. Hermes Trismegistus, Expositiones Dornei, p. 389.

21. Hermes Trismegistus. Tractatus Aureus de Lapidis Physici Secretô, in septem Capitula divisus, cum Scholiis Anonymi, p. 400. 22. Turba Philosophorum

ex antiquo Manuscripto Codice excerpta, qualis nulla hactenus visa fuerat editio, p. 445. Ferguson

: It has been inferred by Schmieder that the anonymous tracts called 'Turba Philosophorum' were written tn the twelfth century, say about 1140, because authors before that date are definitely quoted, while others subsequent to it are not mentioned. Moreover, Alanus, who lived about that time or a little later, refers to the Turba, and it was commended by Albertus Magnus in the thirteenth century. There are two distinct collections which pass under this name. One contains 72 discourses, the other '78. Among the speakers are a few persons of classical antiquity whose names are familiar, such as Plato and Pythagoras, but the majority are quite strange, and their names are peculiar. So far as I am aware, they are met with nowhere else, and when they do occur in other writings it is because a passage is quoted from the 'Turba.' Borel, indeed, has transferred them to his list as if they were genuine alchemists, and for this he has been called to account by Morhof. The person to whom the work has been ascribed is called Arisleus, who is not to be confused with Aristaeus. Great importance was attached by later alchemists to the dicta contained in the 'Turba.' Bernhardus Trevisanus

says that his labour was all in vain till he was put on the right track by what is said by Parmenides in the 'Turba.' From this Kopp has infterred that he used the second form of the collection, but Kopp has made a slip here, for Parmenides' name occurs in both versions. Kopp has devoted a special paragraph to the 'Turba,' and has criticised the age assigned to it by Schmeider, which he considers not substantiated by his arguments, though it is more probable than the great antiquity with which it has been credited. He doubts also if Arisleus is to be reckoned the author, a person of whom nothing exact is known. Schmieder translates the title 'Conflict of Philosophers,' but Kopp prefers to interpret the name as meaning 'Assembly' or 'Convention of Philosophers.' Either of these translations is possible, but anyhow, one has to regard the tractate as the report of a meeting of a ' Hermetic

Association for the Advancement of Alchemy.' of which a certain Pythagoras was president, and Arisleus was the 'convener' and 'recorder.' But while agreeing with Kopp in the rendering of the term 'Turba,' it is possible also to share Schmieder'a opinion that the meaning is 'Streit der Philosophen,' which, without involving the notion of personal—but unphilosophical — violence, may be interpreted as the 'Clash of Scientific Opinion,' such as may be witnessed at more modem congresses. It must be admitted that the woodcut which accompanies the 'Turba' in some editions strongly rapports Schmieder's rather than Kopp's translation. The following index is given by Fabricius, the references being to the reprints in Manget's Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa, T. I. In this volume the first version of tbe Turba , in seventy-two discourses, begins on p. 445 ;

Allegoriae Sapientum et Distinctiones xxix. supra librum Turbae , p. 467 ; second version of the Turba , in seventy-eight discourses, p. 480 ; Allegoriae super Librum Turbae , p. 494 ;

AEnigma ex visione Arislei Philosophi et allegoriis Sapientum , p. 495

. A few inaccuracies in Fabricius' list, detected by comparing it with Manget's text, have been corrected.

23. In Turbam Philosophorum Sermo unus Anonymi, p. 465.

24. Allegoriæ Sapientum supra Librum Turbæ Philosophorum XXIX Distinctiones, p. 467.

25. Turbæ Philosophorum aliud exemplar, p. 480.

26. Allegoriæ super librum Turbæ, p. 494.

27. Ænygma ex visione Arislei Philosophi & Allegoriis Sapientum, p. 495.

28. Exercitationes in turbam Philosophorum, p. 497. 29. Artephius. Liber qui Clavis majoris Sapientiæ dicitur , p. 503. 30. Calid.

Liber de Compositione Alchemiæ quem edidit Morienus Romanus, Calid Regi Ægyptiorum

; quem 31. Robertus Castrensis de Arabico in Latinum transtulit, p. 509.

32. Geber. Summa Perfectionis Magisterii in suâ naturâ, p. 519.

33. Geber. Liber Investigationis Magisterii, p. 558. 34. Geber. Testamentum, p. 562.

35. Joannes Braceschus, De Alchemia Dialogus veram et genuinam librorum Gebri sententiam explicens, p. 565.

36. Joannes Gerhardus, Exercitationes perbreves in Gebri Arabis summi Philosophi libros duos Summæ perfectionis, p. 598.

37. Rogerius Baco. De Alcymia Libellus cui titulus Speculum Alchemiae, p. 613.

38. Rogerius Baco. De Secretis operibus Artis & Naturæ et de Nullitate Magiæ Epistola (ad Guilielmum Parisiensem conscripta), p. 616.

39. Avicenna. Tractatulus de Alchemiâ, p. 626.

40. Avicenna, De Congelatione et Conglutinatione lapidum, p. 636.

41. Aristoteles. De perfecto Magisterio Tractatus, p. 638.

42. Aristoteles. Tractatulus de practica lapidis philosophici, p. 659.

43. Arnaldus de Villanova. Thesaurus Thesaurorum & Rosarium Philosophorum, omnium Secretorum maximum secretum, de verissima compositione Naturalis Philosophiæ qua omne diminutum reducitur ad solificum & lunificum, p. 662.

44. Arnaldus de Villanova. Novum Lumen, I. p. 676.

45. Arnaldus de Villanova. Perfectum Magisterium & Gaudium transmissum ad inclytum Regem Aragonum, quod quidem est Flos Florum, Thesaurus omnium incomparabilis & Margarita, p. 679.

46. Arnaldus de Villanova. Epistola super Alchemia ad Regem Neapolitanum, p. 683.

47. Arnaldus de Villanova. Speculum Alchemiæ, p. 687.

48. Arnaldus de Villanova. Carmen, p. 698.

49. Arnaldus de Villanova. Quæstiones tam Essentiales quam accidentales ad Bonifacium Octavium cum suis Responsionibus, p. 698.
50. Arnaldus de Villanova. Semita semitæ , p. 702.

51. Arnaldus de Villanova. Testamentum, p. 704.

52. Raymundus Lullius. Testamentum, & primum de Theorica, p. 707.

53. Raymundus Lullius. Testamentum, pars Practica super Philosophico Lapide, p. 763.

frontispice du Testamentum attribué au pseudo Lulle [

Testamentum Raymundi Lulli doctissimi et celeberrimi philosophi

. Duobus libris universam artem chymicam complectens, antehac nunquam excusum. Item ejusdem Compendium animae transmutationis artis metallorum, absolutum jam et perfectum. (Ludolphus Verdemanus edidit) apud Ioannem Byrckmannum (Colonia) , 1573.] illustrations tirées de l'ouvrage (p. xx) : 1 - 1bis

(p. 709, Lib. II, sect. III, subsect. V - cap. III) - 2

(p. 711, cap. III : de forma minori et de principus natura mineralis simplicis per extremitates et media) - 3

(p. 712, cap IV : De approximatione Temperamenti respecta natura, de genera secundum regulam scientiae, de extremitatibus et de mediis et de ipsorum divisione in principiis essentialibus) - 4

(p. 764, cap. V : de secunda distinctione, quae est de figuris prima partis solutive) - 5

(p. 765, cap. VI : de tertia distinctione quae est de figuris, de secunda parte solutionis) - 6

(p. 765 : cap. VIII : de figura prima triangularis, qua demonstrat principium practica et de intentione triangulari) - 7

(p. 766, cap IX : de prima dispositione incipiendo spus in fermae practica) - A noter que la Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa

ne reprend pas une illustration qui, pourtant, paraît des plus importantes, car elle est en forme de lettres chiffres : 8 - 9

. La planche 9 donne l'explication des lettres de la planche 8. De même, la planche 10

n'est pas reprise non plus ; elle figure p. 170 de la Practica .

54. Joannes Gerhardus. Analysis Partis Practica Raymundi Lullii in Testamento, p. 778.

55. Raymundus Lullius. Compendium Animæ Transmutationis Artis Metallorum, Ruperto Anglorum Regi transmissum, p. 780.

56. Raymundus Lullius. Testamentum novissimum, Carolo Regi dicatum, p. 790.

57. Raymundus Lullius. Testamenti novissimi pars altera, p. 806. 58. Raymundus Lullius. Elucidatio Testamenti , p. 823. 59. Raymundus Lullius. Liber dictus Lux Mercuriorum

in quo explicatur quod in aliis Libris occultatum est, p. 824.

60. Raymundus Lullius. Experimenta in quibus veræ Philosophicæ Chemicæ Operationes clarissime traduntur, p. 826.

61. Raymundus Lullius. Liber Artis Compendiosæ quem Vademecum nuncupavit, p. 849.

62. Raymundus Lullius, Compendii Animæ Transmutationis Artis Metallorum aliud exemplar, p. 853.

63. Raymundus Lullius. Epistola de Accurtatione Lapidis Benedicti missa Anno 1412. Roberto Anglorum Regi, p. 863.

64. Raymundus Lullius. Liber Potestas Divitiarum dictus, in quo optima expositio Testamenti Hermetis continetur, p. 866. 65. Raymundus Lullius.

Clavicula quae & Apertorium dicitur, in qua omnia quæ in opere Alchemiæ requiruntur, aperte declarantur , p. 872.

66. Raymundus Lullius. Compendium Artis Alchemiæ et Naturalis Philosophiæ, p. 875.

67. Raymundus Lullius. Tractatus de Lapide et Oleo Philosophorum, p. 878.

68. Raymundus Lullius. Codicillus, seu Vademecum & Cantilena in quo fontes Alchemicae Artis ac Philosophiæ reconditioris uberrime traduntur, p. 880.

69. Joannes Braceschus. Lignum Vitæ, seu Dialoeus ex Italico in Latinum versus à G. Gratorolo Physicæ, quo 70. Raymundi Lulli Scripta explicantur, p. 911. 71.

Liber Mutus Alchemiæ Mysteria filiis Artis nudis figuris, evidentissime aperiens (15 planches), p. 938. planche 8 du Mutus Liber , édition de la Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa - cf. autres planches in gravures . Ferguson

: This is a series of fifteen engraved plates, without a word of explanation, portraying the preparation of the philosopher's stone. The plates are partly symbolical, partly pictorial, representing an alchemist and his wife engaged to chemical operations, such as sublimation, distillation, the hermetic sealing of flasks, and the old chemical apparatus is very well displayed. There is hardly a clue, however, to the substances symbolized, and none whatever to those obtained by the processes. The first edition of this work appeared at La Rochelle in 1677, in folio. [

les gravures de l'édition rochelaise sont accompagnées de commentaires et de l' Hypotypose de Pierre Dujols de Valois, dans le Mutus Liber] Barbier (Dictionnaire des Anonymes

, 1824, iii. No. 20997) has the following note upon it: L'auteur anonyme, dit Arcere dans son Histoire de la ville de la Rochelle

, 1757, in-4, t. 2, p. 384, pourrait être Jacob SAULAT, sieur DES MAREZ, lequel demnda un privilége pour ce manuscrit. Je crois que le vrai auteur est TOLLÉ médecin de la Rochelle, grand chimiste ; le nom

emprunté Altus le désigne assez. Quérard (Les Supercheries Littéraires Dévoilées

, 1869, i. 282d) enters this book under Altus and agrees with Barbier in ascribing it to Tollé. Brunet (i. 203) also enters it under Altus, but prefers ascribing it to Saulat. May Altus not be meant for a kind or anagram of Saulat ? Vogt (Calalogus. . . Librorum Rariorum

, 1747, p. 481), says merely that Saulat was the editor. - Kopp (Die Alchemia

, 1886, ii. 318) mentions the book, but says nothing about the author, and Lenglet-Dufresnoy before him is equally silent (Hist. de la Phil. Hermétique , 1742, iii. pp. 68, 91, 249). frontispice du tome II de la Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa de Mangetus Volume II. 72. Petrus Bonus. Margarita pretiosa novella , p. 1.

73. Joannes de Rupescissa. Liber Magisterii de confectione veri Lapidis Philosophorum, 4. 80.

74. Joannes de Rupescissa. Liber Lucis, p. 84. 75. Rosarium Philosophorum, p. 87.

76. Rosarii Philosophorum aliud Exemplar . . . per Toletanum Philosophum maximum, in p 119.

77. Rosarium Abbreviatum Ignoti, p. 133.

78. Guido de Montanor. Scala Philosophorum, p. 134. Ferguson

: Guido de Montanor, or Montano, or Guido Magnus de Monte, not Guido de Monte, was apparently a Frenchman, who flourished in the fourteenth or fifteenth century, judging from the fact that while he quotes Roger Bacon and Richardus, he in turn is referred to by writers of the fifteenth century, as by Ripley, who says that his,' fame goeth wide,' and calls him also ' sapient Guido.' Besides the Scala Philosophorum , he is credited with Decreta chymica , printed in Rhenanus' Harmoniae imperscrutabilis , and De arte chymica libellus , printed in Condeesyanus' Harmonia

, Francofurti, 1625, 8°. Of this there is a German translation, Guidonis Magni de Monte

Thesaurus chymiatricus, oder lange verborgener Schatz der Chymie

, Halle, 1623, 8°. Borel says that he is praised by Ripley, and wrote an Epistola chemica to a certain Greek Bishop. He also quotes De arte Alchemiae libellus

, which is probably only a variation of the above title. Some of these tracts I have not seen, and am consequently unable to say whether they are different or not. Nazari includes the Scala philosophorum in his list, but does not allude to Guido de Montanor. Baumer ascribes to him not only the Scala Philosophorum and Libellus de Arte chemica , but also the Clangor Buccinae , and Correctio Fatuorum . 79. Clangor Buccinæ, p. 147. 80. Correctio Fatuorum, p. 165.

81. Marsilius Ficinus. Liber de Arte Chemica, p. 172.

82. Calid Filius Jaici. Liber Secretorum Artis, p. 183.

83. Calid Rex. Liber Trium Verborum, p. 189. 84. Merlinus. Allegoria , p. 191. 85. Thesaurus Philosophiæ, p. 192.

86. Aurelia Occulta cum Senioris Zadith Tractatulô de Chemia, p. 198. Ferguson

: Schmieder does not hesitate to call this writer an

Arabian, and thinks that Arabic MSS. of him may

exist in the libraries of the Rhine towns. The

epithet 'Senior' he thinks denotes his antiquity, as

there is no Zadith junior ! His full name seems to

be Zadith Ben Hamuel, and he is placed io the

thirteenth century. Kopp does not allude to him and Hoefer, though he mentions bis name, has nothing to say about him. Schmieder quotes editions. Argent., 1566, 8°; Francof., 1605,4°. The 'Tabula Chymica' was included in the collection entitled:

Philosophiae Chymicae quatuor vetustissima scripta

, Francof. apud Johan. Bernerum, 1605, 8°. -

Zadith est Abû Abdallâh Muhammad ibn Umayl al-Tamîmî. Il vécut au dixième siècle de notre ère. Si l'on ne connaît pas ses dates exactes et si l'on sait effectivement très peu de choses sur sa vie, il est toutefois possible de bien cerner l'époque où il vécut et les milieux qu'il fréquenta, par une série de renseignements indirects que l'on peut tirer notamment du Fihrist d'Ibn al-Nadîm et qui concernent des personnages mentionnés par ailleurs par cet auteur dans le De Chemia. Le nom latin de Senior Zadith

, fils d'Hamuel s'explique ainsi : Senior traduit certainement l'arabe Cheikh; Zadith est très probablement une corruption de al- sâdiq, le véridique, le qâf final donnant un th, comme dans azoth (on rencontre également azoch) qui vient de al-zâwûq (le mercure); et filius Hamuel est la latinisation immédiate de Ibn Umayl. Ce dernier est l'auteur de plusieurs traités et poèmes, dont certains ne sont connus que par leur titre. On a pu émettre l'hypothèse que son Kitâb mafâtîh al-hikma al-`uzmâ était l'original de la Clavis majoris sapientiae

attribué à Artephius. Le texte qui nous intéresse se compose en réalité du traité intitulé Kitâb al-mâ' al-waraqî wa al-ardh al-najmîya (Livre de l'eau foliée et de la terre étoilée), se présentant lui-même comme un commentaire de la Risâla al-shams ilâ al-hilâl (Epistola Solis ad lunam crescentem). Ce traité est un classique et un jalon important de l'alchimie musulmane. Il représente une synthèse de plusieurs enseignements antérieurs (parmi ses sources possibles, citons la version arabe de la Turba philosophorum

, avec laquelle on peut relever nombre d'analogies très précises, ainsi que le Shawâhid d'al-Râzî). Il eut également une influence profonde et durable, puisque trois siècles plus tard al-`Iraqî en transcrivit un long passage dans son Kitâb al-`ilm al-muktasab fi zirâ`a al-dhahab (Livre de la science acquise concernant la culture de l'or), et que Jaldakî fit un long commentaire de la Risâla. En Occident, mentionnons que le texte

intitulé Rosinus ad Euthiciam, qui se trouve dans le recueil Artis Auriferae

quam Chemiam vocant... est une traduction d'un passage du De Chemia, lequel présente également de nombreuses similitudes avec les deux versions de la Turba que contient le même recueil. [d'après A. Allard]

87. Consilium Conjugii, seu de Massa Solis & Lunæ Libri III., p. 235.

88. Richardus Anglicus. Libellus utilissimus peri CemeiaV

, cui titulum fecit Correctorium, p. 266. 89. Georgius Ripleus. Liber Duodecim Portarum , ii, p. 275.

90. Thomas Northon. Tractatus Crede Mihi, seu Ordinale dictus, p. 285. [cf. Theatrum Britannicum, p. 1 et Muaseum Hermeticum, p. 433]

91. Joannes Dausten. Rosarium alcanum Philosophorum Secretissimum, p. 309.

92. Dialogus inter Naturam & filium Philosophiæ, p. 326. 93. Dionysius Zacharias. Opusculum Chemicum , p. 336.

94. Nicolaus Flamellus. Commentarius in Dionysii Zacharii Opusculum Chemicum, p. 350. 95. Collectanea ex Democrito, p. 361.

96. Nicolaus Flamellus. Tractatus brevis, seu Summarium Philosophicum, p. 368.

97. Joannes Aurelius Augurellus. Chrysopoeia, & Vellus Aureum, seu Chrysopüia major & minor, p. 371.

98. Nathan Albineus. Carmen Aureum, p. 387. 99. Nathan Albineus. Ænygma, p. 388.

100. Bernardus Trevisanus Liber de Secretissimo Philosophorum opere Chemico, p. 388. Hermes. Tabula Smaragdina , p. 389.

101. Bernardus Trevisanus. Responsio ad Thomam de Bononiæ . . . super eodem Opere, p. 399.

102. Basilius Valentinus. Liber de magno Lapide Antiquorum Sapientum, p. 409. 103. Basilius Valentinus. Liber duodecim Clavium , p. 413.

104. Basilius Valentinus. De prima Materia Lapidis Philosophici, p. 421.

105. Basilius Valentinus. Brevis Appendix & perspicua repetitio aut iteratio in librum suum de Magno lapide Antiquissimorum, p. 422.

106. Gerardus Dorn. Congeries Paracelsicæ Chemiæ de Transmutationibus Metallorum, p. 423. 107. Michael Sendivogius. Novum Lumen Chemicum , p. 463. 108. Michael Sendivogius. Parabola, seu Ænigma Philosophicum, p. 474. 109. Michael Sendivogius. Dialogus Mercurii, Alchemistæ et Naturæ , p. 475.

110. Michael Sendivogius. Tractatus de Sulphure, p. 479.

111. Michael Sendivogius. Apographus Epistolarum hactenus ineditarum super Chemia, p. 493.

112. Orthelius. Commentarius in Novum Lumen Chemicum Michaelis Seudivogii XII. figuris in Germania repertis illustratum, p. 516.

113. Guilielmus Trognianus. De lapide, p. 530.

114. Hydrolithus Sophicus, seu Aquarium Sapientum, p. 537.

115. Joannes Franciscus Picus Mirandulæ Dom. Opus Aureum de Auro tum æstimando, tum conficiendo, tum utendo, p. 558

116. Joannes Grasseus, alias Cortalasseus. Arca Arcani artificiossimi

de Summis Naturæ Mysteriis, constructa ex Rustico ejus majore & minore, & Physica naturali rotunda, per visionem Cabalisticam descripta, p. 585.

117. Anonymus Discipulus Joannis Grassei. Mysterium Occultæ Naturæ; De duobus Floribus Astralibus Agricolæ minoris in ejus Arca Arcani Artificiosissimi contentis, p. 619. 118. d'Espagnet. Enchiridion Physicæ restitutæ , p. 626. 119. d'Espagnet. Arcanum Hermeticæ Philosophiæ Opus

in quo occulta Naturæ & Artis circa Lapidis Philosophorum materiam & operandi modum, canonice & ordinate fiunt manifesta, p. 649. [Ferguson

: Espagnet's history is nearly as great an Arcanum as that of which be has attempted the revelation. Though by the majority of writers — if not by all -he seems to be quite well known, he is still called "Anonymus Gallus," and the books ascribed to him appear under the two phrases " Penes nos unda Tagi " and " Spes mea est in Agno," which pass for anagrams of his name. It may, however, be as well to note that the anagrams are by no means strict, if " Joannes d'Espagnet" be the form of the name operated on. For the former of these contains the letter u, which is not in the name, and only two e's, while the name has three. This discrepancy is frankly acknowledged in Roth-Scholtz's reprint, where it is said: " Anagr. e in u mutat. - Borrichius says that " Don Janus Espagnet" can be taken out of the anagram, which, certainly, it can be, letter for letter, but then the name never appears in that form. The other transposition is even farther astray, for it wants a d and an n, and it has an m which does not appear in the name at all. Apart, however, from this there is want of unanimity as to Espagnet's identity and as to the authorship of the tracts in question. Borrichius gives a very circumstantial account. He commends the Arcanum Hermeticae philosophiae Opus

as the wisest, most open and free from obscurities and double meanings of all the works he had perused. The author was concealed in the anagram, but was believed to be Don Janus Espagnet, a senator of the parliament of Toulouse. In 1664, when Borrichius met the son, also a senator of Toulouse, who was about sixty years of age, a straight-forward, learned man, and a chemist wholly devoted to the study of Raymund Lully, he asked him if his father had been an adept, and had published the book. He received no satisfaction as to the first point, whether because the son did not know or would not tell Borrichius leaves doubtful, but he admitted the second. In this account Borrichius is followed by Fuchs. All other writers state that Espagnet was president

of the parliament of Bordeaux; town-president Schmieder calls him, I presume, provost, or head of the town council, who adds that be followed Gaston Claveus as a defender of alchemy. Nothing more is on record about his life. There are various opinions as to the authorship of the books. Borel informs us that some affirmed that the Enchiridion

was not by Espagnet, but by another who was called ' Eques Imperialis,' or ' le chevalier imperial,' which he admits he had difficulty in believing. Borrichius also says that it was a question whether he was author or editor, and the doubt turns up in Bayle, Lenglet Dufresnoy, and others. Hoefer

holds a different opinion on the matter. After indicating the clear views and notable anticipations which he finds ia the Enchiridion he refuses to believe that the Arcanum . . . opus

be by tbe same person because the ideas and we style are so different. There is no doubt, however, that the books announce themselves as being by the same author, and Schmiede r— not that he is an authority upon such a point — regards the Arcanum . . . opus as the second part of tbe Enchiridion

, and apparently it did not occur to him to entertain doubts about the authorship. Morhof speaks of the Arcanum . . . opus

as a work " added on to the Enchiridion of Espagnet," and apparently not by him. He says it is elegantly written, and shows by its very style mat it is genuine, which is further proved by the fact that Philaletha

, who possessed the stone if ever any one did, mentions it and transcribes portions from it. The elegant diction in both if such that they seem to be by tbe same author, who was known as Anonymus Gallus. Dufresnoy expresses surprise that Morhof should have ascribed the works to Philaletha, but it seems to me that be has misunderstood his meaning. Morhof meant to convey that Philaletha, who was certainly an adept, would never have copied passages from it unless he had believed in its truthfulness. But he does not affirm that he was the author. Without any argument or hesitation Bayle ignores the two

difficulties which had been in existence for a couple of centuries, and at once states Espagnet to have been president of the parliament of Bordeaux and one of the learned men of the seventeenth century and reputed author of the Arcanum . . . opus . In 1623, at Paris, the Enchiridion

was printed, and this is known for his, because people who knew him well affirmed it to be this, and because the two anagrams are of his name. It was the first treatise in France which was in opposition to the physics of Aristotle. It was followed by the Arcanum . . . opus

in which is described the philosopher's stone, its preparation and properties. He also edited an old manuscript entitled Rozier des Guerres

, which was printed in 1616 exactly as it stood without changing or modernizing the spelling or language, which be followed with the almost exactitude. He believed that his was the first edition, but it was subsequently found that there had been already an edition in 1525. He also wrote a tract on the education of a young prince. He is reputed editor of the work of Pierre de L'Ancre on Demons, but this I have not been able to confirm. Of the writings several editions are enumerated: in Latin, Paris, 1608, 8° (which is the first); 1633, 8°; 1647, 1650, 32°; in German: Leiprig, 1685, 8°. According to Gmelin the Arcanum . . . opus

first appeared in the edition of 1638. If the dates now given be complete and correct, the above edition of 1638, called editio secunda, must be regarded merely as a reprint or reissue of that of 1623. '

- cf. également l'article que Chevreul consacre à Isidore Geoffroy Saint Hilaire et où il analyse des passages de l' Enchiridion de D'Espagnet.]
120. Philaletha.

Introitus apertus ad occlusum Regis Palatium , p. 661.

121. Philaletha. Tractatus de Metallorum Metamorphosi, p. 676.

122. Philaletha Brevis Manuductio ad Rubinum Celestem, p. 686.

123. Philaletha. Fons Chemice Philosophie, p. 693.

124. Joannes Ferdinandus Hertodt a Todtenfeldt. Epistola Contra Philaletham, 697.

125. Anonymi ad precendentenn Epistolam Responsio, p. 699.

126. Liber Praxeos Alchemicæ cum Additionibus Libavii, p. 700.

127. Nicolaus Barnaudus a Crista Arnaudi Delphinas. In Ænygmaticum quoddam Epitaphium Bononiæ ante multa sæcula marmoreo Lapidi insculptum, Commentariolus [Aelia Lelia Crispis], p. 713. [cf. Theatrum Chemicum, iii, p. 744]

128. Carolus Cæsar Malvasius. Extractum e Tractatu super eodem Epitaphio conscripto, p. 717.

129. Pantaleon. Bitolium Metallicum, seu Medicina duplex pro Metallis et Hominibus infirmis . . . in. venta . . ., p. 718.

130. Pantaleon. Tumulus Hermetis apertus p. 728.

131. Pantaleon. Examen Alchemisticum, p. 736.

132. Pantaleon. Disceptatio de Lapide Physico, in qua Tumbam Semiramidis ab Anonymo Phantastice non Hermetice sigillatam; jam vero reclusam, si sapiens inspexerit ipsam, promissis Regum Thesauris vacuam inveniet, p.744.

133. Tumba Semiramidis Hermetice sigillata quam si sapiens aperuerit, non Cyrus ambitiosus, avarus, Regum ille thesauros divitiarum inexhaustos, quod sufficiat inveniat, p. 759.

134. Ludovicus de Comitibus. Tractatus de Liquore Alchaest, & Lapide Philosophorum, . . . item de Sale volatili tartari &c., p. 764.

135. Ludovicus de Comitibus. Metallorum ac Metallicorum naturæ operum ex Orthophysicis fundamentis recens Elucidatio, p. 781.

136. Ludovicus de Comitibus. Appendix Symbole Crucis aliqualem explicationem exhibens, p. 840.

137. Claudius Germain Icon Philosophiæ occultæ, p. 845.

138. Christianus Adolphus Balduinus. Aurum superius & inferius Aure Superioris & Inferioris Hermeticum, p. 856.

139. Melchior Friben. Brevis enumeratio hactenus a se in Chemia actorum, p. 875.

140. I. B. De Spiritu Mundi Positiones aliquot, p. 876.

141. Andreas Cnöffelius. Responsum ad Positiones de Spiritu Mundi, quod in se continet Reserationem Tumbæ Semiramidis, p. 880.

142. Trames facilis & planus ad Auream Hermetis Arcem recta perducens, p. 887.

143. Daniel Stolcius de Stolcenberg. Hortulus Hermeticus e Flosculis Philosophorum cupro incisis conformatus, & brevissimis versiculis explicatus; quo Chemie studiosi pro Philotheca uti, fessique Laboratoriorum ministri, recreari possint, p. 895. Ferguson : [

à propos de l'édition originale, Francoforti, Impensis Lucae Jennisii. An. M.DC.XXVII

] 8°. Pp. 165 [3 blank]. The first eight pages are printed as usual, then on page 9, and every fourth page thereafter, there is a steel engraving containing four small emblematic pictures with a motto and an alchemist's name. Below the engraving are printed the mottoes. Pp. 10-11,14-15,18-19, and so on to the end, are blank. Pp. 8, 12, and every fourth page thereafter, have two couplets on each of the symbols on the following page.Nothing seems to be known about this author except what the title-page tells us, that he was from Bohemia, a 'candidatus medicinae' and a laureated poet. If be were so, his poems must have bad some merit, but his existence nevertheless has been overlooked by such literary historians as Jördens, Grässe, and Goedeke. The present work in German was appended to the 'Dyas Chymica Tripartita,' printed by Lucas Jennis in 1625, 4°. It has a distinct title-page and pagination:

Hermetico-Spagyrisches Lustgärtlein: Darinnen Hundert und Sechtzig unterschiedliche, schöne, Kunstreiche, Chymico-Sophische

Emblemata, oder Geheymnufs-reiche Sprüche der wahren Hermetischen Philosophen. Sampt beygefügten, noch vier grossen, schönen vnnd tieffsinnigen Theosophischen Figuren. Nicht allein sehr dienstlich, Augen vnnd Gemüt dardurch zu erlüstigen, sondern zugleich ein scharffes nachdencken der Natur, bey allen Filijs Doctrinae, zuerwecken

. Franckfurt am Mayn bey Luca Jennis zu finden. Anno M.DC.XXV, 4°, pp. 24 [2], 4 large folding plates. The ten plates, each containing sixteen emblems belonging to the most famous chemists from Hermes to Mylius, begin on p. 7 and fall on every odd page following. In his preface Jennis seems to claim the authorship of the collection, and says that it was previously used in the' Opus Medico-Chymicum' of Johannes Daniel Mylius (q.v.), but without mentioning in which of the three divisions of that work, published in 1618, it occurs. It is in the third: 'Tractatus III. seu Basilica Philosophica

continens lib. III.' The emblems are printed in four rows of four each, and occupy ten leaves. In my copy they are inserted at the end of the Praefatio. In the British Museum copy they are placed at the end of the volume, after the third book. To Stolcius also is ascribed another work:

Viridarium Chymicum figuris cupro Incisis adornatum & Poeticis Picturis illustratum authore Daniele Stolcio

, Francofurti, Jennisius, 1624, oblong 8°. The difficulty connected with this ascription is that a similar book bears the name of Michael Maier (q.v.) :

Viridarium Chymicum, Das ist: Chymisches Lust-Gärtlein

. . ., MDCLXXXVIII. Oblong 8°, pp. 112. The illustrations begin on p. 9 and fall on the odd pages to the end; the accompanying verses are on the even pages opposite. They start with the Twelve Keys

of Basilius Valentinus; then come the emblems from the Aurea Mensa , twenty-eight from the Atalanta fugiens , and eight modified from the Rosarium . 7)- Mylius, Johann Daniel.

Anatomia Auri, Sive Tyrocinium medico-chymicum , Continens in se partes quinque: Quarum frontispice de l 'Anatomia Auri ,

Sumptibus Lvcae Iennisi (Frankfurt), 1628 - cliquez sur l'image pour visualiser l'Incipit

Mylius, from the Wetterau, calls himself Theol. et Med. Candidatus. He was a physician and chemist early In the seventeenth century, and wrote several other works on iatro-chemistry, which are enumerated by Mercklin. - Opus Medico-Chymicum

: Continens tres Tractatus siue Basilicas; Quorum prior inscribitur Basilica Medica, Secundus Basilica. Chymica. Tertius Basilica Philosophica. Francofurti, apud Lucam lennis, 1618. 4°. Pp. [8] including the engraved title and the authors portrait. Each tract has a separate title and pagination, viz.;

. . . Tractatus Primus. Seu Basilica Medica continens Tres Libros seu Partes de salutifera. Medicina Antiqua Hippocratica: i. Physiologiam. 2. Pathologiam. 3. Therapeuticam, succincte demonstrat. Francofurti apud Lucam lennis. M.DC.XVIII. Pp. [36] 438. Vignette.

. . . Tractatus II. Seu Basilica Chymica continens Lib. VII. r. Anatomiam Auri. 2. Argenti & Mercurij. 3. lovis, Martis ac Veneris. 4. Tractat de gemmis. 5. Examinat mineralia. 6. Vegetabilia resoluit. 7. Animalia explicat. Francofurti apud Lucam lennis. M.DC.XVIII. Pp. [247, 1 blank] 184, 492, [Vignette of a Laboratory.] Three folding symbolical plates,

- [Basilica Philosophica continens Libros Tres. i, Philosophorum ac Sapientum antiquorum Consilia super Lapidem Philosophorum, seu Mediciam universalem. 2. Chymicorum Vasa et Fornaces. 3. Quaedarn Philosophorum obscura. Pp. [88] 271 [1] 44.] This copy wants the Basilica Philosophica. An index to this work was published in 1630 at Frankfurt. -

Anatomia Auri, sive Tyrocinium Medico-Chymicum , Francof., 1628, 4°,

- Pharmacopaea Spagyrico-Medica, Francof., 1628, 8°. - Philosophia Reformata , Francof., 1622, 4°; 1638, 4°. illustrations tirées de l'ouvrage

: 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - I.

Tradit concordantiam et harmoniam Solis coelestis cum Auro terrestri: item Auri definitionem et confusam multorum Physicorum de Auro opinionem; p. 1 II

. Agit de Medicinis aureis et Receptis antiquorum ac recentium Medicorum, Aurum ingredientibus, tam in simplici, quam præparata forma; p. 39 III

. Tractat de Auri potabilis præparatione tam vulgari, quam Philosophica; p. 145 IV

. Exhibet usum Medicinalem Auri potabilis tam communis, quam veri et Philosophici; p. 284 V

. Demonstrat ideam Lapidis Philosophici in duodecim figuris. [

cf. illustrations 4 à 6; elles reprennent les images du Pretiosissimum Donum Dei] p. 1 - 27

8)- Geberi, philosophi ac alchimistae maximi, de alchimia libri tres .

Ejusdem liber investigationis perfecti magisterii artis alchimicae. Iis additus liber trium verborum. Epistola item Alexandri imperatoris, qui primus regnavit in Graecia, persarum quoque extitit imperator, super eadem re. frontispice du Geberi Philosophie ac Alchimistae

, impensa Iohannis Grieninger (Estrasburgo), 1531 illustrations tirées de cet ouvrage : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - 8 - 9 -

9)- Gratarolo, Guglielmo. Alchemiae, quam vocant, artisque metallicae doctrina

certusque; modus, scriptis tùm novis, tùm veteribus, duobus his voluminibus comprehensus. Quorum elenchum à praefatione reperies. Cum gratia & privilegio Caesareae majestatis frontispice de l' Alchemiae

de Guillaume Gratarole, petrum Pernam (Basilea), 1572 In Primo Volumine continentur :

1. Chrysorrhoas, sive De arte Chimia dialogus. p. 1

2. Lignum vitae, dialogus Braceschi de materia lapidis. p. 26

3.Tauladani Animadversio in Braceschum. p. 153

4. Dialogus veram et genuinam Librorum Geberi sententiam explicans, Demogorgon Dialogus. p. 359 5. Speculum Alchimi Rogerij Bacchonis. p. 518 6. Correctorium Ricchardi Angli. p. 534 7. Rosarius minor. p. 577 8. De alchimia Albertus Magnus. p. 611 In Secundo Volumine continentur :

1. De Magni lapidis compositione incerto autore. 2. Aristoteles de Perfecto magisterio.

3. Liber perfectionis magisterii Arnaldi Villan.

4. Efferarius Monach. de Thesauro philosoph. 5. Practica Magisti Odomari. [

There are two accounts of this writer. One, the earliest authority for which, so far as I know, is Lenglet Dufresnoy, is that he was practising the Hermetic Art in 1330. Gmelin calls him a monk, which may be justified by the fact that he addresses his disciple as ' frater Ludovicus,' saying at the same time that he is violating all the rules of the sages in revealing the secret. Schmieder decorates these bare statements and depicts the monk in his cloister at Paris working hard at alchemy in spite of the pope's bull against the alchemists. He describes him as a true teacher who stated what he knew, but that be was more of a worker than an author, and be quotes his preparation of common salt. Hoefer

following the same line calls him a monk who pursued alchemy in Paris about the middle of the 14th century, in the reign of Phillippe of Valois.

He quotes the advice which Odomarus gives, to guard against the fumes which are liable to be produced in alchemical operations by stopping the nostrils with cotton dipped in oil of violets - cf. Chevreul, critique de Cambriel

-, and refers to his method of preparing aqua regia. The other account to given by Zedler. According to it Odomarus was a 'physicus' of the 17th century, and wrote not only the ' Practica,' but the six or seven

tracts following it in the above collections. From the way in which these books are printed, there is some colour for this statement of Zedler's, but at the same time he seems to have credited him with too many. Judging from the arrangement of the tracts and the sub -divisions, the following seem to be the most that could be assigned to Odomarus: Practica ad discipulum

, Theatrum Chemicum, 1659, iii. p. 166. -

Arcanum philosophorum ut ex Saturno facias Aurum perfectum , p. 168. -

Perfecta salis communis praeparatio ad lapidem philosophorum , p. 168. -

Historiola antiqua de Argento in Aurum verso

, p. 170, ending p. 172. The "Tractatus de Marchasita' and the others which are quoted by Zedler apparently belong lo other writers. Oddly enough Zedler refers not to the Theatrum Chemicum , but to the Thesaurus chymicus

, Strassb., 1613, iii. I do not know a collection of that name and date, but there is the Theatrum Chemicum

, Argent, 1613, add the above tracts are in vol. iii., pp. 154-161. They are also in the Theatrum Chemicum

, Ursellis, 1602, iii. pp. 164-171;. The ' Practica,' as its name denotes, is a series of directions for certain preparations and experiments, with silver, lead, mercury, common salt, green vitriol, saltpetre. By heating Roman vitriol one part saltpetre one part, common salt two parts in an alembic the author got a corrosive liquid which attacked all metals,' even mercury,' and he calls it 'aqua calcinationis omnium metallorum.' [cf. là-dessus arcanum duplicatum et laboratoire 2 .

] But to the mixture be also added half a part of quick lime, possibly with the idea of increasing its corrosive effect. One writer at least has affirmed that the above tract was brought out in a new edition by Ortholanus in 1358, under the title ' Practica vera Alkimica

.' Comparison of the two tracts, however, does not confirm this, and so far I have failed to see any connection between them. If Ortholanus edited Odomarus' tract he has edited it out of existence, or at least past recognition.] 6. Tractatus de Marchasita.

7. Epistola vetus de metallorum materia.

8. Io. de Rupescissa, de confectione veri lapidis. 9. Idem de Quinta essentia. 10. De viribus aquae ardentis.

11. Michael Savonarola de conficienda aqua vitae.

12. Aqua aurea, balsamum et oleum nigrum.

13. Ioan. augustini Augurelli Chrisopoeia, etc. - Gratarolo, Guglielmo : Verae Alchemiae

Artisque Metallicae, citra Aenigmata, Doctrina, certusque modus, scriptis turn novis tum veteribus nunc primum & fideliter maiori ex parte editis, comprehensus : quorum elenchum à Praefatione reperies. Habes, amice Lector, admiranda utilissimaq; multa, quae hactenus occultata, & veluti sepulta iacuerunt: quorum editionis rationem in Praefatione ad philosophos Chemistas paucis intelliges. Basileae M.D.LXI.

Folio in sixes, pp. [15, 1 blank] 244, 299 [1 blank], Colophon: Basileae per Henricum Petri & Pettrum Pernam, Anno salutis humanae M.D.LXI. frontispice du Verae Alchimiae de Guillaume Gratarole, 1611

1. Chrysorrhoas, sive De Arte Chymica Dialogus, i.

2. Dialogus loannis Braccschi, cui titulus est Lignum vitae, in quo etiam Gebri Pllilosophi expositio succincta continentur, i. p. 3.

3. In eundem Braceschuni Gebri interpretem, animadversio, authore loanne Tauladano, i, p. 47. (The author is called Robertus Tauladanus in the title of the tract)

4. Gebri Opera: Oc investigatione perfectionis, i. p. 112.

5. Gebri Opera: Summa perfectionis, i. p. 118. [

Attributed to Paul of Taranto OFM (late 13th cent.) by W. R. Newman, The genesis of the Summa perfectionis

, Archives internationales d'histoire des sciences 35 (1985) 240--302]

6. Gebri Opera: De inventione veritatis sive perfectionis, i. p. 184.

7. Gebri Opera: Liber Fornacum, i. p. 193.

8. Rogerii Bachonis De Alchemia libellus cui titulum fecit. Speculum Alchemiae , i. p. 201. 9. Richardi Anglici Libellus peri ChmeiaV

, cui titulum fecit, Correctorium, i. p. 207. 10. Rosarius minor, i. p. 222.

11. Liber Secretorum Alchemiae compositus per Calid, filium lazichi, i. p. 233.

12. Loci aliquot practiciae ex Gebero declatali per . . . Joannen Braceschum Vraeanum, i. p. 242.

13. Liber de Magni lapidis Compositione et Operatione, Authore adhuc incerto (also called De Alchemia), ii. p. 1.

14. Sententia loannis Baptistae Montani, de sublimatione, ii. p. 35.

15. Rosarius philosophorum Arnaldi de Villanova, ii. p. 35 [il s'agit en fait du Sommaire du Rosaire de Villeneuve par Lacidius].

16. Novum lumen eiusdem vel alterius, ii. p. 60.

17. Epistola Magistri Arnaldi de Villa nova super Alchymiam ad regem Neapolitanum, ii. p. 65.

18. Liber perfecti Magisteni, qui Lumen Luminum nuncupatur . . . vocatur etiam Flos florum Arnaldi de Villanova, longe correctior & melior hactenus impressis, ii. p. 67,

19. Practica Magiistri Arnaldi de Villanova, ad quendam Papam, ex libro dicto, Breviarius librorum Alchymiae, ii. p. 73.

20. Alberti Magni Ratisponensis episcopi de Alchymia liber integerrimus, ii, p. 78.

21. Scriptum Alberti super Arborem Aristotelis, ii. p. 102.

22. Apertorium Raymundi Lullii De veri lapidis compositione, ii. p. 104.

23. Ars intellectiva ejusdem super Lapidem Philosophorum, ii. p. 112. 24. Practica ejusdem, ii. p. 127.

25. Idem de intentione Alchimistarum, ii. p. 139. (Doubtful tract?)

26. Ejusdem Summaria Lapidis Consideratio et eius abbreviationes, ii. p. 156.

27. Ejusdem Libellus utilissimus de Mercurio solo, ii. p. 163. 28. Liber experimentorum, ii. p. 174.

29. Pulcherrimum opus de transmutatione metallorum, ii. p. 175.

30. Capitulum valde magnum in albedine, & omnibus nobilius, ex libro qui dicitur Philosophus mirabilis, ii. p. 180. 31. Liber Mercuriorum Raymundi Lullii, ii. p. 183.

32. Intentio summaria, quae aliter dicitur Repertorium, valde utilis ad intelligentiam Testamenti, Codicilli & aliorum librorum Raymundi Lullii, ii. p. 185

33. Aristotelis de Perfecto Magisterio exquisitum & integerrimum opus, &c., ii. p. 188.

34. Libellus duodecim aquarum, ex libro Emanuelis, ii. p. 209.

35. Aquae rubeae Avicennas ad tingendum quatuor spiritus sublimatos albos, ii. p. 211.

36. Elixiriorum varia compositio & modus, ii. p. 220.

37. Joannis de Rupescissa liber de confectione ver Lapidis Philosophorum, ii. p. 226.

38. De lapide Philosophorum secundum verum modum formando Efferarii monachi, ii. p. 232. 39. Thesaurus Philosophiae, ii. p. 237.

40. Praxis universalis Magni operis, ex Raymundo, ii. p. 248.

41. De lapidis philosophorum formatione epilogus, ii. p. 248.

42. Practica Magistri Odomari ad discipulum, ii. p. 249

43. Arcanum Philosophorum, ut ex Saturno facias aurum perfectum, ii. p. 250.

44. Perfecta Salis communis praeparatio ad lapidem philosophorum, ii. p. 250,

45. Historiola Antiqua de Argento in aurum verso, ii. p. 252.

46. Tractatus de Marchasita, ex qua fit Elixir ad album verissimum, ii. p. 254. 47. Caput de sale alchali, ii. p. 258.

48. Quaestio an Lapis philosophicus valcat contra pestem, ii. p. 259. [

un écrivain moderne a mis en scène dans le roman Imprimatur

- Monaldi & Sorti, JC Lattès, 2002 - une recette qu'aurait élaborée le père Kircher contre la peste ; l'autre héros du roman qui apparaît en toile de fond est Fouquet. L'ambiance rappelle Umberto Eco dans ses meilleurs moments...]

49. Velus Epistola doctiss. de Metallorum materia, & artis imititatione, ii. p. 263.

50. Practica Caravantis Hispani, ii. p. 264.

51. Lapidis Philosophici Nomenclaturae, & Gulielmo Gratarolo collectae. ii. p. 265.

52. loannis Aurelii Augurelli Chrysopoeiae libri iii., et Geronticon Liber i., ii. p. 269. 53. Regimina Artis, ii. p. 299. Ferguson

: The tract on nomenclature was translated into English and published in H. P.'s Five Treatises of the Philosopher's Stone, London, 1652, p. 65; but the author is misnamed ' Gratacolle.' Gratarolo was a native of Bergamo, where he was born in 1516. He went through the customary training, and then turned his attention to medicine. Having acquired a liking for Protestantism he settled in Basel in 1555, and remained there till 1562, when he was summoned to Marburg as professor of medicine. He, however, remained only a year there, and returned to Basel, where he practised medicine and wrote several works. The date of his death is given variously by the different authorities. Nigidius, Freher, Boissard,

Jöcher, Bayle give the date as 6 May, 1562. As against that are theses published by him on 9 May, 1562, and the works of Pomponatius and of Wilhelmus neponymus' Dialogus de substantiis physicis, &c., Argent. 1567. So Niceron quoting from his epitaph gives the date 16 April, 1568, he being in his fifty-second year, and Strieder gives the same date. He points out, however, that in the Diarium eruditorum virorum, Frft. 1612, Gratarolo is said to have died on 16 April, 1564, in his seventy-fourth year, which would carry his birth back to 1490, for which there is no authority, as in the above inscription he is said to have died in his fifty-second year. The dates given by the different authorities do not at all agree. His works treat of medicine, on the strengthening of the memory, rural economy, wine, Marpurg University, the hot springs in Rhaetia, &c. He edited the works of Bernard of Trevisan, Pietro d'Abano, and a Praxis medica, which last however is doubtful. 10)- Elias Ashmole's Theatricum Chemicum Britannicum

Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum. Containing Severall Poetical Pieces of our Famous English Philosophers, who have written the Hermetique Mysteries in their owne Ancient Language. Faithfully Collected into one Volume, with Annotations thereon, by Elias Ashmole, Esq. Qui est Mercuriophilus Anglicus.

The first part, London, printed by J. Grismond for Nath: Brooke, at the Angel in Cornhill. MDCLII. 1652. xvi + 486 + viii pages .

frontispice du Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum, Londres, Brooke, 1652 illustrations tirées de l'ouvrage : p. 13 - 44 - 51 - 91 - 102 - 116 - 117 - 213 - 348 - 350 - 379 - Ferguson : Ashmole (1617-1602)

is famous for his keen delight in the acquisition of knowledge and for his business capacity. He was an antiquary, herald, astrologer, alchemist, collector of all sorts of curiosities and rarities: a remakable mixture of shrewdness and what would now be termed superstition. Under the anagram James Hasolle, he also edited a small volume called

Fasciculus Chemicus or Chymicall Collections

, London, 1650, 12°, containing prolegomena, Arthur Dee's collections, and a translation of Espagnet's Arcanum , His chief alchemical work is the Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum

, London, 1653,4° with several engravings. It contains a series of old English poems on Alchemy, with notes by Ashmole. It is called Part i.. and in the preface to the present work Ashmole regrets that he had been prevented carrying it any further. No more was published, and the first part is now very rare, and difficult to get complete. The contents are reprinted by Gmelin, Geschichte der Chemie (1797), i. p. 620.

1. To All Ingeniously Elaborate Students, In the most Divine Mysteries of Hermetique Learning

2. The Ordinall of Alchimy. Thomas Norton p. 1 [cf. Musaeum Hermeticum , p. 433 et Bibliotheca Chemica Curiosa , vol. 2, p. 285] 3. Compound of Alchymie . George Ripley p. 107 [il s'agit des Douze Portes]

4. the Figure conteying all the secrets of the Treatise both great & small

5. Liber Patris Sapientiae. Anonymous p. 194 6. Hermes's Bird. Anonymous p. 211

7. The Tale of the Chanons Yeoman. Geoffry Chaucer p. 227 8. Dastin's Dreame. John Dastin p. 257

9. Upon the Elixir. Pearce (the Black Monke) p. 269 10. Richard Carpenter's Worke p. 275

11. The Hunting of the Greene Lyon. Abraham Andrewes. p. 278

12. The Breviary of Naturall Philosophy. Thomas Charnock p. 291 13. AEnigmaes. Thomas Charnock p. 303

14. Bloomefield's Bloffomes. William Bloomefield p. 305 15. Sir Edward Kelley's Worke. p. 324

16. Sir Edward Kelley to G.S. Gent. p. 332 17. Doctor John Dee'sTestament. p. 334

18. Of the Philosophers Stone. Thomas Robinson p. 335

19. Experience and Philosophy. Anonymous p. 336 20. The Magistery. W.B. p. 342

21. Anonymi, or Severall Workes of unknowne Authors. p. 334 & 404

22. Upon the Philosopher's Stone. John Gower p. 368

23. The Vision of Sir George Ripley. p. 374 24.

Verses Belonging to an emblematic Scrowle . Ripley's Scrowle. p. 375 25. Mistery of Alchemists. p. 380

26. Preface to the Medulla, Geo. Ripley p. 389 27. A Short Worke. George Ripley p. 393

28. Secreta Secretorum. John Lydgate p. 397 29. The Hermit's Tale. Anonymous p. 415

30. Discription of the Stone. Anonymous p. 420

31. The Standing of the Glasse, etc. Anonymous p. 421

32. AEnigma Philosophicum. William Redman p. 423 33. Fragments. p. 424

34. Annotations and Discourses upon Some part of the preceding Worke.

35. A Table of The Severall Treatises, with their Authors Names, contained in this Worke p. 501 36. A Table explaining the Obscure, Obselete, and mis-spell'd words used throughout this Worke. p. 503

11. Bono da Ferrara, pietro et al. Pretiosa margarita novella

de thesavro ac pretiosissimo philosophorvm lapide, artis huius diuin typus, & methodus: collectanea ex Arnaldo, Rhaymundo, Rhasi, Alberto, & Michaele Scoto, per Ianum Lacinium Calabrum nunc primum, cum lucupletissimo indice, in lucem aedita .

8°. Ff. [20] 202. Tabula, Errata, Registrum, and Colophon, and Aldus' device [14]. 22 woodcuts. The anchor is on the title-page, and on the verso of the last leaf. The colophon, on the verso of the last leaf but one, runs: Venetiis, Apud AIdi Filios, M.D.XXXXVI. Ferguson

: Toppi says that Lacinius was a Calabrian whose work was printed by Aldus in 1546 and again by Gabriel Hayn at Nuremberg, 1554. 4°. This last book has the following title: Praeciosa ac nobilissima artis Chymiae Collectanea de occultissimo ac praeciosissimo Philosophorum lapide. Per lanum Lacinium Calabrum Minoritam Theologorum minimum. Nunc primum in lucem aedita cum totius libelli capitum indice [Vignette]. Norimbergae apud Gabrielem Hayn,Ioann. Petrei generum, M.D.LIIII. 4°, ff. [8, including a full-page woodcut] 124. It contains collections in five books, the last of which is a reproduction with modifications of ff. 160-194 in the Pretiosa Margarita Novella of 1546. The work by Petrus Bonus, so called, was afterwards issued under the following title: Introductio in divinaro Chemiae Artern Integra Magistri Boni Lombardi Ferrariensis Physici. Nunc primum integra in lucem edita. . . . Basileae, apud Petrum Pernam, M.D.LXXII. 4°, pp. (7, 1 blank) 278. [Index ?] It claims therefore to be more complete than the Aldine edition. The preface to Albertus, Duke of Bavaria, was written by Toxites. This book was reprinted: Montisbeligardi, apud lacobum Foillet, M.DC.II. 8°, pp. [20] 398 [12, 2 blank]; and again: Argentorati, Impensis Lazari Zeteneri Bibliop. M.DC.VIII. 8°, pp. [20] 398 [12, 2 blank]. See the notes to BONUS (PETRUS) . frontispice de la Margarita Preciosa Novella

de Petrus Bonus, apud Aldi filis (Venecia), 1557

Colloquium nuncupatorium, interloquutores Bonus et Lacinius, iiij. verso. illustrations tirées de l'ouvrage : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - 8 - || - 9 - 10 - 11 - 12 - 13 - 14 - 15 - 16 - 17 - [

il existe des versions en couleurs mais elles ne semblent pas originales. On trouve encore d'autres versions de ces gravures de meilleure qualité mais de format beaucoup plus réduit et sans texte dans le site suivant :

http://www005.upp.so-net.ne.jp/macrocosm/alchemy/alchemy.html]

1. Pretiosa Margarita Novella, ex concordantijs sapientum collecta, . . . Petro Bono Ferrariensi autore, f. 1. 2. Epistola Boni Ferrariensis, f. 132.

3. Collectanea Lacinii ex Arnaldo de Villa Noua quae practicae compositionem lapidis philosophorum continent & exquisite decent, f.

136.

4. Epistola sive Epitome Raymundi Lulli, f. 160.

5. Collectanea Lacinii sive breuia excerpta ex libro luminis luminum Rhasis, f. 167.

6. Collectanea Lacinii ex Alberto Magno atque diuo Thoma alijsq; autoribus, f. 180.

7. Quaestio Curiosa de Natura Solis et Lunae ex Michaele Scoto, f. 195. Ferguson

: The work professes to have been written in 1330-39 at Pola in Istria. The author was a Master of Arts, was convinced of the truth of Alchemy which he defended from the attacks made in his time, and maintained that the real way had been shown by Geber. Gesner, followed by Morhof, makes him coaeval with Lully. Nasari calls him in one place Fertarien; (sic}, but in another Florensis, which presumably is a slip. Maszuchelli, however, drawing from apparently good sources, calls him Pietro Antonio Boni, says he lived in 1494, was a phystician who was skilled in philosophy and took delight in Alchemy and wrote Rationes pro Alchimia et contra

, which was included in Lacinius collection of 1546, and has been criticised by Hoefer, because in the first chapter he proves that alchemy is not wise, and in the second that it is. He is identical with Pietro Boni Lombardo Ferrarese of the present work. These accounts, however, obviously do not tally. In the British Museum Catalogue this work is ascribed to Piotro Buono Avogario. See the note on LACINIUS

. The first edition of the Margarita was edited by Lacinius, Venice, Aldus, 1546, 8°; thereafter, Nürnberg, 1554, 8°; Basel. 1572, 4°; Strasburg, 1608, 8°. The De Secreto omnium secretorum Dei domo

is contained in Lacinius' collection, Basel, 1572, as well as his Epistola

. An English translation from the edition of 1546, with a prefatory notice, was made by Arthur E. Waite: Tht New Pearl of Great Price,

A treatise concerning the treasure and most precious Stone of the Philosophers

, London, 1894. 8°, pp. xi.[1 blank] 441 [3]. 12. Ferguson, John. Bibliotheca chemica :

a catalogue of the alchemical, chemical and pharmaceutical books in the collection of the late James Young of Kelly and Durris,.... Volume II / by John Ferguson,..., Maclehose and sons (Glasgow), 1906 frontispice du volume 2

John Ferguson was born on 23 January 1837 in Alloa, Clackmannanshire, Scotland, son of William, a merchant. He was educated at the High School of Glasgow and at Glasgow University from 1855-1864 . His first studies at Glasgow University were in the Arts Faculty, receiving a BA in 1861 and an MA the following year. After this he continued his studies, finishing in the Medical Faculty, the only way he could then study Chemistry. He won a number of prizes at University including the Ewing Gold Medal for his essay "Historical Account of the Papacy as a temporal power in Europe", the Gartmore Gold Medal for "The Advantages & Disadvantages of Federal Government" and he twice won the Watt prize for essays entitled "On Cohesion" and "Electricity & Magnetism from the Middle of the Last Century".

John Ferguson studied Natural Philosophy under Professor William Thomson, Lord Kelvin, and Chemistry with Professor Thomas Anderson. From finishing his studies in 1864 until 1868 when he was appointed University Assistant with charge of tutorial classes and laboratory supervision, he worked as private assistant to Professor Anderson. In 1869 , Professor Anderson was taken seriously ill and John Ferguson undertook the general running of the department until November 1870 when the Professor returned. It was during this time that the University moved from the High Street to Gilmorehill and it was down to Ferguson to plan the new Chemistry Laboratories. Anderson never fully recovered from his illness and when he died in 1874 , John Ferguson became his successor.

He wrote widely on Chemistry and particularly on the history of the subject when the History of Science was not widely published in scientific journals. He was often published in the Proceedings of the Royal Philosophical Society of Glasgow, the Society for which he was president of the Chemical Section and then full President from 1892-1895 .

The major work for which he will be remembered is

Bibliotheca chemica: a catalogue of the alchemical, chemical and pharmaceutical books in the collection of the late James Young

(Glasgow, 1906). His interest in alchemy and the occult science lead him to collect a large number of books on the subject.

His nickname "Soda" is said to have derived from his personality -a little caustic. Besides holding the office of President of the Royal Philosophical Society of Glasgow, Professor Ferguson was a President of the Glasgow Archaeological Society 1892-1893, a Fellow of the Royal Society of Edinburgh 1888 and of the Society of Antiquaries 1890, the Chemical Society 1872 and the Institute of Chemistry in London 1878 . He was awarded an LLD by St Andrews University, Scotland, in 1887. He belonged to several learned societies in Europe and was an honorary member of the Imperial Military Academy of Petrograd. Throughout his life, John "Soda" Ferguson had been connected with Glasgow University, his last position being as Honorary Curator of the Hunterian Library. He died on 2 November 1916 .

Dr. James Young (1811-1883) - photogravure par Armand & sons Introduction : DR. JAMES YOUNG, [

Dr. Young was born on July 13, 1811, and died May 13, 1883. for details about his life

and career there may be consulted the article by P. T. Hartog in the Dictionnary of National Biography, 1900, Ixiii, p. 376, with the references there given, the obituary notices of him in the Proceedings of the Societies with which he was connected, and a brief estimate of him by

myself, with a portrait, in Memoirs and Portraits of One Hundred Glasgow Men, Glasgow, 1886, ii. p. 341, No. l00

.] under whose directions the present collection of books was made, was a native of Glasgow. In his youth he was set to learn a trade, but having entered Anderson's College when Thomas Graham, afterwards Master of the Mint, was professor there, and was commencing those researches which have put him in the first rank of experimental chemists, he studied chemistry under Graham, and by a succession of events came to be the originator of the paraffin oil industry in Scotland. In after years, when he had retired from active participation in business, not unmindful of his own early drawbacks and difficulties, he established a Chair of technical chemistry in Anderson's College, which has been incorporated with the recently created institution called the Glasgow and West of Scotland Technical College. Furthermore, he erected a statue in Glasgow to the memory of his teacher, Graham, and he gathered the present library, which he bequeathed to the Chair which he had endowed. The collection was begun by himself about the middle of last century, and it is plain that he took much interest in the history of chemistry and must have discussed the study of it with his friend, the late Dr. Angus Smith of Manchester, who also was a collector and was desirous of seeing more attention devoted to it. Dr. Smith's idea of reprinting epoch-making books and papers was long after carried out in part by the Alembic Club in Edinburgh, and on a more general plan by Ostwald, in his series of chemical and physical classics. Of more living importance, however, is the recent movement, in Germany especially, which has led to the formation of the Society for the History of Medicine and the Natural Sciences, to the establishment of courses of lectures on that subject and to the recognition of it as an important branch of knowledge by both the International Historical and the Medical Congresses. As yet no action in this direction has been taken in Britain; the history and evolution of chemical, natural, and physical science are ignored by the British Association, of medicine by the Medical Association, and the Antiquarian Societies have their attention otherwise occupied. Still there is not wanting proof that even in this

country there is interest in this section of history and that there are some who pursue it [

In England the only original contribution which has been wade in recent years to the history of any part of physical science is the edition of Gilbert's book on the Magnet, with the accompanying: notes and various biographical papers and essays by Professor Sylvanus Thompson. This is as fine a piece of work as could be desired

.] Perhaps if the few who do this could combine their efforts, a stimulus might be given to a systematic cultivation of the subject. Dr. Young's prescience was exhibited in various ways, but in none was his breadth of view and foresight more conspicuously displayed than when, long before this movement had begun, he was making provision for the study and teaching of the history of the science, which he had cultivated practically and technically with such success. The founder of a great industry, which has added so much to the comfort, .and even luxury of life, immersed as he was in the mechanical and chemical details of the process, engrossed in business transactions, distracted by the worries of competition, and by attempts to minimize the merit of his invention, was hardly the person whom one would have expected to undertake the formation of a library of old, neglected, and out of the way books on the practically extinct topic of alchemy; yet Dr. Young did this because he perceived that as alchemy happens to be one of the phases which chemistry formerly presented, a survey of it is indispensable for completing the history of the whole science. He did not collect for one of the bibliophile's reasons: because the books were rare and curious, but for the student's reason: because they were needed for research, and because no collection of them was accessible to the student here in connection with his Chair. The collection thus made by him consists of about 1300 pamphlets and volumes, but, as a good many volumes contain several tracts bound together, the actual number of separate items may reach 1350 or 1400. This number, however, includes only the works printed separately and does not represent the whole contents of the library. There are, besides, writings which do not seem ever to have

been printed by themselves, but only in the collected editions which form a characteristic feature of alchemical literature. If these be included the number of distinct and independent articles will be increased by a considerable amount. One, indeed, could have wished that the lines upon which the library was begun, had not been departed from quite so much, and that the attention originally given to English works had been maintained. That desire is intensified by knowing that when the collection was making, these books could still be purchased, whereas now they have disappeared altogether; and it may be said, without much fear of contradiction, that they will hardly be seen again. An odd specimen may make its appearance from time to time, but the books as a class are no longer to be had. It is fortunate that some of these exceedingly rare treatises in English were secured before it was too late; they are so much gain to the library. Considering what influence the great idea of supplying material for the study of the history of chemistry exercised upon Dr. Young, one can imagine how much more he would have done for his library had he lived longer. Having made so full a gathering of the alchemical writings, he might have got together even more of the works by the chemists in the latter half of the eighteenth century than has been done. They would have been invaluable to those interested in the origins of modem chemistry. This period has not been forgotten by any means, but it has not been so elaborately worked out as some of those before it. It may afford a more exact view of the extent of the library, if the chief authors in the different periods, whose works have been here brought together, be enumerated. When one considers that speculations and operations relative to the chemical properties of matter have been in vogue certainly from the second or third century of our era, and that the alchemists and chemists were diligent composers of books, it will be easily understood that the literature is extensive, as well as rare, and much beyond the power of anyone, however eager and persistent, to amass in his life-time. In fact even the largest libraries exhibit deficiencies. Now Dr. Young's collection is noteworthy in being so comprehensive as it is, and containing so many of the writings

especially of the German alchemists of the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries. The student will not find everything, and still less every edition—for that he will get nowhere—but he will have ample material for acquiring a knowledge of the earlier phases of the science. The history of chemistry presents various aspects for treatment, but, for our present purpose, it may be arranged broadly in three periods:

1. The period of belief in transmutation — the alchemical period — which begins at the earliest date of which there is a record and stretches down to the commencement of the nineteenth century, with sporadic survival to the present time. Along with the notion of transmutation there existed the preparation and employment of various kinds of bodies in pharmacy and medicine, and practical applications of substances in the technical arts. These were empirical, but from both a considerable body of experimental facts of important practical use was brought together, though still without anything of a guiding principle.

2. The iatro-chemical period, which began in the sixteenth century, and died out about the close of the seventeenth century.

3. The period of scientific chemistry, which began in the seventeenth century shortly before or about Boyle's time, and continues to the present moment

These aims of chemistry, therefore, for a time ran parallel with each other and materially influenced each other. The iatro-chemists transplanted alchemical ideas into medicine and pharmacy, and on the other hand one of the most important of Boyle's labours was his criticism of the then current doctrines of elements and theory of composition. It belongs to history to trace and explain the processes by which each period was modified, absorbed, and at last replaced by another, to allot to the various labourers their due praise for what they accomplished, and to record the acquisitions of fact which remain established to this day. As it is solely from the literature which has descended to us, that insight into the state of the science during these periods is obtained, an ideal historical library should represent all

periods and all aspects, and should contain the works of all authors. I am not aware that such a library exists. It is only an approximation to this ideal that any collection can offer. We may now see what the present one embraces.

1. As the alchemical books in the library are much the most abundant, they may be taken first, and roughly in chronological order. The earliest portion is that of the Greeks, beginning with Democritus

in the second or third century A.D. Apart from the Greek MSS. themselves, which are attainable only in certain European libraries, the first access to their contents was through the translation of a portion of them by Pizimenti. There is a copy of the rare reprint of 1717 in the library, so that the student can thus start from the very oldest records. Next comes the Arabic epoch represented by the works of Geber , Kalid

, Rhazes, Avicenna. This is followed by the productions ascribed to Morienus , Hortulanus , Arisleus , Artephius

, Ferrarius, petrus v. Zalento, Haimo and the pseudo. Merlin .

Most of these personages are more or less shadowy, but writings in their names are extant, and it rests with the historian to appraise their claims to acceptance as genuine. The authors of the thirteenth century are better known than the preceding, but there are doubts as to some of the alchemical writings which pass for their composition. Such as they are these are said to be by Albertus Magnus , Thomas Aquinas

, Michael Scotus, Christophorus of Paris, Roger Bacon , Arnaldus de Villa Nova , Richardus Anglicus, Guido de Montanor

. The next century furnishes a list of notable people: Pope John XXII., Jean de Meun, Raymond Lully , Cremer of Westminster, Pietro Bono , Antonio de Abbatia, Odomar, Rupescissa , Ortolanus, Flamel

. As time goes on more writers on the subject appear. In the first half of the fifteenth century there are the reputed Basilius Valentinus , Joannes of Tetzen , Isaac Hollandus, Lasnioro, Lambspringk , and, in the second half, Bernard of Trevisan

, Ficinus, Trithemius, Poyselius, Vincent Koffsky , George Ripley , Thomas Norton , Trissmosinus

. In the early part of the sixteenth century one meets with Augurello, Picus de Mirandula, Pantheus, Lacinius , Bracesco, Grewer , P aracelsus , Agricola, Denis Zachaire

, Petrus Arlensis, Robertus Vallensis, Alexander von Suchten, p. haedro, Wenceslaus Lavinius

. In the latter part flourished Thurneysser, Nazari, Carerius, Quadrammii da Gubbio, Blaise de Vigenère, Penotus, Barnaud , Balbian, Edward Kelley, Dr. Dee

, Francis Antony, Robert Fludd, Beuther, Sebald Schwertzer, Wittestein, and the two Khunraths .

The seventeenth century is perhaps the mast prolific of all in alchemical writers, and richest in narratives of transmutations accomplished, in books written in explanation and defence of the art, as well as in those by others who doubted it. It opens with the adventures of Alexander Seton the Cosmopolite

, followed by the romantic episode of the Rosicrucian Society, and among the crowd of alchemists and chemists may be mentioned Libavius , Figulus , Crollius , Pontanus , Grasshof , Schaubert, Rhenanus , Gerhard, Michael Maier

, Birelli, Billich, Johannes de Padua, Angelo Sala, Guibertus, d'Espagnet , Nuysement , Potier, Castaigne , L'Agneau, Palmarius, Drebbel

, Hoghelande, Samuel Northon; though some of these are also to be found among the iatro-chemists. The second quarter of the century includes Sendivogius

, Ambrosius Muller, Grosschedel ab Aicha, Batsdorf

, Rist, Johannes Agricola, Kessler, Liberius Benedictus, Conringius, Peter Faber, Philaletha , Starkey

, Zwelffer, Zwinger. Between 1650 and 1675 fall the names of Richthausen, Monte Snyder, Glauber

, Harprecht, Kircher, Blauenstein, Clauder, Otto Tachenius, Becher

, Löwenheim, Drechssler, Albineus, Morhof, Borrichius, Helvetius

, Kerkring, Vreeswyk, Johnson, Borel, Germain, Atremont, Du Clos , de Comitibus, Ashmole

, Borri. In the last quarter are W. v. Schröder, Seyler, Krohnemann, Cardilucius, Balduinus, Kunckel , Wedel, v. Helbig, Orschall

, Weidenfeld, Grummet, Kirchmayer, Hannemann, Boyle

, Dickinson, Mundanus, Colson, Headrich, Tollius , Salmon

, Gualdo, Lancilotti. The eighteenth century also furnishes an abundance of names, but there is a marked change in the character of the writings. There may be enumerated the following: Bötticher

, Caetano, Delisle, Paykul, Stahl, Dippel, Ettner von Eiteritz, Barchusen, Manget

, Söldner, Kellner, Axtelmayer, Faustius, Müller, Horlacher, S. Richter, Klettenberg , Roth-Scholtz

, Chymiphilus, Siebenstern, Hensing. There were also Plusius, Keil, Creiling, Fictuld , Richebourg

, Lenglet Dufresnoy, Tharsander, Jugel, J. F. Meyer, Wenzel, Schröder; and from 1775 to 1800, Semler, Wiegleb, ab Indagine, Adamah Booz, Herverdi, Güldenfalk, Kortum, Henckel, von Murr. All these and many more less prominent are in the library, and it may be said with some confidence that little of importance relating to alchemy, in the seventeenth century especially, is wanting. Not only so, but certain books which are very scarce indeed, and are not alluded to in some of the fullest lists, are here present. The best running commentary on this division of the library is Kopp's last work, Die Alchemie

, and one might almost imagine that in writing the bibliographical appendix he had had access, if not to this collection, to one similarly

furnished. But here again there are items which have escaped Kopp's observation. The only other books to be considered are the collected editions of alchemical tracts, which, as I have already said, are characteristic of the literature, even from the earliest times. The Greek MSS. always contain treatises by different writers, ranging from four to as many as fifty-three ; and in Pizimenti's translation, the tracts of Democritus, Synesius

, Pelagius, Stephanus and Psellus are printed together. Later MSS. in Latin, of which various specimens have passed through my hands, are similarly made up, and when they were printed, what they contained was simply reproduced. So it must have been in the Vatican MS. of Geber; for, not only his works, but tracts by Kalid

, Avicenna, and others are included in Silber's edition, printed at Rome before 1520, and in several of those which followed. But from the sixteenth to the end of the eighteenth century the practice of printing collected editions became common, and quite a number appeared. The most comprehensive in the library may be mentioned: De Alchemia Volumen , Petreius, 1541 ;Lacinius' Pretiosa Margarita Novella , 1546; De Alchimia Opuscula , 1550; Gratarolo's Verae Alchemiae Doctrina , 1561; Eröffnete Geheimnisse des Steins der Weisen : Vellus Aureum ; Ars Auriferae ; Theatrum Chemicum ; Manget's Bibliotheca ; Museum Hermeticum ; Ginaeceum Chemicum , 1673; Albineus' Bibliotheca Chemica Contracta

, and a swarm of others under fanciful titles, which have been amusingly classified by Kopp. Some of the smaller ones may contain three or four tracts only, while the Theatrum Chemicum , and Manget's Bibliotheca

, which are the largest, contain about two hundred and a hundred and forty respectively, some of considerable length. In French there is the Bibliotheque Chimique of 'le Sieur S.' [Guillaume Salmon

] enlarged by Richebourg. In German there is the Vellus Aureum , Tancke's Promptuarium , the translation of the Pretiosa Margarita

of Lacinius, Morgenstern's translation of the Ars Aurifera , Roth-Scholtz's Deutsches Theatrum Chemicum the body of extracts called Hermetisches A. B. C. , and Schroder's Alchymistische Bibliothek

. In English there are Salmon's translation of Hermes , Geber, Kalid , Bacon , and Flamel , appended to his Medicina Practica , the Collectanea Chymica , and the Aurifontina Chymica

. These collected editions have impressed a distinctive feature on the catalogue, for, in drawing it up, the contents have been duly recorded under their respective titles, while each item has been entered under its author's name, or its own title, or, maybe, under both. This was a necessity, in order that no document bearing on the subject should be by any chance overlooked.

2. But besides these authors who were concerned solely or mainly with alchemy, there were others who, without questioning the reality of it, employed its principles merely as a guide, and instead of attempting to effect practically the change of metals into gold and silver, used, partly for medicine, partly for the practical arts, the knowledge of substances accumulated by the alchemists and others. This epoch was inaugurated by Paracelsus

in the sixteenth century by his asserting that alchemy was one of the pillars of medicine, and that alchemy was not confined to transmutation of metals, but was the art of preparing substances for medical use; that, in fact, it was the art of the transmutation of every kind of matter. Paracelsus

started the iatro-chemical school, and he had many followers, as well as many opponents. His theories belong to the history of medicine rather than of chemistry; still, his adherents were chemists, and wrote books on chemistry for physicians, while his opponents, in order to controvert his doctrines, had themselves to acquire some familiarity with the new science. Of the iatro-chemical school, some supporting Paracelsus' views, others accepting them with reservation and criticism, and still others breaking away from them, may be mentioned Quercetanus ,

Thurneysser, Dorn, Rhenanus, Libavius , Beguinus, Crollius , Sala, Polemann, Potier, Joannes Agricola

, Pierre Faber, v. Helmont, Glauber, Lefevre, Glaser, Lemery, Rolfinck, Tachenius, Barchusen, Guibertus, Ludolf, Morley, Sennertus, Rivinus, Bolnest, Brendelius, Charas, Elsholtz, Jungken, Poppius, Hoffmann, Wedel, Mynsicht . _____ [sur tous ces chimistes, consultez Chevreul critique de Hoefer , II et III .

Le cas de Rhenanus est intéressant en ce qu'il permet de placer un point de jonction entre la collection Dyas Chymica Tripartita et l' Aurora Consurgens ; voici des notes de Ferguson : Ferguson : Johannis Rhenani, Medici Celeberrimi, Opera Chymiatrica, quae hactenus in

Lucem prodierunt onnnia, a plurimis, quae in prioribus editionibus irrepserant,

mendis vindicata, & selectissimis medicamentis aucta, inque vnum fasciculum

collecta, quorum catalogum versa indicabit pagina . Francofurti Sumptibus Conradi Eifridi. Anno M DC XXXV.

8°. Pp. [31, 1 blank] 367 [1 blank]. Folding table. 44 woodcuts of apparatus. Vignette. An edition of Frankfurt, 1641, is reported and

there is one: Francofurti, apud Jacobum Gotho

fredum Seylerum. Anno MDCLXVlll. 8°, pp.

[2] [15, 1 blank] 367 [1 blank]; folding table.

This is a reissue of the remainder of the 1635

edition with a new and new-dated title-page want

ing the symbolical vignette, and with the omission

of the Epistola Dedicatoria to Bruno Carolus ab

Uffeln, dated 1634, and the half-title to the 'Chy

miotechnica.' It is not really a new edition.

The writings contained in this collection are these: -

Solis e Puteo emergentlis, hoc est, Chymiotech nicorum Libri III ., pp. 1-179.

The first book contains a description, with illus

trations, of chemical apparatus, of operations, and

of the preparation of certain substances. Book

second deals with the ' Lapis Philosophicus.' Book

third is a ' Clavis & Manuductio in libros Theo phrasti Paracelsi.' frontispice du Solis e Puteo, etc. [

notez que l'image centrale, en bas, est remployée de l'emblème du

Traité des Choses Naturelles et supernaturelles du pseudo Basile Valentin] -

Aureus Tractatus de Philosophorum Lapide.

Ab adhuc vivente, sed anonymo Philosopho Ger

manice in lucem emissus, nunc autem in Latinum donatus , pp. 181-253.

This tract, says Rhenanus in his prefatory note

to the reader, appeared originally in the Dyas

Tripartita of Heermann Condeesyanus, and was

subsequently rendered into Latin in an inaccurate

and misleading version by some one ignorant of

chemistry, and published by Lucas Jennis at Frankfurt in the MUSEUM HERMETICUM (q.v.).

He, therefore, thought it worth while to give a correct translation. [

ce traité est parfois attribué à Grasseus ou Grasshoff alias Condeesyanus et se ressent d'une influence R+C manifeste. Il forme la 1 ère partie du Dyas Chymica Tripartita] -

Epistola de Solutione et Menstruo Philosophorum ,

T. G. Chymiatrophili ad Dn. Auctorem, pp. 254-257 - Responsio Auctoris. pp. 258-271 -

Antidotarium Pestilentiale. Hoc est: Brevis

quidem, sed ex rei medicae fontibus petitus, de

borrenda illa lue pestifera, eiusque origine, opera tionibus, & curatione discursus . . . Lingua ver

nacula olim in lucem emissus a Johaone Rhenano.

Nunc vero in Latinam linguam translatus per

Fridericum Vogt, Medicum Hassum. pp. 273-326. -

Vrocriterium Chymiatricum, siue Ratio Chym

iatrica exacte diiudicandi vrinas ex tribus

principiis actiuis, & vno passiuo, hactenus neglectis; aphoristice ostensa : Auctore Johaone Rhenano, pp.327-367.

The author's name was property Rheinland, and

he was the son of Dr. Martin Rhenanus, and

grandson of Johannes Rhenanus, who was first

preacher and afterwards superintendent of the

salt works at Allendorf. Rhenanus was born at Cassel, but Strieder was unable to ascertain the date either of his birth or death. He studied at Marburg under Hartrmann, took the degree of M.D. in 1610, and became physician to Cassel of the Landgrave Moritz, who employed him actively in chemical experiments. His wife died in September, 1637, aged 57, and the marriage of a son, Jonannes, In 1632, is mentioned. Besides the present works them are the following: -

Dissertatio chymiotechnica, in qua totius operationis chymicae methodus practica clare ob oculos ponitur. . . sub praesidio . . . Johannis Hartmanni . . .

Marpurgi Cattorun, 1610, 4°, with a folding table. The title 'Opera chymiatrica' to not that given originally to the above book. It is:

Solis e puteo emergentis: sive Dissertationis chymiotechnicae Libri tres. In quibus totius Operationis chymicae methodus Practica: Materia lapidis Philosophici, & nodus (sic) soluendi eius, operandique, vt & Clavis operum Paracelsi, qua abstrusa explicantur deficientia supplentur. Cum praefatione Chymiae Veritatem asserente

. Authore loanne Rhenano, Medico. Uber primus. Francofurti.M.DC.XIII, 4°. Engraved border round the title, folding table, woodcuts in the text. ln three parts, with separate title-pages and pagination. Numerous editions are recorded: Francof., 1623, 8°; 1625, 1635, 8° (as above), 1641, 8°; 1668, 8°; 1676, 8° - Antidotarium Pestilentiale , Frankf., 1613-4 (in German), -

Syntagma harmoniae chymico-philosophicae sive philosophorum antiquorum conscientium hactenus quidem plurimum desideratorum sed nondum in lucem publicam editorum, collectum & distributum in certas decades

, Francof., 1625. 8°. This work ' Syntagma harmoniae chymico-philosophicae' is presumably identical with one which bears a somewhat different title: Harmoniae imperscrutabilis chimico-philosophicae decades duae, quibus continentur auctores de Lapide, Francofurti, 1625. 8°. of the twenty tracts in which a list is given by Lenglet Dufresnoy. He also states that it is a continuation of a collection with the same title, but containing three decades of hitherto unpublished tracts, made by Hermann Condeesyanus, Francofurti, 1625, 8°. [il s'agit à l'évidence du Dyas Chymica Tripartita ; on voit s'établir une relation entre Grasseus

et Rhenanus ; il se trouve que le texte de l' Aurora Consurgens

- je ne parle pas du commentaire à l'Aurora consurgens, cf. infra Artis auriferae - a été publié dans ce texte de Rhenanus]

I do not know whether this is a fact, or not, but I doubt it. In the British Museum Catalogue, under Condeesyanus, there is the following entry:

Harmoniae inperscrutabilis Chymico-Philosophicae, give philosophorum antiquorum consentientium. . . nondum In lucem. . . missorum decas I. . . . Collectae

ab H. C. D. (Decas II. Collecta studio et industria J. Rhenani.) a pt. Francofurti, 1625. 8° This contains the twenty tracts. (There is, by the way, no cross reference in the B. M. Catalogue from Rhenanus to Condeesyanus.) Two works in manuscript by him remain: -

Secreta quaedam de praeparatione lapidis philosophici, and Speculum aestheticum, & comedy

in which all the senses take part and the tongue has a contention with the others.

The grandfather, who seems to have been a person of great energy and spirit, passed an active and unsettled life and had disputes and quarrels with a number of people. Objection was taken to his being both a clergyman and a saltmaker; the saltmakers disliked his innovations, and his salary was occasionally withheld from him. He was, however, the ablest of his family, and his grandson speaks of him making a discovery of coal and using it for salt-boiling, which would be somewhere about the year 1580. His life was described by U. F. Kopp In his "Beytrag zur Geschichte des Salzwerks in den Soden bel Altendorf an der Werra,' Marburg, 1788, 8°, from which Strieder has taken his account, and more recently there is a biography by H. Cramer:

Johannes Rhenanus der Pfarrherr und Salzgräfe zu Allendorf an der Werra , Halle, 1879, 8°, pp. 41.] _____

3. The epoch of scientific chemistry began with two controversies. The first was that between Conring and Borrichius as to the antiquity of Hermes, the reality of the Hermetic medicine and the soundness of Paracelsus' innovations; the second was the discussion by Boyle

of the elements or principles of the chemists and of the Aristotelians. This was the first systematic criticism of chemical theory from a purely scientific or philosophical standpoint, and it gradually led to an observation of phenomena apart from applications to medicine, or arts, or alchemy. Those who pursued this course and, so to speak inaugurated scientific chemistry, were Becher and Stahl

, Lemery, Boerhaave, Weigel, Rothe, Marggraf, Priestley, Lavoisier, Scheele, Sage, Baumé, Bergman, Scopoli, Achard, Crell, Dandolo, d' Arcet

, Demachy, Trommsdorff, Spielmann, Teichmayer, Wiegleb, Jacquin, Scherer, Fourcroy, Macquer, Claude de la Metherie, Morveau. Without belonging to any of these periods, as has been said above, there are works in the library which, while involving a certain amount of chemistry, are concerned not with transmutation, or medicine, or theories and speculations, but with the needs of ordinary life, or with the positive and technical side of the science. Among these are the miners and metallurgists; Ercker, Entzel or Encelius, George Agricola, Alonso Barba, Sir John Pettus, Webster, Gabriel Plattes, Löhnayss; assayers: as Schreitmann, Zimmermann, and the anonymous author of the Probier Büchlein

; the mineralogists: Marbodaeus, Nicols, Henckel; technologists: as Neri, Merrett and Haudicquer de Blancourt, who all wrote about glass; Axt, who published a little treatise on the making of rosin, wood tar and charcoal; Caneparius, the author of the treatise de Atramentis

; the compilers of books of practical receipts and secrets, as they were called, such as the author of the Rechter Gebrauch d'Alckimei, Andriessen, Fioravanti, Alessio, Lemnius, Wecker, Hugh Plat, Kertzenmacher, Cortese, Schmuck. In some respects, as in giving insight into everyday practical working, these books are as interesting and important as any. The books on pharmacy also constitute a series by themselves, but as they are, — with one or two exceptions, such as the Dispensarium of Praepositus , Luminare Majus of Manlius de

Boscho, Lumen Apothecariorum of Quiricus, Thesaurus

of Gesner, — comparatively recent, they do not require special notice. It is an illustration of the persistence of an idea that all through the eighteenth century to its very close, when most important discoveries were making and entirely new theories were advanced, the controversy as to the reality of transmutation — as a fact and as a theory — was still sustained. At the opening of it, in 1702, came the attack by Söldner — as it is said — in the Teutsches Fegfeuer der Scheide-Kunst , replied to in the Erlösung der Philosophen aus dem Fegfeuer der Chymisten ; Creiling's vindication of alchemy in Die Edelgeborne Jungfer Alchymia , 1730, Lenglet Dufresnoy's Histoire

, 1742, which must be regarded as unfavourable; Fictuld's ProbierStein

, 1753, a sort of biographical dictionary of genuine and false alchemists, more remarkable for the author's judgments than for the information supplied; the curious dictionary of Pernety, 1753, in which as in his other work he strives to interpret the myths of antiquity as Hermetic; [

rappelons que nous partageons les doutes de Ferguson et de tant d'autres sur le degré de vraisemblance que l'on peut accorder à l'autorité intellectuelle de Pernety

; mais ses écrits sont sauvés - si l'on peut dire - par une érudition que l'on ne retrouve plus, ensuite, que chez Jung et Fulcanelli] Wiegleb's onslaught on the truth of alchemy

, 1777, with Kortum's learned and rather dexterous reply, 1789, and the collection of narratives about transmutation by Güldenfalk, 1784. Then at the close of the century, 1797 to 1799, appeared Gmelin's Geschichte

, in which for the first time the subject was treated as a whole, and as an independent branch of history, without bias, and apart from controversy as to the truth or reality of any section of it, but merely as a record of events, persons and books. All these, with others of less note, are in the library. In endeavouring to construct the catalogue of such a library as

this, which labour I undertook at Dr. Young's request, I considered who were likely to consult it and how best it could be made serviceable for the study of the history of chemistry.

The persons who may possibly refer to it — besides those who actually use the library itself —- are, in the first place, librarians, bibliographers, booksellers, and collectors of this branch of literature, if there be any such, and, in the second, students. For the convenience of the first group, the catalogue has been constructed on a more liberal and elaborate scale than would have been necessary, had the object been merely to make a list of short titles sufficient to serve as a register for the library. Instead of that the titles are reproduced in full, the particular copy is described, and any peculiarities it may possess are noted, other editions are enumerated, and, when practicable, an account of them, too, is added, which in many cases has been possible-by inspection of the books themselves. To the different classes of bookmen these details may be convenient for reference, and for comparison with other copies. The literature is scarce, obscure and almost unknown, and, so far as my experience goes, while there are lists and enumerations of alchemical books, there is no bibliography of any part of it. More particularly intended for the student, who is concerned with the contents rather than with the externals of the books, are the notes which contain biographical and descriptive details and discuss doubtful or disputed points of chronology, authorship, and other matters. The authors of most of these books are strangers in this country and are but little remembered, or thought of, in their own. Some of them, however, were amongst the foremost men of their day, conspicuous by their lives, learning, discoveries and writings. It seemed desirable therefore, in carrying out the plan I had drawn up, to give the student some notion of the position and authority of the different writers so far as lay in my power, to refer to the questions which have arisen about them or their writings, and to the criticisms and judgments which have been passed upon them. As it was impossible to accomplish this in full within the limits of a catalogue, I have endeavoured by lists of authorities, whom I have been able to consult, to assist the student further in surveying the

field for himself. In the authorities quoted others will be found, and in these again others, and so the student can continue his research till he has exhausted the literature, and possessed himself of all available information at first hand. The authorities are not all of equal value; for while some supply much sound information, others furnish an irreducible minimum. Nor do they always agree as to dates and other matters of fact, which is a defect, and their criticisms and decisions also are sometimes at variance, which is of very little importance; but this uncertainty adds to the liveliness and zest of the inquiry, and stimulates originality and independence of judgment on the student's part, for he must lay his account for long and sometimes baffling investigation if he want to arrive at the truth. I have also endeavoured to give him some hold upon the authorities by arranging them as far as may be chronologically. An advantage is that if they be examined in this sequence, the statements made, whether accurate or inaccurate, can be traced to their sources, and thus by careful examination and comparison it can be decided who are original authorities and who are compilers and copyists. Another advantage of the lists is that from their extent and the status of the persons composing them, an inference can be drawn as to the importance and interest surrounding any particular writer, from his own time to the present. All the rest is for the student of history himself to do; it is his affair to examine the facts, the doubts, the difficulties, the errors; to confirm what is correct, to correct what is faulty and wrong, to throw light if possible on confused and debateable problems, and to confess his inability to reconcile contradictory averments and opinions, when the means for doing so have failed him. In the present work he will find plenty of opportunities for expending labour and exercising his critical faculties. Nor do I presume to think that what I have said is in every case correct and final. There is too great a want of agreement amongst the authorities for any one, at this time of day, to do more than get as near the truth as possible through the mists of defective records and discordant results. The brief abstracts and "accounts which I have given are therefore liable to such modification, or correction, as further examination of the existing authorities, or new

discoveries, may necessitate. There is no weed which spreads so quickly as error; I can only hope that I have introduced as little as may be in my statements. One, however, cannot escape the common lot, but one can perhaps plead, with Lactantius, the common imperfection: "

est enim aliquid medium quod sit hominis, scilicet scientia cum ignorantia conjuncta et temperata

." What success this work may achieve will depend on the proportion of those constituents, and how they are combined. The inducement which I have had to go into the matter in detail, is simply the want of a book of any kind whatever on the subject in English, while those which exist in other languages, in German for instance, do not cover this ground. With the exception of Ladrague, whose work, printed at Moscow in 75 copies, is about as rare as a manuscript, no one supplies even the pagination, and no one at all reproduces the titles in full. The compilation of the present work, therefore, afforded an opportunity, which it behoved me not to neglect, not merely of making a catalogue, but of attempting to begin a bibliography, at all events within the limits which the collection allowed, and of thus filling a gap in the literature of the history of chemistry, while the addition of the biographical notes and the references to the authorities constituted a guide to the relative literature. In no better way, it seemed to me, could the purpose of the founder be attained. If, -for such flaws in the plan and its execution'as use may reveal, an apology be necessary, I can use the words of Pliny, without, I hope, being charged with presumption : "

nec dubitamus, multa esse, qua et nos praeterierint. Homines enim sumus, et occupati officiis: subcisivisque ternporibus ista curamus, id est, nocturnis, ne quis vestrum putet his cessatum horis ."

At the conclusion of a work like the present, one can hardly refrain from contemplating the theme of it It deals with phases of a science which is of active interest and influence just now certainly, but is as different from its former condition as to views, aims, methods, and results, as if there never had been any connection between them. Yet the chemistry of the

moment is also merely a phase, and by its more rapid development is so much less stable than that of three hundred years ago, when discovery made slower advance. Still the books enumerated here, unattractive as they are — even unintelligible, maybe — record the thought and experience of many men, some of them among the most skilful and far-seeing of their time. But their labours have disappeared as if they had never been, their controversies are forgotten, their discoveries have long ago been assimilated into common knowledge; what was right in their work has, as far as they are concerned, shared the fate of what was wrong: it is not even known that It was theirs. "

The chiefs of other tiroes are departed; they have gone without their fame. The sons of future years shall pass away; and another race arise ."

Let not the modern student of science imagine that he and his work will escape the universal doom. His discoveries, his theories, the most recent, the most comprehensive and progressive, sooner or later will become mere archaeological data, to be included, or, just as likely, omitted, in a historical review of this time. Such, at least, has been the rule in chemistry for the last eighteen hundred years, and there is no sign of its being suspended in favour of any chemist of to-day. "

Thus times do shift; each thing his turne do's hold; New things succeed as former things grow old ."

It is this phenomenon which stimulates to the writing of history and to the antiquarian research on which it rests, the passing, namely, of the generations with their ideas and pursuits. But change itself is inevitable, and as the past conditions cannot be recalled or reproduced, either in the individual or the race, the most that can be done is to record something of them. The history of chemistry, as indeed of all science, is but a succession of epitaphs upon forgotten men and forgotten discovery. What then do these men not owe to him who gathers up their works, and in so doing recalls their achievements, and thus labours to lift that icy pall of oblivion which descends on everything human, just

because it is human, imperfect, temporary, and has to be forgotten to make way for something else? It was to mitigate that fate as far as human effort can, when it has to strive with the eternal law and necessity of change, that this gathering of the writings of bye-gone thinkers and workers was made. That they were struggling with error-obscured vision towards the light of reality should cause not neglect of them and contempt for their shortcomings and failures, but should arouse the fellow-feeling and interest of those who at the present moment are engaged in the same struggle, and whose turn for neglect and contempt is coming. Dr. Young realized this, and the library is his effort to awaken and foster such sympathy and remembrance. Whether or not I have succeeded by the present catalogue in carrying out his wish to make it as instructive for the purpose he contemplated as may be, It is impossible for me to say. The decision of Dr. Young himself is what I should have pre-eminently desired; and I should have prized the judgment of one other, whose interest in the catalogue was to me its inspiration, and whose verdict at its close would have been my reward. But these voices are now still. To friends who have assisted me in various ways, by loans of books, by references to authorities to which access for me was difficult, by revision with roe of certain portions of the work, I desire to tender my warmest thanks. First and last I have read the proofs, and am alone responsible for whatever errors and misprints exist. May I ask those who may have to consult this book not to overlook the additions and corrections at the end of the second volume? So, in the old-fashioned words of old Jean Rey: "

Le trauail a este mien, le profit en soit au lecteur, et a Dieu seul la gloire ." JOHN FERGUSON. GLASGOW, 13 NEWTON PLACE, 23rd January, 1906.

13. Robert Boyle's Sceptical chymist (1661, 1680) frontispice du Sceptical Chymist

, Oxford, Hall, 1680 - cliquez sur l'image pour la version : London, Cadwell & Crooke, 1661 The SCEPTICAL CHYMIST ;

or Chymico-Phyfical Doubts and Paradoxes

touching the Experiments, whereby Vulgar spagyrists are wont to endeavour to evince their Salt,Sulphur and Mercury to be the true Principles of Things, to which, in this Edition, are fubjoined divers Experiments and Notes about the Produciblenefs of Chemical Principles,

- Phyfiological Confiderations touching the Experiments wont to be employed to evince either the four Peripatetic Elements, or the three Chymical Principles of mixed Bodies. Part of the firft Dialogue. 1. The Sceptical Chymist Part I 2. Part II. 3. Part III. 4. Part IV. 5. Part V. 6. Part VI. The Conclusion Errata 14. ARTIS AURIFERAE ,

quam chemiam vocant, volumina duo, quae continent Turbam Philosophorum, aliosque, antiquiss. auctores, quae versa pagina indicat. [...]

frontispice de l'Artis Auriferae, Basileae, 1572 Ferguson : Bibliotheca Chemica

, pp. 51-52 : The contents of vol. iii. are given on the title-page. This is one of the chief collections of standard alchemical authors. A certain number of the tracts and the Rosarium had been already printed in the De Alchimia Opuscula

, Francoforti, 1550 (q.v.) and others in Gratarolo's collection

, Basel, Petrus Perna, 1561, in folio (q.v.). The hitter was again printed at Basel by Perna in 1572, in 8°, and immediatly thereafter Perna printed in 1573 Auriferae Artis

quam Chemiam vocant, antiquissimi Authores, sine Turba Philosophorum, in two volumes, small 8°, with an address to the reader by himself. Of the tracts in the first volume he says that the first ten and the last were from manuscripts. In 1593, Conrad Waldkirch at Basel reprinted both volumes in a somewhat handsomer form [

ces volumes sont disponibles à la bibliothèque digitale de la Slub

, Dresden. Dans les deux cas, il s'agit de l'édition Waldkirch].

Then came this reprint of 1610, to which was added the third volume. [notons que Jung, dans son Psychologie et Alchimie

, donne l'Artis Auriferae en deux volumes et son édition date de 1593, publiée à Bâle] A German translation of the Turba

and of a tract by Roger Bacon, edited by Paulus Hildenbrandt von Hildenbrandseck appeared at Franckfort am Mayn in 1597 and in 1608 (q.v.). The first two volumes were translated into German by Philip Morgenstern (q.v.), and published at Basel, 1613, reprinted 1750. In the

Beytrag zur Geschichte der hühern Chemie , 1785, p. 578, it is called a " collection full of hid heavenly wisdom

." This critic's sincerity maybe doubted.

Vol. i. pp. [16], 405; Index [23] [4 blank], one woodcut. Vol. ii. 346; Index [16] [2 blank]; 20 woodcuts. Vol. iii. [2] 185; Index [5]; one woodcut. The following are the contents of this collection:

table des matières du vol. I de l'Artis auriferae Vol. i .

After the title comes the address by Peter Perna, the Basel printer, to the reader. Then

1. Propositiones, seu maximae artis Chymicae. 2. Turba Philosophorum , p. 1. Turba philosophorum, frontispice

3. Turbae Pliilosophorum alterum Exemplar, p. 43

4. Allegoriae super librum Turbae, p. 89.

5. Aenigmata ex Visione Arislei, p. 94. & Exercitationes in Turbam, p. 99. 7. Aurora Consurgens , p. 110. [

il s'agit en fait du commentaire au traité De Alchimia ou Liber Trinitatis

, que l'on trouve dans Johannes Rhenanus,

Harmoniae inperscrutabilis chymico-philosophicae sive Philosophorum antiquorum consentientium Decades duae

, Francoforti, 1625 ; d'après M.-L. von Franz, l'Aurora consurgens est d'une autre main que ce texte, cf. Aurora consurgens

, la Fontaine de pierre, p. 24, Paris, 1982 ; cf. supra

sur Rhenanus et sur Aurora consurgens, notre essai] 8. Rosinus ad Euthiciam, p. 158.

9. Idem ad Saratantam Episcopum, p. 178. 10. Liber Definitionum eiusdem, p. 203.

11. Mariae Prophetissae Practica, p. 205.

12. Uber Secretorum Calidis filij Iazichi, p. 208.

13. Liber Trium Verborum Kallid, p. 226.

14. Aristoteles de lapide Philosophorum, p. 232.

15. Avicenna de Conglutinatione lapidis, p. 240.

16. Expositio Epistolae Alexandri Regis, p. 245.

17. Ignotus Autor de Secretis lapidis, p. 249. 18. Merlini allegoria de Arcano lapidis , p. 252.

19. Rachaidibi... de Materia lapidis, p. 255.

20. Avicennae Tractatulus de Alchimia, p. 260. 21. Semita Semitae , p. 280. 22. Clangor Buccinae p. 289. 23. Correctio fatuorum, p. 349.

24. Incertus Autor de Arte Chymica, p. 369. Vol. ii .

frontispice du tome II de l'Artis Auriferae, 1610

1. Liber de compositione Alchemiae, quem edidit Morienus Romanus, Calid Regi Aegyptiorum: quem Robertus Castrensis de Arabico in Latinum transtulit, p. 3.

2. Bernardi Trevirensis responsio ad Thomam de Bononia de Mineralibus, & Elixiris compositione, Roberti - - - - Vallensis Tabulis illustrata, p. 38.

3. Liber de Arte Chimia incerti Authoris nunquam hactenus in Lucem editus. [

Note. — A tract of similar name is in vol. i. There is no such tract in the present volume.] 4. Scala philosophorum, p. 71.

5. Ludus puerorum (et Opus mulierum), p. 111.

6. Rosarium philosophorum (cum figuris), p. 133. Rosarium , fons mercurialis 7. Arnaldi Rosarium, p. 253. Nouum lumen, p. 298. Flos florum ad Regem Aragonum, p. 311.

Epistola super Alchimia ad Regem Neapolitanum, p. 323.

8. Rogerius Bacho Anglus de mirabili Potestate artis et naturae, p. 327. Vol. iii .

frontispice du tome III de l'Artis Auriferae, 1610 1. Lullij ultimum Testamentum.

2. Elucidationem Testam. totius ad R. Odoardum.

3. Potestatem diuitiarurn, cum optima expositione Testamenti Hermetis.

4. Compendium Artis Magicae, quoad compositionem Lapidis, 5. De Lapide & oleo Philosophorum. 6. Modum accipiendi aurum potabile.

7. Compendia Alchimias & naturalis Philosophiae. 8. Lapidarium.

Item Alberti Magni secretorum Tractatus.

Abbreviationes quasdam de Secretis Secretorum loannis pauperum.

Arnaldi Quaest. de Arte Transmut. Metall. eiusque; Testamentum.

Omnia hactenus nunquam visa nec edita, Cum Indicibus rerum et verborum locupletiss.

Basileae, Typis Conradi Waldkirch. cIo Io.cx. 8°. 15. Hermetisches A.B.C .

deren ächten Weisen alter und neuer Zeiten vom Stein der Weisen. Ausgegeben von einem wahren Gott und Menschenfreunde.

bey Christian Ulrich Ringmacher, Berlin. 1778-9. 318 + 348 + 299 + 325 pages. frontispice de l 'Hermetisches A. B. C. - Ferguson : Erster Theil 8°. Pp. [2] [8] [1-6] 7.318. Zweiter

Theil, Berlin, 1779. 8° Pp. [2] 348. [2 blank]. Dritter

Theil, Berlin, 1779. 8°. Pp. [2] 299. [1. 2 blank]. Vierter

und letzler Theil, Berlin, 1779. 8°. Pp. 325. [3]. There was afterwards prefixed an extra title page: A. B. C. vorn Stein der Weisen. Erster [Zweiter, Dritter, Vierter und letzter] Theil. Mit Churfürstl. Sächsisch. gnädigster Freiheit. Berlin. 1778 [1779], bey Christian Ulrich Ringmacher. The book consists of extracts from the current literature, which give an idea of what was considered of importance to be studied at the time. It if also of some use as it sometimes supplies the names of the authors of certain anonymous and doubtful tracts. Kopp, Die Alchemie , 1886, ii. p. 332. -

Cette compilation vaut avant tout, à notre avis, pour les traités de

Hermann Fictuld - encore introuvables sur internet - et dont on peut avoir une bonne idée de l'importance en lisant le chapitre consacré à Fictuld dans Antoine Faivre : Accès de l'Esotérisme occidental , Gallimard, 1986, t. I, chap.

Miles Redivivus, Hermann Fictuld et l'Orde de la Toison d'Or

, pp. 215-224. Fictuls est lié à Naxagoras, cf. Faivre : Toison d'or et Alchimie , Paris-Milan, Archè, 1990 ou : The Golden Fleece and Alchemy

, New-York, State-University of New-York Press, 1993. Volume I. 1. Hermes. Die Smaragdtafel . p. 57

2. Samuel Baruch. Die Gabe Gottes. p. 61

3. Rabbi Abraham Eleazar. Schrift. p. 71

frontispice de l'Uraltes Chymisches Werk [on retient deux titre d'Abraham Eleazar : - R. Abrahami Eleazaris Uraltes Chymisches Werk

, welches ehedessen von dem Autore theils in Lateinischer und Arabischer, theils auch in Chaldäischer und Syrischer Sprache geschrieben, nachmals von einem Anonymo inunsere deutsche Mutterepiache übersetzet, nun aber nebst zugehörigen Kupfern,

Figuren, Gefäfsen, Oefen, einer kurzen Vorrede, nöthigen Registern, wie auch beygefügtein Schlüssel derer in selbigem vorkommenden fremden Wörter, ingleichen einigen philosophischen Regeln von dem Steine der Weisen zu Nutz und Gebrauch aller Liebhaber der edlen Hermetischen Philosophie, in II. Theilen zum offentlichen Druck befördert worden durch lulium Gervsium Schwartzburgicum, P. M. & I. P. E. Zweyte Auflage. Leipzig, in Lankischens Buchhandlung, 1760. 8°. Title, Preface, Letter signed L. N. Dobelius, Jan. 18, 1735, Verses. Abraham's address to the Jews, quotation from Lib. iv. Esrae, in all pp. [28]; Text, pp. 122; Register, pp. [14]. Frontispiece and 7 Engravings. Woodcuts in the text of apparatus and cabbalistic figures, expressing Hermetic secrets.

The second part has the following title-page : - Donum Dei Samuelis Baruch

, Des Juden Rabbi, Astrologi und Philosophi, gebohren aus dem Stamm Abrahams, Isaacs, Jacobs und Judä, welcher erlernet das grofse Geheimnifs des grofsen Meisters Tubalkains aus dessen Tabell, gefunden von Abrahamo Eleazare, dem Juden. I. N. U. CXI. 8°. Title, Short vocabulary of chemical words, with title and preface, pp. [14]. Text, pp. 104. Regitter, pp. [12]. 8 plates containing 15 symbolical designs; woodcuts of chemical apparatus in the text. This, though it has separate title, pagination and signatures, is printed uniformly with the preceding part, and is an integral portion of Abraham Eleazar's work, being referred to by Gervasrius in the preface to Part 1.] Ferguson

: An edition, most probably the first, was published by Augnstinus Crusius at Erfurt, In 1735. It contains in Part I.: pp. [30], dictionary [12], text, 122, index [14]; and in Part II.: title [2], text, 87; index, etc. [15]. The title is printed in red and black, and the impressions of the plates engraved by J. C. Boeck of Weimar are better than those in the 1760 issue. In one copy which I have seen, the dictionary is put after the preliminary matter in Part I., but in another copy it is placed at the very end of Part II. Among the preliminary matter the first edition has one leaf containing a list of 11 MSS. which Crusius had it in his mind to publish.

Of these No. 6 is the tract of a certain LUDOVICUS ORVIUS (q.v.), to which Gervasius refers in his preface as alluding to Abraham Eleazar. This leaf is omitted in the second edition. The second edition, however, contains at the end of the second part, pp. 87-104, a series of 156 philosophical rules or canons respecting the philosopher's stone. This series is not in the first edition. (See PHILOSOPHISCHE Regeln.) In the preface Gervasius gives an account of the book which be says existed in MSS, only, eagerly sought after, but difficult to see and costly to copy, and he therefore had it printed. It was from the book of Abraham the Jew that Flamel gained his skill, and the work was used also by Orvius, above mentioned, and by the author of the CURIEUSE UNTERSUCHUNG etlicher Mineralien (q.v.). He tries to ascertain the date at which Abraham Eleazar may have flourished, and the probable truth of the statement that he drew the 'principia' of the art from the copper tables of Tubal-Cain, who transmitted his secrets to posterity both by writing and by symbolic pictures as well. Gervasius, naturally, supports the truth of this statement, and proves, as he thinks, that Tubal - Cain was the first engraver, metallurgist, and chemist. In the second part there are several references to these copper tables. Of Abraham Eleazar, Samuel Baruch, and even Gervasius himself, nothing seems to be known. The main question is as to the authenticity of the book, and it has to be proved that it is identical with that described by Flamel, and not a later production written to suit Flamel's description. There is a certain similarity, especially in the symbolic pictures, which can be accounted for in either way, but when it is remembered how much doubt hangs round the whole Flamel legend, the second explanation is the more probable. Dr. Kopp (Die Alchemie

, 1886, ii. pp. 314-317) has given the work careful consideration, and from internal evidence, has drawn the conclusion that the book is spurious, that Abraham Eleazar and Samuel Baruch are supposititious personages, that Gervasius is the pseudonym of the real author, and that the work is later than Flamel. and not earlier than the seventeenth century. While this is most likely the correct conclusion as to the book in its present form, Gervasius may, however, have based his adaptation

on some old MSS., if he did not actually reprint one, as he professes to have done. There is a drawing of the massacre of the innocents, evidently symbolical, from the " book of Abraham the Jew

" in the Library of the Arsenal, Paris, given by Lacroix in Le Moyen Age et la Renaissance

, Paris, 1848, i. Art. vii., and again by Lacroix [

il s'agit de Paul Lacroix (1806-1884) qui est l'auteur d'une Curiosité des Sciences Occultes

où 100 pages sont consacrées à l'alchimie, Paris, A. Delahays, 1862] In Moeurs, Usages et Costumes au Moyen Age

, Paris, 1871, p. 465. This drawing is a more elaborate version of the same scene which is given both in Abraham Eleazar's and in Flamel's works (q.v.). Without an examination, therefore, of such MSS. as may exist, I should not like to assert unhesitatingly that Gervasius was the author, and did not actually reprint a MS. in whole or in part. Such MSS. were known to Lenglet Dufresnoy (Hist. de la Philosophie Hermétique

, 1742, iii. p. 79), and probably some are still to be found both in public and in private libraries. 4. Nodus sophicus enodatus. p. 73

5. Kinderbett des Steins der Weisen. p. 86

6. M. Barcius, Johann von Sternberg. Gloria Mundi, Kleine Paradeis-Tafel. p. 95

7. Johann Grashofer, Chortolasseus genannt, Schriften;

Geheimnisse des grossen und kleinen Bauers ; Cabala Chemica. p. 121

8. Johann Siebmacher aus Nürnberg. Güldenes Vlies. p. 145

9. Johann Siebmacher aus Nürnberg. Wasserstein der Weisen. p. 156

10. Johann Friedrich Hautnorthon. Tractat vom philosophischen Salze. p. 157

11. Leona Constantia (Johanna Leade). Sonnenblume der Weisen. p. 172

12. Radtichs Brotoffer. Elucidarius maior. p. 176

13. Alexander von Suchten. Explicatio Tincturae Physicorum Theophrasti Paracelsi. p. 195

14. Alexander von Suchten. De tribus Facultatibus. p. 214 15. De Nuysement

. Vom wahren Salz der Weisen und dem Allgemeinen Geist der Welt. p. 230

16. Antonio de Abbatia. Bericht von Verwandlung der Metallen. p. 261

17. Aufrichtig deutscher Wegweiser zum Lichte der Natur. p. 263

18. Laurentius Ventura Venetus. De Lapide Philosophorum. p. 268

19. Johann von Padua. Vollendete Heilige Weisheit. p. 283

20. Marsilius Ficinus. Büchlein vom Stein der Weisen. p. 294

21. John Dausten. Rosarium vom Stein der Weisen. p. 300 22. Hermes. Güldener Tractat

von Zusammensetzung des Steins der Weisen. p. 311

23. Raymundus Lullius. Apertorium de Compositione Lapidis Philosophorum. p. 312 24. Raymundus Lullius. Elucidarius über sein Testament und Codicill. p. 315

25. Aristoteles. Alchymische Schrift an Alexandrum Magnum, de Lapide Philosophorum. p. 316 Volume II.

1. P. Spiess. Concordanz über das Nuysement Sal coeleste. p. 15

2. Benedict Gutwasser. Aufrichtig Chemisches Glaubens-Bekenntniss. p. 41 3. Das philosophische Vaterherz. p. 56 4. Amor Proximi. p. 72

5. Das aus der Finsterniss von sich selbst hervor-brechende Licht. p. 106 6. Fama mystica hermetica. p. 163

7. Der rechte Weg zur hermetischen Kunst. p. 175

8. Sendivogius. Die geheime Naturlehre. p. 193

9. Georg von Welling. Opus mago-cabalisticum et theosophicum. p. 231

10. Franc. Sebast. Fulvus. Melvolodemet, of Pisa. Non plus ultra Veritatis, Untersuchung der hermetischen Wissenschaft. p. 269 11. D.M. -- 3 Tractätlein. p. 288

12. Ben Adam. Traum-Gesicht, zur Zeit der regierung Ruacharetz, Königs von Adama, von Floretus a Bethabor and den Tag gegeben. p. 296 13.

Das hermaphroditische Sonn- und Monds-Kind . p. 301 Volume III. 1. Der uralte Ritterkrieg, und hermetische Triumph . p. 15

2. Henry Vanghan [Thomas Vaughan] gennant Eugenius Philaletha:

Eröfneter Eingang zu des Königs verschlossnem Pallast . p. 73

3. [Thomas Vaughan] Von Verwandlung der Metallle. p. 78

4. [Thomas Vaughan] Kurze Anleitung zum himmlischen Rubin. p. 80

5. [Thomas Vaughan] Brunn der Chemischen Wissenschaft. p. 83

6. [Thomas Vaughan] Magia Adamica, Alterthumb der Weisheit oder Himmel der Erde. p. 86

7. [Thomas Vaughan] Antroposophia Magica. p. 115

8. [Thomas Vaughan] Anima magica abscondita. p. 122

9. [Thomas Vaughan] Euphrates, die Wasser von Aufgang. p. 134

10. [Thomas Vaughan] Lumen de Lumine, neues magisches Licht. p. 151

11. [Thomas Vaughan] Aula Lucis, Hauss des Lichts. p. 177

12. Aus Peter Steiners Handschrift von der Universal-Materie. p. 189

13. Aus Nedeganders kurzer Anleitung zum Naturgeheimniss. p. 203

14. Aus der güldenen Rose: durch I.R.V.M.D. p. 207

15. Aus dem Gespräch zwischen dem Saturn der Weisen, und einem Chemisten. p. 209

16. Aus Jamsthalers Gedicht vom Stein der Weisen. p. 213

17. Aus dem Gedicht der ächten Rosenkreuzer. p. 214

18. Aus dem Lehrsätzen von der Weisen Steine. p. 216

19. Aus dem Aria von der Weisen Stein. p. 217 20. Aus dem Brunn der Weisheit. p. 218 21. Aus dem Blut der Natur. p. 225 22. Aus Fictulds Azoth et Ignis. p. 252

frontispice de deux traités de Herman Fictuld : Azoth Et Ignis , Aureum Vellus , Blodsberger, 1749 Ferguson : Nothing is recorded about Fictuld's life, but his

name and works are familiar to most writers on the

subject, and the Probier-Stein is sometimes quoted

and recommended as an authority, which it is not.

Doubtless some of the information be gives in it is

correct, but he has made such erroneous state

meats in matters which can be checked, that he

is quite unreliable in those where no check can be applied.

Besides the above works he himself enumerates:

' Gespräcb zwischen dem König Mascos und seiner Schwester Agos' appended to Das edle Perlein

(q.v.); ' Hermetischer Triumph-Bogen &c. nemlich,

Cabbala mystica naturae, und Occulta occultissime.' According to Kopp (Dis Alchemie, 1886.

ii. p. 367) the person who printed under the

pseudonym of Fictuld was really called Johann

Heinrich Schmidt von Sonnenberg, who is not

to be confused with Johann Georg Schmid (q.v.}.

But in the HERMETISCHES A. B. C., 1779, ii. p. 72, the Probier-Stein is ascribed to a Baron Meinstoff;

without taking any notice of Fictuld. Which of these is correct I am unable to say. See also HERMETISCHES A. B. C., 1770, iv. p. 39.

There is still another version. It if said that he

was a native of Langenthal, and that his real

name was Mummenthaler, that he had travelled

much and seen much, but that he was certainly

not an adept Count Franciscus Onuphrio de Marsciano gave him a copy of bis book in 1764.

Fictuld died in 1777, in the seventy-eighth year of

his age. Semler was of opinion that he did not

err on the side of modesty, and points out that his

name HerMann FICtVLD is a chronogram for

1656, but he does not deduce anything from the fact, if It were intentional.

23. Aus Fictulds Aureum Vellus, goldenem Vliess. p. 263

24. Aus Fictulds Hermetica Victoria. p. 271

25. Aus Fictulds Abhandlung von der Gewissheit der Alchemie. p. 288 Volume IV. l. Aus Fictulds Turba Philosophorum . p. 15

2. Aus der fürstlichen Rose von Jericho, oder Moses Testament. p. 39

3. Aus Elias Artista Geheimnis vom Salze. p. 47 4. Einzehne Zeugnisse aus Fictulds Probiersteine. p. 71

5. Aus Johann Ferdinand von Freydau Sendschreiben. p. 75

6. Aus desselben Licht des Lichts. p. 95

7. Aus Leonhards delarvatione Tincturae Philosophorum. p. 122

8. Aus v. Loen Geheimniss der Verwesung und Verbrennung aller Dinge. p. 137

9. Aus dem mikrokosmischen Vorspiel eines neuen Himmels und der neuen Erde. p. 167

10. Aus des Grafen Marsciano Sendschreiben und hermetischen Untersuchung. p. 202 16. Vigilantus de MONTE CUBITI.

Dreyfaches Hermetisches Kleeblat, in welchem begriffen dreyer vornehmen Philosophorum herrliche Tractätlein. Das erste von dem geheimen waaren Saltz der Philosophorum, und allgemeinen Geist der Welt, H. Nuysement aus Lothringen

. Das andere Mercurius Redivivus Unterricht von dem Philosophischen Stein so wol den weisen als rohten aus dem Mercurio zu machen, Samuelis Nortoni sonsten Rinville. Und das dritte von den Stein der Weisen Marsilii Ficini Florentini, welche ehedessen von denen Authoribus in Frantzösischer und Lateinischer Sprach beschrieben, nunmehro aber allen Liebhabern, so der Lateinischen Sprach unkündig, zum besten, in unser Teutsche Muttersprach übersetzet, und mit einem zweyfachen Register zum Druck verfertiget. Durch Vigilantium de Monte Cubiti. Nürnberg, In Verlegung Michael und Johann Friderich Endtern, 1667. l'une des gravures de Dreyfaches Hermetisches Kleeblat

8°. Pp. [24, engraved title containing emblematica sorrel included] 448. Index [32]. 16 symbolic engravings. Nuysement, p. 1; Norton, p. 209; Ficinus, p. 373. Herrn de Nuysement Tractat von dem waaren geheimen Saltz der Philosophorum, und von dem allgemeinem (sic) Geist der Welt. Zu eigäntzung dei lang-begehrten dritten Principii, Michaëlis Sendivogii , welches er vom Saltze verbeissen hat.

Mercurius Redivivus oder Unterricht, wie man den Philosophischen Stein, sowol den weissen, als den rohten, aus dem Mercurio machen solle. Erstlich von weiland Samuele Nortono, sonsten Rinvillo Briszollensi angefangen. Nachmals mit Fleifs verbessert und vermehret, durch Edmundum Deanum von Oxonien, Doctorem der Artzney, zu Eborach in Engelland. Nunmehr aber wegen seiner grossen Nutzbarkeit

dieser

Kunst Liebhabern, die der Lateinischen Sprach unkündig sind, zum besten aufs fleissigste in die Teutsche Muttersprach versetzet worden. Bey welchem Ttractätlein (sic) zu finden, wie man beede Fermenta, so wol zum weisen, aus der Luna oder dem Silber, als zum robten aus Sole oder dem Golde machen solle.

This is in eight books, each of which has a short title in Latin and German [

les n° se rapportent aux illustrations et une mention spéciale doit être apportée au n°3 d' l' Alchymiae

dont nous développons le sens dans le commentaire de l' Aurora Consurgens , à propos des Essais sur la symbolique de l'Esprit

de Jung. L'ensemble de ces écrits apparaît sous forme d'un volume de huit petits traités en latin, imprimés à Francfort en 1630 par William Fitzer sous le titre de Mercurius redivivus .

Une version en allemand est incluse aussi dans la compilation

Eines wahren Adepti besondere Geheimnisse von der Alchymie , 1757. On notera que le n°4 du Venus Vitriolata n'est autre que le n°1 du Mercurius Redivivus :]:

1. Herrn de Nuysement Tractat von dem waaren geheimen Saltz der Philosophorum, und von dem allgemeinem Geist der Welt. Zu ergäntzung des lang-begehrten dritten Principii, Michaelis Sendivogii, welches er vom Saltze verheissen hat. p. 1

frontispice du Traité de l'Harmonie et du Sel de Nuisement

2. Mercurius Redivivus oder Unterricht, wie man den Philosophischen Stein, sowol den weissen, als den rohten, aus dem Mercurio machen solle. Erstlich von weiland Samuele Nortono, sonsten Rinvillo Briszollensi angefangen. p. 209 a. Mercurius redivivus ,

seu Modus conficiendi lapidem philosophicum tàm album quàm rubeum è mercurio : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - p. 211 ; b. Catholicon physicorum ,

seu Modus conficiendi tincturam physicam & alchymicam : 1 , 2 , 3 - p. 231 ; c. Venus vitriolata, in elixer conuersa ,

nec non Mars victoriosus, seu Elixerizatus, siuè Modus conficiendi lapidem philosophicum tàm è enere, siuè cupro, quàm à Marte, siuè Chalybe : 1 , 2 , 3 , 4 - p. 247 ; d. Elixer, seu medicina vitae ,

seu Modus conficiendi verum aurum, et argentum potabile : 1 , p. 263 ; e. Saturnus saturatus dissolutus ,

et coelo restitutus, seu Modus componendi lapidem philosophicum tam album, quam rubeum à plumbo, ac etiam eadem / olim a Samuele Nortono ... inchoatus ; nunc vero edente Edmundi Deani ... auctus, illustratus & perfectus : 1 , 2 , 3 , p. 283 ; f. Metamorphosis lapidum ignobilium

in gemmas quasdam pretiosas, sev Modus transformandi perlas parvas, et minutulas, in magnas & nobiles , p. 313 ; g. Alchymiae complementum et perfectio

sev Modus et processus augumentandi, sive multiplicandi omnes lapides & elixera in virtute : 1 , 2 , 3 - p. 329 ;

h. Auslegung der duncklen Wörter, Namen and seltzamen Reden, so in dieser Kunst geführet werden, [Tractatulus de antiquorum scriptorum considerationibus in alchymia] p. 355 ;

3. Marsilii Ficini Büchlein vom Stein der Weisen, erstlich von dem Authore selbsten in Lateinischer Sprach beschrieben, anjetzo aber allen Leibhabern und des Lateins unkündigen zulieb in die Teutsche Muttersprach übersetzet. p. 373 Ferguson

: The name of the present editor appears in Lenglet Dufresnoy's list, with an inaccurate and ignorant transcription of the title; it is given by Gmelin; by Ladrague, and by Kopp, but nothing to said as to the true name of the editor. Deane's or Norton's tracts were reprinted a Dresden, in 1757, under the title

Eines wahren Adepti besondere Geheimnisse von der Alchymie . See under H. (C.G,).

Samuel Norton was the son of Sir George Norton and great-grandson of Thomas Norton (q.v.). He was born in 1548, studied at St. John's College, Cambridge, and in 1584 succeeded to bis father's estate of Abbots Leigh in Somerset. He occupied several public positions, and died about 1604. The notice given by Jöcher is erroneous. He has put Brüssel for Bristol ! His works were edited by Edmund Dean or Deane, who, as Wood informs us, was son of Gilbert Deane of Saltonstall in Yorkshire, and brother of Richard, Bishop of Ossory, and was born In Yorkshire. In 1591 he entered Merton College, Oxford, in his nineteenth year, took a degree in Arts, retired to St. Allan's Hall, studied medicine and graduated in it, returned to York, and practised there. He wrote: Spadacrene Anglica or the English Spaw

, being a brief Treatise ot the acid or tart Fountain in the Forest of Knaresborough in Yorkshire, London, 1626. Some, who have referred to Norton, seem to think that only ' Mercurius redivivus

,' and perhaps one or two others, were edited by Deane, but it is plain from the preceding that he had the whole set through his hands, and it even looks as if he not only edited Norton's tracts but had completed them, for what else can be understood, by the expression 'inchoatus' as applied to Norton's share in them? Some have gone the length of ascribing them to Deane entirely, while Schmieder, who is never at a loss for a bold, not to say a reckless, suggestion, calmly states that Deane was a name assumed by Norton ! Deane speaks in high terms of Norton, and compares him to Cabot, another Bristolian. [

Samuel Norton ne doit pas être confondu avec Thomas Norton et Josaphat Friedreich Hautnorthon, cf. l'

Enfant hermaphrodite du Soleil et de la Lune .] [

on compte de fait plusieurs ouvrages édités par Edmund Deane ;

les n° se rapportent aux illustrations et une mention spéciale doit être apportée au n°3 d' l' Alchymiae

dont nous développons le sens dans le commentaire de l' Aurora Consurgens , à propos des Essais sur la symbolique de l'Esprit

de Jung. L'ensemble de ces écrits apparaît sous forme d'un volume de huit petits traités en latin, imprimés à Francfort en 1630 par William Fitzer sous le titre de Mercurius redivivus

. Une version en allemand est incluse aussi dans la compilation Eines wahren Adepti besondere Geheimnisse von der Alchymie, 1757.. On notera que le n°4 du Venus Vitriolata n'est autre que le n°1 du Mercurius Redivivus : 17. Deutsches theatrum chemicum ,

auf welchem der berühmtesten Philosophen und Alchymisten Schrifften, die von dem Stein der Weisen, von Verwandlung der schlechten Metalle in bessere, von Kräutern, von Thieren, von Gesundund Sauer-Brunnen, von warmen Bädern, von herrlichen Artzneyen und von andern grossen Geheimnüssen der Natur handeln, welche bisshero entweder niemahls gedruckt, oder doch sonsten sehr rar worden sind, vorgestellet werden durch Friederich Roth-Scholtzen. Felsecker, Nürnberg. 1728-30. frontispice du Deutsches Theatrum Chemicum de Friederich Roth-Scholz, 1728 Volume 1.

1. Iohann. Franc. Buddei, Untersuchung von der Alchemie.

2. Georg Phillip Nenters, Bericht von der Alchemie.

3. Wilhelm, Freyherrn von Schröderns, Unterricht vom Goldmachen.

4. Treuhertzige Warnungs-Vermahnung an alle Liebhaber der wahren Natur gemesen Alchemiae Transmutatoriae von einem Liebhaber der Wahrheit aufgesetzt.

5. Leonhard Müllners, Grundlicher Bericht von der Generation und Geburt der Metallen.

6. Bericht von der Generation und Regeneration der Metallen.

7. Iosaphat Friedrich Hautnorthons, oder Johann Harprechts, dritter Anfang der Mineralischen Dinge, vom Philosophischen Saltz.

8. Chrysogoni de Puris, Pontische oder Mercurial-Wasser der Weisen.

9. Eugenii Philalethae, Euphrates oder die Wasser vom Aufgang.

10. Iohann. Friedrich Helvetii, guldenes Kalb. [Vitulus Aureus : cf. Musaeum Hermeticum, 20 et Bibliotheca Curiosa Chemica, vol. I, 9]

11. Iohann Pordaedsche, Philosophisches Send-Schreiben vom Stein der Weisheit.

12. Iohannis de Monte Raphaim Vorbothe der am Philosophischen Himmel hervor brechenden Morgenröthe. 13. Fr. Basilii Valentini, Triumph-Wagen des Antimonii

, mit Theodori Kerckringii Anmerckungen. Deme noch vorgesetzet Hrn. D. Georg Wolffgang Wedels, berühmten Professoris zu Jena An. 1704. in einem Programmate vom Basilio Valentino ertheilte Nachricht und Recommendation. Volume 2.

14. Bened. Nicolai Petraei, Critique über die Alchymistischen Schrifften.

15. Bedencken über die Frage, ob die Transmutatio Metallorum möglich sey.

16. Responsum einer berühmten Juristen-Facultät: da sich ein Ehemann belehren lässet: Ob ihm das seiner Frauen in Gold transmutirte silberne Gefässe nicht zukomme? oder doch wenigstens der usus fructus davon?

17. Julii Sperberi, Isagoge, d.i. Einleitung zur wahren Erkänntnuss des Drey-einigen Gottes und der Natur. Worinnen auch viele vortreffliche Dinge von der Materia des Philosophischen Steins enthalten sind.

18. Pantaleonis, Tumulus Hermetis Apertus: oder: das eröffnete Hermetische Grab.

19. Pantaleonis Examen Alchymisticum, oder: Alchymistische Prüffung.

20. Pantaleonis Bifolium Metallicum, das ist: Metallisches Zweyblat.

21. Joel Langellotts, Send-Schreiben von der Chymie; samt der Philosophischen Mühle in Kupffer gestochen.

22. Johann Heinrich Rudolffs, Unterricht von der Amalgamation.

23. Johann Heinrich Rudolffs, Extra-Ordinair Bergwerck, durch die Amalgamation mit Quecksilber.

24. Johannis Garlandii, seu Hortulani, Compendium Alchimiae, oder Erklärung der Smaragdischen Tafel Hermetis Trismegisti. 25. Tabula Smaragdina Hermetis.

26. M. Arnoldi de Villanova Erklärung über den Commentarium Hortulani.

27. Send-Schreiben von der Vortrefflichkeit der Chymischen Schrifften Petri Joh. Fabri.

28. Bartholomaei Korndorffers Beschreibung der Edelgesteine.

29. D. Joh. Joachim Bechers Oedipus Chymicus, oder Chymischer Rätseldeuter. 30. Joannes d'Espagnets

geheime Werck der Hermetischen Philosophie. Volume 3.

31. Rogerii Baconis, Chymisch- und Philosophische Schrifften... Nebst einer Vorrede, darinnen von dem Leben und Schrifften Rogerii Baconis Nachricht gegeben wird.

32. Rogerii Baconis, Radix Mundi, oder Wurtzel der Welt, verdeutscht nach dem Englischen von William Salmon.

33. Rogerii Baconis, Medulla Alchimiae, darinnen vom Stein der Weisen, und von der vornehmsten Tincturen des Goldes, Vitriols und Antimonii, gehandelt wird. Item eine Alchymische Epistel, so Alexandro zugeschrieben worden. Vormals durch Joachim Tanckium... Nun aber, durch Friederich Roth-Scholtzen... publiciret... 34. Rogerii Baconis, Spiegel der Alchemie .

35. Rogerii Baconis, Tractat vom Golde, oder gründlicher Bericht von der Bereitung des Philosophischen Steins, so aus dem Golde gemacht wird.

36. Rogerii Baconis, Tractat von der Tinctur und Oel des Vitriols.

37. Rogerii Baconis, Tractat von der Tinctur und Oel des Antimonii, von der wahren und rechten Bereitung des Spiessglases, menschliche

Schwach-heiten und Kranckheiten dadurch zu heilen, und die imperfecten Metallen in Verbesseerung zu setzen.

38. Epistel oder Send-Brief des Kayser Alexandri, welcher zu erst in Griechenland und Macedonian regieret hat, auch ein Kayser der Persianer gewesen: Darinnen der Stein der Weisen durch ein Gleichnüss und Parabel sehr lustig und wohl beschrieben erkläret wird.

39. Rogerii Baconis, Angli, Send-Schreiben von geheimen Würckungen der Kunst und der Natur, und von der Nichtigkeit der falschen Magiae.

40. Rogerii Baconis, Epistola de secretis operibus Artis & Naturae, & de nullitate Magiae. Opera Johannis Dee... e pluribus exemplaribus castigata olim, & ad sensum integrum restituta (in Latin).

41. Responsum ad Fratres Rosaceae Crucis illustres (in Latin).

42. Gloria Mundi, sonsten Paradeiss-Tafel.

43. Ein ander Tractätlein gleiches Innhalts mit dem vorigen.

44. Alethophili Philosophische Betrachtung von Verwandelung der Metallen.

45. Warnungs-Vorrede wider die Betrüger, welche ein Anonymus A. 1670 und A. 1691 in Hamburg des Johannis Ticinensis, Anthonii de Abbatia und Eduardi Kellaei Chymischen Schrifften vorgesetzet hat.

46. Johannis Ticinensis, Chymische Schrifften; oder Process vom Stein der Weisen.

47. Anthonii de Abbatia, ausgefertigtes Send-Schreiben von dem Stein der Weisen, und von Verwandelung der Metallen.

48. Anthonii de Abbatia Epistolae duae, scrutatoribus artis Chymicae mandatae. Accessit Arcanum a quodam Philosopho Anonymo deductum (in Latin).

49. Eduardi Kellaei, Buch von dem Stein der Weisen... Nun aber nebst einer Vorrede von dem Leben und Schrifften Kelläi zum Druck befordert.

50. Fragmenta quaedam Edu. Kellaei ex ipsius Epistolis excerpta.

51. Eduardi Kellaei, Via Humida, sive Discursus de Menstruo Vegetabili Saturni (in Latin).

52. Aula Lucis, oder: das Hauss des Lichts durch S. 18. ARS CHEMICA

,

quod sit licita recte exercentibus, probationes doctissimorum lurisconsultorum. Septem Tractatus seu Capitula Hermetis Trismegisti, aurei. Eiusdem Tabula Smaragdina, in ipsius sepulchro inuenta, cum commento Hortulani Philosophi. Studium Consilii Coniugij de massa Solis & Lunae. Opvscula, studiosis arts secretissimae, ut sumrnè necessaria, ita lectu iucundissima. Antehac typis non excusa. frontispice de l' Ars Chemica , Strasbourg, 1566

8°. Pp. 263. After the title comes a vindication of Alchemy, pp. 3-6 ; Hermes, pp. 7-31; Tabula Smaragdina , pp. 32-.3; Hortulanos

, pp. 33-47; Studium Consilii Conjugii . . . pp. 48-263.

Colophon: Argentorati excudebat Samuel Emmel. Anno M.D.CXVI. 19 . Ginæceum chimicum ;

seu, congeries plurium anthorum qui in artem hermeticam de lapide philosophico scriptserunt, quorum tractatus nec in Theatro, aut alio volumine usque adhuc simul impressi fuerunt... Volumen primum. 8° Lugduni: Jean de Trevis 1679 pp. [4] 727 [1 blank]

1. Geber, Summa perfectionis magisterii. p. 1 2. Geber, Liber investigationis. p. 164

3. Georgius Horn, Medulla Alchimiae in aphorismos contracta ex Gebro desumpta. p. 179

4. Joannes Braceschus, De alchemia dialogi duo: Prior Gebri sensum explicans. p. 212

5. Alter lignum vitae nominatus, Raimundi doctrinam, & misteria occulta artis pandens. p. 332

6. Brevis libellus minera philosophorum dictus. p. 349

7. Libellus alter, sive restrictus theoricus, Radius ab Umbra vocatus cum eiusdem authoris brevi dialogo. p. 368

8. Oliverius de Oliveriis, Tractatus duo, Unus de lapide philosophico conficiendo, Alter de auro potabili. p. 415

9. Panthaleon, Bifolium metallicum, sive medecina duplex pro metallis & hominibus. p. 453

10. Joannes Belye, Tractatus singularis chimicus. p. 495

11. Bernardus Trevirensis, Tractatus de lapide philosophorum. p. 503
12. Quibus appendicis loco accessit:

H. Aquilae Thuringi ex Manuscripto doctrina. p. 510 Ex Epistola Eduardi Kellaei. p. 512

Fragmentum ex Theoriis Joannis Isaaci Hollandi. p. 513

13. Liber de principiis naturalibus, & principiis artis. p. 517 [

Cet ouvrage est contenu dans deux autres complilations sous le titre de :

Aureus Liber de principiis Naturae et Artis, woraufs die Wissenschafft der Primae Materiae erkennet, und das Universale Generalissimum Philosophorum erlanget werden möge , cf. Der Hermetische Philosophus , 1709, p. 1 et Hermetisches Museum , 1785, iii, p. 151]

14. Joannes Dausten, Visio in Chimicam. p. 548

15. Avicenna, De mineralibus liber parvus. p. 554

16. Alexander Rex, Epistola abditam Philosophici lapidis compositionem declarans. p. 561

17. Opusculum philosophici lapidis secreta methaphorice describens. p. 566

18. Merlinus Allegoria profundissimum Lapidis arcanum perfecte continens. p. 569

19. Recaidib, Veradianus, Rhodianus, & Khalid Rex Persarum: Fragmentum de Materia Phisici Lapidis. p. 573

20. Lux obnubilata suapte natura refulgens: vera de lapide Philosophico Theorico, pars prima. p. 579 20. De Alchimia opuscula

complura veterum philosophorum quorum catalogum sequens pagella indicabit ... 2 partes in 1... Rosarium philosophorum. Secunda pars alchimiæ de lapide philosophico vero modo præparando...

Iacobus, Frankfurt. 1550. 168 + 96 folios.

frontispice du De Alchimia Opuscula Complura

[notez que l'image est remployée pour partie de la 11 e figure et surtout de la 18 e figure du Rosarium Philosophorium] First part 1. Correctio Fatuorum. f. 1 2. Clangor Buccinæ. f. 19 3. Semita Semitæ. f. 69

4. Avicenna : De tinctura metallorum. f. 75

5. Raimundus (Lullius) : Compendium animæ transmutationis. f. 92 6. Scala Philosophorum. f. 101

7. Opus mulierum, Tractatulus, sive ludus puerorum. f. 135

8. Raimundus Lullius : De Tincturis compendium, seu Vade Mecum. f. 153

9. Aristoteles : Tractatulus de Practica lapidis Philosophici. f. 162 [

une main a ajouté : X. Rosarium Philosophorum cum figuris - XI. Alchymia Gebri cum figuris - XII. Rogerij Bachonis Speculum Alchimiae. Cf. 2 et 2 bis -] Second part Rosarium philosophorum . frontispice du Rosarium Philosophorum, Francoforti, Cyriaci Iacobi, 1550

Ferguson : The 'Rosarium Philosophorum' describes the preparation of the 'stone ' in a series of chapters or sections, each having a symbolic picture, most of them accompanied by explanatory verses In German, and Illustrated by parallel passages from the leading authorities so that the whole forms a' Rosary of selected blossoms. It was a favourite work, and copies in manuscript are not uncommon, sometimes with the pictures coloured. Besides the German version of Morgenstem, there is a translation in French, which, so for as I know, was not printed, but of which I have seen a copy in manuscript with the pictures finely executed

with pen and ink. Schmiederf (p. 236) refers to a 'Rosarius' in French, by George Aurach, which he seems to think is different from the above ' Rosarium,' but, from his description, it is apparently merely a French translation of it and not an original work, and is the same as that just mentioned, in which manuscript, however, Aurach's name does not occur. The 'Rosarium Philosophorum' is sometimes called 'magnum,' to distinguish it from the 'Rosarius' of Arnaldus, which is different and which contains no pictures [cf. Sommaire du Rosaire

par Lacidius, in Verae Alchimiae de Gratarole

]. From both of these again is to be distinguished the 'Rosarius Minor. [figure dans l'Alchemia de 1541, p. 309 , dans le Theatrum Chemicum, 1659, ii, p. 466

et aussi dans le Verae Alchimiae de Gratarole, 1561, i, p. 222

]' This tract, having been once ascribed to Richardus Anglicus by Borel, has continued to be called his by Gmelin, Schmieder, and Kopp. This, however, is inaccurate, for in the very first issue of the tract, that of 1541, and in the subsequent reprints, the author is said to be doubtful : Rosarius Minor . . . Incerti quidem, sed harum tamen rerum non imperiti authoris.' [inséré dans le De Alchimia]

Naxari (Della Tramutatione Metallica Segni tre 1599, p. 143) quotes a 'Rosarius philos.' and a 'Rosarius maior,' but from such imperfect titles it is impossible to draw any conclusions as to the writings he intended.

illustrations tirées du Rosarium Philosophorum : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - 8 - 9 - 10 - 11 - 12 - 13 - 14 - 15 - 16 - 17 - 18 - 19 - 20 - 21 - [la version que possède l' UCM de Madrid est annotée d'une main française] 21. Medicina Practica :

or, Practical Physick. Shewing The Method of Curing the most Usual Diseases happening to Human Bodies... To which is added, The philosophick Works of Hermes Trismegistus, Kalid Persicus, Geber Arabs, Artefius Longævus, Nicholas Flammel, Roger Bachon, and George Ripley. All Translated out of The best Latin Editions, into

English; and Carefully Claused, or divided into Chapters, and Sections, for the Pleasant Reading, and easier Understanding of those Authors. Together with a singular comment upon the first book of Hermes, the most Ancient of Philosophers. The whole Compleated in Three Books. By William Salmon, Professor of Physick... 8° London: Printed by W. Bonny, for Tho. Howkins and John Harris 1692 portrait de William Salmon (1644-1713) par R. White [

à noter que sous le portrait figure le prénom Guglielmo - Guillaume

- or, nulle part nous n'avons pu trouver d'indication faisant état que William Salmon portait comme second prénom Guglielmo ; il faut en conclure que le site scientific-identity

s'est trompé en attribuant ce portrait à William alors qu'il s'agit de celui du compilateur de la première version de la Bibliothèque des Philosophes Chymiques] Ferguson

: William Salmon was born a June, 1644, according to the portrait in his ' Ars Anatomica,' but that prefixed to the fifth edition of the Polygraphice, 1685, states that he was in his 27th year in 1675, which would imply that be was born in 1648. There is no reliable information as to his early life and education, or as to bow be became a doctor, whether licensed or unlicensed. He travelled, and then settled in London, where be engaged In the form of medical practice common at the time, including astrology, preparation of secret remedies and alchemy. He wrote a great deal on medical topics, and compiled works on botany, the pharmacopoeia, and anatomy, medical and chirurgical observations, and the above collection of alchemists. He took part also in the controversy about the dispensaries and wrote a ' Rebuke to the authors of a Blew-Book; . . . written In Behalf of the Apothecaries and Chirurgians of the City of London.' London, 1698, 8°. pp. 32. He resided at various places in London, indications of which can be gathered from his books. Thus in 1671 be had his abode in Smithfield, near St. Bartholomew's Hospital, in 1681 his dwelling was at the Red Balls in Salisbury Court, off Fleet Street. In 1685 he was 'Professor of Physick,

living at the Blew Balcony by FIeet-Ditch, near Holborn-Bridge,' or 'at the Blew Balcony by the Ditch-side near Holbourn-.bridge.' In 1692, the name of his house seems to have been changed, for be was then ' living at the Blue-Ball by the Ditch-side, near Holborn Bridge.' On 34 Oct., 1700, he dates the eighth edition of the Potygraphice from his house 'at Black-Fryers Stairs,' and in the Rebuke he is ' living near Black-Fryers Stairs. Some of his books went through a good number of editions notwithstanding the despite shown him by some of bis contemporaries, as by James Younge, and one of the most popular was his Polygraphice, a collection of receipts on the fine and practical arts, first published In 1672. Of this book there were numerous editions, of some of which I have given details elsewhere. The second edition in four books appeared in 1073. the fifth in seven books, in 1685, with a badly -executed portrait signed: W. Sherwin ad vitam sculpt.,' the eighth, much enlarged, in 1701, with a characteristic portrait signed: M. v. Gucht, Sculpt. Salmon died in 1713. If one may judge by bis library Salmon must have been a man of erudition, and of wide and liberal tastes; he must also have been a thorough-going bibliophile and possessed of means sufficient to gratify his acquisitiveness. Part of bis library was sold, and from the auction catalogue of it, one gathers a clear notion of its contents. It is arranged according to size, and broadly according to subject, and the catalogue was drawn up by Thomas Balland The tide-page gives the best idea of how the collection was regarded:

'Bibliotheca Salmoaeana, Pars Prima. Or, a Catalogue of Part of the Library of the Learned William Salmon, M.D. Deceas'd. Consisting of many very Valuable and Uncommon Books, in several Faculties and Languages. Chiefly, in Physitck. Chirurgery, Chyrmistry, Divinity, Philology, History, and other polite parts of Learning, most of the Classlcks, Notis variorum, and other choice editions, well Bound and very Fair, several being of the large Paper. Which will begin to be Sold by Auction at St. Paul's Coffee-House, next Door to Dean's Court the West End of St. Pauls, on Monday the Sixteenth Day of November, 1713: beginning every Evening at Five of the clock till the Sale is

finished. By Thomas Ballard, Bookseller, at the Rising Sun in Little-Britain. Where Catalogues may be had; as also of Mr. King In Westminster-Hall..., Price One Shilling, 8°, pp. [6] 119 [1 blank]. The preface throws some light on Salmon himself: 'The following Catalogue contains Part of the Library of the Famous Doctor William Salmon, deceas'd, whose Character and Abilities an sufficiently made known to the World by the great Number of Elaborate Works set forth by him; and Indeed our Proprietor's jilomaqeia

. his Extraordinary Love of Books, and his Singular Judgment in the Choice of them, are transcendently remarkable, since he has been for many Years taken up in mailing so large a Collection, which apparently to as valuable, both for Quality, Condition, and Number of Volumes, especially in Folio, as any that ever was transported to an Auction-Box, or Sold sub ictu Mallei: for here the Ingenious will not only find a Rich Treasure of Books to several Languages relating to the Noble Art of Physick, but even a mighty Stock in all other Faculties, that constitute the respective Branches of Polite Literature, viz. Theology, Law, Philosophy, Philology, History, Mathematicks, Classicks. &c.. besides great Variety of curious add uncommon Tracts on Miscellaneous Subjects, and a very fine Collection of English Books In the same Faculties ; so that to say more of this incomparable Library would seem to derogate from the Value of it, and from the Merit of its late indefatigable Owner; we shall therefore leave the Whole to the View of such Gentlemen as are really jilobibloi

, and disposed to purchase these valuable Pieces when the Sale comes on .'

The catalogue contains 919 lots in folio. 866 in quarto, and 1789 in 8° and 12°, or 3574 in all. I do not know if there was any subsequent sale. It has become the custom to call Salmon the compiler of the ' Bibliothèque des Philosophes Chimiques

' which appeares at Paris in 1672-73. That work has the name 'le Sieur S.' on the title-page as the editor's, but I do not know what justification

there is first, for interpretting the initial as meaning Salmon, as Kopp does : ' Der Pariser Arzt Salmon,' he calls him; and secondly, for identifying the author with William Salmon of the Blew Balcony. How did it come about that he first made this alchemical collection In French, and then twenty-years after brought out a much smaller collection appended to another and quite different work ? Still less reason there seems to me to be in connecting William Salmon with the ' Dictionnaire hermétique,' 1695.

frontispice du Medicina Practica, London, 1692

- figures contenues dans l'ouvrage : quatre se rapportent aux Figures Hiéroglyphiques

du pseudo Flamel ; deux se rapportent au Liber Fornacum du pseudo Geber - The contents are as follows:

The preface contains a short account of each of the alchemical authors contained in the book, and this is followed by a list of Salmon's own writings, published and unpublished. - Practical Physick, pp. 176,

- The second book has a title, dated 1691, and another, dated, 1692, p. 177 contains:

1. Hermes Trismegistus: The Golden Work, pp. 179-283, including the ' Smaragdine Table ,' p. 258. 2. Kalid , Secreta Alchymiae, pp. 284-334.

3. Geber, The Sum, pp. 335-472, with four plates of apparatus. 1 - 2 -

The third book has a title, dated 1692, p. 473. and contains: 4. Artefius Longaevus, Liber Secretus

, pp. 433-520 (sic for 475, &c.), in Latin and English. 5. Nicholas Flammel, The Hieroglyphicks , pp. 531-584, with four plates. 1 - 2 - 3 - 4

6. Roger Bachon, Radix Mundi, pp. 585-620. 7. Roger Bachon, Speculum Alchimiae , pp. 621-642.

8. George Ripley, The Marrow of Alchymie, pp. 643-696.

The remainder copies were reissued with a new title-page:

Medicina Practica: or, the Practical Physician: Shewing the True Method of Curing the most Usual Diseases Incident to Humane Bodies, viz.: All Sorts of Aches and Pains, ... To which is added the Chymical Works of Hermes Trismegistus, . . . And an Account of their Lives. . . . By William Salmon, M.P. (sic) . . . London Printed and Sold by Edmund Curll at the Peacock without Temple-Bar, 1707. Price 5£. In this reissue the title-pages of Books II. and III. have been cancelled. 22. Thesaurinella Olympica Aurea Tripartita ,

Das ist: Ein himmlisch güldenes Schatzkämmerlein, von vielen aufserlesenen Kleinodien zugerüstet, darinn der uhralte grosse und hochgebenedeyte Charfunckel-stein und Tinctur-schatz verborgen. In drey unterschiedliche Cellulas aufsgetheilet. Allen Liebhabern der himmlischen Warheit, und Hermetischen Philosophey, so den Grund der Hochmagischen Tinctur suchen, zu gute: Wie auch zu Beförderung der edlen Alchimey anjetzo eröffnet und publicirt durch Benedictum Figulum Utenhoviatem Franc. Poëtam L. C. Theologum, Theosophum, Philosophum, Medicum, Eremitam.' D. T. P. D. G. N. M DCLXXXII. Franckfurt am Mayn, Jn Verlegung Georgii Wolffii Büchhändl. in Hamburg in S. Joh. Kirchen, Gedruckt durch Johann Görlin.

8°. Pp. [16. including frontispiece] 402 [should be 392, as pp. 225-234 are dropped] The vignette represents a rayed sun for gold, surrounded by the symbols for silver, iron, mercury, lead, tin and copper. The book contains the following tracts:

1. Secretum Magicum D. Philippi Theophrasti Paracelsi von dreyen gebenedeyeten Magischen Steinen, p. 1.

2. Bernhard, Graf von der Marck mid Ternis (sic) Symbolum Apostolicum Cabalistisch erkläret und mit dem grossen uhralten Stein der Weisen verglichen, p. 42.

3. Vincent Koffskhy: Tinctur-Wurtzel, und auch Materia Prima defs gebenedeyten uhralten Steins der Weisen, p. 52.

4. Alphidius: Kurtzer Bericht und Parabolisch Tractätlein, p. 66.

5. Corollaria quaedam in nostram Thesaurinellam.Processus Universalis Viae, Tincturae Rubedinis & Albedinis, Alchymicae artis: Mngistri Nicolai Melchioris, . . . sub Forma Missae, p. 69.

6. Carmina auf das Philosophische Werck, 74. Thesaurinellae . . . Pars II .

Genandt Schola Hermetica, darinnen zu studieren, wie der Königliche, Orientalische, Durchleuchtende Rubin defs gebenedeyten Astralischen Magneten, defs Magischen und ChaldäischenTinctur-Steins zu erlangensey. p. 77 Contains:

7. Raymundus Lullius: Tractat vom Philosophischen Stein, p. 79.

8. Xamolxides: Tractatus Aureus quem Dyrrachium Philosophicum vocavit, p. 91. 9. Colloquium, p. 94.

10. Colloquium spiritus Mercurii cum Fratre Alberto Bayrs. p. 110. [

See also HAUTNORTHON (J. F.), Lucerna Salis Philosophorum, 1658, p. 159].

11. Divi Leschi Genus Amo (M. Sendivogius): Colloquium Hermetico-Spagyricum

, das ist: Ein wunderhöfliches, wolgegründetes Chymiscbes Gesprach zwischen der Natur, dem Mercurio, undeinem Alchymisten, p. 121. Thesaurinellae . . . Pars III.

Genandt und intitulirt. Lux in Tenebris Lucens Raymundi Lullii darinnen Bericht gethan wird, wie die höchste Geheimnüfs der Natur zu erforschen, und aus dem verborgenen am Liecht zu bringen nach Philosophischen Brauch . . . p. 142. Contains:

12. Raymundus Lullius: Tractatus de preparatione Lapidis Philosophici, p. 146.

13. Arcanum de Multiplicatione Philosophica in qualitate, p. 193.

Hortulus Olympicus Aureolus, Das ist: Ein himmlisches, güldenes, Hermetisches Lust-Gartlein, von allen und neuen Philosophis gepflantzet und gezielet, darinn zu finden, wie die Coelestivische, Edle,

Hochgebenedeyte Scbwebelrofs und Scharlachblum defs hochgläntzenden und Tingirenden Carfunckelsteins (dadurch Menschliche, Metallische, und Vegetabilische Cörper ihre Renovation und höchste Perfection, oder Vollkommenheit erlangen mögen) zu brechen sey. Anjetzo allen Filiis Doctrinae Magyco-Spagyricae zu gutem eröffnet, geschenckt und publicirt. Durch Benedictum Figulum Utenhoviat. Fr. Poëtam L. C. Theologum, Theosophum, Philosophum, Medicum, Eremitam. D.T.P.D.G.N.

Anno TrIsMegIstae gratia Del, In toto orbe Chrlstlano genitae. Zum andern mal 1682. In Verlegung Georg Wolff. [p. 197]. Contains:

14. Das Büchlein Theophrasti mit der Himmlischen Sackpfeiffen, p. 202.

15. Theophrasti Tractatus de Lapide Philosophorum, p. 209.

16. Caspar Hartung vom Hof, Beschreibung von der Bereitung defs gebenedeyten Steins, p. 245.

17. Eine warhaffte und einfältige Aufslegung der Schriften aller Philosophen von dem . . . Stein der Weisen, p. 264.

18. Ulrich Poysel: Spiegel der Alchymey. p. 277.

19. Georg Fueger: De Lapide Philosophorum, Theoria brevis, p. 300.

20. Practica vom Universal oder gebenedeyten Tinctur Stein der Allen Weisen. Rythmice gestellet, p. 307.

Paradisus Aureolus Hermeticus Fluens Nectare & Ambrosia, in cujus perlustratione sedula fidelis & ocularis offertur instructio, quomodo Aureola Hesperidum Poma, ab Arbore Benedicta Philosophica sint decerpenda: a variis Philosophis, tum veteribus tum modernis plantatus in gratiam et emolumentum filiorum Doctrinae Chemico Spagyricae (huc usque praeclusus) nunc reseratus & publici Juris factus, per Benedictum Figulum Utenhoviat. . . .

Anno TrIsMegIstI SpagyrI ArChIatrI nobIs DonatI, &c. De novo Impensis Georgi Wolffii ; 1682. [p. 317.] Contains:

21. Alphonsus, Rex Castellae: Liber Philosophiae Occultioris (praecipue Metallorum) profundissimus: Cui titulum fecit, Clavis Sapientiae , p. 322.

22. Aristoteles Alchymistes, Tractatus ad Alexandrum Magnum de Lapide Philosophorum, p. 356.

23. Epistola ad Hermannum Arcbiepiscopum Coloniensem, De Lapide Philosophico, p. 374.

24. Divi Leschi Genus Amo (M. Sendivogius),

Dialogus Naturae, Mercurii et Alchymistae , p. 384,

The three tracts in the present collection had been published previously: Thesaurinella, Frankfurt a. M., 1608, 4°: Hortulus, Frankfurt, 1608, 4°; Paradisus, Frankfurt, 1600, 1608, 4°, and there was another work besides, Auriga benedictus spagyricus, Norimberg. 1609, 12°. In addition to these Gmelin quotes an edition of the Pandora, Strassburg, 1600, 8°, but that may be a misprint for 1608. Ferguson

: The author's name is said to be Benedict Töpfer, and he belonged to Utenhoven in Franconia, as he tells us. Schmieder thinks that his books had some circulation because they were in German and were not without humour. No notice of his life has been forthcoming, but his books are known, and Semler has drawn attention to a passage in the preface to the Thesaurinella

, in which are adumbrations of the Rosicrucian ideas some years before their manifesto had been published. 23. Rosarium Novum Olympicum et Benedictum .

Das ist: Ein newer Gebenedeyter Philosophischer Rosengart, darinnen vom aller weisesten König Salomone, H. Salomone Trismosino, H. Trithemio, D. Theophrasto, &c.gewiesen wirdt, wie der Gebenedeyte Guldene Zweig, vnnd Tincturschatz, vom vnverwelcklichen Orientalischen Baum der Hesperidum, vormittels Göttlicher Gnaden, abzubrechen vnd zu erlangen sey: Allen vnd jeden Filiis doctrine Hermeticae, vnd D. Theophrasticae Liebhabern zu gutem trewlich eröffnet in zwen Theilen. Pars Prima.Per Benedictum Figulum;

Vtenhoviatem, Francum; Poëtam L. C. Theologum; Theosophum; Philosophum; Medicum Eremitam. T. M. Getruckt zu Basel, in verlegung des Autoris, Anno 1608.

4°. Pp. [10] 83 [1 blank]. Diagrams in the text. Title red and black. The vignette is a rose bush or tree with the metals as flowers, surmounted by the sun.

Rosarii Novi Olympici et Benedicti, Pars Altera: In sich haltent ein Buch mit 32. Capiteln, Laurentii Venturae Veneti, Medicinae Doctoris, &c. Aufs dem Latein vertiert vnud trewlich verdolmetschet, in vnsert Teutschen Sprach vor nie gesehen, De Lapide Benedicto Philosophorum, &c. Interprete Benedicto Figulo, Vtenhoviale, Franco, Poëta L. C. Theologo; Theosopho ; Philosopho, Medico, Eremita. D. T. P. D. G. N. Getruckt zu Basel, in verlegung des Autoris. Anno BeneDICtI Regis & MagIstrI GratIae & bonItatis, &c .

4°. Pp. [15, 1 blank] 117 [2] [1 blank]. The vignette is a figure in Roman dress. The chronogram stands for 1608.

The first part of this book consists of : 1. extracts from Salomon Trismosinus , Trithemius, p. 16; 2. Paracelsus, p. 33; 3. von Suchten, p. 56;

4. Tractalulus Rythmicus Novus vom Stein der Weysen, p. 58; 5. Aenigmata, p. 71;

6. Processus ad Lapidem Philosophorum Monachi cuiusdam anonymi, p. 79.

The second part is a translation of Ventura's work, De Lapide Philosophorum. 24.

Pandora Magnalium Naturalium Aurea et Benedicta ,

de Benedicto Lapidis Philosoph. Mysterio. Darinnen Apocalypsis des Hocherleuchten Aegyptischen Königs vnd Philosophi, Hermetis Trismegisti, von vnserm Teutschen Hermete, dem Edlen, Hochthewrem Monarchen vnd Philosopho Trismegisto, A. Ph. Theophrasto Paracelso &c. Verdolmetschet: wie anch Tinctura Physicorum Paracelsica, mit

einer Schönen Erklerung des auch Edlen vnd Hocherfahrnen Philosophi, Alexandri von Süchten, Utrijusque Medicine D. Sampt Seiner AL. V. S. angehengten 3. Vnderschiedlichen Tractetlein, so vor nie gesehen worden, wie auch Anderen Ejusdem materige Corollariis, wie sie nach der Vorredt Specifiret (sic) werden: Allen Filiis Doctrinae Henneticae zu nutz vnd gutem jetzo publiciret. Durch Benedictum Figulum; Utenhoviateni, Fr: P. L. C. T. T. P. M. E. D. T. P. D. G. N. Getruckt zu Strafsburg, inn Verlegung Lazari Zetzeners. 1608.

Pandora magnalium Naturalium Aurea..., 1608

8° Pp. [32] 393 [1. 1 blank]. 1 woodcut. The vignette is a six-rayed star. In the centre circle is the symbol for Mercury, in the rays are the astronomical symbols for gold, silver, copper, lend, tin and iron. The book contains the following tracts:

1. Liber Apocalypseos Hermetis, Theo. Paracelso, interprete, De supremo Mundi Secreto, p. 1.

2. De Vera Medicina Alexandri à Suchten Elegia, Dialogus, Alexandri à Suchten, p. 49.

3. Ex libro de tribus Facultatibus Alexandri à Suchten, p. 112.

4. Explicatio Tincturae Physicorum Theophrasti Paracelsi, ab Alexandro à Suchten, p. 143.

5. Regulae seu Canones aliquot Philosophici de Lapide Philosophico, p. 216.

6. Tractätlein von Lapide Philosophorum Anonymi, p. 234.

7. Rythmi Germanici von diesem hogen Tincturwerck Anonymi Authoris, p. 263.

8. De Auro Potabili Theophrasti Paracelsi, p. 275.

9. Von der Krafft vnnd Würckung auch rechtem nutzlichem Gebrauch des herrlichen Antidoti so man Aurum Potabile nennet, p. 279. 24bis . Pandora

: Das ist, Die edelst Gab Gottes, oder der werde vnd heilsame Stein der Weysen, mit welchem die alten Philosophi, auch Theophrastus Paracelsus, die vnvollkommene Metallen durch gewalt des Fewrs verbessert: sampt allerley schedliche vnd vnheiisame kranckheiten, jnnerlich vnnd eusserlich haben vertrieben. Ein Guldener Schatz, welcher durch einen Liebhaber dieser Kunst, von seinem Vndergang errettet ist worden,- vnd zu Nutz allen Menschen, fürnemlich den Liebhabern der Paracelsischen Artzney, jetzt widerumb in Truck verfertiget Getruckt zu Basel, Durch Sebastianum Henricpetri. 8°. Pp. [16]317[1 blank], [l] Colophon: Getruckt zu Basel durch Sebastianum Henricpetri. Anno Clc Icxxcviii. [l] Petri's device. 42 woodcuts. Pandora, Reusner, 1598 1)- REUSNER

(Hieronymus) He was the son of Christopher Reusner, and was

born at Lemberg in Silesia 26 Sept., 1558. He graduated as M.D. at Basel, and became

town physician at Hof in Vogtland and then at Nörd-town.He wrote a small number of medical works: De pollinctura et sepultura cadaverum. Decisiones, Basileae, 1578,4°. Epistolae, Francof., 1600, 8°. Tractatus de Scorbuto, 1600.

Urinarum probationes Iodoci Willichii illustrate Scholiis Medicis, . . . Remedia item plurima ex urina desumpta, Basil., 1583, 8°.

Curationes et observationes medicae in the 'Sylloge' of Georg Hieron. Welsch, Aug. Vindel., 1668. 40.

Beschreibung des minerabschen Bades zu Wemb-dingen, Neuburg, 1618, 8".

This was apparently a posthumous publication.

'Pandora' is not mentioned by Eberti, but his judgment on the author is flattering: 'Vir certe eruditus, qui editis cultissimi sui ingenii & ex-quisitae doctrinae lucubrationibus aeternum nomen si hi comparavit,' but his name is hardly remembered now. The first edition of the present work appeared in 1582, with the following title-page: Pandora, Das ist, Die

Edleste Gab Gottes, oder der Werde vnnd Heilsamme Stein der Weisen, mit welchem die alien Philosophi, auch Theophrastus Paracelsus, die vnuolkofnene Metallen, durch gewalt des Fewrs verbessert: sampt allerley schadliche vnd vnhetlsame Kranckbeiten, jnnerlich vnd eusserlich haben vertrieben.

Ein Guldener Schatz. welcher durch einen Liebhaber diser Kunst, von seinem Vmergang errettet ist worden. vnnd zu nutz alien Menschen, fiirnem-lich den Liebhabern der Paracelsischen Artzney, erst jetz in Truck verfertiget.

Getruckt zu Basel Anno M.D.LXXXII. 8° pp. [16] 309 [1 blank]. Colophon'. Getruckt zu Basel, bey Samuel Apiario. Symbolical woodcuts in the text.

Reusner was apparently only the editor of this book, and he calls it 'Pandora Francisci Epi-methei' as if that were indeed the author's name. That, however, wears the air of a pseudonym, and accordingly Fictuld informs us that the real name of the author was Ulmannus, and that he was a Franciscan. Schmieder, on the other hand, states boldly, 'Hieronymus Reufsner wrote: Epimethei Pandora, oder Stein der Weisen. . . . Basel, 1598, 8°. Though the book probably made its first appearance in 1582, at all events in German, it, or the symbolical pictures in it, were known some time earlier. In an anonymous tract, entitled: 'Liber de arte chimica incerti autboris,' printed in the ars AURIFERA. 1572, there appears at the conclusion of Cap. xvii. a description which applies unmistakably to certain of the allegorical plates contained in the 'Pandora,' though the book itself is not mentioned by name. After explaining these in some detail, and showing how widely symbols had been used, the author adds: 'Has not also Ulmannus Franciscan monk and "frater minor" described our wisdom with great skill in the German tongue and tested it by the Passion, and proved that it is sure?' It is on this passage that Fictuld based his statement that Ulmannus was the author of the Pandora, but it is difficult to see any justification of this view in the words employed. This anonymous tract is contained, of course, in the different editions and

translations of the ARS aurifera. See the edition of 1610, i. pp. 400-401, and Morgenstern's translation, 1613, i. p. 552;

1750. i. p. 671. It would seem, however, as if the plates had been known before 1572, whether accompanied by a verbal elucidation of their meaning or not. For, even before this, namely in 1550, one or two of the plates had already appeared in the Rosarium PHILOSOPHORUM along with the verses, which, with some omissions, are also contained in the 'Pandora.' One of these plates, which represents a hermaphroditic figure holding in one hand a goblet with three serpents rising out of it, and in the other a single serpent, is referred to by Michael Maier in the Symbola Aurea Mensae, 1617, who says that between it and the accompanying verses — rythmi germanici he calls them — the author elucidates the whole of the art Maier gives a translation, because they had not been put into Latin before, and because of their truth and merit, Thesse are the verses in the 1550 edition of the rosarium, sig. Miiij. Maier, however, has made his quotation from the rosarium and not from the 'pandora' with which, indeed, he does not seem to have been acquainted. It may be observed that while both contain allegorical pictures, expressing alchemical processes, one set is quite different from the other, with the exceptions already specified. The verses also seem to apply more correctly to the plate in the 'Pandora' to which they are referred, than to that in the Rosarium, but the subject is by no means clear and it stands in need of further investigation. 2)- FAUSTIUS (Johannes Michael).

Joh. Michaelis Faustij, Med. Doct Physici Francofurt. Ordinarij, Academ. Leopoldino Imperialis Theophili, Compendium Alchymist. Novum, sive Pandora Explicata & Figuris Jllustrata. Das ist, die Edelste Gabe Gottes, oder ein Güldener Schatz, mit welchem die alten und neuen Philosophi, die unvollkommene Metall, durch Gewalt des Feuers verbessert, und allerhand schädliche und unheylsame Kranckheiten innerlich und äusserlich, durch deren Würckung, vertrieben haben. Dieser Edition wird annoch, nebst vielen Kupffern, und über 800. Philosophischen Anmerckungen, ein voll-komenes Lexicon Alchymisticum Novum, und

ein vollständiges Register Rerum & Verborum, beygefüget Franckurt und Leipzig, Verlegts Johann Zieger, 1706. 8°. Pp. [32] 1071. Index [194]. 19 woodcut plates separate. Small woodcuts in the text Title red and black, printed across two pages. Engraved title prinled on two pages, both included in signaturc)(. The letterpress explaining the woodcuts is not paged, but is lettered from A to T. The pagination, however, runs on consecutively. 'Lexicon Alcbemiae,' pp. 104 ; 'Summarischer Begriff,' pp. 236.

Pandora, Faustius (Johannes Michael), 1706 (frontispice)

The work has a preface by Faustius and a reprint of that by Hieronymus Reusner prefixed to ' Pandora.' The present work consists of the text of Pandora illustrated by numerous extracts and parallel passages from all the alchemical writers with the supplementary matter above mentioned added. See Pandora

. The remainder of the 'Lexicon' and 'Summarischer Begriff' were reissued together at Hamburg in 1727, the former with a title-page: "Lexikon Alchemize D. Joh. Michaelis Faustii," and the latter with an interpolated very detailed title-page beginning: "Succincta & brevis Artis Chemiae Instructio.' Copies of Faustius 'Pandora' occur without this supplement See below. Schmieder quotes : Compendium Alchymia novum, Francof. 1706, 8°, as if it were a distinct work. 25. HERMETISCHES Museum .

Erster Theil. Alten Liebhabern der wahren Weisheit gewidmet von dem Herausgeber. Reval und Leipzig bey Albrecht und Compagnie . . .

8°. Pp. 192. The date has been torn off. - Zweyter Theil. .. (date torn off). 8°. Pp. 190. - Dritter Theil , 1785. 8°. Pp. 179 [1 blank].

- Vierter Theil, Leipzig, 1790, in Geislers, des jüngern, Verlagshandlung. 8°. Pp. vi. 170.

The date of parts I. and II. is 5782, which of course stands for 1782. Erster Theil.

1. Warum gelangen nur wenige Menschen zum Meisterstük der königlichen Kunst ? eine Frage, beantwortet von einem ächten Maurer, I., p. 13.

2. Johann de Monte Raphaim. Vorbothe der am philosophischen Himmel hervorbrechenden Morgenräthe, I., p. 65.

3. P. A. Theophrasti geheimes und vollständiges Wünschhütlein, . . . mit einer Nachricht von des Verfassers Leben vermehrt von Sincero Aletophilo. Nach der Erfurter Ausgabe von 1738 abgedrukt, I., p. 111. Zweyter Theil.

1. Johannis Augurelli Güldenes Vliefs und Golderzielungskunst . . . übersezt von M. Valentin Weigel ... abgedrukt nach der Hamburger Ausgabe vom Jahre 1716, II, p. 3

2. Reine Hermetische Wahrheit von einem unbekannten Verfasser, II., p. 143. Dritter Theil.

1. Schlüssel zur wahren Weisheit. III., p. 3.

2. Philadelphia oder brüderliehe Liebe von Irenaeus Philoctetes, III., p. 37.

3. Sendschreiben eines Adeplen. über das Geheimnis der grossen Kunst, aus Gelegenheit derjenigen

Lehren abgefafst, die Aristaeus seinem Sohne, das philosophische Meisterstük betreffend hinterlassen

hat. Der Name des Verfassers ist in diesem lateinischen Annagramma (sic) enthalten. Dives sicut Ardens, s. Sanctus Desiderius. zu Paris bey Lorenz D'Houry, 1688, III., p. 95.

4. Liber de Principiis Naturalibus et de principiis artis Chemicae. Incerto Authore, III. p. 151. Vierter Theil.

Die wahrhafte und vollkommene Bereitung des Philosophischen Steins der Brüderschaft aus dem Orden des Gülden, und Rosen-Creutzes ... Dabey angehänget die Gesetze oder Regeln, welche die gedachte Brüderschaft unter sich hält, denen Filiis Doctrinae zum Beslen

publiciret, von S. R., iv. p. 1. The 'Gesetze, 'p. 143. 26.

DIVERS Traitez de la Philosophie Naturelle .

Sçavoir, la Turbe des Philosophes, ou le code de vérité en l'Art. La Parole Délaissée de Bernard Trevisan. Les deux traitez de Corneille Drebel Flaman. Avec le Très-Ancien Duel des Chevaliers. Nouvellement traduits en François, par un Docteur en Médecine. A Paris, chez Jean d'Houry à l'Image S. Jean, au bout du

Pont-neuf, sur le Quay des Augustins. M.DC.LXXII. 12°. Pp.[8] 298. [5, 1 blank]. 1. La Turbe des Philosophes , p. 1. 2. La Parole Délaissée

, Traité de Bernard Comte de la Marche Trevisane, p. 97.

3. Deux traitez philosophiques de Corneille Drebel, p. 175 : I. De la Nature des Elemens, p. 191. II. De la Quinte Essence, p. 245

Ferguson : Drebbel was born at Alkmaar in Northern Holland in 1572. Though only a pensant he was wealthy, but in the wars he was taken prisoner and lost his property. On being set free he came to London, where he died in 1634. He constructed a submarine boat in which he failed from Westminster to Greenwich, and he seems to have been an ingenious mechanician and maker of apparatus, and a clever optician, and he has been even credited, though inaccurately, with the invention of the thermometer. He discovered, in part accidentally, the lake formed when a tin salt is added to cochineal, which was used for dyeing scarlet, and as an alchemist he was in communication with Rudolph II. In the present work on the elements he describes experiments to illustrate the formation of the wind. His tracts were written in Dutch, and printed at Rotterdam In 1702. They were translated into Latin by Joachim Morsius (Hamburg), 1621: Geneva, 1628. The French translation appeared at Paris, 1673, 12°. Hoefer mentions a German translation, Erfurt, 1634, and Schmieder says it was reprinted in Kleeblatt's Chymische Tractätlein, Frankf. u. Leipz., 1768, 8° 4. Le Très-Ancien Duel des Chevaliers

ou Dialogue Chymique de la pierre physique, p. 275.

An edition of this collection seems to have come out at Paris, in 1618. Compare Schmieder, Geschichte der Alchemie. 1832, p. 234, No. 4 . 27. OCCULTA Philosophia

von den verborgenen Philosophischen Geheimnussen der heimlichen Goldblumen, vnd Lapidis Philosophonun, was derselbige: vnd wie zu Erlangung dessen zu procediren, aufsführlicher Bericht in einem Philosophischen Gepräch verfässet, sampt Der Schmaragd-Taflfel, Paraboln, Symbolis, vnd 18. sonderbaren Figuren, der hochberühmten Philosophen Hermeris Trismegisti, vnd F. Basilii Valentini durch welche diese Kunst der Philosophischen Goldblumen vollkomlich erkläret an Tag gegeben. Gedruckt zu Franckfurt am Mayn durch Johann Bringem. Anno M.DC.XIII vignette de l'Occulta Philosophia

4°. Pp. (8] 78. Title red and black. Vignette: Senior and Adolphus with the tree of the metals between. 14 symbolic woodcuts.

- Das ersteTheil : Ein Colloquium Oder Gesprech zwischen eiene alten [Senior] vnd jungen Studenten [Adolphus], p. 1 - Das ander Theil : Aureliae Occultae Philosophorum, p. 47. - Verba Hermetis in Pimandro, p. 49, - Schmaragt Tafel Hermetis, p. 50.

- Symbolum Fratris Basilii Valentini, p. 52. illustrations de l'ouvrage : 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 - 5 - 6 - 7 - 8 - 9 - 10 - 11 - 12 - 13 - [

tirées de l'Azoth ou le Moyen faire l'or caché des philosophes, Paris, Perier, 1624]

Ferguson : The dedication to Ludwig Georg, Count of Stolberg, Königstein, Rochefort. Wernigeroda and Hohensteio, dated 8 January, 1613, is signed by Bringer, the printer. He says the collection was made by a diligent lover of the subject, so that it might be acquired without special trouble. A former owner has written; Dieser Tractat ist Echt und Recht; Sehr Rahr zu haben. 28. COLLECTANEA Chymica :

A Collection of Ten Several Treatises in Chymistry, concerning the Liquor Alkahest, the Mercury of Philosophers, and other Curiosities worthy the Perusal. Written by Eir. Philaletha, Anonymus, Joh. Bapt

Van-Helmont, Dr. Fr. Antonie, Bernhard Earl of Trevisan, Sir Geo. Ripley, Rog. Bacon. Geo. Starkey, Sir Hugh Piatt, and the Tomb of Semiramis, see more in the Contents. London, Printed for William Cooper, at the Pelican in Little Britain, 1684. 8°. Pp. [6] 193 [4, i blank]; 32.

The tracts in this collection are as follows:

1. Eireneus Philaletha, Arcanum, or secret of the immortall Liquor Alkaest, p. 5. 2. Anonymus. Practice of Lights, p. 27.

3. Joh. Bapt. Van Helmont, Praecipiatum, p. 47. 4. Fr. Antonie, Aurum Potabile, p. 73.

5. Bernhard of Trevisan, Treatise, p. 83. 6. George Ripley. Bosome-book, p. 101.

7. Roger Bacon, Speculum Alchymiae, p. 125.

8. George Starkey, Oil of Sulphur-vive, p. 137.

9. Hugh Platts, Remedies against Famine, p. 153. 10. H. V. D., Tumba Semiramidis,

Ferguson : Notwithstanding the Latin titles the tracts are all in English, except the first, which is in both languages. Each tract has a title-page. In 1893, at London, appeared a volume entitled Collectanea Chymica

; being certain select Treatises on Alchemy and Hermetic Medicine. The prefatory note states that the tracts were printed from a MS. belonging to the late Frederick Hockley, itself a transcript from an older work. No date is given for the MS., so that it is not possible to say whether or not it was taken from the present work. The 1803 edition contains the tract on the 'Alka. hbest,' Antonie's 'Aurum Potabile,' Starkey's 'Oil of Sulphur-Vive,' Ripley's ' Bosom book,' all as in the above; the others are omitted, but it has a tract ' On the stone of the philosophers,' and one on the ' Preparation of the Sophick Mercury,' which are not in the older edition. 29. AURIFONTINA Chymica :

or, a Collection of fourteen small Treatises concerning the First Matter of Philosophers, for the discovery of their (hitherto so much concealed) Mercury. Which many have studiously endeavoured to hide, but these to make manifest, for the benefit of Mankind in general. London, Printed for William Cooper, at the Pelican in Little-Britain. 1680.

frontispice de l'Aurifontina Chymica, London, 1680

Small narrow 24°. Pp. [23] containing title, John Frederick Houpregh't's dedication of the Hydropyrographum

to Charles II., Contents, To the Reader. Text, pp. 372. Advertisement of Chemical books [4].

This curious and very rare little volume was probably compiled and edited by William Cooper, a well-known vendor of Alchemical books, and the author of the first catalogue of such books in England. The treatises contained are the following:

1. Hydropyrographum Hermeticum, or the Metallicick Water-fire, translated by J. F. Houpreght, p. 1.

2. The Privy Seal of Secrets, plainly discovering the first Matter of the Philosophers, p. 41.

3. A strange letter concerning an Adept, his curious Learning and vaster Treasure, from Frederick, Duke of Holsatia and Sleswick, p. 53.

4. Sir George Ripley's Treatise of Mercury, and the Philosophers stone, p. 69.

5. Colours to be observed in the operation of the Great Work of Philosophers, p. 93.

6. A plain and true Description of the Treasure of Treasures, or the Golden Medicine, p. 97.

7. A Treatise of the Philosophers Stone, the Blessed Manna, &c., with its wondrous Virtues and Use, both for the curing the Body of Man, and the making of precious Stones, p. 107.

8. Nic. Flammell, his Summary of Philosophy, or Short Treatise of the Philosophers Stone, p. 145. 9. Rayrn. Lullie's Clavicula

, Apertorium, or little Key explaining all the rest of his Works, p. 163.

10. Secrets disclos'd of the Philosophers Stone, p. 180.

11. A Philosophical Riddle of Gold, in Verse, p. 185.

12. Item. Trevisan's Epistle to Thomas of Bononia, concerning the secret workings of Nature in the product of thing; p. 187.

13. Bern. Trevisan, his short Epistle Dedicatory before his Works, to the same man, p. 269.

14. A brief Preparation of the Philosophers Stone, for the conclusion of this Book. p. 271.

30. ERÖFFNETE Geheimnisse des Steins der Weisen

oder Schatz-Kammer der Alchymie, darinnen die vortrefflichsten Schrifften derer berühmtesten alten und neuern Scribenten denen Liebhabern der Kunst dargestellet werden. Nebst vielen Kupfferstichen und andern dazu dienlichen Figuren. [Hamburg, Bey Christian Liebezeit in der Joh. Kirch, 1708-18.]

This is the Hamburg reprint of Trismosin’s Aureus vellus, 1598 (q.v.). Though the special titles are dated Harnburg, 1708, the general title-page is that of 1718. The five ‘Tractatus contain the following : I. Trissmosinische Schrifften, p. 1. II.

Paracelsische Schrifften, p. 91. Korndorfferische Schrlfften, p. 129 III. 1. Splendor Solis mit schönen Figuren, p. 163.

2. Spiegel der Alchymey Ulrici Poyselii, p. 214.

3. Clavis sampt seiner Declaration der Chymischen Handgriffen, p. 229.

4. Allerley Particularia die Handtgriff zuer. lehrnen, p. 237.

5. Ein Tincktur oder Elixier eines unbekandten philosophi, p. 250.

6. Processus pro Tinctura auff den Mercurium Solis und Lunae, p. 256,

7. Modus procedendl in praeparatione lapidis philosophici, p. 258. 8. Dialogus philosophiae, p. 272.

9. Exemplum artls Philosophiae. Ein Exemplum der philosophischen Kunst, p. 278.

10. De lapide Philosophorum 12 capita incerti authoris, p. 281.

11. Vom Stein der Weisen ein schöner Process Episcopi Melchioris Brixiensis Card. Romae, etc., und ein Philosophisches Werck und Gespräch von dem Gelben und Rotten Man, p. 296. 12. Von dem Rebis einem Stein, p. 305. 13. VarIa Philosophica, p. 307.

(a) Capitulum, darinnen das gantze Werck kürtslich begriffen, p. 307. (b) Ein schönes Gedicht, p. 310. (c) Ein Gespräch, p. 312. (d) Ein Gedicht, p. 314. (e) De Oleo Philosophorum, p, 314. (f) Vera praeparatio Mercurii. p. 315.

14. Tractalus vom Saltz der Weisen, p. 315. 15. Novum Testamentum, p. 318.

16. Von dem Philosophischen Bley. p. 319.

17. Avicenna Septem regulae ex quibus componiftur lapis Philosophorum, p. 320. 18. Tabula Scientiae maioris p. 321.

19. De quinta essentia vini pulcherrimus tractatus, p. 342. 20. Tabula schmaragdina

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21. Aufslegung und erklärung des Gemelds oder Figur (in verse), p. 337. IV.

1. Von der Bereitung des gebenedeyten Philosophischen Steins-Caspar Hartung von Holf, p. 349.

2. De Prima Materia Lapidis Philosophorum (In verse), p. 360.

3. Vollkommener Bericht und Handgriff in Zubereitung des Lapidis Philosophorum und Tincturae Physicae, p. 370.

4. Liber Secretorum Ionnis deo Padua de Lapide Philosophorum. Liber Primus, p. 376 5. Liber secundus, p. 393. 6. Liber tertius, p. 399

7. Clavis Philosophiae Chemicae, p. 447.

8. Grundtlicher Bericht was die warhafttige Kunst Alchemia innhalte und vermag in Via Universali & Particulari, aufs allen Philosophis zusammen gezogen, p. 479.

9. Hortus Divitiarum. Der Garten der Reichthumb aller Weifsheit Gottes, p. 500 10. Ein Werck der Alchimey, p. 519,

11. Zwo Tincturen auff Weifs und Roth, p. 533.

12. De Lapide in Aqua Mercurlali, p. 540.

13. Ein Mercurij Arbeit und Augment mit dem Mercurio Lunae, p. 545.

14. Ein schönes Tractätlein in welchem etliche schöne und lustige Particular Stücklein begriffen sind, p. 554.

15. Ein schön Stuck von Doctor Scheneken, p. 563.

16. Von dem Antimonio Philosophorum, non Vulgi, p. 570.

17. Oleum Antominii : Die Fixatio, sein Quinta Essen, Caspar Eberlein. p. 579 V.

1. Von Offenbahrung der Philosophischen Materien und Dingen, aufs weichen vollbracht wirdt die Meisterechafft, in wirckung defs Edlen und gebenedeiten Steins der Philosophen, p. 593.

2. Thesaurus Philosophen Euferarij, p. 606.

3. Tractatus darinn das gantze Secret der Alchimey vom Stein der Weisen begriffen ist, p. 623. 4. Lux lucens in Tenebris, p. 636.

5. Tractatus deVitriolo Philosophorum, p. 642.

6. Oleum Vitrioli [by R. Bacon], p. 651.

7. Experinmenta ... durch ... Raimundum Lilium ... und von Raimundo in Iatein beschrieben. Jets aber durch Herrn Georgium Sanderreuter von Wasserburg verteutscht worden, p. 664. 8.

Des Buchlein von der natürlichen Philosophey

der Metallen des Edlen und Hochgelehrten Herren Dionisij Zacharij Galli, p. 727

9. Ein streit und Gespräch des Goldes und Mercurij wider des Stein der Weisen, p. 765

10. Etliche Korndorfferische Particularia, p. 773. 11. Spiegel der Philosophey , p. 787. Introduction aux manuscrits alchimiques d'Isaac Newton ¯ Collection d'ouvrages alchimiques de l'Institut de France et du Museum d'Histoire Naturelle Introduction

L'Académie des sciences et le Museum d'Histoire Naturelle possèdent un certain nombre d'ouvrages sur l'alchimie. Pour ce qui est du Museum, ils sont issus du fonds Chevreul, légué au musée par le chimiste Eugène Chevreul

(1783-1886) à sa mort. On se reportera aux deux sections sur Artephius et Cambriel

pour plus de renseignements sur l'oeuvre critique de Chevreul sur l'alchimie. Cf. aussi l'étude plus générale consacrée à Chevreul .

1. Paris, Bibliothèque de l'Institut de France MS. 795. 13 folios. papier. 190 x 125mm. XVIII e

[Alchemical treatises by Isaac Holland.] f. 1 OEuvre philosophique. f. 7 Pratique de grand oeuvre. f. 10 Théorie de l'arcane. Du grande oeuvre cy devant ou pierre des philosophes.

2. Paris, Bibliothèque de l'Institut de France MS. 1772-1775.

4 volumes. 80, 99, 104 et 203 folios. papier. 199 x 145mm.

Recueil de chymie et d'alchymie, par Mr Dupont, médecin à Antibes, donné pour tel par Mr Arnauld, avec un table des matières.

3. Paris, Bibliothèque de l'Institut de France MS. 2974. 164 folios. papier. 230 x 190mm. XIX e

[Copy of a Syrian alchemical treatise from a manuscript in the British Museum.]

4. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2021. 48 folios. Paper. 240 x 170mm. XVII e

1. Le miroir d'alchimie d'Arnauld de Villeneuve. 2. f. 37 Questions tant essentielles qu'accidentelles de Maistre Arnauld de Villeneuve à Boniface VIII... [Copie manuscrite de Claude-Alexandre Séguier (1656-1725). Pour le MS. de Séguier, voir M.-E. Chevreul in Journal des Savants, 1851, p. 758-760. - repris in extenso dans Chevreul, critique d'Artephius]

5. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2022.

148 + 41 pages. papier. 275 x 200mm. XVII e

Testament of Raymond Lully. [Copie manuscrite de Claude-Alexandre Séguier.]

6. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2023.

98 + 20 pages. papier. 190 x 135mm. XVII e

Testament de Raymond Lulle. [Copie manuscrite de Claude-Alexandre Séguier.] Le titre de la page est manquant et les deux parties de l'oeuvre « Théorie » et « Pratique » sont dans un format différent.

7. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2024. 79 folios. papier. 205 x 135mm. XVII e .

1. De la transmutation métallique. Trois anciens traittés en rithmes françoises, à sçavoir: 2. La fontaine des amoureux de science, autheur J[ean] de la Fontaine [1413]; 3. Les

remonstrances de nature à l'alchimiste errant, avec la réponse dudt. alchimiste, par J[ean] de Meung, ensemble un trait de son Roman de la rose concernant ledt. art [1320]; 4. Le sommaire philosophique de Nicolas Flamel [1399]. A Paris, chez Guillaume Guillard et Amauri Warancore, rue Saint-Jacques, à l'enseigne Sainte-Barbe, 1561. [Copie manuscrite de Claude-Alexandre Séguier.]

8. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2025.

95 + 76 + 66 + 93 pages. papier. 235 x 185mm. XVII e

1. [George Ripley] Les oeuvres de Georges Riplée, philosophe, chanoine de Bridli[n]gton. Traduit du latin par Raimond Bascon, sieur de Presles, médecin chimiste, l'an 1689. p. 5-75 Le livre des douze portes. p. 76-81 La chanson de Georges Riplée. p. 82-91 La lettre de Georges Riplée au roy Edouard IV... p. 95 La vision du chevalier Georges Ripleys... p. 93 [illustrations représentant le système chimique de Ripley.] 2. [trois textes de Pantaléon.] p. 1-76 Le tombeaux d'Hermès ouvert... mis en lumière... par Anonime Pantaléon... et traduit du latin par Raimond Bascon... A Paris, l'an 1689. [Tumulus Hermetis apertus published at Nuremberg in 1676.] p. 1-66 Examen alchimistique par lequel comme par le pierre de touche l'on discernera l'Adepte du sophiste et le philosophe de l'imposteur... autheur Pantaléon... traduit du latin par Raimond Bascon... A Paris, l'an 1689. p. 1-93 La double feuille métallique ou La médecine double pour les métaux et pour les hommes infirmes... par Pantaléon... traduite du latin par Raimon Bascon... A Paris, l'an 1689. 3. Volatilisation du sel de tartre [d'après Van Helmont]. Régule de Mars comme l'a faict l sieur Prince [recette].

9. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2026. 128 pages. papier. 220 x 165mm. XVII e

La clef majeure de sagesse et science des secrets de nature d'Artephius. [traduction du Clavis majoris sapientiae, extrait du Theatrum Chemicum, vol IV, p. 198.] Ensuit la practique de la théorique cy dessus écritte par le méme auteur. [cf. traduction A dont parle Chevreul dans son examen de la Clavis Majoris Sapientiae -]

10. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2027.

398 pages + 14 folios. 2 volumes. papier. 165 x 125mm. XVII e

La clef du secret des secrets de phylosophie ou Premier livre de Pierre Vicot ou le serviteur prestre, serviteur de Nicolas de Grosparmy comte de Flers et de Noël Le Vallois gentilhomme compagnon de Grosparmy. [traduction et adaptation de la Clavis majoris sapientiae d'Artephius. Le manuscrit est enrichi de nombreuses notes de main différente. Les derniers folios sont illustrés avec des images peintes au crayon. - c'est ce que Chevreul nomme le traité de Vicot dans son étude sur Artephius. Il parle de ce MS. comme le Manuscrit A.]

11. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2028.

344 pages. 2 volumes. papier. 165 x 125mm. XVII e

1. La clef du secret des secrets de Nicolas Valois, compagnon du sieur de Grosparmy. [traduction et adaptation du Clavis majoris sapientiae. Ex-libris d'Etienne Clavier (1762-1817). 2. p. 119 Oeuvre ou Traitté premier de Nicolas de Grosparmy de Normandie. [figure peinte à la p. 133.] 3. p. 187 Quelques usages de la pierre, tirés d'un manuscrit appelé Manne du ciel. 4. p. 208 La manné

terrestre, venant du ciel, se répand sur les enfants des hommes sages. Poème en 732 vers par un phylosophe inconnu [Jean-Albert Belin?] 5. p. 255 Les 40 propositions suivantes ont été publiées par un seigneur allemand [Marcellus Palingenius] qui provoquoit par là tous les sçavants de l'Europe sur cette matière et s'engageoit à leur prouver ses raisons par l'expérience. L'ouvrage a paru en latin, et il est copié sur la traduction qui en a été donné par M. La Monerie dans celle du poème de Palyngene... 6. p. 283 Falx in bifolium processus contra examen alchimisticum tumulatio tumuli Pantaleonis ab anonymo authore edita in commodum filiorum artis ut caveant ad ejusdem jactabundi Pantaleonis interpellatis erroribus et imposturis. Amsterodami, praestant apud Johannem Janssonium, 1678. [Anonymous critique of Tumulus Hermetis apertus of Pantaléon.] 7. p. 330 Poème phylosophique sur le sujet des sages.

12. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2029. 96 folios. papier. 230 x 130mm. XVII e

[collection de divers écrits alchimiques, de la main de Claude-Alexandre Séguier. - il s'agit de ce que Chevreul nomme le manuscrit D dans son étude sur Artephius] 1. Les particularités de Bernard de Badie. 2. f. 17 Ici sont les livres des trois Adeptes [Nicolas Vallois, Nicolas de Grosparmy and Pierre Vicot] qui firent à Rouen la pierre philosophale. [Adaptation of Clavis majoris sapientiae of Artephius.] 3. f. 48 ... Pratique de l'oeuvre minéralle par Nicolas de Grosparmy à son ami Nicolas de Valois. 4. f. 58 La clef de quelque secret de philosophie qui est le premier livre de Me Pierre Nicot [sic] preste serviteur de Nicolas de Grosparmy comte de Fles [sic] et de Nicolas de Vallois gentilhomme

compagnon de Grosparmy, lesquels touts [sic] trois d'une même union, amitié, fidélité et concorde firent la pierre des philosophes et leurs livres pour leurs successeurs. 5. f. 63 v La clef de nature. 6. f. 69 La révélation de la parole cachée par la sagesse des anciens ou la généalogie du mercure des philosophes. 7. f. 77 Lettre qui sert d'introduction pour le traité cy-dessus. 8. f. 80 Extraction du dissolvant ou Le moien d'extraire le dissolvant universel de sa matrice originelle par Mr L.A. 9. f. 86 Extrait d'un livre intitulé Novum lumen medicum de mysteris sulphuris philosophorum Joachimi Polemanni.

13. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2030.

2+212 folios. papier. 235 x 185mm. XVIII e

[Collection de divers écrits alchimiques, qui commencent par une table à la fin de laquelle l'auteur se nomme...ce volume appartenant à moy Jean-Baptiste-Léonard Dion de Saint-Jory.] 1. Le petit paysan ou Le Lys parmi les épines, traduit de l'allemand par [Jean] Valachie. 2. f. 55 L'arche de l'arcane ou Secret des souverains misteres de la nature, de Mre Jean Grassée... construi de son Grand et Petit paysan. [voir Theatrum Chemicum, VI, p. 294.] 3. f. 68 Le grand paysan. Discours particulier... Histoire de feux souterrains qui se voyent en Europe... dans l'Asie... en Affrique... l'Amérique... 4. f. 118 La clef du secret des secrets de Nicolas de Valois, compagnon de Mr de Grosparmy. 5. f. 173 La clef majeure de sapience et science des secrets de nature où il est simplement traité des qualités des métaux et de leur transmutation par Nicolas de Grosparmy et son amy Nicolas de Valois. [Adaptation of Artephius, Clavis majoris sapientiae. - cf. Traduction C dont parle Chevreul dans son examen de la Clavis majoris Sapientiae - Il le nomme

manuscrit B -] 6. f. 208 Traité de phisique hermétique, d'astrologie, de cabale et de théologie en bref. 7. f. 211 Poème philosophique sur le sujet des sages. [la fin du poème est au ff. 115-117.]

14. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2031.

12+110 folios (81-96 manquantes). papier. 235 x 135mm. XVIII e

[deux textes sur l'antimoine, manuscrit de Claude Alexandre Séguier.] 1. [table alphabétique des matières incluse dans le Char triomphal de l'antimoine attribué à Basile Valentin.] 2. Journal d'une série de travaux alchimiques dont l'exécution dura plus de trois ans. [à la fin, on trouve cinq folios de recettes médicales et alchimiques.]

15. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2032.

79 folios (34 blank). papier. 220 x 170mm. XVII e

[collection de textes alchimiques en français et en latin, manuscrits deClaude Alexandre Séguier.] 1. [50 recettes.] (31ff.) 2. Index aphabeticus rerum quae continentur in libro Caneparii. [index des matières de Pietro Maria Canepari, De atramentis cujuscumque generis... London, 1660.] (14 ff.)

16. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2033. 55 folios. papier. 235 x 170mm. XVII e

Cosmopolite, ou Nouvelle lumière physique. [copie manuscrite de Claude Alexandre Séguier.]

17. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2034. 47 folios. papier. 245 x 175mm. XVII e

Traitté chimique contenant le secret surnaturel de la pierre des sages. [texte manuscrit de Claude Alexandre Séguier

peut-être inspiré du traité d'Edward Kelley sur la pierre philosophale in Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum - Ashmole.] [avec une peinture traversant un fourneau alchimique]

18. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2035. 136 pages. papier. 230 x 175mm. XVII e

Traduction de la langue latine en françois de l'Amphithéâtre de la sapience composé par Henry Khunrath de Leypsic, amateur de théosophie. Imprime en 1602. [suivi de] Symbole phisico-chimique du docteur Khunrath.

19. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2036.

2 vols. 2 folios + 536 pages, and 5 folios + 690 pages. papier. 235 x 185mm. XVIII e

Pharmacopée chymique et alchymique divisée en deaux volumes dont le premier contient les opérations du Char triomphal de l'antimoine du frère Basile Valentine commentées par Kerkringius, philosophe allemand, & celles de divers autres fameux médicines et philosophes qui ont travaillé sur l'antimoine, avec des remarques judicieuses contre les antagonistes de l'antimoine de Charles Lancillotti, médecin spagirique de S.A.S. le duc de Modène. Le second volume contient la Coupelle des souffleurs, ou les secrets des adeptes en cent cinquante disolvans universels divisés en vingt-quatre classes ou genres, par moyen desquels l'on peut tirer de l'antimoine des végétaux, des animaux & des minéraux, la véritable médicine des hommes et des metaux. Oeuvrage qui peut servir pour examiner les souffleurs et faiseurs d'or et découvrir leurs fraudes & impostures, compilés, commentés et enrichis de remarques par Jean Seger Weidenfeld philosophe allemand. Traduit de l'italien

et du latin à faveur des curieux amateurs de leur santé et de la philosophique hermétique, par G.G. interprête du roi à Marseille, en 1715. [le premier volume contient deux dessins- 'Figure du fourneau et vaisseaux, p. 48 de l'original de Kerkringius' (p90), et 'Vaisseaux pour tirer le vinaigre philosophique' (p139).]

20. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2037.

14+229 pages. papier. 240 x 180mm. XVIII e

Les trois cents expériences, observations et remarques phisico-chimiques de George Ernée Staahl, telles que personne jusqu'ici n'en a fait mention... [traduction de Georg-Ernst Stahl, Experimenta, observationes, animadversiones, CCC numero, chymicae et physicae,... Berolini, A, Haude, 1731.]

21. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2038. 101 folios. papier. 230 x 180mm. XVIII e

Théorie chimique du feu, ou Les 300 expériences, observations et remarques de Staahl [traduction incomplète de l'oeuvre en latin comme mentionné ci-dessus in MS. Du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle 2037. Texte de la main de Pierre-Jean-George Cabanis.]

22. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2039. 88 folios. papier. 200 x 160mm. XVIII e

Leçons de chymie. [MS. autographe de Pierre-Jean-Georges Cabanis, qui fut publié à Paris en 1823-25.]

23. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2040. 103 folios. papier. 175 x 110mm. XIX e

Le banquet des sages, ou Instruction de Mercure à un de ses disciples. [Interleaved with notes in a different hand from that of the text.]

24. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2041. 160 folios. papier. 180 x 110mm. XIX e

La gymnosophie alchimique par Telputh gymnosophiste chinois. 1re ouverture par Onomin philosophe arabe...

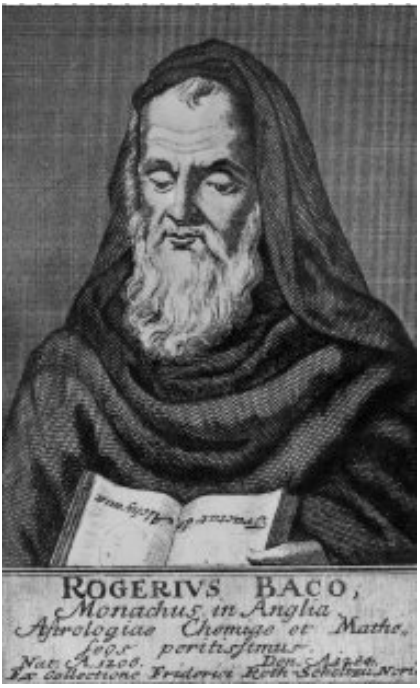
25. Paris, du Muséum d'Histoire Naturelle MS. 2042. 113 folios. papier. 200 x 140mm. XVII e

1. Extrait de la révélation et déclaration de F. Bazile Valentin contenant les plus curieux mistères des teintures essentielles des sept métaux avec leur vertu médicinale divisé en sept chapitres. [Sommaire de Basile Valentin,

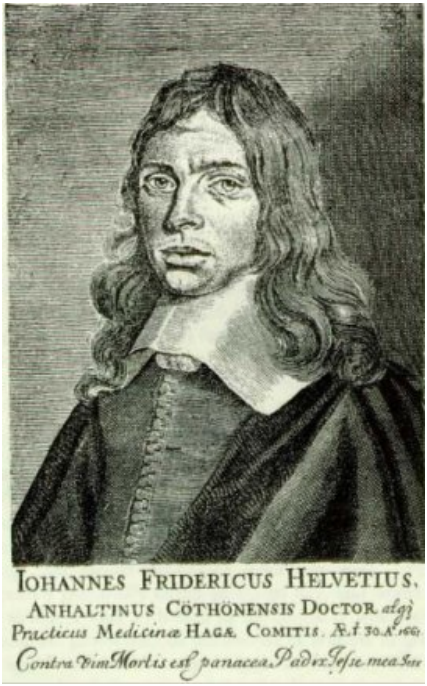
Révélation des mystères des teintures essentielles des sept métaux ... Paris, 1645.]

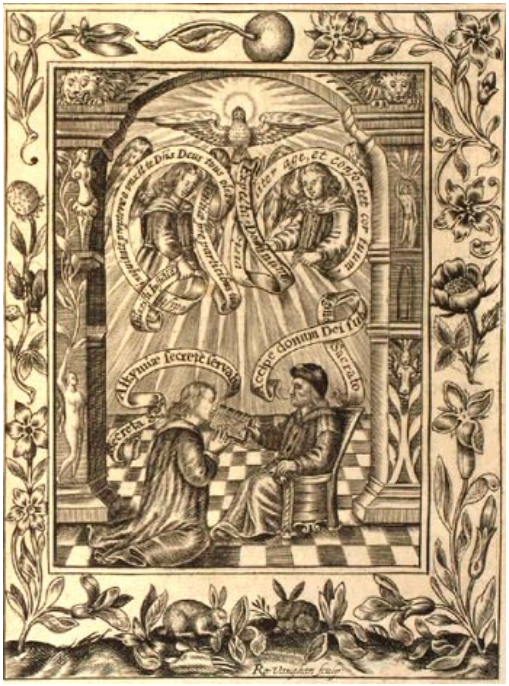
2. [Formules variées et recettes alchimiques et culinaires, avec une table des caractères alchimiques (p. 94), et 8 dessins au crayon représentant la chute de la manne céleste, tandis que d'autres montrent un alchimiste occupé à divers travaux.]


NITI
ME TIO
MO
RA
Hon.mus Francisc.s Bacon.s Baro de Verul.
tum Vice-Comes S.ti Albani Mortuus 9 Aprilis.
Anno Dni 1626 Annoq Aetat 66.


ROGERIVS BACO,
Monachus in Anglia
Astrologiae Chemiae et Mathe-
seos peritissimus.
Nat. A. 1200. Obi. A. 1284.
Ex collectione Friderici Roth Scholtzii Norl.




IOHANNES FRIDERICUS HELVETIUS,
ANHALTINUS CÖTHONENSIS DOCTOR atq;
Practicus Medicinæ HAGÆ COMITIS. Æ.t 30.A.1667
Contra vim Mortis est panacea Pudor Iesse mea Sue


Accipe donum Dei tui
Secreto

BIBLIOTHEQUE DES PHILOSOPHES [CHYMIQUES,] OU RECUEIL DES OEUVRES DES AUTEURS LES PLUS APPROUVEZ QUI ONT ECRIT DE LA PIERRE PHILOSOPHALE.

TOME PREMIER.

Contenant sept Traitez qui sont énoncez dans la page suivante.

Avec un Discours, servant de Preface, sur la verité de la Science, & touchant les Auteurs qui sont dans ce Volume.

Et une Liste des Termes de l'Art, & des Mots anciens qui se trouvent dans ces Traitez, avec leur explication.

Par le Sieur S. D. E. M.



PARIS,
Chez CHARLES ANGOT, ruë Saint Jacques, au Lyon d'or.
M. DC. LXXII.
AVEC PRIVILEGE DV ROY.

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DES
PHILOSOPHES
CHIMIQUES
NOUVELLE EDITION,

Revûë, corrigée & augmentée de plusieurs Philosophes, avec des Figures & des Notes pour faciliter l'intelligence de leur Doctrine.

Par Mr. J. M. D. R.

TOME PREMIER.



A PARIS,
Chez ANDRE' CAILLEAU, Place de Sorbonne, au coin de la ruë des Maçons, à Saint André.

M. DCC. XLI
Avec Approbation & Privilege du Roy.

BIBLIOTHEQUE DES PHILOSOPHES ALCHIMIQUES, OU HERMETIQUES.

TOME QUATRIE'ME.

SECONDE PARTIE.

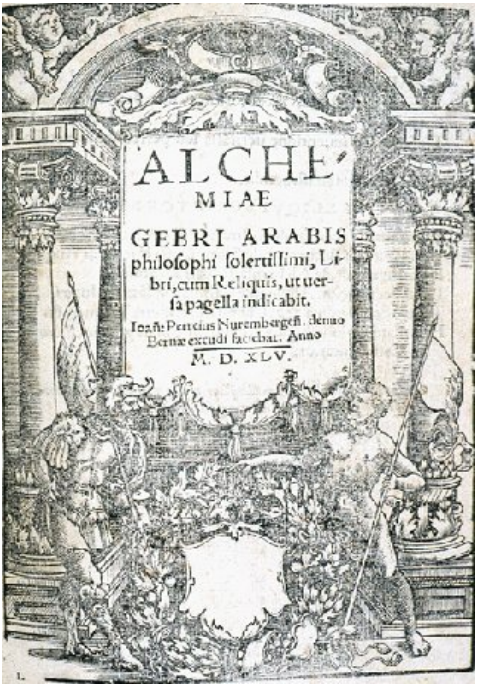
Contenant des Ouvrages en ce genre, très-curieux & utiles, qui n'ont point encore parus.

Spirat ubi vult & quando vult ; spirat autem omne verè quod est bonum : de superiùm est, & à Patre luminum.



A PARIS,
Chez ANDRÉ-CHARLES CAILLEAU, Libraire, Quay des Augustins, à l'Espérance & à Saint André.
M. DCC. LIV.

Avec Approbation & Privilége du Roy.


ALCHE'
MIAE
GEBRI ARABIS
philosophi solertissimi, Li-
bri, cum Reliquis, ut uer-
sa pagella indicabit.
Ioan. Petreius Norembergen. demum
Bernæ excudi faciebat. Anno
M. D. XLV.

IN HOC VOLVMINE

DE ALCHEMIA

continentur hæc.

GEBRI Arabis, Philosophi solertissimi, rerumq; naturalium, præcipue metallicarum peritissimi,
De inuestigatiõe pfectionis metallorũ. Liber I.
Summæ perfectionis metallorum, siue perfecti magisterij. Libri II.
Quæ sequuntur, omnia nunc primũ exacta sunt.
Eiusdem De inuentione ueritatis seu perfectionis metallorum. Liber I.
De Fornacibus construendis. Liber I.

ITEM.

Speculũ Alchemiæ, doctissimi uiri Rogerij Bachonis.
Correctoriũ Alchemiæ doctiss. uiri Richardi Anglici.
Rosarius minor, de Alchemia, Incerti authoris.
Liber Secretorũ Alchemiæ Calidis filij Iazichi Iudæi.
Tabula Smaragdina de Alchemia, Hermetis Trismeg.
Hortulani philosophi, super Tabulam Smaragdinam Hermetis Commentarius.

Omnia collatis exemplaribus, cum doctissimis, non nisi modo ad mẽtẽ authorũ dijũcta, & argumẽtis atq; figuris necessarijs illustrata, ut merito ea renata uideri queãt.

Norimbergæ apud Ioh. Petreium,
Anno M. D. XLI.

THEATRUM CHEMICUM,

PRÆCIPUOS

SELECTORUM AUCTORUM TRACTATUS DE CHEMIÆ ET LAPIDIS PHILOSOPHICI

Antiquitate, veritate, jure, præstantia, & operationibus, continens:

In gratiam Veræ Chemiæ, & medicinæ Chemicæ studiosorum (ut qui uberrimam inde optimorum remediorum messem facere poterunt) congestum, & in Sex partes seu volumina digestum;

SINGULIS VOLUMINIBUS, SUO AUCTORUM ET LIBRORUM Catalogo primis pagellis: rerum verò & verborum Indice postremis annexo.

VOLUMEN PRIMUM.

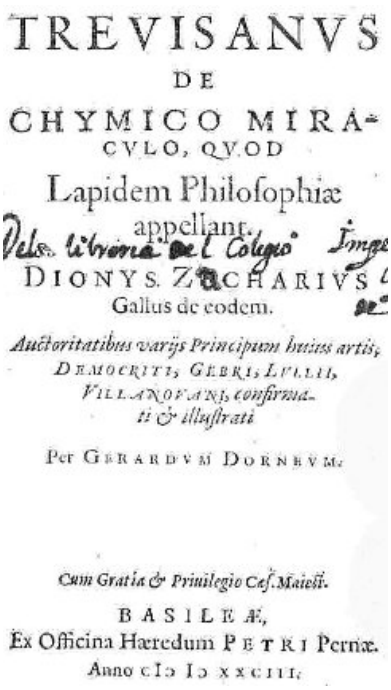
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Anno cIↃ IↃ XXCIII.

manuscrits alchimiques d'Isaac Newton - introduction

Capture du 2016-03-06 — http://herve.delboy.perso.sfr.fr/mss_newton.html

Introduction aux manuscrits alchimiques d'Isaac Newton revu le 12 février 2006 Plan : préambule - Clavis - I. Keynes Mss., King's College Library , Cambridge, UK - II.

Yahuda Mss., Jewish National and University - III. Edwin Newton Ohl Collection , Francis A. - IV. The British Library, London , UK - V. Fitzwilliam Museum , Cambridge, UK - VI. Hampshire Record Office , Winchester - VII. Estates of Mind', Great Neck , New York, USA - VIII. St Andrews University Library , Fife, UK - IX. Massachusetts Institute of Technology - X. Dibner Library , Smithsonian Institution - XI. Bodleian

Library, Oxford , UK - XII. Harry Ransom Humanities Research Center - XIII.

Library of the University of Wisconsin-Madison - XIV. Babson Collection, Burndy Library , Dibner - XV. Stanford University Library , Stanford - XVI. Cushing/Whitney Medical Library , Yale - XVII. Add. Mss., Cambridge University Library - XVIII. Mellon Alchemical Mss ., Beinecke Library - XIX. Joseph Halle Schaffner Collection , Chicago - XX. Rare Book and Manuscript Library , Columbia - XXI.

Alchemical manuscripts whose location is unknown - XXII. Alchemical Newton's Printed Sources - Préambule

: Nous avons eu l'occasion à de multiples reprises de nous pencher sur les travaux alchimiques d'Isaac Newton qui ont égalé ses travaux dans le domaine des mathématiques, de la physique et de l'astronomie. A peu près tous les historiens des sciences sont aujourd'hui d'accord pour dire que Newton est le dernier grand alchimiste de la tradition hermétique ; dans le même temps, qu'il ait été l'un des plus grands génies qu'a compté l'humanité reste absolument extraordinaire. Plusieurs ouvrages ont été traduits de l'anglais sur les papiers alchimiques de Newton : il faut citer une biographie monumentale : Isaac Newton

, par Richard Westfall, Flammarion (1994),

Isaac Newton, un alchimiste pas comme les autres , Pierre Thuillier, in La Recherche , 876-887, 212, 1989 et Les Fondements de l’alchimie de Newton

, Betty J. Teeter Dobbs, Guy Trédaniel (1981), ouvrage fondamental pour la compréhension historique et épistémologique qui a décidé Newton à entreprendre une étude « rationnelle » de l'alchimie, et en même temps, dans l'orthodoxie hermétique la plus accusée. En France, un ouvrage récent, Newton ou le triomphe de l'alchimie

, dû à Jean-Paul Auffray, Editions Le Pommier (2000) fait aussi le point sur la question mais en éludant un peu, du moins à ce qu'il nous paraît,

le degré de signifiance purement alchimique des travaux du grand physicien. On citera enfin un autre ouvrage, tout à fait remarquable, la Malle de Newton

, de Loup Verlet, paru chez Gallimard, coll. Idées, NRF (1993) à orientation purement épistémologique. Nous ne souhaitons pas dans cette page faire une recension des travaux alchimiques de Newton - cf. l'une de nos pages sur les études de symbolisme alchimique

où nous avons repris en les critiquant, plusieurs notes de B.J.T. Dobbs (elle confond par exemple Sendivogius et Alexandre Sethon !) - mais reprendre la liste des papiers alchimiques de Newton. Une liste de ces papiers - non exhaustive - peut être consultée sur le site

http://www.newtonproject.ic.ac.uk/catalogue/newton.htm

; cette liste est répartie sur plusieurs pages et il nous a semblé faire oeuvre utile en les réunissant sur une seule page. Si l'on reprend Les Fondements de l'alchimie de Newton

, p. 281, on voit déjà dressée une liste de mss en Annexe A. Ces mss se trouvent réunis dans la Collection Keynes, à King's College, Cambridge. La description des mss que reprend B. Dobbs suit celle établie à l'époque de la vente des mss par Sotheby et Co, en 1936. La liste que nous donnons est en anglais ; on se reportera à l'ouvrage de B. Dobbs pour la traduction. Nous avons disposé les liens vers les ouvrages cités, lus par Newton, que nous avons commentés sur ce site.

Si l'on lit attentivement cette liste assez impressionante, on retiendra que Newton a dû avoir sur sa table de chevet des auteurs comme Artephius, Philalèthe, Nicolas Flamel, Monte Snyders, D'Espagnet ou Limojon de saint Didier. Voilà qui laisse réveur...Nous ne résistons pas au plaisir, pour finir, de donner à lire un mss

singulier, que certains attribuent à Newton, et qui est connue sous le nom de « Clavis

». Toutefois, ainsi que le note B. Dobbs, il se pourrait qu'il s'agisse d'un passage de Philalèthe simplement retranscrit par Newton [cf.

Fondements , p. 217, note 101].

Isaac Newton, gravure de J. Houbraken, d'après G. Kneller, 1702 Clef

/f Ir/ Sachez tout d'abord que l'antimoine est un minerai cru et immature 1

, ayant en soi matériellement ce qui est propre au métallique, bien que par ailleurs il soit un minéral cru et non digéré. Néanmoins, il est véritablement digéré par le soufre qu'on trouve dans le fer, et jamais autre part 2

. Deux parties d'antimoine avec du fer donnent un régule qui dans sa quatrième fusion produit une étoile ; à ce signe vous reconnaîtrez que l'âme du fer a été rendue complètement volatile par la vertu de l'antimoine 3 . Si ce régule étoile est fondu avec † de l'or ou de l'argent 4

dans un pot en terre cuite chauffé par des cendres, le régule entier va s'évaporer, ce qui est un mystère. Donc, si ce régule est amalgamé avec du mercure commun et qu'il est digéré dans un récipient fermé, à chaleur douce, pendant peu de temps — deux ou trois heures —, puis qu'il est broyé pendant 1/8 d'heure dans un mortier sans trace d'humidité moyennement chauffé, jusqu'à ce qu'il ait rejeté sa noirceur, ensuite il peut être lavé pour que se dépose la majeure partie de sa noirceur, jusqu'à ce que l'eau, qui au début devient presque noire, soit à peine teintée de noir. Ceci peut être fait par un afflux et reflux répétés d'eau 5

. Laissez sécher l'amalgame, placez-le de nouveau près du feu et maintenez-le à la chaleur susdite pendant trois heures. Par la suite, faites le de nouveau broyer comme avant dans un mortier sec et chaud. II rejette de nouveau de la noirceur, laquelle doit être de nouveau lavée, ceci doit être répété continuellement jusqu'à ce que l'amalgame entier devienne comme de l'argent brillant et coupellé, alors qu'au début il avait une couleur obscure de plomb 6

. Puis distillez ce mercure qui a été si bien lavé et * amalgamé a plusieurs reprises sept ou neuf fois de suite, et à chaque amalgamation, veillez à ce que le chauffage, le broyage et le lavage soient effectués autant de fois qu'a l'opération précédente et distillez le tout comme auparavant. A la septième fois, vous aurez un mercure dissolvant tous les métaux, en particulier l'or. Je sais ce sur quoi j'écris, car j'ai dans le feu un certain nombre de verres avec de l'or et ce mercure. Ils croissent dans ces verres sous la forme d'un arbre 7

, et à la faveur d'une circulation constante, les arbres se dissolvent de nouveau avec la fermentation pour donner un nouveau mercure. J'ai un récipient de ce type dans le feu avec de l'or ainsi dissout, ou l'or visiblement n'a pas été dissout par un agent corrosif en atomes, mais intrinsèquement et extrinsèquement en un mercure aussi vivant et mobile que n'importe quel mercure que l'on peut trouver dans le monde. Car il fait en sorte que l'or commence à gonfler, à être gonflé et à entrer en putréfaction et à pousser des bourgeons et des branches, en changeant de couleurs chaque jour, dont les manifestations me fascinent quotidiennement.

Je reconnais que c'est la un grand secret en Alchimie 8

, et / Je Juge / qu'il n'est pas bon que des artistes qui ont trop de sagesse aient décidé que le mercure commun devait être attaqué à la faveur d'une cohobation réitérée par le régule du lion (c'est-à-dire de fer ou d'antimoine). Ce corps unique, ce régule, toutefois, est apparenté au mercure puisqu'il est le plus proche de ce mercure que vous avez connu et identifié dans tout le règne minéral, et par conséquent en relation tout a fait intime avec /f Iv/ l'or. Et telle est la méthode philosophique pour améliorer la nature dans la nature, la consanguinité dans la consanguinité. Quant a cette opération, regardez la Lettre en réponse à Thomas de Bologne 9

, et vous aurez l'entière solution de cette question. Un autre secret est que vous avez besoin de la médiation de la vierge Diane 10

(quintessence, argent le plus pur) , autrement le mercure et le régule ne sont pas unis.

Le régule est fait d'antimoine quatre onces \ neuf parties /, de fer deux onces / quatre parties / , c'est une bonne proportion. Ne négligez pas d'avoir une masse d'antimoine plus importante que celle de fer, car si une erreur est faite a ce moment, vous serez fort déçu. Faites le régule en ajoutant dedans du nitre petit à petit, ajoutez entre trois et quatre onces de nitre de façon à ce que

la matière puisse s'écouler. Ce n'est pas une bonne idée de préparer dans un seul creuset une plus

grande quantité que la mesure d'antimoine indiquée ci dessus. L'antimoine est broyé, puis coupellé avec le fer, quoi que puissent dire ou écrire d'autres auteurs. On peut se servir de petits clous, et en particulier des bouts de clous cassés récupérés sur les fers a cheval 11

. Faites un feu bien fort pour que la matière puisse couler (comme de l'eau), ce que l'on obtient facilement. Lorsqu'elle coule, jetez dedans une cuillerée de nitre, et lorsque ce nitre a été détruit par le feu, jetez-en une autre. Continuez ce processus jusqu'à ce que vous ayez jeté dedans trois ou quatre onces. Puis entassez les cendres autour du creuset, en prenant soin qu'elles ne tombent pas dedans. Activez le feu autant que l'exige la fusion de l'argent commun, et maintenez le dans cet état pendant 1/8 d'heure (La matière doit être comme une eau subtile si vous avez travaillé correctement).

Puis versez la matière dans un cône. Le régule va tomber au fond. Séparez du régule les scories de cendres. Conservez le matériau refroidi dans un récipient sec. C'est un signe de bonne fusion si le fer est complètement fondu et si les scories se résolvent elles-mêmes en poudre. Battez-le régule et ajoutez-y deux, ou deux onces et demie au plus de nitre. Broyez le régule et le nitre ensemble complètement et fondez une nouvelle fois. Eliminez les scories arsenicales et sans utilité. Broyez le régule une troisième et une quatrième fois avec au plus une once de nitre et faites fondre dans un nouveau creuset, et à la

quatrième fois vous allez avoir des scories teintes avec une couleur dorée et un régule étoilé.

NB Au cours des trois dernières fois les scories doivent être jetées car elles sont arsenicales, néanmoins elles sont utiles en chirurgie.

NB Au cours des trois dernières fusions le régule doit être battu et broyé et mélangé avec du nitre. Certains jettent le nitre dans le creuset, mais ce n'est pas conseillé, car, premièrement, il en resulte que la fusion est prolongée et que le régule perd une partie de lui-même par exhalaison. Deuxièmement le nitre ajouté de cette manière reste à la surface et parfois il refroidit le régule. Et puisque le nitre coule facilement /f 2r/ il peut couler en premier et se couvrir d'une croûte de sorte qu'il ne se fluidifie pas de nouveau si l'on n'a pas un feu important. Si cela se produit, la meilleure partie du régule disparaît dans la conflagration d'ou il se passe que parfois une étoile est perdue parce qu'elle est faussement attribuée a une constellation. Vous verrez que le régule mélangé avec le nitre de cette manière coule facilement avec lui, et vous ne le verrez devenir dur d'aucune façon, sauf en ce qui concerne la différence dans la dépuration laquelle est beaucoup plus grande si lenitre est mélangé que s'il est simplement jeté dedans. Prenez une partie de ce * régule, deux parties d'argent et fondez les ensemble jusqu'à ce qu'elles soient comme un métal fondu. Versez, et vous obtiendrez une masse friable de la couleur du plomb.

NB Si le régule est uni à l'argent, ils coulent plus facilement que l'un séparément de l'autre, et ils restent fondus aussi longtemps que le plomb, même s'il y a donc deux parties d'argent, lequel est alors changé en la nature de l'antimoine, friable et de la nature du plomb. Battez cette masse friable, ce plomb, et coulez-là avec le mercure commun dans un mortier en marbre. Le mercure doit être lavé (disons dix fois) avec du nitre et du vinaigre distillé et mêmement séché (deux fois), et le mortier doit être constamment chauffé juste assez pour que vous puissiez en supporter la chaleur avec le doigt. Broyez le mercure 1/4 d'heure avec un pilon de fer et ensuite ajoutez le mercure, les colombes de Diane 12

assurant la médiation avec son frère, l'or philosophique, dont il va recevoir la semence spirituelle. La semence spirituelle est un feu qui va purger toutes les superfluités du mercure, la vertu de fermentation intervenant. Puis prenez du sel ammoniaque un peu battu et broyez-le avec le mercure. Lorsqu'il sera complètement amalgamé, ajoutez juste assez d'humidité pour humecter le tout, et ce seul signe philosophique va vous apparaître à savoir que dans cette très petite quantité réalisée de mercure il y a une grande puanteur. Finalement, lavez votre mercure en versant dessus de l'eau, en le broyant, décantant, et versant de nouveau de l'eau fraîche dessus, jusqu'à ce que n'apparaissent que quelques fèces. Notes 1 . On croirait lire le début du Livre Secret

d'Artephius, car il est écrit en substance que « l'antimoine est des parties de saturne ». Notez que Chevreul traduit par « Plumbum est, etc. » au lieu de « antimonium...». 2

. L'attention est attirée vers un sulfure ou un sulfate. Les alchimistes modernes comme Fulcanelli et E. Canseliet en tiennent pour l'oxysulfure d'antimoine. A noter que la gangue sulfureuse contient souvent du bismuth, cf. Gardes du corps , notes. 3

. Il s'agit du régule étoilé d'antimoine, préparé avec le fer. Cf. le Char Triomphal de l'Antimoine

du pseudo Basile Valentin ; cf. aussi un traité de Philalèthe

sur le sujet. On obtient que du régule, c'est-à-dire de l'antimoine plus ou moins dépuré, à l'état de métal, l'étoile radiante n'étant quu'ne simple « retassure ». 4

. c'est-à-dire avec une chaux d'or ou d'argent. 5 . Il s'agit des Aigles volantes

de Philalèthe, parce que l'Aigle ressortit des crues du Nil, comme l'écrit Diodore de Sicile ; l'Aigle est donc équivalent à l'EAU, envisagée comme Elément de Platon. 6

. Il s'agit là des trois réitérations ou imbibitions signalées par la plupart des textes. Fulcanelli dit - Mystère des Cathédrales

- qu'il faut crucifier avec trois pointes de fer. 7

. Sur ces concrétions mystérieuses, voyez les expériences de Kuhlmann , décrites dans la section voie humide et or potable . 8

. Hélas, Newton s'est absolument fourvoyé dans cette voie de l'antimoine ; ce qui l'intéressait en fait, c'était la nature « d'attracteur » des petits éléments métalliques : il voulait étendre ainsi les lois qu'il avait découvertes sur la gravitation universelle. Que, dans le même temps, il ait versé dans les fabulations ésotériques n'est pas le moindre des paradoxes de ce génie universel... 9

. Il s'agit d'une lettre de Bernard de Trèves [et non de Bernard Le Trévisan] à Thomas de Bologne, cf. mss alchimiques . On en trouvera une recension dans la

Lumière sortant par soy-même des Ténèbres . Il s'agit du Mercure des Philosophes. 10

. Diane aux cornes lunaires est l'hiéroglyphe du Mercure. Il faut la différencier du Suc de la Lunaire qui est le Soufre blanc ou Arsenic de Geber [ou Sel de Paracelse]. Cette expression se trouve dans l 'Introïtus, V

du Philalèthe. Voyez là-dessus aussi le commentaire de la note 15 de l' Introïtus, VI

. On l'appelle encore Diane nue, Diane ou Lune. 11

. C'est presque mentionner les battitures de fer, cf. au sujet des reliques d'Oreste, Atalanta XXVII . 12

. On voit que Newton a une autre définition des colombes de Diane que celles que l'on a supposées en cojecture dans ces pages ; pour nous, il s'agit des Soufres sublimés, au lieu que Newton y voit comme des intermédiares entre le Mercure et l'Or alchimique. Toutefois, dans la section compendium

, on a été amené à comparer l'une des colombes à l'antimoine...On a également fait remarquer que Philalèthe avait entièrement emprunté

son allégorie des colombes à D'Espagnet, qui écrit dans son Oeuvre secret d'Hermès : « Car le seuil [du Jardin des Hespérides

] est gardé par des bêtes à cornes furieuses, qui écartent, non sans dommage, ceux qui s'approchent témérairement. Seuls les insignes de Diane, et les colombes de Vénus adouciront leur férocité, si les destins t'y appellent. » [cap. 42].

Ajoutons que le vautour paraît avoir quelque analogie avec la colombe, car lui aussi vole sans aile, cf. Atalanta, XLIII

. On pourra compléter avec un passage tiré de l 'Introïtus, VII où Philalèthe écrit : «

Quand la Lune brillera en son plein, donne des ailes à l'Aigle, qui s'envolera, laissant mortes derrière elle les colombes de Diane qui, si elles ne sont pas mortes à la première rencontre, ne peuvent servir à rien. »

La mort des colombes de Diane peut signifier l'ouverture des corps métalliques, signalant la « mort » des métaux. On a aussi vu dans ces colombes le vaisseau d'Hermès, c'est-à-dire la maison de verre, cf. Psautier d'Hermophile

. On sait, enfin, que dans le voyage des Argonautes, Aristée parvient à faire franchir le seuil des roches cyanées en envoyant au devant du bâteau Argos, une colombe, dont seules les ailes de la queue seront arrachées au passage des symplegeades. Le lacher de colombe, quoi qu'il en soit, marque la fin de la phase de putréfaction, c'est-à-dire le début de la constituion de l'eau mercurielle permanente : le Mercure philosophique, par opposition au Mercure des Philosophes. Enfin, il y a un point important : c'est que ces colombes ou ce vautour volent sans aile, c'est-à-dire qu'elles sont suspendues dans un milieu à l'instar des poissons dans l'eau, argument supplémentaire pour en faire nos Soufres sublimés dans le nitre philosophique.

Pour des études plus générales sur Newton, on pourra lire utilement les Etudes Newtoniennes

d'Alexandre Koyré (Gallimard, NRF, 1968), qui font malheureusement l'impasse sur la carrière alchimique du physicien. Mais Alexandre Koyré s'était intéressé à l'alchimie, puisqu'il nous a laissé un fragment intitulé :

Mystiques, spirituels, alchimistes du XVIe siècle allemand

(Gallimard, Idées, NRF, 1971). Afin de donner une idée de la manière dont Newton a abordé l'alchimie, on peut résumer à grands traits le chapitre qu'y consacre R. Westfall [in Newton , op. cit.

]. Il s'agit du chapitre 8 : Rébellion. Pourquoi ce titre ? Parce que Newton, qui manifestait déjà sa nature animiste, ne pouvait se suffire d'une interprétation mécaniste de la philosophie naturelle telle que la concevait, par exemple, Descartes. Descartes qui ne pouvait supporter de relation à l'occulte et qui avait imaginé - à sa manière - des épicycles presque infinis [théorie des tourbillons

] pour expliquer la cause de la gravitation universelle et du déplacement de grandes masses les unes par rapport aux autres. On peut estimer que c'est vers 1666 que Newton s'intéressa de très près à la chimie et que, probablement sous l'impulsion des écrits de Robert Boyle, il embraya presque immédiatement vers l'alchimie. On peut considérer qu'il lut d'abord les écrits de Philalèthe [Eirenaeus Philalethes], de Jean d' Espagnet

, ainsi que les traités attribués à Alexandre Sethon [Nouvelle Lumière Chymique , qui est attribué à tort à Sendivogius], Nicolas Flamel et à Artephius . Il lut toute la collection du Theatrum Chemicum

, et acheta du matériel pour construire ses fourneaux ainsi que des produits chimiques. C'est donc [cf. nos commentaires de ces traités

] sur la base d'écrits à caractère très spéculatif en général, qu'il batît ses hypothèses et qu'il prit des milliers de note. Hélas, il s'engagea dans la voie chimérique de l'alchimie des transmutations métalliques - mais eut-il pu faire autrement à une époque où la notion de corps simple était encore dans les limbes ? Cf. Hist. Chim.

Hoefer - et s'évertua à trouver le Mercure des métaux par l'opération dite du régule étoilé d'antimoine ; dans un autre groupe d'expériences, il s'intéressa au filet, préparé à partir de « mixtes » de fer et de cuivre en se basant sur la légende d'Héphaistos que nous avons rapportée ailleurs. Il passa peut-être à côté des processus d'oxydo-réduction puisqu'il cite les métaux, à peu près, dans l'ordre de leurs potentiels redox... Et cet intérêt pour l'alchimie dura trente ans.

Pour finir, nous donnons la liste des travaux portant spécifiquement sur l'alchimie de Newton, citée dans Westfall [op. cit.] :

On a beaucoup moins étudié la chimie et l'alchimie de Newton que les autres aspects de ses activités scientifiques. B.J.T. Dobbs,

The Foundation, of Newton's Alchemy : The Hunting of the Green Lyon

(Cambridge, 1975 (traduction française par Sylvie Girard, Paris, 1981), supplante tous les travaux antérieurs et, pour la première fois, propose un véritable guide de la compréhension des nombreux documents alchimiques laissés par Newton. Karin Figala a écrit une thèse sur l'alchimie de Newton, malheureusement non publiée. Elle a écrit une recension du livre de Dobbs, « Newton as Alchemist », History of Science

, 15 (1977), 102-137. P.M. Rattansi est l'auteur de deux articles généraux qui soulignent l'importance des documents alchimiques : « Newton's Alchemical Studies », in Allen G. Debus. ed..

Science, Medecine and Society in the Renaissance (New York, 1972); pp. 167-182, et «

Some Evaluations of Reason in Sixteenth- and Seventeenth-Century Natural Philosophy

», in Mikulas Teich et Robert Young, ed.,

Changing Perspectives in the History of Science

(Londres, 1973), pp. 148-166. Pour les ouvrages qui ne traitent pas uniquement d'alchimie, voir Hélène Metzger, Newton, Stahl ,

Booerhaave

et la doctrine chimique (Paris, 1930) (second volume de son travail de pionnier dans le domaine de l'histoire de la chimie), A.R. et Marie Boas Hall, « Newton's Chemical Experiments »,

Archives internationales d'histoire des sciences

, 11 (1958), 113-152, et les passages concernés dans Arnold Thackray, Atoms and Powers :

An Essay on Newtonian Matter-Theory and the Development of Chemistry (Cambridge, Mass., 1970).

Liste établie selon Rob Iliffe, Peter Spargo and John T. Young, publiée par The Newton Project,

November 2001. Modifiée et annotée. Compilation du 1/01/2003.

I. Keynes Mss., King's College Library, Cambridge, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• Ms. 12 (SL1/R18) Two sets of notes, mainly in Latin, in all c. 2,400 words, 7 pp.

A 'Propositions': alchemical notes in Latin, c. 400 words, 3 pp. Apparently Newton's own formulations.

B Miscellaneous notes on multiplication by solution and coagulation, mostly in Latin with some English, c. 2,000 words, 4 pp. Drawn from various (acknowledged) sources including Aristotle, Nicholas Flamel and Michael Maier [Mayer].

Bought at the Sotheby sale by William H. Robinson for £5.10s.; on 13 August 1936 Robinson told Keynes it was available and he evidently bought it.

For highly divergent theories about the dating, see Figala, 'Exakte Alchemie', 177 and Dobbs, Foundations, 133.

• Ms. 13 (SL2/R18) Three lists of alchemical writers and works, partly on the reverse of Mint-related material (various dates between 1684 and

late 1690s), 8 pp.

pp. 1-3 A list of writers and works on alchemy, variously classified according to antiquity, nationality and degree of usefulness.

p. 4 Draft of 'An account of Gold & Silver moneys coyned since Christmas'.

pp. 5-6 Another list of writers, with their dates, signed 'Ieova sanctvs vnvs' [an anagram of Isaacvs Nevvtonvs]. p. 7 'Authores optimi': another list.

p. 8 Extract from 'An Act for encouraging Coynage' (18 Charles II cap. 5).

Bought at the Sotheby sale for £9.10s. by Bernard Quaritch, who presumably sold it to Heffers. Keynes took it from them on approval on 17 August 1936 for £16 and must have bought it by 11 September, when Quaritch told Yahuda that the lot had already been sold.

The Mint material is obviously no earlier than 1696 (when Newton joined the Mint) and some of the rest of the manuscript is written in an identical hand; other sections appear to be earlier, and the last internal date in 1684.

See Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus', passim, and Dobbs, Foundations, 174, n.100.

• Ms. 14 (SL7/R18) 'Artephius his secret Book', c. 9,000 words, 20 pp., followed by 'The Epistle of Iohn Pontanus, wherein he beareth witness of ye book of Artephius', c. 1,500 words, 2¼ pp., in English (c. 1670s).

Excerpts from Nicholas Flammel, His Exposition of the Hieroglyphicall Figures

which he caused to be painted upon an Arch in St Innocents Church-yard in Paris. Together with The secret Booke of Artephius , And the Epistle

of Iohn Pontanus: Containing both the Theoricke and the Practicke of the Philosophers Stone. This English translation was published in

London, 1624 and seems to have been Newton's main source. However, in the Pontanus letter he departs from the text of this edition at some points, possibly through reference to the Latin version in vol. 6 of Lazarus Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum

(1659-61: H1608): see Dobbs, Foundations, 130-31. [

le Theatrum Chemicum peut être consulté à cette adresse :

http://www.wbc.poznan.pl/dlibra/publication?id=4878]

Bought at the Sotheby sale by the London bookdealer C.A. Stonehill for £13; offered to Keynes for £20 on 7 September 1936 (and presumably accepted).

Cf. H1309-10, Keynes Ms. 25, and Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.

• Ms. 15 (SL8/R18) Four alchemical verse allegories, in English, 8 pp. in total.

'Out of Bloomfield's Blossoms' (an excerpt, beginning 'Father Time set me at ye gate'), 212 lines; 'A short work that beareth the name of Sr George Ripley

', 92 lines (almost complete); and two 'Fragments', one untitled (beginning 'Let ye old man drink wine till he piss'), 8 lines, and the other headed 'The whole science', 11 lines.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £7.10s. and sold to Keynes on 4 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

These are all taken from Elias Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum

(1652: H93), 305-23, 393-6, 436 and 434 respectively.

• Ms. 16 (SL9/R18) 'Causæ et initia naturalium' (notes on Jan Baptista van Helmont's Ortus medicinae (1667)), in Latin, c. 2,000 words, 7 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by C.A. Stonehill for £8.10s., and offered to Keynes for £12.10s. on 7 September 1936.

See H751 for Newton's copy of van Helmont's work.

• Ms. 17 (SL10/R18) Notes on and excerpts from George Ripley's ' Clavis Aureæ Portæ

', 'Medulla Alchimiæ', and 'Pupilla Alchemiæ', in Latin, c. 4,000 words, 8 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by C.A. Stonehill for £8.10s. and offered to Keynes for £12.10s. on 7 September 1936; Stonehill advised Yahuda on 18 September that it had already been sold.

Taken from George Ripley, Opera Omnia, Chemica, quotquot hactenus visa sunt (Kassel, 1649: H1405).

• Ms. 18 (SL11/R18) 'Clavis': detailed directions for a lengthy alchemical operation beginning with the digestion of antimony, iron and sulphur, in Latin, c. 1,200 words, 3 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £6 and sold to Keynes on 5 September 1936 for £8.5s.

Printed with an English translation in Dobbs, Foundations, 251-5. This was long regarded by Dobbs and many others as probably Newton's own work, but was in fact copied from an unpublished manuscript of George Starkey: see Newman, 'Newton's "Clavis"' (and Dobbs's acknowledgment of the reattribution, Janus Faces, 15). • Ms. 19 (SL12/R18) 'Collectiones ex Novo Lumine Chymico quæ ad Praxin spectant', 5½ pp., and ' Arcanum Hermeticæ Philosophiæ Opus

', 2½ pp. (early 1669?), in Latin, c. 3,000 words in total.

Annotated extracts from Michael Sendivogius [

l'ouvrage n'est pas de Sendivogius mais d' Alexandre Sethon

] and Jean d'Espagnet respectively. The right-hand half of each page consists of exegetical notes, which in the first set are headed 'Collectionum Explicationes', and in both cases take up rather more space than the original citations. f. 3v has the column headings 'Arcanum Hermeticæ Philosophiæ Opus' and 'Explicationes'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £9.10s. and sold to Keynes on 5 September for £12.10s. Heffers had originally asked £15.

Reproduced with German translation and commentary in Karin Figala's unpublished thesis 'Newton als Alchemist' (Munich, 1978). See Dobbs, Foundations, 152-5 and 160-62 for a fuller description and arguments for the dating; also Figala, 'Exakte Alchemie', 179. H1192 is the Sendivogius work in question: for the rest of Newton's Sendivogius collection see also H445, 1131 (the Musaeum Hermeticum reformatum

, which includes tracts by Sendivogius) and 1485 (but H445, a French version, post-dates these notes if Dobbs's dating is correct). H1311 is his copy of d'Espagnet's La philosophie naturelle

. Further notes on Sendivogius in Keynes Ms. 55, Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.4 and Babson Ms. 925, Dibner Institute.

• Ms. 20 (SL13/R18) Miscellaneous extracts from and notes on various alchemical authors, in English, 8 pp. in total.

'The standing of ye glass for ye time of Putrefaction & Congelation of ye medecine', in verse, 14 lines; 'The hunting of ye Green Lyon' (an extract), in verse, c. 180 lines; 'Notes upon ye hunting of ye green Lyon', c. 500 words.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £12 and sold to Keynes on 18 August 1936 for £16.

Both verses are copied from Elias Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652: H93), 421-2 and 278-9 respectively, though the notes on the 'Green Lyon', comprising elucidatory cross-references to other alchemical authors, would seem to be Newton's own. (Ashmole's edition does include notes on the work as an appendix, but they are completely different from those in this manuscript.)

• Ms. 21 (SL17/R18) 'The method of ye work': a commentary on [A.T. Limojon, Sieur de] Didier's ' Six Keys

' (early 1690s?), in English with Latin citations, c. 8,500 words, 35 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £15.10 and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

Keynes Ms. 23 is a Latin translation of the French original of Didier's work. See Dobbs, Janus Faces, 180-81, and Westfall, Never at Rest, 529. Westfall argues that this manuscript and Keynes Ms. 53 represent the first steps, taken in the early 1690s, that led ultimately to the major essay 'Praxis' (Babson Ms. 420).

• Ms. 22 (SL19/R18) 'The Epitome of the treasure of health written by Edwardus Generosus Anglicus innominatus who lived Anno Domini 1562', in English, c. 14,000 words, 28 pp.

Copy of an unpublished treatise on the Philosophers' Stone, the 'Animal or Angelicall Stone', the 'Prospective [not 'Perspective' as stated in the Sotheby catalogue] stone or ye magical stone of Moses' and 'ye vegetable or ye growing stone'; concludes with an alchemical poem.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £26 and sent on approval to Keynes on 17 August 1936 for £33.

• Ms. 23 (SL20/R18) 'Epistola ad veros Hermetis discipulos continens claves sex principales Philosophiæ secretæ' (early 1690s), in Latin, c. 4,750 words, 19 pp.

A translation of the last section of Limojon de Didier's Triomphe Hermétique (1689), ' Lettre Aux vrays Disciples d'Hermes

, Contenant six principales clefs de la Philosophie Secrete', then only extant (in published form, at least) in French (H1642).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £18.10s. and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

Contains a Strasbourg lily watermark, as does Keynes Ms. 53: see Shapiro, 'Dating Game', 197-8.

See Dobbs, Janus Faces, 180: she suggests this is probably Newton's own translation. Cf. Keynes Mss. 21 and 53, and Babson Ms. 420.

• Ms. 24 (SL21/R18) 'Anno 1656. Serenissimi Principis Frederici Ducis Holsatiæ et Sleswici &c. communicatione sequens epistola me sibi vendicat, inaudita memorans. Veni et vide', in Latin, c. 1,300 words, 7 pp.

Transcript of an anonymous alchemical manuscript, an English version of which appeared in Aurifontina chymica

, published by William Cooper in 1680 (see Westfall, 'Newton's Index Chemicus', 176, n. 9).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £7 and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

• Ms. 25 (SL26/R18) Short extracts from an assortment of alchemical writers (early to mid-1670s), in English and Latin, 7 pp. on 4 ff., c. 3,000 words in all.

f. 1r 'Out of Flammel./ The ffirst agent [not 'Angel' as stated in the Sotheby catalogue] painted in Abraham ye Iews 4 Hieroglyphicks

', in English. From the same source as Keynes Ms. 14.

f. 1v 'Out of ye Comment[ary] on Ripleys Epistle to K. Edward' [i.e. 'Sir George Ripley's Epistle to King Edward Unfolded' by 'Eirenæus Philalethes'], in English.

f. 2r 'Ex libro de Metallorum Metamorphosi', in Latin.

f. 2v 'Ex Brevi Manuductione ad Rubinum cælestem', in Latin.

'Ex Fonte Chemicæ Philosophiæ', in Latin.

f. 3v 'Iterum ex Comment[ario] in Ripl[æi] Epist[ola] ad Reg[em] Edw[ardum]', in English with one sentence of Latin.

'Ex Epistola Com[itis] Trevisani ad Thom[am] Bonon[iam]', in Latin. f. 4r ' Ex Artephio ', in Latin. 'Ex Turba

[i.e. 'Turba Philosophorum']', in Latin.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £9 and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1636 for the sale price plus 20%.

Same watermark (with countermark AI) as Mellon Ms. 79 (probably mid-1670s), the essay 'De ære et æthere' (date uncertain but definitely not before 1673), part of the 'Hypothesis' sent to the Royal Society in December 1675, and a letter to Hooke of the same month: see Shapiro, 'Dating Game', 195-6.

See Dobbs, Foundations, 132 for discussion of the sources and dating of this manuscript. Apart from the first two items, Newton could have taken all this from Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum. The first five are all based on works of 'Philalethes'. Cf. also Keynes Mss. 14, 29, 36 and Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.

• Ms. 26 (SL45/R19) Memorandum by Newton (1696), in English, c. 700 words, 3 pp.

Begins: 'On Munday March 2d or Tuesday March 3 1695/6, A Londoner acquainted wth Mr. Boyle & Dr. Dickinson making me a visit, affirmed that in the work of Iodochus a Rhe wth [vitriol] twas not necessary that the [vitriol] should be purified but the oyle or spirit might be taken as sold in shops', and goes on to record the mystery visitor's account of his method of 'subliming' vitriol to produce a 'menstruum' that dissolves all metals.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £13.

Printed with an introduction in D. Geoghegan, 'Some indications of Newton's attitude towards alchemy', Ambix 6 (1957), 102-6 (Newton's text on 105-6); text also in NC, 4: 196-9. Cf. the variant version in SL46 (Joseph Halle Schaffner Collection, Chicago), and excerpts from Edmund Dickinson in Harry Ransom Research Center, University of Texas. See also Keynes Ms. 50 and Yahuda Ms. Var.259.

• Ms. 27 (SL30/R19) 'The Seven Chapters' (late 1680s-1690s) plus notes and an unrelated draft letter, mainly in English, c. 4,750 words, 20 pp. on 12 ff. of which two blank.

Translation [by Newton?] of a treatise on transmutation by 'Hermes Trismegistus'. f. 1r ' The contents of ye 7 Chapters '.

f. 1v Brief Latin notes from Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum. ff. 4r-12r The translated text.

f. 12v Partial draft letter, undated and with no indication of addressee, on mathematics.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £32.

Printed with an introduction in Churchill, 1967, q.v. for a discussion of sources and the suggestion that this is Newton's own translation. Dobbs (Janus Faces, 272) considers it to be a translation from the French Bibliothèque des philosophes (1672-8), and dates the translation late 1680s/early 1690s but considers the table of contents (f. 1r) to have been added in the late 1690s if not later. The main text (ff. 4r-12r) originally belonged after f. 2v of Keynes Ms. 28 (see Dobbs, Janus Faces, 272) but had been separated from it before the Sotheby sale, possibly by Newton himself. See H84 for Newton's copy of the Latin edition of the text, and H221 for his copy of the Bibliothèque des philosophes.

• Ms. 28 (SL31/R19) Translation and transcription of the Tabula Smaragdina of 'Hermes Trismegistus', with notes (early 1680s-1690s), in English and Latin, c. 1,000 words, 5 pp. on 10 ff. f. 2r-v ' Tabula Smaragdina Hermetis Trismegistri

[sic] Philosophorum patris': English translation of the Tabula Smaragdina followed by references to the 'ffrench Bibliotheque' [i.e. Bibliothèque des philosophes (1672-8): see notes to the previous entry] and Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum.

f. 6r 'Hermes Trismegisti opera Chemica./ Tabula Smaragdina': the same passage in Latin. ff. 6v-7r ' Commentarium ': Latin notes on the above.

(ff. 1r and 5r both have the heading 'Hermes' but no text: according to Dobbs these were originally cover sheets for what are now the English sections of Keynes Mss. 27 and 28; the other leaves are blank.)

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £10 and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

Described in the Sotheby catalogue as '3½ pp.', presumably meaning 3½ written leaves, since all three parts of the document are listed there.

Transcribed with notes in Dobbs, Janus Faces, 271-7. She argues, mainly on the basis of the handwriting, that the document was composed as follows: f. 6r copied from a Latin version in the early 1680s, followed immediately or not long afterwards by what she considers to be Newton's own 'Commentarium' (ff. 6r-7r); the English translation (f. 2r-v) in the late 1680s or early 1690s (from French: cf. notes to Keynes Ms. 27) and the following annotations (f. 2v) later still, possibly even post-1700. These suggestions are repeated, with some modification, from her earlier article 'Newton's Commentary on the Emerald Tablet', which also includes a transcript of the English translation (183-4). See also notes to Keynes Ms. 27.

Another copy of the Latin text in Keynes Ms. 60, f. 6r. See H84.

• Ms. 29 (SL32/R19) Alchemical notes (probably before 18 May 1669), in Latin and English, drawn largely if not entirely from Michael Maier's Symbola Aureæ Mensæ duodecim nationum (Frankfurt, 1617: H1048), c. 5,000 words, 9 pp. on 5 ff.

Begins with half a page in Latin on Hermes Trismegistus. Followed by English notes on the alchemical interpretation of ancient myths, then (ff. 1r-3r) Latin notes on a wide range of alchemical authors and myths, including references to Albertus Magnus, Flamel, the Rosicrucians, Lull and Geber. f. 2r has a diagram of a 'philosophical tree' taken from 'Anonymus Philosophicus Delphicus'. f. 3r has the subheading 'Aurum quot modis crescit & purgatur'. Concludes on f. 5r with 'Symbola 12 Sapientum': a list of the twelve sages who attend Maier's 'Banquet' together with their alchemical mottoes: they are Hermes [Trismegistus], Maria [the Jewess], Democritus, Morienus, Avicenna, Albertus Magnus, Arnoldus [de Villanova], Thomas Aquinas, Raim[undus] Lullius, 'Rocher [i.e. Roger] Bacon', Melchior [Cibinensis] and 'Anonymus Sarmata'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £13.10s. and sold to Keynes on 5 September 1936 for £17.10s. See Dobbs, Foundations, 131.

• Ms. 30 (SL33/R19) 'Index Chemicus' (1680s), in Latin, c. 20,000 words, 123 pp. on 94 ff., followed by related drafts and supplementary material, also in Latin, c. 5,000 words, 49 pp.

The main text of the 'Index' appears on the rectos, with supplementary notes on the facing versos.

An elaborate alphabetical subject-index to the literature of alchemy, giving page references to over 144 different works, with several earlier and less elaborate drafts. In the most finished (though evidently incomplete) version (Ms. 30 a), the references are frequently supplemented by definitions of terms and processes or even short essays on the topic in question. Ms. 30 a)

f. 1 An unrelated title page and table of contents which appears to have come astray (before the Sotheby sale) from Keynes Ms. 35: many though not all of the headings listed occur also in that manuscript.

f. 2 Title: 'Index Chemicus'. On the following folios (3-94), most head-words are followed by a definition and references, others merely by references, and a few by gaps to be filled in at a later date. Ms. 30 b)

f. 1r 'Index Chymicus': alphabetical draft list of subject headings for the index, followed (ff. 2-5) by another index, much less developed than that in a) above. Ms. 30 c)

Another draft 'Index Chemicus' on 12 ff. Ms. 30 d) 'Supplementum Indicis Chemici' on 8 ff.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Gabriel Wells for £58. Yahuda attempted to buy it on 12 August 1636 and had done so by 25 August since Keynes asked to see it on that date but was advised by Wells on 4 September that the lot had gone. Yahuda subsequently exchanged it, together with SL72 (now Keynes Ms. 44) for lots 236 (now Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 5), 258 (now Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 23) and 263 (now Babson Ms. 434). See Spargo, '1936 sale', 130-1.

Erroneously described in the Sotheby catalogue as 113 pp. + 49 pp.

Detailed account in Westfall, 'Newton's Index Chemicus'; see also his Never at Rest, 358-9.

• Ms. 31 (SL37/R19) 'Liber Mercurioum [sic: leg. 'Mercuriorum'] Corporum' (1668-75), in English, c. 3,000 words, 8 pp. on 4 ff.

Seven pages of alchemical recipes followed by a table of (al)chemical symbols. Clearly not Newton's own composition though the source(s) has/have not been identified.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £14 and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%. See Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

Discussed, with a transcript of two of the recipes and facsimile of the table of symbols, in Dobbs, Foundations, 137-8.

• Ms. 32 (SL43/R19) Abstracts of five works by Michael Maier (early 1690s), in Latin, c. 50,000 words in total, 88 pp.

On the cover in Thomas Pellet's hand: 'No 17'.

a) 'Symbola aureæ mensæ duodecim nationum, Authore Michaele Majero. Dat. Francofurti mense Decemb. 1616. Edit Francofurti 1617. Anno ætatis Majeri 49', including copies by Newton of two of Maier's alchemical emblems, 20 pp.

b) 'Lusus Serius. Authore Mich. Majero Com. Pal. Med. D. Dat. 1616 mense Septembri', 4 pp. c) '

Atalanta fugiens, hoc est Emblemata nova &c.

Dat Francofurti mens. Aug. 1617. Edit 1618', 24 pp.

d) 'Viatorium, hoc est De montibus Planetarum septem. Datum Francofurti ad Mœn. 1618. mense Septembri. Edit Rothomagi 1651', 16 pp.

e) 'Septimana Philosophica. Dat. Magdeburgi Anno 1620, Ian. 11 styl. vet.', 24 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Gabriel Wells for £34 and sold to Keynes on 8 September 1936 for the sale price plus 10%.

See Westfall, Never at Rest, 524, and H1044, 1046, 1048 and 1052.

• Ms. 33 (SL44/R19) 'Manna': transcript (1675?) of an anonymous alchemical treatise, in English, in another hand with additions and notes by Newton, c. 1,500 words, 11 pp. on 6 ff.

A disquisition on the nature of alchemy, stressing that making gold is the most trivial of its aims. Followed by recipes 'To make all pretious stones better then the Natural', 'To make a Diamant', etc. On f. 5r, in Newton's hand, two further recipes under the headings 'Praxis Lapidis' and 'Multiplication', and then a series of notes on the foregoing text headed 'Here follow several notes & different readings collected out of a M.S. communicated to Mr F. by W.S. in 1670, & by Mr F. to me 1675'. Finally (f. 6r), 'An epitome of the practise of the work', also in Newton's hand.

Bought by Maggs Brothers at the Sotheby sale for £6.10s. and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

'Mr F' may be Ezekiel Foxcroft, Fellow of King's College and translator of J.V. Andreæ's Chymische Hochzeit: see Dobbs, Foundations, 111-12 (though the suggestion is disputed by Figala, 'Newton as Alchemist', 103). There is another reference to 'Mr. F.', unequivocally meaning Foxcroft, in 'De Scriptoribus Chemicis', Stanford University Library Ms.: see Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus', 146-7. Newton's notes clearly date from no earlier than 1675 (the year in which the manuscript was communicated to him), and the handwriting suggests not much later: the preceding text could of course be earlier.

See Figala, 'Exakte Alchemie', 161, including a partial transcript of Newton's comments. A similar version of the text, but without Newton's additions and commentaries, was published by William Cooper in the anthology Aurifontana Chymica (London, 1680: H103).

• Ms. 34 (SL48/R19) Notes on the preparation of 'philosophical mercury' by fermentation and 'ye mediation of Diana's Doves', on the preparation of 'menstrua', etc., in English, c. 2,500 words, 6 pp. on 3 ff.

Abstracted (with copious page references) from various works of 'Eirenæus Philalethes'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £14 and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

• Ms. 35 (SL50/R19) Notes on various alchemical texts (early 1680s?), mainly in Latin but with several sections in English, c. 26,100 words, 45 pp. on 30 ff. of which 3 blank.

a) 'Cap 1.', text beginning 'Quomodo metalla generantur', in Latin, c. 1,200 words, 3 pp.

b) 'Cap 3 De radice semine spermate et corpore mineralium', in Latin, c. 1,200 words, 3 pp.

c) 'Cap 3 De Mineralibus ex quibus lapis desumitur', in Latin but including an English verse extract from Thomas Norton, c. 3,500 words, 11 pp.

d) Untitled notes on mercury, lead, tin, sulphur and iron, in Latin and English, citing a very wide range of authors, c. 4,500 words, 14 pp.

e) 'De Mercurio duplato', in Latin, 4 pp., with the sub-headings: 'Ex Turba', 'Ex Artephio', 'Ex Bernardo Trevisano', 'Ex Flamelli Annotationibus'; followed by an earlier draft also headed 'De [mercurio] duplato' (1 p.) and notes out of Dionysius Zacharias (1 p.); in all c. 1,600 words.

f) 'De conjunctione in hora nativitatis', in Latin and English, c. 2,500 words, 8 pp.

Originally enclosed in a wrapper bearing a list of contents, which has somehow found its way into Keynes Ms. 30 (f. 1).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Gabriel Wells for £44. Yahuda told Keynes on 11 November 1936 that he had bought it and an exchange was agreed: see notes to Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 24 and Spargo, '1936 sale', 130.

Sections (e) and (f) are wrongly described in the Sotheby catalogue as 5 and 4 pp. respectively.

• Ms. 36 (SL51/R19) Three alchemical excerpts (1668/9), in Latin, c. 4,000 words, 8 pp. on 4 ff.

'De Metallorum Metamorphosi' (f. 1r), divided into a preface and chapters; 'Brevis Manuductio ad rubinum cœlestem' (f. 3r); 'Fons Chemicæ Philosophiæ' (f. 3v).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £13.10s.

Taken from Martinus Birrius, Tres Tractatus De Metallorum Transmutatione [...] incognita auctore (Amsterdam 1668: H1641), containing these three compositions, which are in fact by 'Eirenæus Philalethes' (i.e. George Starkey). See Dobbs, Foundations, 131-2.

• Ms. 37 (SL55/R19) Three alchemical verse extracts, in English, 7 pp. on 4 ff.

'Out of Norton's Ordinal', 200 lines; 'Out of Chaucer's Tale of ye Chanon's Yeoman', 12 lines; 'Out of ye work of Richard Carpenter', 14 lines. Followed by the heading 'Out of Dastins Dream', but this entry breaks off after only one line.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £26.

These are all excerpted from Elias Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652: H93), in which the works quoted from appear on pp. 1-106, 227-56, 275-7 and 257-68 respectively.

• Ms. 38 (SL58/R19) Notebook (early 1690s), containing alchemical notes from a wide range of sources, in English and Latin, c. 7,500 words in all.

Arranged under the headings 'Notanda Chemica' (in Latin, 3 pp.) and 'Sententiæ notabiles' (in Latin and English, 22 pp.). Preceded by the heading 'Index Chemicus', under which is a single entry ('Ablutio') in Latin, and followed by 76 blank leaves.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £40.

'Sententiæ notabiles' published with notes and a brief commentary in Sherwood Taylor, 'Alchemical work'.

• Ms. 39 (SL62/R19) 'Observations of ye matter in ye Glass. Authore Anonymo' (mid-1670s), in English, c. 2,500 words, 6 pp. on 3 ff.

An account of an alchemical experiment, and directions for undertaking another (the latter beginning f. 2r under the heading 'Emanuel'). Presumably transcribed or translated from an unpublished manuscript, and thoroughly non-'mystical' in tone except for the specification (f. 2r) of a prayer for success to be offered before undertaking the experiment and another of thanks to be offered on its successful completion.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £13.10s. and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

• Ms. 40 (SL64/R19) Incomplete draft treatise on the sequence of operations to be effected in transmutation, mainly in Latin with some English, c. 12,000 words, 42 pp. on 33 ff.

Drawn from the writings of a range of alchemical authorities.

f. 1r Title page reading only 'Opus primum'.

f. 3r 'Gradus primus/ Extractio et Rectificatio Spiritus'

f. 5r 'Extractio auri vivi, et conjunctio ejus'

f. 9r 'Opus Quintum/ Vivificatio et Putrefactio Terræ foliatæ.'

f. 15r 'Opus Quintum/ Vivificatio et Putrefactio Terræ foliatæ': though the title is identical to the foregoing, the text is quite different.

f. 19r 'Opus sextum./ ffixis in album et rubrum. Conjunctio viri rubri cum fœmina alba, & decoctio ad complementum' (partly in English).

f. 27r 'Opus sextum/ Præparatio Mercurij Vulgaris per Veneris Columbas.'

f. 29r 'Opus septimum/ Solutio Metallorum ‹primo› in Mercurium per Mercurium, deinde in aquam [mercur]ialem et compositio mercurij nostri duplati' (partly in English).

f. 31r 'Opus Octavum/ Conjunctio Putrefactio et Regimen Decoctionis'

f. 33r 'Opus Octavum/ Conjunctio Putrefactio et Regimen Decoctionis' (variant draft).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by William H. Robinson for £27. Keynes asked after it on 12 August 1936 and Robinson informed him the next day that it had been sold to Gabriel Wells. Keynes contacted Wells on 8 September and was offered the lot on 11 September for £34.

Cf. Keynes Ms. 41, Babson Ms. 417 and Dibner Institute NMAHRB Mss. 1070 A.

• Ms. 41 (SL65/R19) A similar composition to Keynes Ms. 40, covering the first six 'operations' (but the fourth is missing). In Latin apart from some citations from George Ripley

in English verse in the last two sections, c. 12,000 words, 39 pp. on 20 ff.

Also features extensive interlinear notes and additions apparently inserted after the main text had been written.

f. 1r 'Opus primum. Extractio ‹& rectificatio› spiritus.' f. 2r 'Opus secundum. Extractio animæ.' f. 3r 'Opus tertium. Terræ calcinatio'

f. 5r 'Opus quintum./ Acuatio spiritus rectificanti cum rebus calidis sui generis per sublimationes, & conversio in mercurium vegetabilem ut et in Quintessentiam quæ cælum est Philosophorum, et Liquor Alkahest, quocum fit Aurum potabile.'

f. 11r 'Opus sextum. Solutio sicca et humida metallorum vulgi ‹eorumq[ue] purgatio &› multiplicatio infinita mercurij sophici et extractio auri vivi.'

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £15 and offered to Keynes on approval on 2 September 1936 for £24. Keynes had presumably accepted the deal by 16 September, when Edwards told Yahuda it had been sold.

• Ms. 42 (SL68/R19) 'Pearce the black Monck upon ye Elixir': an alchemical verse allegory, in English with the last four lines in Latin, 226 lines, 7 pp. on 4 ff.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £14.10s., though Lymington had left a bid 'on the house' under the pseudonym 'Ludford'.

Copied from Elias Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652: H93), 269-74 and 427-30.

• Ms. 43 (SL71/R19) Transcripts from two published alchemical tracts, in Latin and English, in all c. 3,000 words, 8 pp. on 4 ff.

f. 1r 'Regulæ seu canones aliquot Philosophici de Lapie [sic: leg. 'Lapide'] Philosophico Authore docto quodam Anonymo. Impress in fine Curationum Paracelsi'. List of alchemical rules in Latin, c. 2,500 words.
f. 4r 'Mayer's ffigures præfixed to Basil Valentine's Keys

'. Description of ten alchemical symbols, in English, c. 500 words.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £21 and sold to Keynes on 18 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

See H1238-H1243 for Newton's Paracelsus collection, and H128 for references to Maier's emblems in Newton's annotations to his copy of Basil Valentine's Last Will and Testament.

• Ms. 44 (SL72/R19) 'Several Questions concerning the Ph[ilosoph]ers St[one]', in English, c. 2,000 words, 7 pp. on 4 ff.

A dialogue between a novice and an adept, each 'Question' being followed by an answer. Transcript or translation of an anonymous

unpublished work.

f. 1r 'Quest. 1. Of what kind is the true & only one Philosophical matter'

f. 1v 'Quest. 2. But how ought ye reduction into the first matter to be done.'

f. 2r 'Quest. 3. What is the signe of a perfect fixation and where by can it be known.'

f. 2v 'Quest. 4. But if it should ascend in the said operation what must be done.'

'Quest. 5. What is to be done when the tincture has obteined its perfection.'

f. 3r 'Quest. 6. What ought to be done wth this golden powder' 'Quest. 7. What hereafter'

f. 3v 'Quest. 8. How must the silver be proceeded with'

'Quest. 9. What fire is used in this work'

f. 4r 'Quest. 10. What do you think of the colours of Bernardus.'

'Quest. 11. Is the labour of this work troublesome'

'Quest. 12. Are there no more lyes of the Sophisters.'

Bought at the Sotheby sale for £46 by Gabriel Wells and sold to Yahuda by 4 September 1936. Yahuda then exchanged it, together with SL33, for three lots bought by Keynes (SL236 (now Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 5), SL258 (now Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 23) and SL263 (now Babson Ms. 434)). See Spargo, '1936 sale', 130-31.

• Ms. 45 (SL73/R19) 'Practica Mariæ Prophetissæ in Artem Alchemicam' (early 1690s), in Latin, c. 1,500 words, 4 pp. on 3 ff. of which one blank. A dialogue between 'Aros' and 'Maria',

the sister of Moses, in which she replies to his queries about acquiring alchemical wisdom. Concludes with the note 'Extat hoc opus in Theat Chem Vol 5 & Vol 6 p 479 [i.e. Lazarus Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum (1659-61): it is in fact only in vol. 6] & Arte Aurif. vol. 1 et in Bibliotheca

Gallica' [i.e. Bibliothèque des philosophes (1672-8): it is in vol. 1].

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £8. Sent to Keynes on approval for £10.10s. on 17 August 1936, and on 7 September following Heffers advised Yahuda that it had already been sold (presumably to Keynes).

See H1608, H90-H91, H221 for the works cited as Newton's sources.

• Ms. 46 (SL77/R19) 'The Three Fires', in English, c. 1,000 words, 3 pp. on 2 ff.

Notes interpreting various pieces of alchemical symbolism. This appears to be Newton's own work, though as usual in his alchemical writing he leans heavily on a range of authorities.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £10.10s., and sold to Keynes on 17 August 1936 for £13.10s. On 7 September Heffers told Yahuda it had gone.

See Dobbs, Janus Faces, 124, and cf. SL78 (whereabouts unknown).

• Ms. 47 (SL80/R19) 'Experimenta Raymundi', in Latin, c. 2,500 words, 5¼ pp.

Descriptions of and notes on 24 experiments, interspersed with alchemical recipes, drawn from the works of (or supposedly of) Ramón Lull [Raimundus Lullius].

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £10.10s. and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

See H994-1001 for Newton's Lull collection.

• Ms. 48 (SL84/R19) Two alchemical treatises (one incomplete; after 1686) and a collection of short extracts from various alchemical sources, in Latin and English, in all c. 23,000 words, 76 pp. on 62 ff.

Foliation is continuous through the three sections.

a) Begins with two pages of rough notes in Latin and English. Then comes an incomplete tract in Latin, consisting largely of extracts from

other writers but woven into a continuous text, with the following sub-headings: f. 2r 'Lapidis Compositio'

f. 6r 'Elementorum Conversio Conjunctio et Decoctio in Opere secundo vel utroq[ue]' f. 10r 'Regimen Ignis'

b) Excerpts, mostly in Latin but with some English:

f. 15v 'Ex Tractatus quinto Rosarij abbreviati'

f. 16r Main heading: 'Materia'. Followed by extracts on the subject 'Ex Philalethi' (f. 16r), 'Ex Trevisano' (f. 18r), 'Ex Grassæ' (f. 19r), 'Ex Epistolo Anonymi in Th. Ch. vol 6 p. 474' (f. 21v), 'Ex Maiero' (also f. 21v), 'Ex Basilio Valentino' (f. 22v), 'Ex Snydero' (f. 23v), 'Iterum ex Basilio Valentino' (f. 24r), 'Ex Rosario Magno' (f. 24v). [

Grassae se rapporte vraisemblablement à Grasseus ou Crasseus, cf. Commentaire d'Hortulain à la Table d'Emeraude]

c) 'Decoctio': a self-contained treatise or chapter on the 'regimens', in English with some Latin, consisting like a) of interwoven extracts from a huge range of sources. The headings are drawn (in order) from chapters 24-30 of 'Philalethes'' Secrets Reveal'd, as follows: f. 26r 'Regimen Mercurij' f. 32r 'Regimen Saturni' f. 37r 'Regimen Iovis' f. 45r 'Regimen Lunæ'

f. 51r 'Regimen Veneris Martis et Solis'

Followed (f. 54r to the end) by an earlier partial draft also headed 'Decoctio'.

The whole is enclosed in a wrapper covered with notes and rough drawings of stills, retorts, etc., on which Thomas Pellet has written 'No 13'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £62 and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

See H554, 838, 1034, 1296, 1407, 1478, 1553 and 1644 (Newton's 'Philalethes' collection), H168-9 (Trevisanus), H1044-1052 (Maier), H127-130 (Basil Valentine). See also Dobbs, 'Newton's Copy of

"Secrets Reveal'd"', 158-9.

• Ms. 49 (SL86/R19) 'The Regimen' (early 1680s), in English and Latin, c. 3,000 words, 7 pp. on 4 ff.

A series of seven 'aphorisms', in English, relating to the stages of transmutation, followed by supporting 'Annotations upon ye foregoing Aphorisms', mostly in Latin but with some English and consisting mainly of notes from various authors. It seems likely that the 'aphorisms' are Newton's own summation of his alchemical reading: he notes, 'This Process I take to be ye work of the best Authors, Hermes , Turba , Morien , Artephius , Abraham ye Iew & Flammel, Scala, Ripley , Maier , the great Rosary, Charnock, Trevisan . Philaletha . Despagnet '.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £9.10s. and sold to Keynes on 4 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

The seven 'aphorisms' are printed in Dobbs, 'Newton's Copy of "Secrets Reveal'd"', 158 and Westfall, Never at Rest, 357-8.

• Ms. 50 (SL89/R19) Excerpts from Jodocus a Rhe [Johannes Rhenanus], with transcripts of letters to Dr. John Twysden [Twisden] from 'A.C. [leg. A.O.?] Faber' and notes on a work by Faber. In Latin, c. 7,500 words in all, 22 pp. on 11 ff.

f. 1r 'Iodoci a Rhehe Opera Chymica [properly 'Chymiatrica': Frankfurt, 1668]. Descripsi hæc ex originali Msto Mri Iohannis quod penes me habeo. Io. Tw.'

f. 9v 'Epistolæ ‹quædam A.C.› Fabri, qui una cum consanguineo quodam Dris Io. Twysden opus hocce aggressus est et ad usq[ue] extractionem spiritus [mercur]ij Annis 1673 & 1674, fæliciter perduxit, et autographis descriptæ'. Notes on four letters, dated 3 June and 23 December 1673, 14 January and 24 June 1674. f. 11r 'Notæ in opus Fabrianum'

Bought at the Sotheby sale by C.A. Stonehill for £13 and offered to Keynes on 7 September 1936 for £20; Stonehill informed Yahuda on 18 September that it had been sold.

Discussed in Westfall, Never at Rest, 288-9. Westfall rather confusingly suggests that 'A.C. Faber' is a mistake for 'A.D. Faber', personal physician to Charles II and author of a book on 'aurum potabile': this seems likely, except that the physician in question is neither A.C. nor A.D. but A[lbert] O[tto] Faber, originally of Lübeck, author of De Auro potabili medicinali (1677). John Twisden was another London physician. See H1397 for Newton's copy of Rhenanus's Opera Chymiatrica: also H740, the compilation by Rhenanus and J. Grasshoff: Harmoniæ inperscrutabilis chymico-philosophicæ, sive Philosophorum antiquorum consentientium [...] decas I(-II) (1625), extensively annotated by Newton. His interest in Rhenanus is also evident in Keynes Ms. 26 and Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.

• Ms. 51 (SL91/R19) Notes on the works of George Ripley [from a manuscript version of 'Eirenæus Philalethes'' Ripley Reviv'd (1678)] (late 1660s/ early 1670s), in English, c. 8,000 words, 14 pp. on 8 ff.

Includes sections 'On Ripley's vision', 'On Ripleys preface to his Gates

', and on each of the first six 'Gates' (calcination , solution , separation , conjunction , putrefaction and congelation).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £16 and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

Westfall (Never at Rest, 287-8 and 288, n. 21) points out that the notes clearly predate the publication of Ripley Reviv'd (1678). Newton cites page references which do not correspond to the printed version and presumably refer to a now lost or unidentified manuscript. Further examples of Newton's interest in Ripley and his expositors (especially 'Philalethes') in Keynes Mss. 17, 52, 53, 54; he subsequently acquired a copy of the published version of Ripley Reviv'd (H1407).

• Ms. 52 (SL92/R19) Complete transcript of 'Sr George Ripley His Epistle to K Edward unfolded' [by 'Eirenæus Philalethes'] plus excerpts from a variant version (late 1660s/ early 1670s), in English with some Latin, c. 10,000 words, 17 pp. on 9 ff.

Variant excerpts begin on f. 7v under the heading 'Ex chartis Mr Sloane'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £11.10s. and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

This does not correspond to any of the three published versions of the work in question and predates two of them (it appeared in Chymical, Medicinal, and Chirurgical Addresses made to Mr Samuel Hartlib Esq. (1655: H378), on its own in 1677 and in Ripley Reviv'd (1678: H1407)). It can be collated with BL Sloane 633, while the variant excerpts correspond to BL Sloane 3633. See Dobbs, Foundations, 113 and Wilkinson, 'Bibliographical puzzles', 235-44. See also Keynes Mss. 17, 51, 53, 54.

• Ms. 53 (SL93/R19) 'Of ye first Gate' (mid-1690s), in English with some Latin, c. 4,000 words, 9 pp. on 5 ff.

A compilation, and in some cases an exposition, of other writers' comments on (or supposedly on) Ripley's ' First Gate

' (in the 'Compound of Alchemie', Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652), 107-93).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £12.10s.; Keynes expressed an interest on 12 August 1936 and presumably went on to buy it.

Contains a Strasbourg lily watermark, as does Keynes Ms. 23: see Shapiro, 'Dating Game', 197-8.

Probably composed together with Keynes Ms. 21: see notes there; see also Keynes Mss. 17, 23, 51, 52, 54 and Babson Ms. 420.

• Ms. 54 (SL94/R19) 'Ripley expounded', in English, c. 4,500 words, 12 pp.; and 'Notes upon Ripley,' in English, c. 1,500 words, 7 pp.

The first section is another commentary on Ripley's ' Gates

', similar in construction to Keynes Mss. 51 and 53 but quite different in content, and this time covering all twelve 'gates': in addition to the six

mentioned above under Keynes Ms. 51 there are cibation , sublimation , fermentation , exaltation , multiplication and projection .

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £13 and sold to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

The 'Notes upon Ripley' represent, in Dobbs's words, 'Newton's study of Philalethes' comments on Ripley' (Janus Faces, 122, n. 1). See also Keynes Mss. 17, 51, 52, 53.

• Ms. 55 (SL97/R19) Notes on Sendivogius (c. 1685-90), in English and Latin, c. 12,000 words, 37 pp. on 21 ff. f. 1r ' Sendivogius Explained

': notes on Treatises 1-7 and 9-12 [of Sendivogius's A New Light of Alchymie (English translation London, 1650)], with precise page and line numbers for each reference.

f. 13r 'The Preface to ye Philosophick Riddle' 'The Philosophick Riddle' f. 15v Very brief notes on '

The Dialogue between Mercury the Alchymist & Nature

'; 'The 3 principles of all things'; 'Of Sulphur' (ff. 15v-16r).

f. 17r-21r 'Sendivogius explained': another set of notes on Sendivogius, in Latin.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £17.10s. and sold to Keynes on 13 August for (mysteriously) exactly the same price: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 127.

Earlier copies (not in Newton's hand) of ff. 1-12 in BL Sloane Mss. 3630.6 (ff. 102-12) and 3778.1 (ff. 2-18). Sloane Ms. 3630 belonged to Richard Dee in 1648, so this section is undoubtedly not by Newton. Figala ('Exakte Alchemie, 183) identifies it as an extract from a lost work ascribed to 'Philalethes', though she doubts whether in this case this means George Starkey. See also Keynes Ms. 19, Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.4, Babson Ms. 925, Dibner Institute, and H1192 and 1485.

• Ms. 56 (SL98/R19) 'Sententiæ luciferæ et Conclusiones notabiles' (1696-8?), in Latin and English, c. 6,000 words, 18 pp.

Short extracts from a wide range of alchemical authors.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £13 and sold to Keynes on 18 August 1936 for £18.

On the first page in identical handwriting is a note relating to the silver recoinage of 1696-8.

• Ms. 57 (SL99/R19) Notes on various (al)chemical processes (separations, processions, sublimations, distillations, etc.), mainly in Latin with some English, c. 9,000 words, 17 pp. on 10 ff. Includes references to ' Raymundus ' [Ramón Lull], Ferrar, Avicenna, Sendivogius , Flamel , Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum, ' Philalethes ' and others.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £13.10s. and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

• Ms. 58 (SL100/R19) Three apparently unrelated fragments (early-mid 1670s), in English and Latin, c. 3,000 words in all, 12 pp. on 8 ff.

a) f. 1r Copy of a recipe for multiplying silver (by adding silver, antimony and lead to cinnabar).

b) ff. 2r-5r Notes on 'Aqua Sicca', 'Aquila Iovis' and 'Sceptrum Iovis', with repeatedly reworked recipes for preparing these substances, accompanied by annotations either in parallel columns or at the foot of the page.

c) ff. 6r-8v Notes and recipes derived from an unidentified source, with rough sketches of furnaces and calculations.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £14.10s. and offered to Keynes on approval on 5 September 1936 for £19.10s. Heffers told Yahuda on 7 September that it was out on approval, and a week later that 'Our client is keeping this lot'.

Section b) is analysed in detail by Dobbs (Foundations, 167-75), who regards it as 'of extraordinary importance for a study of his [Newton's] alchemical methodology' (ibid., 168), being Newton's attempt to elucidate the symbolism of John de Monte Snyders' The Metamorphosis of the Planets (see Newton's transcript of this text, Cushing/Whitney Medical Library, Yale University). See also the notes on Snyders in the Rare Book and Manuscript Library, Columbia University.

• Ms. 59 (SL101/R19) 'De secreto solu[tionum? (MS torn)]', in English and Latin, c. 1,000 words, 3 pp. on 2 ff.

Mainly about strategies for identifying 'Diana's Doves', and drawn largely from various works of 'Eirenæus Philalethes'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £7 and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%. • Ms. 60 (SL105/R19) ' Tabula Smaragdina

' and 'Hieroglyphica Planetarum', in Latin, c. 1,750 words in all, 4 pp. on 3 ff. of which one blank.

f. 1r 'Tabula Smaragdina': another copy of the Latin excerpt from 'Hermes Trismegistus' reproduced in Keynes Ms. 28, with the [correct] page reference 'Theatr. Chym. Vol. 1 pag 362', followed by other excerpts on transmutation from Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum.

f. 2r 'Hieroglyphica Planetarum': notes, principally from Lull , Maier and Flammel , on astronomico-alchemical symbolism.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £4.10s. and sold to Keynes on 19 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%. See also Keynes Ms. 27.

• Ms. 61 (SL107/R19) 'Thesaurus Thesaurorum sive Medicina Aurea', in English (apart from the title and the concluding remark 'Laus Deo'), c. 1,200 words, 5 pp. on 3 ff.

Transcribed from an unpublished manuscript (see Dobbs, Janus Faces, 123). Begins with a defence of alchemical writings which, despite their apparent obscurity, do contain real truths, and proceeds to a detailed

recipe for producing a red 'elixir' to transmute all metals into gold.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £9.10s. and sold to Keynes on 22 July 1936 for £12.10s.: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 126.

• Ms. 62 (SL108/R19) 'The Work of an old Priest, viz: B.' and other alchemical recipes (late 1660s), in English, c. 3,500 words, 8 pp. on 9 ff. of which one blank.

Includes directions 'To turne [silver] into [gold]' and for making '[silver] out of [mercury] and [iron]', a recipe for 'aurum potabile', etc., with drawings of retorts, receivers, and other chemical equipment.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £16 and sold to Keynes on 30 July 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

Evidently abstracted from Keynes Ms. 67.

• Ms. 63 (SL111/R19) 'Verses at the end of B. Valentine's mystery of the Microcosm' (c. 1670?), in English, c. 580 lines, 20 pp. on 10 ff.

Several extracts from verses on various chemicals, on the 'planets' that symbolise the metals, and on 'the first Matter'. On f. 10r, a small pen-and-ink drawing of an alchemical emblem (dogs chasing hares in a circle) illustrating one of the verses.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £7.10s. Keynes asked to look at it on 12 August 1936, and when Yahuda later enquired he was told by Heffers on 7 September that it had been sold. It is marked '£10', presumably by Heffers, though whether this is the price Keynes actually paid is not clear. • Ms. 64 (SL112/R19) 'Basil Valentine Currus Triumphalis Antimonij

': notes and abstracts (c. 1667-8), in Latin, c. 4,500 words, 8 pp. on 4 ff.

Includes (in square brackets) a very few explicatory notes by Newton.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £8 and sold to Keynes, who had asked to inspect it on 12 August, on 5 September 1936 for £10.15s. It had appeared in Heffers' Catalogue 493 (1936) as Item 7, and rather bewilderingly appeared again, despite having been sold to Keynes, as

Item 750 in their Catalogue 513 (1937), in both cases priced £12.10s.

See Dobbs (who suggests the date), Foundations, 191, and H129 (a heavily dog-eared English translation of the work, though these notes were obvious based on a Latin edition).

• Ms. 65 (SL118/R19) Incomplete copy of W[illiam] Yworth, 'Processus Mysterii Magni Philosophicus' (c. 1702), in English, in (probably) Yworth's hand, c. 22,000 words, 75 pp. on 38 ff.

Copy of a ten-chapter version of this unpublished treatise. The last chapter is incomplete. The author's name appears on ff. 1r and 2v. A dedicatory epistle (to Newton?) refers to a work (Mercury's caducean rod, by 'Cleidophorus Mystagogus', i.e. Yworth) published in 1702.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £2.10s. and sold to Keynes on 18 August 1936 for £3.10s.

Cf. the abstract in Keynes Ms. 66, the further fragment in Keynes Ms. 91, and the variant copies in Hampshire Record Office, Ms. NC17, and Yale Mellon Ms. 80. See also Figala, 'Zwei Londoner Alchemisten', and Figala and Petzold, 'Alchemy in the Newtonian circle' (esp. 179-90). There is a letter in the same hand from Yworth to Newton, New College, Oxford Ms. 360(2), f. 78r-v, printed in NC, 7: 441 (and dated c. 1705 in NC but shown to be 1702 by Figala and Petzold, op. cit., 186). H1138, 1302-3 and 1760 are all printed Yworth works owned by Newton; H1138, 1302 and 1303 are works written under his pseudonym Cleidophorus Mystagogus.

• Ms. 66 (SL119/R19) Incomplete abstract of Yworth's 'Processus Mysterii Magni Philosophicus' condensed into five chapters (c. early 1690s), in English, c. 3,300 words, 12 pp. on 7 ff.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £10.10s. Keynes expressed an interest on 12 August 1936 and presumably went on to buy it.

The Sotheby catalogue describes this as an abstract of the first five chapters of the work, but it is a five-chapter abstract of the whole work, or at least of as much of it as is preserved in the ten chapters of Keynes

Ms. 65.

See Keynes Mss. 65 and 91, Hampshire Record Office Ms. NC 17 and Yale Mellon Ms. 80.

• Ms. 67 (SL120/R19) Miscellaneous collection of mostly unpublished alchemical texts, recipes, reports of experiments, etc. (1660s). In English and Latin, in four different hands, none of them Newton's, though there are a few additions by him, 125 ff.

On the cover, in Thomas Pellet's hand: 'No 2 Miscellanea'.

f. 1r 'The Apocalyps or Revelacon [sic] of the Secret Spirit by an vnknowen Author', in English.

ff. 7r-10r Collection of short citations (all in English) from Hermes , Pythagoras, Rasis, Morienus , Arnoldus de Villanova , Ripley , Johannes Damascene, Lull

, Agrippa, Aristotle, Geber, Vincentius, the Rosarium Philosophorum, Gratian and Avicenna. f. 10v List of axioms, in English.

f. 11r 'of the Stone', in English and Latin.

f. 13r 'Hic sequitur questiones et soluciones inter magistrum & Disipulum [sic]', in English.

f. 19r 'The philosophers water of might', in English.

f. 20r 'The true order in ye worke of ye ph[ilosoph]ers stone fownde written, by an vnknowne aucthore', in English.

f. 23r 'An vnknowen author, vpon the philosophers stone', in English verse [from Elias Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652: H93), 420].

f. 27r 'Sr Ed. Kelley Concerninge the philosophers stone written to his especiall friend G.S. Gent.', in English verse [Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum, 332-3].

f. 28r 'The vision of Sr George Ripley Chanon of Bridlingtone', in English verse [Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum, 374].

f. 29r 'Arnould de villa noua touching the philosophers stone', in English verse.

f. 34r 'A true Cittrination: de Sr Ino Bar:', in English.

ff. 34v-41r A great many largely technical instructions, eg. 'To seale upp any glass wth Hermes seale'.

f. 43r An untitled passage on transmutation, in English.

f. 46r 'The practize of ye stone ‹by a parable› written by Doctor Alemant, & Lorde Barnard Erle of Treuisone, of the Philosophers stone', in English.

f. 49r 'Ex epistole Ioh[ann]is paup[er]is', in Latin.

f. 50v 'Ex Breuiaru[m] Ioh[ann]is Paup[er]is', in Latin. f. 51r 'Vsus eius ad morbos', in Latin.

ff. 52r-64r Latin extracts from a variety of alchemical authors.

f. 64v A list of the works of 'Iohn Dastian' [Dastin].

f. 65v Account of a medical preparation of juniper, in English.

f. 66r 'De Alkymiæ veritate. liber antiqu[us] in pergameno script[us] Mr Savils prœbet': Latin digest.

f. 68r A Latin prayer for God's blessing on alchemical labours, and English excerpts from 'Mr barkers notes' about his furnaces.

ff. 69v-101v Miscellaneous alchemical recipes in English and Latin, many with detailed source references.

f. 102r-104r Notes on alchemical terms, symbols and processes, in English.

f. 104v An elaborate recipe for 'Aqua p[er]manens p[er] Lapide Philosophico', in English.

f. 106v 'The breefe of Sr Edwards Veres booke. August. 18. 1610', in English.

f. 109r-112r Sketches of chemical vessels, then a resumption of the recipes at ff. 69v-101v.

ff. 114r-117v Alchemical recipes, in English but transliterated into the Greek alphabet.

ff. 122r-124r A series of Latin notes headed 'Cristallus'.

f. 125 is blank apart from the heading 'Contra [mercurium]'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £6.10s. It appeared in Heffers' Catalogues 493 (1936) as Item 11 and 513 (1937) as Item 753, at £10.10s. in both cases, although Keynes had expressed an interest on 12 August 1936. Heffers also told Yahuda on 7 September 1936 that it was available for £10.10s. Quite when Keynes acquired it, or for how much, is not clear.

SL120 is described in the Sotheby catalogue as 112 leaves (presumably not including the blank ones).

Cf. Keynes Ms. 62, which was copied from various parts of this.

• Ms. 91 (Part of SL28/R19) Two unrelated tracts in the same hand (not Newton's), in English, c. 1,000 words in total, 1 p. + 8 pp.

The first tract, which has three lines added by Newton, begins 'The Pondus in Dissecting the Subject Matter'. The second and more substantial, entitled 'Experim[ent] the 4th. Being the Coralary of all ye former, Containing a true Process of the whole Worke', concerns how to 'Continue ye Hunting of ye Green Lyon'.

The remainder of SL28 is in Babson Mss. 433 and 725 and Francis A. Countway Library of Medicine, Boston Medical Library B MS c 41 c). The complete lot was bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £17. Keynes must have taken it on approval but returned it on 19 August 1936. It was subsequently split into four (following a division suggested by Keynes in a note accompanying the returned manuscript). Parts 3 and 4 appeared as Items 161 and 162 in Catalogue 3 (1943) of the London bookseller E. Weil: this part (part 4) was bought by Keynes for £4 on 9 December 1943 (seemingly his last purchase of an

alchemical manuscript).

The second tract is identified by Figala and Petzold ('Alchemy in the Newtonian circle', 180, 187-8) as a variant fragment of the 'Processus mysterii magni philosophicus' of William Yworth: cf. Keynes Mss. 65 and 66, Yale Mellon Ms. 80, and Hampshire Record Office Ms. NC17.

• Ms. 96 (SL134/R17) Five original letters from Fatio de Duillier to Newton, all in English; also letters from Fatio to John Conduitt and other Fatio-related material.

a) 17 September 1692, on Fatio's ill health and probably imminent death, c. 300 words, 1 p.

b) 22 September 1692, on improvements in his health, with a character of his elder brother, c. 600 words, 2 pp.

c) 4 May 1693, on medicines and a 'metallick putrefaction and fermentation' being conducted on mercury by an unnamed friend, c. 1,000 words, 2 pp.

d) 15 June 1717, on getting a watch made for Dr Bentley, with an attached note on astronomy for Halley, c. 100 words, 1 p.

e) 1 April 1724, covering note for a draft 'Advertisement' (not present) about a project relating to watch-making, c. 90 words, 1 p.

Followed by six letters from Fatio to Conduitt dated between 8 August 1730-12 April 1732, two copies of a petition for a reward for uncovering a plot against the king's life, one addressed to the king and one to the Commons, an abstract of his letter to Dr Worth concerning this plot (all in Fatio's hand) and a printed copy of Fatio's Latin verse eclogue 'Neutonus' (1728).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £12 and sold to Keynes on 30 July 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

a) printed in NC, 3: 229-30; b) in NC, 3: 231-3; c) in NC, 3: 265-7; d) in NC, 6: 391-3, and e) in NC, 7: 270-71.

• Ms. 98 (SL143/R17) Original letter from Locke to Newton, dated London, 26 July 1692, in English, c. 400 words, 2 pp.

Includes a copy of two alchemical recipes (the first, headed 'First Period', being only part of a longer process with the rest of which Newton was apparently familiar), found among the papers of Boyle (d. 30 December 1691), which were being inspected by Locke, 'Dr Dickison' (i.e. Edmund Dickinson) and Dr [Daniel] Cox [or Coxe, another associate of Boyle].

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £38 and sold to Keynes on 4 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

Printed in Brewster (1855), 2: 461-2 and NC, 3: 216-17. Newton's reply (2 August 1692) is in the Bodleian and printed in NC, 3: 217-19.

• Ms. 99 (SL144/R17) Miscellaneous correspondence.

Original letter from 'Fran: Meheux' to Newton, 2 March 1683, in English, c. 200 words, 1 p. Reports the progress made by an unspecified chemist in extracting different coloured 'earths' from 'the first watter'. On reverse, in Newton's hand: a list of names of 21 people in the Stanford and Colsterworth district, four of whom are bracketed as 'Freeholders examined as witnesses'.

Original letter from John Drummond to Newton, in English, acknowledging a copy of the Opticks in Latin presented to the Royal College of Physicians, 20 July 1708, 1 p.

Original letter to Newton from John Chamberlayne, in English, regarding a Signior Bianchi, 21 Aug. 1710, 1 p., with theological notes on Plotinus and Marcellus on the reverse.

Copy of a letter from John Caswell to John Flamsteed concerning magnetism, not in Newton's hand, 14 October 1694, 5 pp.

Original letters from M. Pilkington to Mrs Savage, 20 February 1711, 2 pp., and from Henry Newton to Newton, December 1710, 4 pp., and a two-line note (not in Newton's hand and evidently written shortly after his death) on the dates of Newton's membership and presidency of the

Royal Society.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £7 and sold to Keynes on 4 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%.

Meheux's letter printed in NC, 2: 386-7 (with the list on reverse as a footnote), Drummond's in NC, 4: 528, and Chamberlayne's in NC, 5: 59-60, without the theological notes.

II. Yahuda Mss., Jewish National and University Library, Jerusalem, Israel Alchemical Manuscripts

• Var. 1 Ms. 30 (SL40/R41) 'Out of La Lumiere sortant des Tenebres' and '

Out of the Commentator on La Lumiere sortant de Tenebris

[sic]' (c. 1687-92), in English, incomplete, c. 1,700 words, 4 pp. Abstracts translated [by Newton?] from

La lumière sortant par soy même des tenebres

(1687), itself a translation of a Latin translation of and commentary on an original text in Italian verse possibly by Otto Tachenius. The commentary begins on f. 1v. On the 'grand mercury of Philosophers' and analogies between alchemical transmutations and the original Creation. Includes occasional elucidatory notes by Newton in square brackets.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Keynes for £7.10s. On 3 and again on 25 April 1938 Keynes wrote to Yahuda reminding him about a Newton manuscript he (Keynes) had given him as part of a proposed swap but for which Keynes had received nothing in return. Yahuda, however, claimed that as far as he was aware the exchanges had all been fully settled. It seems likely this is the manuscript referred to by Keynes: see Spargo, '1936 sale', 132-3.

The remainder of these notes had become detached before the Sotheby sale and were sold, together with a separate set of notes on the same work, as SL41, which is now Babson Ms. 414 (q.v. for further

details).

The complete text, i.e. Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 30 and Babson Ms. 414B, is transcribed with very useful introductory notes in Dobbs, Janus Faces, 278-87. H1003 is Newton's copy of the French text.

• Var. 1 Ms. 38 (SL76/R41) 'De Igne sophorum et materia quam calefacit', in Latin and English, c. 2,500 words, 6 pp. on 4 ff. of which one blank.

A collection of alchemical extracts under the headings 'Moschus in Turb [a]', ' Philal

[ethes] in Metal[lorum] Metamorph[osi]', ' Nov

[um] Lum[en]' (f. 1r), 'Marrow of Alk' (f. 1v-2r), 'Philal. comment. on Ripl

[ey]' (2r-3r), 'Brevis Manuductio [ad rubinum cœlestem]' (f. 3r-v).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £9 and sent to Yahuda on approval on 26 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%; on 4 September Maggs thanked him for having decided to keep it.

The Sotheby catalogue misreads the title as 'De Igne sophorem et materia quam cale facit', an error replicated in Ch-H. Cf. Keynes Ms. 36.

• Var. 259 (SL35/R41) Twelve small bundles of alchemical notes and extracts (c. early 1680s), in various languages and from a very wide range of sources, 100 pp. enclosed in a wrapper bearing a list of contents.

1 'Le Procede Vniverselle [sic pour faire la Pierre Philosophiale laquelle l'auteur dit davoir faict quatre fois' [by Johannes Rhenanus?], in French, incomplete, c. 1,500 words, 6 pp. 2 '

Artephij antiquissimi Philosophi de arte occulta & lap. Philos. Liber secretus

', in Latin, c. 3,500 words, 8 pp. See H1309-10. 3 '

The Hyeroglyphicall figures of Nicholas Flammel explained

, anno 1399', in English, with a pen-and-ink drawing of some of the hieroglyphs, c. 3,000 words, 7 pp. 4 ' Novum Lumen Chymicum Sendivogij

. Divi Leschi genus amo [anagram of 'Michael Sendivogius']', in Latin, c. 4,000 words, 8 pp. See H445 and 1485. 5 ' Enchiridion Physicæ Ioh. Spagneti

. Spes una est in Agno [anagram of 'Ioannes Spagnetus', i.e. Jean d'Espagnet]', in Latin, c. 3,500 words, 8 pp.

6 A bundle of English notes and extracts: 'Nortons Ordinall', 'Dastins dreame', 'The black monkes Earth of Earth', 'The hunting of ye Green Lyon', 'Riplys Epistle to K. Edward ye 4th', 'Riplys 12 Gates', c. 4,000 words in all, 8 pp. [These are all based on Elias Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652: H93): the 'Epistle' and 'Twelve Gates' are sub-sections of Ripley's 'Compound of Alchemie' (107-93), and 'Pearce the Black Monke upon the Elixir' (269-74) begins 'Take Erth of Erth, Erth's Moder'.]

7 'Ex Augurelli Chrysopœia', in Latin, 2 pp., followed by 'The Marrow of Alchymy' [by 'Eirenæus Philalethes': see H1034], in English, 6 pp.; in all c. 3,000 words.

8 A bundle of Latin notes and extracts: 'Riplæi Tractatus tertius', notes on the Tabula Smaragdina

, 'Ex Authore Anonymo De Tincturis', 'Praxis fæmina'; in all c. 1,800 words, 5 pp.

9 A bundle of Latin notes and extracts: 'Observanda', 'Instructio de Arbori solari', 'Lucerna Salis Philosophorum'; in all c. 1,500 words, 12 pp.

10 'Commentatio de Pharmaco Catholico per Iohn de Monte Snyder Latinitate donata per Authorem Chymicæ Vannus', in Latin, c. 5,000 words, 13 pp. See H1378. 11 ' F[ather] B. Valentine's 12 Keys

', 2 pp., followed by 'References to B Valentines works', 11 pp., in English; in all c. 5,000 words. See H127-130, esp. 128.

12 Miscellaneous notes in Latin, c. 4,000 words, 8 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Gabriel Wells for £70. Yahuda asked for it on 1 and 12 August 1936 but presumably unsuccessfully. What happened in the meantime is not clear, but it was presented to the Jewish National and University Library a little after December 1958 by Dr Sidney M. Edelstein (an American chemical manufacturer).

Bundle 1 is attributed to 'Jodocus a Rhe', i.e. Johannes Rhenanus, in the Sotheby catalogue, but the ascription is queried (though not categorically rejected) by Figala and Petzold, 'Alchemy in the Newtonian circle', 177, n. 1.

• Ms. Var. 260 (SL59/R41) Notebook containing little but headings ('De Sale'; 'Solutio'; 'Conjunctio et Liquefactio'; 'Imbibitio & Calcinatio', etc.), with gaps for entries left blank apart from a few perfunctory notes in Latin, 15 ff.

Bought at the Sotheby sale for £5 by William H. Robinson, who told Keynes on 13 August 1936 that it was still in stock. Presumably, however, Keynes did not buy it. Presented to the Jewish National and University Library a little after December 1958 by Dr S.M. Edelstein.

III. Edwin Newton Ohl Collection, Francis A. Countway Library of Medicine, Boston Medical Library, Massachusetts, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• B MS c 41 (SL87/R42) Nine miscellaneous items relating to (al)chemical processes, in Latin and English, 48 pp. in a wrapper headed 'Alychimya' [sic] in another hand and bearing a list of contents in Newton's.

The headings in the text are as follows:

1 'The Regimens described, wth ye times & signes', mainly consisting of notes and abstracts from 'Philalethes'' works, especially Secrets Reveal'd, in English, c. 2,000 words, 6 pp.

2 'Of Proportions': Latin extracts from various sources, mainly the Turba Philosophorum and 'Philalethes'' Introitus Apertus

[the Latin version of Secrets Reveal'd], c. 1,200 words, 4 pp.

3 'De Primis materialibus principijs', in Latin, c. 1,000 words, 8 pp. Unfinished lexicon, with entries beginning 'De Magnesia', 'De Saturno', 'De 4 Elementis' and the like, with gaps for more material to be added. Includes the sub-headings 'De Sale', 'De præparatione mercurij', 'De Extractione sulphuris', with several individual entries under each.

4 'Axioms', in English with Latin citations, c. 800 words, 4 pp. Forty-three numbered instructions for an alchemical operation, followed by four further unnumbered notes, citing a wide range of sources with blank spaces left for precise volume and page references to be filled in.

5 Draft headings for an alchemical index (from 'Aqua compos' to 'Venus'), 4 pp., described on the title page as 'An alphabeticall explanation of chemicall words': there are no entries except that most of the headings are followed by one or more [page?] numbers.

6 'Conclusione ex Riplei operibus deductæ', in Latin, c. 1,000 words, 3 pp. Twenty-six conclusions interpreting passages from Ripley , with page references.

7 'Præparatio Salis ex Riplæi operibus', Latin notes, c. 500 words, 2 pp.

'Salis virtutes', Latin notes, c. 500 words, 2 pp.

8 'Of the Alcahest', mainly in English with some Latin, c. 3,000 words, 8 pp. Notes drawn principally from [J.B. Van] Helmont and 'Philalethes'.

9 'De medendi Arte, & usu Lapidis', in English and Latin, c. 2,000 words, 6 pp. Notes from a wide range of sources including the Book of Maccabees. Followed by two brief notes in Latin headed 'De projectione' and 'De morbis sanandis', 1 p.

The Sotheby catalogue describes this lot as consisting of seven items, treating sections 5-7 as one item. The divisions used here are those stipulated by Newton himself on the title sheet. The title sheet also promises a tenth section, 'A Collection of ancient Hieroglyphicks', but if this was ever present it had vanished by the date of the Sotheby sale.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £56 and sold to Yahuda, who promised to pass it on to Keynes as part of an exchange deal (see notes to Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 24 and Spargo, '1936 sale', 130). How it was acquired by the Boston Medical Library is unknown.

Section 1 discussed and quoted at length in Dobbs, 'Newton's Copy of "Secrets Reveal'd"', 150-52.

• B MS c 41 b) (Unidentified in Sotheby/R42) Highly technical notes in Latin and English on the distillation of salt, c. 300 words, 2 pp.

• B MS c 41 c) (Part of SL28/R42) Miscellaneous alchemical recipes, including one to turn lead into mercury by mixing it with corn and olive oil over a moderate heat, in English, c. 200 words, 1 p.

The remainder of SL28 is now Babson Mss. 433 and 725 and Keynes Ms. 91 (q.v. for the sale history).

IV. The British Library, London, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• Add. Mss 44888 (SL110/R31) 'Basilius Valentinus & Iodochus a Rhe': abstracts from these authors (the latter is more usually called Johannes Rhenanus) on minerals, transmutation of metals, vitriol, etc., in English, c. 6,000 words, 14 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Bernard Quaritch for £15 and offered as Item 60 in his Catalogue no. 253 (1936) for £24. On 11 September 1936 Quaritch offered it to Yahuda for that price, but it was purchased by Lord Wakefield and presented to the British Museum (now British Library) later the same year. See British Museum Quarterly 11 (1937), 66.

V. Fitzwilliam Museum, Cambridge, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• (SL210/R32) Note-book (1662-69), 118 ff. with entries on 34 pp.

Flyleaf inscribed 'Isaac Newton/ pret. 8d'. This is followed by a sequence of letters (the key to a cipher?), reading: 'Nabed Efyhik Wfnzo Cpmfke'.

The book proper begins with shorthand notes on 3 pp., dated 1662, and detailing Newton's sins before and after Whitsunday of that year. Then

follows a list of expenses, 7 pp., dated from 23 May 1665 to April 1669 (about 140 entries), including assorted chemicals, two furnaces and a copy of the Theatrum Chemicum [ed. Lazarus Zetzner, 1659-61: H1608] bought in April 1669. On f. 10v another hand has listed the names of four German noblemen.

The other end of the book begins with 'Nova Cubi Hebræi Tabella' on 1 p., followed by various problems in geometry and the conic sections (ellipsis, parabola, hyperbole, etc.), with diagrams, 24 pp. On the back flyleaf in Thomas Pellet's hand: 'Sep 25 1727/ Not fit to be printed/ T Pellet'.

Described and partly published in Brewster (1855), 1: 31-3. The shorthand section deciphered and discussed in Westfall, 'Short-Writing and the State of Newton's Conscience, 1662'.

VI. Hampshire Record Office, Winchester, Hampshire, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• NC3/1-6 (SL83/R32) Miscellaneous (al)chemical recipes, in four different hands, none of which is Newton's (or Humphrey Newton's). In English, c. 2,000 words, 10 pp. on 7 ff.

Includes 'A Medicine to transmute Copper'; 'To make artificiall pearle', and other untitled recipes and notes in similar vein.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Maxwell' (i.e. Lymington) for £4.10s. and presumably presented by him to Hampshire Record Office either formally or on permanent loan.

• NC17 (SL116/R32) Incomplete variant copy of William Yworth, 'Processus Mysterij Magni Or An Open Entrance to the Great Mysteries of the Ancient Philosophers', in English, in a clerical hand, c. 10,000 words, 107 pp. plus two title pages.

Dated 'Anno Domini 1701' (this evidently refers to date of the original composition, which was never published, not of the transcription, and may mean early 1702 (before 25 March, the first day of the legal year 1702)). Breaks off after Experiment 9 in Chapter Four. On the flyleaf in

Thomas Pellet's hand: 'Sep 25 1727/ Not fit to be printed/ T. Pellet'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Maxwell' (i.e. Lymington) for £3.10s. and presumably presented or permanently loaned by him to Hampshire Record Office.

Cf. Keynes Mss. 65, 66 and 91, Yale Mellon Ms. 80, and the literature cited in the notes to those entries.

VII. 'Estates of Mind', Great Neck, New York, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• (SL52/R32) 'De Mineralibus': notes on Geber, Basil Valentine , Paracelsus

and other alchemical writers, in Latin, c. 800 words, 3 pp. on 2 ff.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £6.10s. and presumably sold by them to Sir Robert Hadfield, who bequeathed it to the Iron and Steel Institute (later renamed the Institute of Metals). On 13 December 1994 it was sold at Sotheby's for £19,550 to 'Estates of Mind'.

VIII. St Andrews University Library, Fife, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• Ms. 38195(b) (SL14/R32) 'The Hunting of ye Green Lyon & putrefaction of the body according to the number of the eagles', in English, c. 800 words, 2 pp., followed by miscellaneous notes in Latin, c. 400 words, 1 p.

Transcript from an unidentified work: this is not the 'Hunting of the Greene Lyon' of Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum and Keynes Ms. 20.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by John Read (chemistry professor at St Andrews and a writer on alchemy and early chemistry) with an 'on the house' bid of £12. Read had also expressed an interest in lots 27 (now in the Joseph Halle Schaffner Collection) and 55 (now Keynes Ms. 37).

Karin Figala, in a personal communication, has suggested that the title has a ' Philalethan

' ring to it. The headings 'Green Lyon' and 'Eagles' are to be found in the 'Index chemicus' (Keynes Ms. 35).

• Ms. 38195(c) (Part of SL3/R32) A list of 113 alchemical authors, categorised by nationality, and eight anonymous works, 2 pp.

SL3 was bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Goldschmidt' (E.P. Goldschmidt & Co. Ltd., 45 Old Bond Street, London) for £7 and offered to Keynes on approval for £14.15s. but obviously returned. It appeared on p. 38 of a Goldschmidt catalogue of uncertain date divided into two items: 166 ('List of 119 Alchemical Books') at £42, which is now Babson Ms. 418, and 167 ('113 Writers on Alchemy') at £9.9s., which is this manuscript.

See Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus', 142.

• Ms. 38196 (SL42/R32) Notes and abstracts from assorted alchemical works, in Latin, beginning missing, c. 5,000 words, 8 pp.

Includes the sub-headings 'Arnoldi Speculum Alchymiæ' (p. 3), 'Instructio Galli Anonymi ad filium de Arbore Solari' (also p. 3), 'Emblemata Michaelis Maieri Comitis Germani' (p. 8).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £9. Sent to Keynes on approval on 5 September 1936 but presumably returned. Appeared as item 4 in Heffers' Catalogue no. 493 (1936) at £15 and was presumably bought by John Read (see notes to Ms. 38195 (b) above).

IX. Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, Massachusetts, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• (SL25/R43) 'The Book of Nicholas Flamel conteining

The explication of the Hieroglyphical Figures

wch he caused to be put in the Church of the SS. Innocents at Paris', in English, c. 15,000 words, 61 pp.

On the cover, in Thomas Pellet's hand: 'Flamel. No. 54'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Gabriel Wells for £21. Yahuda tried for it unsuccessfully on 12 August 1936. Bought at some point by Sidney M. Edelstein and donated by him to the Massachusetts Institute of

Technology in December 1958.

Cf. Keynes Ms. 14 and Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.3.

X. Dibner Library, Smithsonian Institution, Washington D.C., USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• NMAHRB Ms. 1007 B (Unidentified in Sotheby/R43) Chemical notes, partly in another hand, in English and Latin, c. 400 words, 2 pp. on 2 ff.

The first sheet contains a brief alchemical recipe in another hand, copied out again in Newton's. The second has a Latin extract from Basil Valentine

on distillation, followed by a related recipe in English, all in Newton's hand.

Previously Burndy Ms. 12. Donated to the Smithsonian by Bern Dibner.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1023 B (SL114/R43) Notebook containing abstracts and notes drawn from various alchemical works, mainly in Latin with some English, c. 24,000 words in all, 61 pp. + 208 pp. blank.

On the flyleaf in Thomas Pellet's hand: 'Sep. 25 1727/ Not fit to be printed/ Tho. Pellet'. Main text preceded by 5 unnumbered pages prepared as an index but containing only columns of alphabetical headings (eg. 'Suo/ Suu/ Ta/ Taa/ Tae') and one blank page. The main text has the following sub-headings, though besides the sources given by these there are references on pp. 48-9 to 'Laurent. Ventura' and Ramón Lull's 'Theorica', and on pp. 50-51 to 'Anonym[us] de Arte Chim[ica] in Arte Aurif[era]'.

p. 1 'Ex Rosarij abbreviati tract. quinq[ue]' [This is not, as stated in the Sotheby catalogue, taken from the Rosarius Philosophorum of Arnoldus de Villanova, but from an anonymous tract entitled 'Rosarium Abbreviatum', which appeared in vol. 3 of Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum as part of 'Justus a Balbian. Tractatus septem de Lapide Philosophico' (first pub.1599, though Newton is extremely unlikely to have seen that edition), Balbian being the editor rather than the author of the collection: see Ferguson, Bibliotheca Chemica, 2: 287 and 437.] [

on signal un Rosaire des Philosophes, Lugduni, 1586, cf. Sommaire du Rosaire .]

p. 15 'Ex Petri Boni Lombardi Ferrariensis Margarita Pretiosa' p. 24 'Ex Dionysij Zacharij Opusculo' p. 31 'Out of Philaletha

's works concerning the extraction of [sulphur] out of [mercury]', in Latin and English p. 51 'Ex Clangore Buccinæ'

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £48. Offered to Keynes for £60 on 18 August 1936 but returned a week later. Presumably sold by Edwards to Bern Dibner, who donated it to the Smithsonian. Previously Burndy Ms. 9.

See Dobbs, 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 107. This manuscript (minus the putative index) is also reproduced on R19 of the Chadwyck-Healey microfilm, between Keynes Mss. 64 and 65 (this has perhaps come from a photostat of the notebook held at Keynes Ms. 221). This would appear to be a mistake, since there is no reference to its presence there in the Chadwyck-Healey catalogue.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1024 B (SL23/R43) Notes and abstracts 'Ex Fabri Hydrographo Spagyrico' (f. 1r) and 'Ex Palladio Spagyrico' (f. 2r), with page references (1690s?), in Latin, c. 1,500 words, 4 pp. on 2 ff.

Both works cited are by the French alchemist Pierre Jean Fabré.

Previously Burndy Ms. 13. Bought at the Sotheby sale by Pickering & Chatto for £7. Later offered for sale at $285 by the New York bookseller William Schab, and presumably purchased from him by Bern Dibner, who donated it to the Smithsonian.

See H598 for Newton's copy of Fabré's complete works, and Dobbs, 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 106.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1028 B (SL56/R43) 'Notanda Chymica' (late 1660s), in Latin, c. 1,500 words, 5 pp. (though there is only one word and a page reference on p. 5).

Notes and extracts, with page references, chiefly from Michael Maier's Arcana arcanissima, though there is also reference to the 'Rosarium Philosophorum' from Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum.

Previously Burndy Ms. 14. Bought at the Sotheby sale by C.A. Stonehill for £7.10s Offered on 7 September for £12 to Keynes, who returned it. On 28 October following Stonehill told Yahuda he would accept his offer of £9.9s. but this seems to have fallen through. Acquired at some point by Bern Dibner, who donated it to the Smithsonian.

See Dobbs, 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 106.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1031 B (SL113/R43) Unfinished treatise on the vegetative growth of metals (mid-1670s), in English, with a short supplementary section in Latin at the end, c. 4,500 words, 12 pp.

Begins with a list of 12 numbered subjects for discussion, forming a putative draft outline of the treatise (though the text itself frequently departs from the sequence of subjects listed): e.g. '1 Of natures obvious laws & processes in vegetation', '2 That metalls vegetate after the same laws', etc. The very heavy reworking of the main text and absence of reference to other sources strongly suggest Newton's own composition, making this a centrally important document indicating the nature of his (al)chemical views in the mid-1670s. It is quite without accounts of specific laboratory processes and quite devoid of allegorical or symbolic terminology, and seems to represent the beginnings of an attempt to formulate a coherent theory of chemistry. It is probably related to the 'Hypothesis explaining the Properties of Light' sent to the Royal Society in December 1675.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Pickering & Chatto for £12. They advised Keynes on 23 July 1936 that they had already sold it, but to whom is unclear. Bought by Bern Dibner in London at some point in the 1940s: B.J.T Dobbs noted that 'when I pressed him for details about that transaction, he assured me that it seemed more important at the time to save it from the blitz than to keep records of that sort of thing' (Janus Faces, 256, n. 1). Previously Burndy Ms. 16. Donated to the

Smithsonian in 1976.

Reproduced in facsimile as an appendix to Dobbs, Alchemical Death, and described and transcribed (without the Latin supplement) in Dobbs, Janus Faces, 256-70 (Dobbs treats the first of the twelve subjects for enquiry as the title of the entire document). See also her 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 107, and Rattansi, 'Newton's Alchemical Studies'.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1032 B (SL85/R43) Three related sets of notes (late 1680s-90s), in English, 17 pp. plus 1 p. blank and a loose scrap, c. 5,300 words in total. 8 pp. badly discoloured and barely legible.

Entitled 'The Regimen' (7 pp.), 'The Regimen', (8 pp.) and 'Of ye Regimen' (2 pp., incomplete). Describe a sequence of (al)chemical operations largely drawn from the works of ' Philalethes ', though other authors including Pontanus , Maier and Roger Bacon

are cited, especially in the second set of notes. On the loose scrap (which is not mentioned in the Sotheby catalogue, though the manuscript is described as 18 pp. and the catalogue does not normally count blank pages), various alchemical references, with mention of John Day and of Roger Bacon's Elementorum and Michael Maier's Arcana arcanissima, written over and on the reverse of a receipt dated 11 September 1689.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £12.10s. Offered on approval first to Keynes, who returned it on 19 August 1936, then to Yahuda (for the sale price plus 20%), who returned it on 8 September 1936. At some point acquired by Bern Dibner, who donated it to the Smithsonian. Previously Burndy Ms. 15.

See Dobbs, 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 106-7 and 'Newton's Copy of "Secrets Reveal'd"', 159.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1041 B (Part of SL63/R43) Two accounts of alchemical operations (1690s?), in Latin, c. 2,500 words in all, 7 pp.

1) 'Separatio Elementorum' (2 pp.). On the distillation of elements in a 20 gallon vat, with references to 'Philalethes' and Albertus Magnus

. The large number of corrections and relatively small number of references to other writers may indicate that this is at least partly Newton's own composition.

2) 'Reductio et Sublimatio' (5 pp.). Excerpts and abstracts, principally from Lull

, on an imperfect transmutation of white sulphur into silver and red sulphur into gold.

Previously Burndy Ms. 10. Donated to the Smithsonian by Bern Dibner. The major part of SL63 is now Babson Ms. 417, q.v. for what is known of the sale history.

See Dobbs, 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 106.

• NMAHRB Ms. 1070 A (SL66 + ?/R43) Draft alchemical treatise or compilation, in Latin with odd passages in English, c. 14,000 words, 42 pp. + 4 pp. of unrelated material.

Largely drawn, with page references, from various other works, principally those of Lull and 'Philalethes' but also Ripley , Snyders, Flamel , Sendivogius , Fabré, Arnoldus de Villanova , Van Helmont

and others. Clearly represents an attempt to establish a sequence of operations: 'Opus primum', 'Opus secundum', etc. (cf. Keynes Mss. 40, 41 and Babson Ms. 421); the operations covered here are numbered 1-2 and 6-9). Very rough, heavily reworked draft, several sections incomplete.

Also includes three scraps of unrelated correspondence (1700, 1718, n.d.) and a transcript (in another hand, annotated by Newton) of Bernoulli's letter of 8 April 1717 to Montmort, in French, concerning Newton and Leibniz. These are unmentioned in the rather cursory Sotheby catalogue description of SL66, which gives the total page count as 43 pp.; some or all of the letters are presumably a later addition, though why they have been catalogued together with the foregoing

treatise is a mystery.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by William H. Robinson for £19 and at some point acquired by Bern Dibner, who donated it to the Smithsonian.

See Dobbs, 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 107; also H994-1001 for Newton's Lull collection. Bernoulli's letter printed in Brewster (1855), 2: 437-8.

XI. Bodleian Library, Oxford, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• Ms. Don b.15 (SL16/R32) Dictionary of (al)chemical terms, materials and apparatus (late 1660s-early 1670s), with directions for performing various operations, in English, c. 7,000 words, 16 pp.

Entries run alphabetically from 'Abstraction' to 'Vrinous Salt'. In some cases the headword is followed only by a gap in which to insert the definition. Refers to Boyle's Of Formes and Qualities (1666), but much appears to be Newton's own work.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by R.V. Sowers for £19.10s. Bought, according to the Bodleian Catalogue of Manuscripts, 'with a contribution from Roy V. Sowers' in 1967, the 'contribution' presumably consisting of a discount.

XII. Harry Ransom Humanities Research Center, Texas University, Austin, Texas, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• HRC129 (SL15/R43) Excerpts (probably made in the 1690s) from the correspondence between Edmund Dickinson and Theodorus Mundanus published by the former. In Latin, c. 3,500 words, 16 pp. on 8 ff.

f. 1r 'Ex Epist. Edmundi Dickenson ad Theodorum Mundanum. Dat Londini prid. Cal. Aug. [i.e. 31 July] 1683 edit 1686': this includes a list of eleven questions about alchemical terminology which are answered by Mundanus in the rest of the document, as follows:

f. 1v 'Ex Theodori Mundani Responso Dat. Parisijs 10 Cal. Octob. [i.e. 20 September] 1684' f. 2v 'De materia lapidis' f. 3r 'De Mercurio Philosophorum' f. 4v 'De Philosophorum auro' f. 5r 'De Monte

Philosophorum' 'De Philosophorum Mari' f. 5v 'De Philosophorum aqua vitæ' 'De Philosophorum Diana' f. 7v 'De secreto Philosophorum igne' f. 8v 'De medicamento Vniversali' 'De Patriarcharum longævitate'

Described as c. 2,500 words in both the Sotheby and Hary Ransom catalogues, but this seems a very conservative estimate.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Ulysses' (Jacob Schwartz?) for £6.10s. Appeared as lot 717 in the Sotheby sale of 1 August 1939 but what happened to it after that and how it reached Texas is unclear.

H513 is Newton's copy of Dickinson's Epistola Edmundi Dickinson M.D. & Medica Regii ad Theodorum Mundanum Philosophum Adeptum. De Quintessentia Philosophorum et De Vera Physiologia. [...] His Accedunt Mundani responsa (1686). Newton seems to have thought highly of this work and cited or referred to it frequently in his alchemical compilations of the 1690s (see Westfall, Never at Rest, 290-91, n. 32, and Dobbs, 'Newton's Copy of "Secrets Reveal'd"', 157 and n. 64). See also Keynes Ms. 26 for Newton's later alchemical discussions with a friend of Dickinson and Boyle.

XIII. Library of the University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, Wisconsin, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• (SL121/R43) Newton's copy of 'Philalethes" [i.e. George Starkey's] Secrets Reveal'd, with corrections and additions in Newton's hand on almost every page. Secrets Reveal'd: or,

An Open Entrance to the Shut-Palace of the King:

Containing, the greatest Treasure in Chymistry [...] Composed By a most famous English-man Styling himself Anonymus, or Eyræneus Philaletha Cosmopolita [...] Published for the Benefit of all English-men, by W.C. Esq. [i.e. William Cooper]' (1669)

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £88. Appeared as Item 152 in his Catalogue no. 605 (1936) at £200 and as Item 237 in his Catalogue no. 627 (1938) at £150. It was bought by Denis I. Duveen and passed from him to the University of Wisconsin in 1955.

See Dobbs, 'Newton's Copy of "Secrets Reveal'd"', and H1478.

XIV. Babson Collection, Burndy Library, Dibner Institute, Cambridge, Massachusetts, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• Ms. 414 (SL41/R42) Two sets of notes on La lumière sortant par soy même des tenebres, in English, c. 2,500 words, 5 pp. on 3 ff. Ms. 414A (late 1690s or later): ' Ex Lumine de tenebris

': 2 pp. of notes constituting Newton's abstracts of his own earlier abstracts (Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 30 and Babson Ms. 414B).

Ms. 414B (c. 1687-92): the end of the series of abstracts from this work of which the beginning is now Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 30, 3 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by C.A. Stonehill for £5. Stonehill offered it to Keynes for £10 on 7 September 1936, but Keynes obviously refused this 100% mark-up, and on 18 September Stonehill told Yahuda it was still available. On 15 December 1936 Stonehill reminded Yahuda that he had taken it on approval ten days ago for £7.10s. and asked if he wanted to keep it. A receipt among the Yahuda papers dated 31 December 1936 for £7.10s., in settlement of an account dated 4 December 1936, surely refers to this lot. How it came to the Babson is unclear. See Spargo, '1936 sale', 128.

See H1003. Ms. 414B is transcribed together with Yahuda Var. 1 Ms. 30 as a single reunited text, with notes, in Dobbs, Janus Faces, 278-87.

• Ms. 415 (SL95/R42) Notes 'Ex Rosario Magno', in Latin with some English, 1½ pp. on 4 ff., c. 750 words.

Elucidations of alchemical symbolism with page references to the 'Rosarium Philosophorum' in Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum (H1608) [this was commonly referred to as 'Rosarium Magnum' to distinguish it from various other 'philosophical rosaries': see Ferguson, Bibliotheca Chemica, 2: 287].

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £5 and offered to Keynes, but he returned it on 19 August 1936.

• Ms. 416 (SL70 [+ ??]/R42) Miscellaneous alchemical notes and emblems, in Latin and English with some French, 28 pp. plus one page blacked out. A

1. 'Lapis Philosophicus cum suis rotis elementaribus', 1 p.: an elaborate alchemico-astrological diagram carefully copied in Newton's hand. In the centre is a seven pointed star labelled 'Prima Materia', surrounded by seven more seven-pointed stars each labelled with a gender and humour ('e.g. 'Femina phlegmatica', 'Masculina cholerica'). Each of these in turn is surrounded by the symbols for the seven 'planets'/metals in different configurations. To the right of the diagram, English notes explaining how it should be coloured.

2. Rougher copy of another alchemico-astrological emblem consisting of eight squares containing symbolic names in French (e.g. 'Souphure de terre', 'Loyseau dans son nid', 'La fille du grand Segret' ['Sulphur of earth'; 'the bird in its nest'; 'the great Segret's daughter']), arranged in a geometric grid decked out with a riot of symbols for signs of the zodiac and 'planets'/metals. Beneath this are the letter B surrounded by eight crosses, two allegorical figures labelled 'Simplicita' and 'Prudence', what appears to be a rough sketch of an alchemical operation, and a number of exceptionally cryptic remarks in French such as 'huict Estoilles Cest mon nom' ['eight stars that is my name'] and 'flamel dict Cest son fourneau' ['Flamel says it is his furnace']. 1 p. The reverse had been written on but has been completely blacked out with ink. This sheet is not mentioned in the Sotheby catalogue description. B

1. 'References': 9 pp. of alchemical subject headings (about five or six on each page) followed in some cases by page references to various alchemical works, the vast majority of them by ' Philalethes

' though Ripley and Jan Baptista van Helmont are also mentioned.

2. Notes and abstracts from various authors, in Latin and English, written around some notes about the size and design of a building. 10 pp.

3. 'Testamentum antiquius Clavicula': a list of various (al)chemical terms and sources; also two apparently unrelated geometrical diagrams. 2 pp. C

1. A further list of alchemical headwords followed by notes and page references to various works: 1 p., on the reverse of a fragmentary draft letter to John Aubrey reading in its entirety: 'Mr Aubrey/ I understand by Mr you have a letter from Mr Lucas for me. Pray forbear to send me any thing more of that nature.'

2. Alchemical jottings in Latin and English on 3 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £30 and offered to Keynes on approval on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20% but returned. Invoiced by Maggs to Yahuda for the same price on 23 December following. Acquired at some point by William Schab and sold to the Babson for $800 in February 1948.

Described in the Sotheby catalogue as 1 p. + 25 pp.: it is not clear whether this is an error or whether something has been added. Described still more perplexingly in the Babson catalogue as '19 pages of manuscript on 20 leaves', though the following description proceeds to cover all 28 pages.

• Ms. 417 (Part of SL63/R42) A large compilation of alchemical citations woven into a continuous text (1690s), in Latin, 56 pp. of which 8 blank, c. 17,500 words.

1. Citations from a wide range of sources, including Lull , Aristotle, Faber, Maier and Basil Valentine

. Under the headings: 'Operationum Ordo' (this heading occurs twice in succession but followed by different texts); 'Materiæ Mineralis præparatio prima et conversio in aquam'; 'Extractio et Rectificatio Spiritus'; 'Extractio et Rectificatio Animæ et calcinatio Corporis'; 'Reductio'; 38 pp. of which 6 blank.

2. Earlier drafts of various sections of the above, with the additional headings 'Elementorum Qualitates' and 'Præparatio Corporis'; 18 pp. of

which 2 blank.

The complete lot was bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £58 and offered to Keynes on 13 August 1936 for the sale price plus 20%. Keynes returned it and it was invoiced to Yahuda for the same price on 23 December 1936. Its subsequent fate is unclear: at some point it was split up and the smaller part acquired by Bern Dibner (now in the Dibner Institute, NMAHRB Mss. 1041B).

Cf. Keynes Mss. 40 and 41 and Dibner Institute NMAHRB Mss. 1070 A. See also Dobbs (who suggests the date), 'Newton Manuscripts at the Smithsonian', 106.

• Ms. 418 (Part of SL3/R42) 'Lib. chem.' and 'Manuscriptu[m] meum' (c. 1696-7), 2 pp. on 4 ff. of which 3 blank.

An inventory of Newton's (al)chemical books, printed or in manuscript copies, with shelf marks.

This represents part 2 of SL3: the first part is now in St. Andrews University Library, Ms. 38195(c), q.v. for the sale history.

See Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus', 140-41.

• Ms. 419 (SL4/R42) 'Of Chemicall Authors & their writings' (c. 1670-75), mainly in Latin with a little English, 7 pp. plus 5 pp. blank.

An alphabetical list of about 120 writers on alchemy, with comments on the works of the more important and gaps left for more to be added.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Pickering' (i.e. Pickering & Chatto of 26b King St., St. James's, London SW1) for £11; subsequent history unclear.

Cf. Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus', esp. 142-3.

• Ms. 420 (SL74/R42) 'Praxis' (certainly after 1689, probably c. 1696): an alchemical treatise, with notes and an earlier draft, mainly in English with some Latin, c. 5,500 words in all, 26 pp. of which two blank.

pp. 1-2 Latin notes on the derivation of the names of and symbols for the metals from Egyptian gods, planets, etc., apparently unrelated to the

rest of the document. p. 3 Main heading: 'Praxis'. 'Cap. 1. De Materijs Spermaticis.' 'Chap. 2/ De materia prima'

p. 8 'Cap. 3/ De Sulphure Ph[ilosoph]orum.' p. 10 'Cap. 4/ De agente primo.' pp. 12-20 'Chap. 5. Praxis'

pp. 11a-18a: Earlier partial drafts of chapters 4 and 5, in a separate booklet. The page numbers (introduced by the Babson College Archives) indicate the section of the main treatise to which they correspond.

An elaborate discussion of both the theoretical and practical aspects of alchemy. Though the text is densely packed with precise references to the whole range of Newton's vast reading on the subject, 'the conceptualization and organization of the work are certainly Newton's own', as Dobbs puts it (Janus Faces, 293), and she considers it 'Newton's climactic composition in alchemy' (ibid., 295).

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £34. Maggs informed Keynes on 30 July 1936 that it had been sold (but not to whom); subsequent history unclear.

pp. 1-2 discussed, with a facsimile of p. 2, in Dobbs, Janus Faces, 161-3. The main treatise (pp. 3-20) printed with notes in ibid., 293-305. See also Keynes Mss. 21, 23 and 53, and Westfall, Never at Rest, 529 on the genesis of the work.

SL420 is described in the Sotheby catalogue as only 26 pp. plus a cover, but the cover has since been designated pp. 1-2, and the other page numbers added, by the Babson College Archives. Dobbs's notes include a detailed account of the rather complex physical make-up of the document.

• Ms. 421 (SL24/R42) Three sets of chemical notes, in Latin, c. 3,200 words, 18 pp. of which 4 blank.

a) Notes on fermentation and the 'elements', with page references to a wide range of literature, 3 pp. On p. 3: fragment of a draft letter in English, without date or addressee.

b) Miscellaneous notes largely concerning the definition of alchemical terms and the uses to be made of various substances, 7 pp.

c) Notes on the sequence of operations in transmutation, including the headings 'Opus primum'; 'Opus tertium', 'Opus quartum' and 'Opus quintum' (cf. Keynes Mss. 40 and 41 and Dibner Institute Ms. NMAHRB 107A). Also features the beginning of a draft letter, in English, 'For Mr Proctor an Attorney' about succeeding his father in the management of Newton's affairs.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Robinson' (William H. Robinson Ltd., 16-17 Pall Mall, London SW1) for £13.10s. Robinson advised Keynes on 13 August 1936 that it was still in stock, but presumably he did not buy it.

• Ms. 433 (Part of SL28/R42) Draft letter or memo (1669?), in English, c. 200 words, 1 p.

Requests 'of Antimony about sixty pounds of Copper oare 12 or 16 pounds' and other metallic ores 'from [...] Bohemia or more especially from Hungary'. On reverse: a fragmentary medical recipe and some musings on the distinction between knowledge and wisdom, c. 100 words.

Possibly related to Newton's letter to Francis Aston, 18 May 1669 (Brewster (1855), 1: 387-9; NC, 1: 9-13), in which he advises him to make a number of chemical and metallurgical enquiries during his forthcoming European tour, Bohemia and Hungary (among other places) being specified.

The rest of SL28 is now divided between Babson Ms. 725, Keynes Ms. 91 (q.v. for the sale history) and Boston Medical Library B MS c 41 c.

• Ms. 725 (Part of SL28/R42) 'Experimts of refining Gold wth Antimony made by Dr. Ionathan Goddard', in English, c. 1,500 words, 4 pp. on 2 ff.

The rest of SL28 is now divided between Babson Ms. 433, Keynes Ms. 91 (q.v. for the sale history) and Boston Medical Library B MS c 41 c.

• Ms. 747 (Part of SL81/R42) 'Miscellanea': Latin notes on experiments, chiefly from Ramón Lull's 'Codicillus' and 'Testamentum' and Zetzner's Theatrum Chemicum, c. 1,200 words, 4 pp. on 2 ff.

SL81 was bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £9.10s. and originally included a further 6 pp. of miscellaneous notes, the location of which is now unknown. Cf. SL39 (whereabouts unknown). See H997 and H1608.

• (Ms. 925/SL61) 'Loca difficilia in Novo Lumine Chymico explicata' (c. 1668), in Latin, c. 400 words, 2 pp. + 1 line on 2 ff.

One page of explanatory notes on Michael Sendivogius's Novum lumen chemicum

(H1192). On f. 2, what appears to be a draft index, being a list of chemical terms (not in alphabetical order) followed by page numbers, and below this the same headwords written out again in alphabetical order. [on rappelle que les Douze Traités , c'est-à-dire le Traité du Mercure , encore appelé Nouvelle Lumière Chymique n'est pas de Michel Sendivogius mais d' Alexandre Sethon]

Bought at the Sotheby sale by C.A. Stonehill for £5.

Detailed analysis, including arguments for dating, in Figala, 'Exakte Alchemie', 177-9, with most of the text transcribed in the relevant notes, p. 215. Cf. Keynes Mss. 19 and 55, and Yahuda Ms. Var. 259.4.

• Ms. 1006 (SL297) Series of Latin anagrams of Newton's name and lists of authors cited in the Ludus Puerorum, Scala Philosophorum, and Rosarium Magnum, in the last case followed by page numbers, 1 p. on 1 f.

The last and (in Newton's eyes) obviously most satisfactory anagram, 'Ieova sanctus vnvs,' is used on a paper in Keynes Ms. 13 (SL2/R18). On reverse: rough draft of a letter (probably mid-1699), presumably to the Treasury, objecting to plans by the Ordnance Office to build a smith's house on Mint territory (cf. Mint Catalogue #818 (III.416-17)).

Bought at the Sotheby sale for £10 by C.K. Ogden.

The handwriting of the draft letter is markedly different from that on the recto, which was probably written a good deal earlier.

XV. Stanford University Library, Stanford, California, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• M132/2/3 (SL5/R42) A series of lists of authors and books on alchemy, 12 pp. of which one blank.

Includes (p. 7) a list of 27 items headed: 'Desiderantur opera Lullij sequentia'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £12.10s. and offered to Yahuda on 7 September 1936 for £18 but presumably turned down. Appeared as Item 1 in Heffers' Catalogue 493 (1936) at £18, and again as Item 745 in Heffers' Catalogue 513 (1937) at the same price. At some point acquired by Frederick E. Brasch, who donated it to Stanford.

Described in the Sotheby catalogue as 8 pp. enclosed in a folded sheet used for geometrical diagrams: the wrapper accounts for 4 pp. of which one blank. See Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus'.

• M132/2/4 (SL6/R42) 'De Scriptoribus Chemicis' (mostly late 1660s/early1670s though with later additions), 5 pp.

An (al)chemical bibliography containing titles and particulars of 90 works (six of which are evidently later additions by Newton to his original list), for the most part printed but some in manuscript.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £11.10s. and offered to Yahuda on 7 September 1936 for £17 but presumably turned down. Appeared as Item 2 in Heffers' Catalogue 493 (1936) at £17.10s. and again as Item 746 in Heffers' Catalogue 513 (1937) at the same price. At some point acquired by Frederick E. Brasch, who donated it to Stanford.

Annotated transcript (pp. 163-179) and extensive discussion, including arguments for dating, in Figala et al., 'De Scriptoribus'. Cf. Stanford Ms. M132/2/3 and Keynes Ms. 13.

• M132/2/5 (SL38/R42) 'To make Lucatello's Balsome': a medical recipe, in English, efficacious against 'ye Measell Plague or Small Pox [...] & against poyson & ye biting of a mad dog', c. 250 words, 1 p.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £8.10s. and offered to Yahuda on 7 September 1936 for £15 but presumably turned down. Appeared as Item 3 in Heffers' Catalogue 493 (1936) at £15 and again as Item 747 in Heffers' Catalogue 513 (1937) at the same price. At some point acquired by Frederick E. Brasch, who donated it to Stanford.

• M132/2/6 (SL69/R42) 'Notes out of Philalethes', in English, c. 650 words, 3 pp. on 2 ff.

Notes on the preparation of mercury for fusion with gold, on the nature of the Philosophers' Stone, and exposition of alchemical symbolic language, with page references to various sections of Ripley Reviv'd [1678: H1407].

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £7.10s. and offered to Yahuda on 7 September 1936 for £11.10s. but presumably turned down. Appeared as Item 5 in Heffers' Catalogue 493 (1936) at £11.10s. and again as Item 748 in Heffers' Catalogue 513 (1937) at the same price. At some point acquired by Frederick E. Brasch, who donated it to Stanford.

• M132/2/8 (SL82 + ?/R42) Notes from Ramón Lull, in Latin, c. 5,300 words, 13 pp.

First page headed: 'Ex Raymundi ‹libro secretorum›, seu de Quintessentijs', followed by an incomplete set of notes on the separation of elements. p. 13 does not follow from p. 12 and is not mentioned in the Sotheby catalogue: presumably it was added to the lot later. It contains a paragraph of notes (beginning missing) and the beginning of an alchemical recipe, headed 'Ex Raymundi Lulli Libro Mercuriorum ', which breaks off in mid-sentence.

SL82 was bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £13.10s. Keynes wrote to Heffers on 12 August 1936 asking to see it, but presumably

returned it, as Heffers offered it to Yahuda on 7 September 1936 for £20. He must also have turned it down, since it appeared as Item 6 in Heffers' Catalogue 493 (1936) at £20 and again in Heffers' Catalogue 513 (1937) at the same price. At some point acquired by Frederick E. Brasch, who donated it to Stanford. See H995-6 and 998.

• M132/2/9 (SL106/R42) 'Theatrum Astronomiæ Terrestris': copy of a treatise on the Philosophers' Stone and transmutation, English introduction and Latin text, c. 1,000 words, with 2 astronomico-alchemical diagrams, 4 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by R.V. Sowers for £10. [on rappelle que le Théâtre de l'Astronomie Terrestre

est un traité du médium Edward Kelly ; on y trouve de nombreuses et intéressantes gravures]

• M132/2/12 (Not identified in Sotheby/R42) Fragmentary notes on the astrological characters of the planets and on the gods and metals associated with them, in English, beginning missing, c. 600 words, 2 pp. Not in Newton's hand.

• Barchas Collection QD 25 G367 (R42) Newton's copy of Geber's Chimia (Latin translation by Caspar Horn, 1668), with Latin notes in his hand on both flyleaves elucidating some of Geber's terminology, c. 200 words.

Chimia, sive Traditio summæ perfectionis et investigatio magisterii, innumeris locis emendata à C. Hornio. See H657.

XVI. Cushing/Whitney Medical Library, Yale University, New Haven, Connecticut, USA Alchemical Manuscripts

• (SL102/R42) Transcript of Johann de Monte Snyders' The Metamorphosis of the Planets, with notes, in English, c. 23,500 words in total, 69 pp.

Title reads in full: 'The Metamorphosis of the Planets, That is A wonderfull Transmutation of the Planets and Metalliq[ue] formes into their first Essence, (with an annexed Process,) being a discovery of the

three Keys pertinent to the obteining of ye three Principles. Likewise in what manner the most generall universall is to be obteined is in many places of this treatise described by Iohn de Monte Snyders'. [

ouvrage encore indisponible - note du 1/01/2003 - en français]

A complete transcript of the book (an elaborate alchemical allegory) in Newton's hand (c. 22,000 words on 62 pp. plus title page and a hand-drawn frontispiece showing Jupiter (personified as a bearded man) enthroned on an orb with the sun and moon in his hands). Also 3 pp. of notes 'On ye Metamorphosis of ye Planets' and a further 2 pp. of 'Notes on ye Metamorphosis of ye Planets', c. 1,500 words.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by the London dealer E.P. Goldschmidt for £52.

Cf. Keynes Ms. 58 and the notes on Snyders in the Rare Book and Manuscript Library, Columbia University, and see Brewster (1855), 2: 371 and Dobbs, Foundations, 168-9, esp. n. 87. The work had been published in 1663 (second ed. 1700), but only in German, which Newton did not understand (he says so himself in Mint #206 (II.180-81)). Presumably this translation was copied from a manuscript (or, just possibly, translated by Newton from a Latin or French manuscript translation). See also H1378 for Newton's copy of Snyders' Commentatio de pharmaco catholico.

• (SL34/R42) 'Index Chemicus', in Latin, c. 2,000 words, 5 pp.

The beginnings of a draft version of Keynes Ms. 30, but the alphabetical headings run only from 'Ablutio' to 'Aqua fœtida', each followed by extensive page references to a range of alchemical literature.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Goldschmidt' for £10; subsequent history unclear.

See Westfall, 'Newton's Index Chemicus', 177-8, esp. n. 13.

XVII. Add. Mss., Cambridge University Library, Cambridge, UK Alchemical Manuscripts

• Add. Ms. 3973 (R10) Notes evidently on Newton's own laboratory experiments, mostly in English but two sets in Latin, c. 20,000 words in all, 51 ff. several of which blank. Dates range from Dec. 1678 to Feb. 1695/6.

The numbers preceding each set of experiments (except the tenth, which is not numbered on the manuscript) seem to have been added by a later hand.

1. (f. 1r) 'Experiments' dated 10 Dec. 1678 to 15 Jan. [1678/9?]. On subliming antimony with sal ammoniac and alloying antimony with lead, iron and other metals. In English, 3 pp.

2. (f. 5r) 'Experimts' dated Jan. 1679/80. On subliming antimonial sublimate with lead antimoniate. 22 Jan. Action of nitric acid and sal ammoniac on antimony sulphide, and further sublimations. In English, 8 pp.

3. (f. 9r) 'Experiments Feb. 1679/80.' On fusing antimony with vitriol and other substances. Sublimation of various metals with antimony and sal ammoniac. Action of oil of vitriol on galena, of nitric acid on sublimate of antimony, and others in the same vein In English, 6 pp.

4. (f. 13r) 'Experiments Aug. 1682.' Similar experiments; some on lead ore, others on an alloy of tin and bismuth referred to as 'Diana' (cf. references to the 'Doves of Diana' in Keynes Mss. 34 and 59). In English, 4 pp.

5. (f. 17r) 'Expts. Iuly 10 [no year]'. Sublimations of calx albus with [sal ammoniac?]. [The symbol used is a six-armed asterisk, which is not a conventional symbol for anything. Most (al)chemical writers at the period, including Newton, normally use an eight-armed asterisk for 'sal ammoniac', though Newton sometimes uses the eight-armed asterisk for 'star regulus of antimony': see Dobbs, Janus Faces, 296.] Includes the striking if enigmatic claim 'Iuly 10. Vidi [salammoniacum?] philosophicum. [...] Digestus cum tinctura Veneris [uncia] 5 gr 20 dabat Leonem vir[idem] gr 10. & [vitriolem] gr 180 vel 200 sed [vitriolus] istud per destillationem nullum emittebit [salammoniacum?] ph[ilosoph]icum'

['I saw the philosophical [sal ammoniac?]. 20 grains digested with 5 ounces of tincture of Venus [i.e. copper] gave 10 grains of the green Lion and 180 or 200 grains of vitriol, but upon distillation this vitriol yielded no philosophical [sal ammoniac?]']. In Latin, 1 p.

6. (f. 19r) 'Experimts April 26t 1686.' On a volatile salt of zinc [apparently the chloride], and on an alloy derived from ores of iron, antimony, tin , lead, and bismuth. 16 May. On subliming 'Ve. vo.' [probably 'Venus volans' or 'volatisata', i.e. volatilised copper] with precipitates of antimony and iron, and with mercury. In English, 2 pp.

7. (f. 21r) 'Experiments' dated 5 and 16 March 1690/1. On some bismuth compounds and the action of aqua fortis on alloys of tin, bismuth and zinc. In English, 5 pp. Followed by a page headed 'Experiments of Refining Gold by Antimony made by Dr Ionathan Goddard' but with no text (cf. Babson Ms. 725).

8. (f. 25r) 'Experiments & observations Dec. 1692 & Ian. 1692/3.' On the action of barm in brewing and distilling. Other experiments on the salts of metals and various sublimations. Comparison of the fusibility of alloys of lead, tin, and bismuth in various proportions. Further observations dated April and June 1693 on vitrification of reguluses and the fermentation of 'The two serpents' with the salts of various metals. In English, 7 pp.

9. (f. 29r) 'Experiments April 1695.' Experiments with antimony and ores of iron, copper, and tin, and sublimations with sal ammoniac. (f. 30v) 'Experiments Feb. 1695/6' Sublimations of antimony with iron ore. In English, 5 pp.

[10.] (f. 32r) Undated notes on miscellaneous experiments, including studies of the action of aqua fortis on antimony sulphide; sublimation of an alloy of antimony and lead with sal ammoniac; experiments on lead ore and other substances. In English, 29 pp.

11. (f. 51r) 'De metallo ad conficiendum speculum componendo & fundendo': a Latin recipe, 2 pp. [

sur ces expériences alchimiques, cf. notre section Précis de symbolisme alchimique

. On y fait voir notamment l'étrange contre sens de Newton sur la signification de l'antimoine considéré comme le « loup » des métaux, là où il faut voir un mors ou un grappin.]

Extracts in A.R. and M.B. Hall, 'Newton's chemical experiments'. Section 8 printed in Dobbs, Janus Faces, 288-92. Section 11 printed in Brewster (1855), 2: 535-6. Full critical edition by Peter Spargo forthcoming [2002?].

• Add. Ms. 3975 (R10) Notebook containing notes and experimental reports on a range of subjects, principally optics and chemistry (c. 1664-1696), mostly in English with some Latin, 283 pp. + 4 pp. starting from the back, c. 65,000 words.

A number of the chemical notes are closely related to those in Add. Ms. 3973.

On both sides of the fly-leaf: a table with notes of the value, hardness and other properties of various gems.

pp. 1-22 'Of Colours': a series of 64 'articles'. Articles 1-5: notes on experiments 9, 10 and 11 in Boyle's Experiments and Considerations Touching Colours (1664). Arts. 6-26: experiments with prisms. Arts. 27-43: on the effects of thin layers of air or water between prisms. Arts. 44-8: further experiments with prisms, including (46-8) the production of white and other colours of light by admixture. Art. 49: reflection at two contiguous glass surfaces. Art. 50: on the phenomena of colours in thin flakes of glass, soap bubbles and thin films of metal or water. Arts. 51-3: experiments on the effects of internal reflection of light in spheres of water, with several references to Descartes. Art. 54: on the effect of oblique rays on the size of the spot at contact of two glasses. Art. 55: on the diminished reflective power of a glass surface when placed in water. Arts. 56-7: on the reflective effects of powders and 'flawed' bodies with multiple reflecting surfaces. Arts. 58-62: notes on the effects of distorting the eyeball, including a diagram of Newton's experiment of

putting a bodkin 'betwixt my eye & ye bone as neare to ye backside of ye eye as I could: & pressing my eye with ye end of it' (facsimile in Westfall, Never at Rest, 95). Art. 63: on the after-image of colours on the retina. Art. 64: an account of the retina and optic nerve, with a diagram.

p. 22 Calculations of the 'thicknesse of a vibration' of light passing through various media; notes from Boyle's 'Of ye determinate nature of Effluviums' [1673] on heightened sense perception during illness; notes on vegetable substances that 'turn vitriol to a black precipitate'. p. 23 Recipe 'To make excellent Ink'.

pp. 25-41 'Of Cold, & Heate'. Notes 'On the Mechanical Origin of Heat and Cold', mainly from Boyle [Experiments, Notes, &c. about the Mechanical Origine or Production of divers particular Qualities (1675)] but including some observations either of Newton's own or from another source. [pp. 42-4 blank]

pp. 45-6 More notes from Boyle. An incomplete experiment on the height of the thermometer in various substances. Others on the expansion of air and linseed oil when heated.

pp. 49-51 'Of fire, flame, ye heate & ebullition of ye heart & divers mixed liquors & Respiration': notes from Boyle's New Experiments Physico-mechanicall, Touching the Spring of the Air (1660). An account of experiments on flame, with the conclusion 'yt flame & vapour differ onely as bodys red hot & not red hot' (pp. 49-50), and that heat is 'made by division of parts: for when two particles are parted it makes ye æther rush in betwixt ym and so vibrate' (p. 51).

p. 51 'The Phosphorus': a recipe for making it from urine and sand. [pp. 53-60 blank]

pp. 61-5 'Of fformes & Transmutations wrought in them': notes from Boyle [The Origine of Formes and Qualities (1666)] with page references.

p. 65 Excerpts from Starkey's Pyrotechny Asserted [1658].

p. 66 Note on a petrifying spring in Peru, from a Spanish treatise on 'The Art of metals' translated by the Earl of Sandwich. [pp. 57-70 blank]

pp. 71-80 'Of Salts, & Sulphureous bodys, & Mercury & Mettalls': extracts from Boyle [The Origine of Formes and Qualities (1666)].

p. 80 Recipe for the extraction of mercury from the nitrate and from corrosive sublimate by various other metals.

pp. 81-2 Recipes for making regulus of antimony by different metals.

pp. 83-4 Notes of alloys which fuse at low temperatures, and others which give a crystalline mass from fusion. Notes on the reaction of various chemicals with salt, including that of tartarum vitriolatum ('it makes a great effervescence, and an earthy sediment is precipitated out of the salt of Tartar [...] This precipitate some ‹fools› call Magisterium Tartari Vitriolati' (p. 84)): reference to David Vonder Becke as an authority for this.

pp. 85-92 Notes and extracts mainly from various works of Boyle.

pp. 93-100 Various recipes and extracts on chemical reactions, chiefly from Boyle.

p. 101 Recipes for various preparations of antimony. Note of the action of corrosive sublimate on various ores.

p. 102-4 Notes of experiments on the preparation of regulus of antimony and the action of corrosive sublimate on antimony, silver, and mercury; of the heat produced by mixing oil of vitriol with water or spirit of wine [alcohol]; of the preparation of ether and oil of wine.

pp. 104-5 Notes on the warmth emitted on mixing water with spirit of antimony, and of various chemical reactions: the last (on saturation of spirit of antimony by different substances) has blanks left for the quantities.

pp. 106-7 Further chemical experiments. Note on the composition of fusible metal.

pp. 108-12 Chemical experiments chiefly on preparations of antimony and scoria of reguluses. 'N' [presumably 'N[ota]'] marked in the margin against several of these.

p. 113 Notes on the action of distilled liquor of antimony on salts of lead, iron and copper; action of heat on tartarised antimony.

p. 114 Notes on the action of spar on distilled liquor of antimony, vinegar, and aquafortis, and of salt from the clay of lead mines on the same; action of nitre on antimony.

pp. 115-16 Notes on the action of oil of vitriol on lead ore, and of an antimonial sublimate on several substances.

pp. 117-20 Experiments with 'ven. vol.' ['venus volans' or 'volatisata'].

p. 121 Deleted note in Latin that on 10, 14 and 15 May 1681 Newton comprehended various alchemical names.

p. 122 Another deleted note in Latin that on 18 May [presumably 1681] he finished deciphering the alchemical symbol of the 'caduceus' ['rod of mercury'], followed by experiments dated 10 June on sublimation of green and blue vitriol with sal ammoniac and of the resulting sublimate with lead ore.

pp. 123-6 Experiments dated May and June 1682 on sublimation of various salts with sal ammoniac, and various metals and alloys with sal ammoniac and with antimony.

pp. 127-30 Experiments dated 6 June and 4 July 1682 on obtaining regulus from a mixture of lead ores, antimony and bismuth; and others similar.

p. 131 Experiments on the action of various reguluses with an unspecified spirit [of salt?].

pp. 132-4 Further experiments on sublimation, with the date Tuesday 19 July [no year] at the top of p. 133.

pp. 135-9 Experiment dated 29 Feb. 1683/4 on the preparation of chlorides of mercury.

pp. 140-49 Various experiments relating to 'the net' [an elaborate alchemical concept for discussion of which see Dobbs, Foundations, 161-3]. One experiment (p. 149) is dated 'Friday May 23' [no year].

p. 150 Experiments on the spirit of zinc, dated 'Apr. 26, 1686 Wednesday'.

pp. 151-8 Experiments on alloys of copper, antimony and iron, incomplete here but resumed on p. 267.

pp. 159-167, 169-174, 177-182 (intermediate pages blank) Extracts, chiefly from Boyle but with others from Starkey and van Helmont, on 'The medical virtues of Saline & other Præparations'. [pp. 183-6 blank]

pp. 187-193 'Medical observations', principally drawn from Boyle. [pp. 194-206 blank]

p. 207 'Of volatile salts of Animal & vegetable substances': further extracts from Boyle. [p. 208 blank]

pp. 209-223 'Of Alcalia': extracts from Starkey's Pyrotechny Asserted (1658: H1553).

pp. 224-264 Largely blank, except for a series of headings (only two of which have any text attached), as follows: 'Gross Ingredients' (p. 227); 'ffirst preparation' (p. 229); '3 Principles' (p. 231); '4 Elements' (p. 233); 'Mercuries' (p. 235), 'Sulphurs' (p. 237); 'Salts' (p. 239); 'ffires' (p. 241); 'Of ye work wth common [gold]', followed by notes and excerpts from 'Philalethes'' Secrets Reveal'd and Snyders' Commentatio de pharmaco catholico, gaps being left for page references (pp. 243-4); 'Of ye work with artificial [gold]' (p. 245); 'Times' (p. 247); 'Proportions' (p. 249); 'Hieroglyphicks' (p. 251); 'Progress of ye Decoction' (p. 253); 'Vse of ye stone' (p. 257); 'Miscellanies' (p. 259) 'Of ye work with common sol.', followed by cryptic references to various works of 'Philalethes' (p. 261).

p. 265 Recipe for 'Spiritus dulcis Vitrioli' and notes on its medical uses, in Latin.

p. 266 ff. Three pages (two of which are unnumbered) of medical recipes.

pp. 267-283 Resumption of experimental reports from p. 158, with further similar experiments on regulus of antimony and various alloys, interspersed (p. 267) with an account [from an unidentified source] of a 'menstruum' for extracting the 'tinctures' of all metals). [cf. précis de symbolisme alchimique

, là encore, sur nombre de ces essais alchimiques.]

The rest of the book is blank apart from four pages at the end, which are taken up with notes of Newton's expenses on chemicals bought in 1687 while he was in London to appear before the Ecclesiastical Commission, similar chemical expenses in 1693, and notes on the preparation of sal ammoniac.

The first, primarily optical, section of the manuscript (to p. 22) is discussed in A.R. Hall, 'Further optical experiments of Isaac Newton', Annals of Science 11 (1955), 27-43, and transcribed in McGuire and Tamny, Certain Philosophical Questions, 466-89. Article 64 (on the optic nerve) was first published (with due acknowledgment) in Joseph Harris, Treatise on Optics (1775), 108-10, with a copy of the diagram in the plate following p. 110, and again from Harris's edition by Brewster (1855), 1: 432-6. Several extracts from the following pages printed in A.R. and M.B. Hall, 'Newton's chemical experiments'. Experiments on pp. 45-6 printed in Brewster (1855), 2: 366-7. pp. 81-2 printed in Dobbs, Foundations, 249-50. Full critical edition by Peter Spargo forthcoming [2002?]. See also H254-H276 for Newton's extensive Boyle collection.

XVIII. Mellon Alchemical Mss., Beinecke Library, Yale University, New Haven, Connecticut, USA Alchemical Material not in Chadwyck-Healey Microfilm Collection

• Mellon Ms. 78 (SL47 (Ms. 78.5) + ?) Six sets of notes on Newton's alchemical reading (c. late 1690s). Ms. 78.1

Extracts from Lull's 'Theorica' [the first part of his Testamentum] on the three principles of reduction, with notes on the extraction of gold starting at the other end of the page, 1 f. Written on the cover slip of a letter addressed 'ffor Mr Issiac Nuton mathematik Profesoor in Trenity colidg

cambridg'; remains of the original wax seal carry the initials 'IW'. [on pourra consulter l' Elucidation du Testament de Lulle.] Ms. 78.2

Single page with a list of thirty alchemical operations, in Latin, beginning:

'Opus 1. Vvarum præparatio ‹prima› manuaalis [sic] Opus 2 Fermentatio & putrefactio 3 Extractio et rectificatio spiritus' Ms. 78.3

Paper bifolium with forty-five brief headings from Lull, Aristotle and others, referring to alchemical operations, in Latin, on same paper as Ms. 78.6. (c. early 1690s). Ms. 78.4

Four leaves with a list of operations similar to those in Ms. 78.3. On f. 4v there is a reference to 'Centrum naturæ concentratum. Or ye salt of Nature regenerated. ffor ye most part improperly called ye Phers stone. Written in Arabic by Aliphi a Mauritanian born of Asiatick parents. Published in Low Dutch 1694 & now done in English 1696. Price bound 1s. Printed for Iohn Harris at the Harrow in little Brittain' (H25). Ms. 78.5

Paper bifolium with notes from Bloomfield, Flammel , ' Philalethes

' and Ripley's Medulla Alchimiæ on the 'Rod of Mercury', in English and Latin, 11 pp. f. 1r is headed 'De Virga [Mercurii]', with remarks in English from Bloomfield, Flammel, and 'Ayrenæus' [i.e. 'Eirenæus Philalethes']. Followed by five queries: 'What Lute for distilling O. Vitr.'; 'Whether ye Spt. in ye first degestion stink, & how soon, & with what odor'; 'How he contrives his Lamp', etc. Ms. 78.6

Paper bifolium cut to the same size as Ms. 78.3 containing a series of 'Observationes' beginning with 'Prima operatio est in mineris vivis, secunda in [mercurio] et metallis imperfectis'.

SL47 was bought at the Sotheby sale by 'Ulysses' (Jacob Schwartz?) for £11.10s.

Many pages of Ms. 78.6 printed in facsimile and transcript with further details in MacPhail, Alchemy and the Occult, 2: 470-78.

• Mellon Ms. 79 (SL36) Notes on the mining, preparation and properties of 'Saturn' [i.e. lead] (mid-1670s), mainly in English, c. 3,500 words, 8 pp.

Begins with excerpts from 'Philalethes'' The Marrow of Alchemy (1654: H1034), book 3, p. 1: 'Saturn though vile & base to see, is of oe secrets all ye ground. In [Saturn] is hid an immortal soul. Untie its fetters wch do it forbid to sight for to appear then shal arise a vapour shining like pearl orient. To Saturn Mars [i.e. iron] wth bonds of love is tied who is by him devourd of mighty force whose spirit divides saturns body & from both combined flow a wondrous bright water in wch ye Sun [i.e. gold] doth set & loos its light.' Further notes on lead from Webster's Metallographia: or, An History of Metals (1671: H1718), Georg Agricola's De Re Metallica (1621: H20), Boyle's Sceptical Chymist, Norton's 'Ordinall of Alchemy' [in Ashmole's Theatrum Chemicum Britannicum (1652: H93), 1-106], and Bloomfield's 'Compendiary of Alchemy'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale for £10.10s. by Pickering & Chatto. Acquired on 21 April 1943 by Mary Mellon from William Gannon, a New York bookseller.

Independently dated to mid-1670s by Dobbs (Alchemy and the Occult (1977 edition), 4: 479) and Shapiro ('Dating Game', 195). Only the 1680 edition of the Sceptical Chymist is known to have been in Newton's library (H270), but the work first appeared in 1661.

Printed in facsimile and transcript in MacPhail, Alchemy and the Occult, 2: 479-83. More Bloomfield in Keynes Ms. 15. See H1034, 1718, 20, 270, 93.

• Mellon Ms. 80 (SL117) Incomplete copy, in (probably) the author's hand, of a six-chapter version of William Yworth's 'Processus Mysterii Magni Philosophicus' (1702), in English, 91 pp.

Prefaced by 'A short Epistle to my Children'. Dated 1702 on f. 6r, and signed 'Wiliam Yarworth V.D.' on ff. 7r and 9v.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Heffers for £3.10s.

Cf. Keynes Mss. 65, 66 and 91, and Hampshire Record Office Ms. NC17. On Yworth generally and his association with Newton, see Figala and Petzold, 'Alchemy in the Newtonian circle', esp. p. 187 for this manuscript. See also 'McPhail, Alchemy and the Occult, 4: 484-6, where the manuscript is incorrectly identified as SL116 (which is in fact Hampshire Record Office Ms. NC17: Figala and Petzold are also mistaken in describing the whereabouts of SL116 as unknown (pp. 180, n. 25 and 187, n. 60)).

This is the only known instance of this author calling himself 'Yarworth': in all his other printed or manuscript material he appears as 'Yworth', 'Y-worth' or 'Y.worth'. This has often been taken as an abbrevation of 'Yarworth', but Figala and Petzold suggest ('Alchemy in the Newtonian circle', 181-2) that it may rather be an anglicisation of a Dutch form such as Ijvaert, as the author was by his own account Dutch by birth.

XIX. Joseph Halle Schaffner Collection, Chicago University Library, Chicago, Illinois, USA Alchemical Material not in Chadwyck-Healey Microfilm Collection

• (SL27) Notes on the construction of portable furnaces, c. 300 words, 2 pp., with rough sketches, 1 p.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by William H. Robinson for £24; subsequent history unclear.

• (SL46) Variant version of the memorandum in Keynes Ms. 26 (SL45), in English, 1 p.; on reverse, the draft of a short letter.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by William H. Robinson for £20; subsequent history unclear.

• (SL79) Technical notes, c. 3,000 words, 2 pp.

A summary of the operations and technique of pyrotechny, analysed and arranged in tabular form, with details of various pieces of apparatus and directions for the construction and working of furnaces, illustrated by six diagrams.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by William H. Robinson for £29; subsequent history unclear.

XX. Rare Book and Manuscript Library, Columbia University, New York, USA

Alchemical Manuscripts not on Chadwyck-Healey Microfilm

• (Part of SL103?) Commentary on Monte Snyder's alchemy (after 1678), in Latin, c. 1,000 words, 3 pp.

A commentary on the Tractatus de medicina universali (1678) of Johann de Monte Snyders.

Received as a gift from the Friends of the Columbia Libraries. SL103, described in the Sotheby catalogue as 'A Key to Snyders [in Latin] about 1000 words, on 3 pp.; Sententiæ notabilii expositiæ, about 1400 words, on 4 pp.', was bought at the Sotheby sale by Emanuel Fabius for £6. This sounds remarkably like the first part of that lot, though none of the material bought by Fabius is otherwise known to have entered the public domain. If this is not part of SL103 itself, it is certainly related to it. One page reproduced at

www.columbia.edu/acis/textarchive/rare/40.html

. See the entry for SL103 (whereabouts unknown); also Keynes Ms. 58 and Cushing/Whitney Medical Library, Yale University.

XXI. Alchemical manuscripts whose location is currently unknown Alchemical Material not in Chadwyck-Healey Microfilm Collection

• (SL18) Four pages of miscellaneous alchemical notes.

a) Notes on 'Terra Lemnia & Terra Sigillata [...] sold in but one shop in London [...] for 2s. 6d. per pound', and its distillation products, c. 230 words, 1 p. At the foot, a note: 'Mr. Leibnitz is Counsellor to ye Elector of Brunswick. Mr. Fatio has no correspondence with him. This direction will find him out. Cl. viro D. G. G. Leibnitio Hannoveræ'.

b) 'De Peste' (notes from Van Helmont), c. 650 words, 2 pp.

c) Notes on 'Roth Mallor's work', c. 250 words, 1 p. [

A titre personnel, nous considérons que cette note sur la terre sigillée doit avoir une grande importance, sous l'angle de la symbolique alchimique, cf. 1 , 2 , 3 .]

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Pickering & Chatto for £9.10.

See H751 for Newton's copy of Van Helmont's medical compendium.

• (SL22) Extracts from 'Faber' (probably Pierre Jean Fabré) and other alchemical writers, in Latin and English, c. 7,000 words, 22 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £15. See H598.

• (SL29) Notes from Fabré's 'Hercula Piochymico', c. 1,300 words, 4 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £5.10s. See H598.
• (SL39) Notes 'Ex Codicillo

R. Lullii, impress. Coloniæ 1563', c. 3,000 words, 6 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Davis & Orioli for £6. Cf. Babson Ms. 747, and see H997.

• (SL49) Notes on mercury and its purification, c. 350 words, 1 p.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Bernard Quaritch for £6.

• (SL54) Verse extracts from Hadrian Mynsicht, 'Aureum sæculum redivivum' and 'Testamentum Hadrianeum de aureo Phorem [according to the Sotheby catalogue, though 'Ph[ilosoph]orum is surely intended] lapide', with a diagram, c. 300 lines in all, 8 pp. [sur Mynsicht, cf. 1 , 2 , 3 , 4 , 5 .]

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £9.

See H1137 for Newton's copy of another work by Mynsicht.

• (SL57) 'Notanda chemica': notes on 'Philalethes', Ripley, Maier and other writers, c. 1,500 words, 4 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £9. • (SL60) Notes 'Ex Turba Philosophorum ', over 2,000 words, 6 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £8.10s.

• (SL67) 'Opus Galli Anonymi': notes and excerpts, with the comment: 'Simile est hoc opus operi Fabri', c. 2,750 words, 8 pp. + wrapper.

Includes the chapter headings: 'Practica'; 'De Igne'; 'Multiplicatio'; 'Facere aurum potabile'.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £13.10s.

• (SL75) 'Preparatio Mercurii ad Lapidem per Regulam et Lunam, ex MSS. Phi. [pres. 'Phi[losophi]'] Americani', c. 1,000 words, 6 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £10.

• (SL78) 'The Three Mysterious Fires', mainly in English, c. 1,200 words, 3 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £19.10s. [

sur les différents feus de l'oeuvre, cf. Atalanta XXVIII et La

Lumière sortant par soy-même des Ténèbres]

Cf. Keynes Ms. 46. Half a page reproduced in facsimile in the Sotheby catalogue, between pp. 12 and 13.

• (Part of SL81) Six pages of miscellaneous notes originally grouped together with what is now Babson Ms. 747.

The complete lot was bought at the Sotheby sale by Francis Edwards for £9.10s.

• (SL88) Three pages of alchemical recipes: for making 'Regulus Martis' (an alloy of iron and antimony), c. 300 words, 1 p.; for making aqua fortis and for refining silver (these in John Conduitt's hand), 1 p.; 'Experimentum Bellini', 1 p.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Pickering & Chatto for £5.

• (SL96) Notes from Schroeder's 'Pharmocopœia' with other fragmentary notes, 10 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £7.

See H1473 for Newton's copy of another work by Schroeder.

• (SL103) Key to [Johann de Monte] Snyders, in Latin, c. 1,000 words, 3 pp.; 'Sententiæ notabilii expositiæ' [according to the Sotheby catalogue, though 'expositæ' is surely intended], c. 1,400 words, 4 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £6.

The first part of this lot may be the manuscript now in the Rare Book and Manuscript Library, Columbia University (q.v.). Cf. Keynes Ms. 58 and Cushing/Whitney Medical Library, Yale University.

• (SL104) Notes on sublimation, the Stone, the tincture, etc., in Latin, c. 1,500 words, 6 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Maggs Brothers for £7.10s.

• (SL109) Fragment of a treatise on transmutation, containing several drawings of processes, one occupying a whole page, in English, c. 2,200 words, 8 pp.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Emmanuel Fabius for £10.10s.

• (SL115) 'Notes upon ye working of ---': an account of a purification of vitriol, which took 6 months to accomplish, c. 350 words, 1 p.

On the reverse: seven 'Quares' [leg. 'Quæres'?], and notes of various sums owing to Newton, dated 1673-77.

Bought at the Sotheby sale by Davis & Orioli for £5.

XXII. Alchemical Newton's Printed Sources [

il s'agit des titres que devait compter la bibliothèque alchimique de Newton ; d'après Cambridge University Press on John Harrison, The Library of Isaac Newton

(Cambridge: CUP, 1978). Les titres que nous avons commentés sont indiqués en lien hypertexte.] [H20]

Agricola, Georg. De re metallica libri XII ... Ejusdem De animantibus subterraneis liber ... F°, Basileæ, 1621. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.11.4 [H84]

Ars chemica, quod sit licita recte exercentibus, probationes doctissimorum iurisconsultorum. Septem tractatus seu capitula Hermetis Trismegisti, aurei. Eiusdem Tabula Smaragdina , in ipsius sepulchro inuenta, cum commento Hortulani Philosophi

. Studium Consilii conjugij de massa solis & lunæ ... 8°, [Argentorati, 1566]. (Short notes by Newton in margins and texts of pp.9-13, 15, 21, 22, 29-31, 48, 92, 128, 129, mostly references to alchemical books; many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.145 [H90]

Artis auriferae, quam chemiam vocant, volumina duo, quæ continent Turbam philosophorum

, aliosq[ue] antiquiss. auctores ... Accessit noviter volumen tertium ... 8°, Basileæ, 1610. (Notes and references by Newton mainly relating to other alchemical works on verso of title-page of vol. 1, in vol. 1, pp.20, 21, 68, on verso of title-page of vol. 2, in vol. 2, pp.6, 23, 24, 99, 111, 158, 190, 245, 275; many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.121 [on rappelle que la version de la Tourbe

disposée sur le site n'est qu'une traduction mal faite de Salmon, cf. Girardin, Alchimie , Belfond, 1972] [H93]

Ashmole, Elias. Theatrum chemicum Britannicum. Containing severall poeticall pieces of our famous English philosophers, who have written the Hermetique mysteries in their owne ancient language ... 4°, London, 1652. (Numerous corrections, additions and references by Newton; several signs of dog-earing.) Van Pelt Library, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia. [disponible sur le serveur Gallica de la bnf] [H103]

Aurifontina chymica: or, A collection of fourteen small treatises concerning the first matter of philosophers, for the discovery of their, hitherto so much concealed, mercury ... 24°, London, 1680. (Notes and references by Newton relating to other alchemical works in margins of pp.21, 93, 123, 124, 131, 147; a few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.119

[H110] Bacon, Roger. De arte chymiæ scripta. Cui accesserunt opuscula alia eiusdem authoris. 12°, Francofurti, 1603. (Notes and page references by Newton relating to other alchemical works on fly-leaf and pp.43-4.) Tr/NQ.16.120 [cf. introduction à l'oeuvre de Roger Bacon] [H115]

Barba, Alvaro Alonso. The first book of the Art of mettals, in which is declared the manner of their generation; and the concomitants of them. Written in Spanish. Transl. into English ... 8°, London, 1670. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.143(2) [H127]

Basilius Valentinus. Azoth, ou Le moyen de faire l'or caché des philosophes. Reveu, corrigé & augmenté par Mr. L'Agneau Medecin. 8°, Paris, 1659. Tr/NQ.16.124(1) [H128]

__ Basilius Valentinus Friar of the Order of St. Benedict his last will and testament ... (6 pts.) 8°, London, [1656-]1657. (Pt 2 has a correction by Newton in text of p.7 and references by him in margins of p.13 to 'Maier. Embl. 24, p.70' and p.16 to 'Maier. Embl. 54, p. 150'; many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.135 [H129] __ Basil Valentine his Triumphant chariot of antimony

, with annotations of T. Kirkringius ... 8°, London, 1678. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.97 [H130] __ Les douze clefs de philosophie

. Plus l'Azoth, ou Le moyen de faire l'or caché des philosophes. Traduction françoise. 8°, Paris, 1660. Tr/NQ.16.124(3) [H145]

Becher, Johann Joachim. Actorum Laboratorii Chymici Monacensis, seu Physicæ subterraneæ libri II ... 8°, Francofurti, 1681. (pp.475, 506, 526, 780 turned up and a few other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.96 [sur Becher, cf. Histoire de la Chimie

de F. Hoefer critiquée par E. Chevreul et un Résumé de l'Histoire de la Matière , par E. Chevreul.] [H157]

Bellini, Lorenzo. De urinis et pulsibus, de missione sanguinis, de febribus, de morbis capitis, et pectoris. 4°, Francofurti, 1685. (p.165 turned up and a few other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.8.53 [H221]

Bibliothèque des philosophes (chymiques)

, ou Recueil des oeuvres des auteurs les plus approuvez qui ont écrit de la pierre philosophale ... Par Le Sieur S.D.E.M. [i.e. Walter Salmon]. 2 vols. 12°, Paris, 1672-8. Tr/NQ.16.94 [vol. 1 only] [H225]

Bizot, Pierre. Histoire metallique de la République de Hollande. Nouv. éd. augmentée. 2 vols. & suppl. (3 vols.) 8°, Amsterdam, 1688-90. (A few signs of dog-earing in the set.) Tr/NQ.9.149 to 151 [H245]

Boot, Anselmus Boetius de. Gemmarum et lapidum historia. Quam olim edidit A.B. de Boot. Nunc vero recensuit, à mendis repurgavit, commentariis ... A. Toll. 8°, Lugduni Batavorum, 1636. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.85 [

des titres de Anselme de Boot sont disponibles sur le serveur Gallica de la bnf] [H250]

Borrichius, Olaus. De ortu, et progressu chemiæ, dissertatio. 4°, Hafniæ, 1668. (Several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.92 [H259]

Boyle, Robert. Essays of the strange subtilty, determinate nature, great efficacy of effluviums ... (4 pts.) 8°, London, 1673. (Inscribed at foot of title-page: 'For Mr Isaac Newton from the Authour' in Oldenburg's hand; many signs of dog-earing. Newton acknowledged to Oldenburg receipt of Boyle's gift on 14 Sept. 1673 (NC, 1: 305).) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison [sur Boyle, cf. Hist. Chim .] [H265]

__ Medicina hydrostatica: or, Hydrostaticks applyed to the materia medica ... 8°, London, 1690. ('A Table of refractions given to me by Mr. Halley' in Newton's hand on fly-leaves; notes and corrections by him on unnumbered pages at back of book, relating to a 'Table of specific gravities'; 24 pages turned down or up.) Turner Collection, University of Keele Library [H269]

__ New experiments physico-mechanicall, touching the spring of the air, and its effects ... 8°, Oxford, 1660. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.69 [H270]

__ The sceptical chymist: or Chymico-physical doubts & paradoxes ... (2 pts.) 8°, Oxford, 1680. (Pt 1 has pp.40, 134 turned down and up, pp.213, 399, 405 up, pp.260, 279, 359, 367, 369, 400, 402, 409 down; pt 2 has pp.18, 118, 152, 235 up, pp.19, 259 down and many other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.84 [H275]

__ Tracts, containing new experiments, touching the relation betwixt flame and air. And about explosions. An hydrostatical discourse occasion'd by some objections of Dr. Henry More ... 8°, London, 1672. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.100 [H331]

Caesius, Bernardus. Mineralogia, sive Naturalis philosophiæ thesauri ... F°, Lugduni, 1636. (pp.66, 201 turned down, p.189 up.) Tr/NQ.18.4 [H340]

Caneparius, Petrus Maria. De atramentis cujuscunque generis ... In sex descriptiones digestum. 4°, Londini, 1660. (pp.193, 517 turned down and many other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.7.56 [H397]

Claveus, Gasto, called Dulco. Apologia Chrysopoeiæ et Argyropoeiæ, adversus T. Erastum ... De triplici auri et argenti præparatione. 8°, Ursellis, 1602. (p.207 turned down and a few other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.152 [sur Gaston Claves, dit Dulco, cf. 1 , 2 , 3 , 4 , 5 , 6 , 7 ,] [H419]

Colson, Lancelot. Philosophia maturata: an exact piece of philosophy, containing the practick and operative part thereof in gaining the philosophers stone ... 24°, London, 1668. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison [H436]

Conti, Luigi de'. Clara fidelisqu. admonitoria disceptatio practicæ manualis experimento veraciter comprobata. De duobus artis, & naturæ miraculis: hoc est de liquore alchaest; nec non lapide philosophico ... 12°, Francofurti, 1664. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison [H437]

__ Discours philosophiques sur les deux merveilles de l'art et de la nature. Ou Traité de la liqueur de l'Alchaest ... 2e éd., reveüe &

corrigée. 12°, Paris, 1678. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.110 [H445] Cosmopolite, ou Nouvelle lumière chimique

, pour servir d'éclaircissement aux trois principes de la nature ... [By Michael Sendivogius.] Dernière éd., revue et augmentée ... 2 vols. 12°, Paris, 1691. [sur le vrai Cosmopolite, cf. Alexandre Sethon .] [H462]

Crollius, Oswaldus. Basilica chymica cum notis Hartmanni, et Praxis chymiatrica ... 4°, Francofurti, 1647. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.81(1) [sur Oswald Crollius, cf 1 , 2 , 3 , 4 , 5 ,]

[H493] De alchimia opuscula complura veterum philosophorum, quorum catalogum sequens pagella indicabit. (Pt 1.) 4°, [Francoforti, 1550]. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Sir Geoffrey Keynes, Brinkley [H513]

Dickinson, Edmund. Epistola ad Theodorum Mundanum philosophum adeptum. De quintessentia philosophorum et de vera physiologia ... 8°, Oxoniæ, 1686. (Notes by Newton consisting of references to other alchemical works in margins of pp.70, 180, 187; many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.89 [H554]

Enarratio methodica Trium Gebri medicinarum, in quibus continetur Lapidis philosophici vera confectio. Autore Anonymo sub nomine Æyrenæi Philalethes. 8°, [London,] 1678. [The real author of the Enarratio is not, as Harrison tentatively conjectures, G. Starkey, though this 1678 edition does contain two short tracts written by him under his pseudonym Eirenæus Philalethes: see Newman, Gehennical Fire, 268, entry 19 in his Starkey bibliography.] (Note in Newton's hand on title-page: 'Vide Borelli Bibliothecam Chemicam p.20' [i.e. Pierre Borel, Bibliotheca chimica (Paris, 1654: H426), where there is a reference to this work]; p.212 turned up and several other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.86 [H598]

Fabré, Pierre Jean. Operum voluminibus duobus exhibitorum volumen prius [& II]. (Vol. 2 with title Opera reliqua volumine hoc posteriore comprehensa.) 4°, Francofurti ad Moenum, 1652. (On the fly-leaf of vol.1, a list in Newton's hand of eleven of Fabré's published works under the heading 'Author opera sua hoc ordine impressit', and added at the

end: 'Desumpta sunt hæc ex Libris ipsis impressis in Bibliotheca Bodleiana Oxonij'. Vol.1 has pp.37, 558, 575, 657, 686, 692 turned down, p.690 turned down and up, pp.44, 555, 685, 691 up; vol.2 pp.51, 759, 881 down, pp.62, 422, 854, 882 up, with many other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.9.174 and 175 [H605]

The fame and confession of the Fraternity of R:C: commonly, of the Rosie Cross ... By Eugenius Philalethes. [i.e. T. Vaughan, in fact the translator rather than the author, though he did supply a preface]. 8°, London, 1652. ('Is. Newton. Donum Mri Doyley' in Newton's hand on fly-leaf. Notes by Newton on the Rosicrucians on fly-leaf and in margin of p.4: see Macphail, Alchemy and the Occult, 2: 347-9, where the notes are reproduced in full.) Beinecke Library, Yale [H649]

Garland, John. Compendium alchimiæ: cum dictionario eiusdem artis ... Omnia nunc primum in lucem edita. 8°, Basileæ, 1560. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.137(2) [H657]

Geber. Chimia, sive Traditio summæ perfectionis et investigatio magisterii, innumeris locis emendata à C. Hornio ... Accessit ejusdem Medulla alchimiæ Gebricæ, omnia edita à G. Hornio. 24°, Lugduni Batavorum, 1668. (Two closely written pages of Latin notes by Newton on the fly-leaves, giving his rendering of Geber's terms into contemporary versions.) Barchas Collection, Stanford University Library, QD 25 G367 (see entry under Stanford in main catalogue) [H658]

__ Works of Geber, the most famous Arabian Prince and philosopher ... Englished by R. Russel. 8°, London, 1678. [H659]

__ The works of Geber, the most famous Arabian Prince and philosopher of the investigation and perfection of the philosophers-stone. 8°, London, 1686. Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison. [H740]

Harmoniæ inperscrutabilis chymico-philosophicæ, sive Philosophorum antiquorum consentientium ... decas I[-II]. [By J. Grasshoff and Johannes Rhenanus.] (2 pts.) 8°, Francofurti, 1625. (Notes and

references by Newton all relating to Zetzner's Theatrum chemicum, vols. 4 & 5, in margins of pt 1, pp.205, 228, pt.2, pp.324, 338; pt.2, p.326 turned down and several other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.122 [H751]

Helmont, Jan Baptista van. Ortus medicinæ, id est initia physicæ inaudita ... edente F.M. van Helmont ... Ed. 4a. F°, Lugduni, 1667 [H752]

Helvetius, Johann Friedrich. The golden calf which the world adores, and desires: in which is handled the most rare and incomparable wonder of nature, in transmuting metals ... 12°, London, 1670. (Several signs of dog-earing.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison [H838]

Introitus apertus ad occlusum regis palatium

: autore Anonymo Philaletha [i.e. G. Starkey] ... nunc primum publicatus, curante J. Langio. 8°, Amstelodami, 1667. [H938]

Lemery, Nicolas. A course of chymistry ... 3rd ed., transl. from the 8th ed. in the French ... 8°, London, 1698. (pp.165, 172, 210, 255, 265, 283, 296, 297 turned up, pp.167, 176, 182, 254, 262, 266, 317 down, and many other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.8.118 [H939]

__ Traité de l'antimoine, contenant l'analyse chymique de ce minéral, & un recueil d'un grand nombre d'opérations ... 12°, Paris, 1707. (Several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.128 [H994]

Lull, Raymund. Ars magna, generalis et ultima ... 8°, Francofurti, 1596. Tr/NQ.10.70 . [H995]

__ De secretis naturæ sive Quinta essentia libri II. His accesserunt, Alberti Magni Summi philosophi, De mineralibus & rebus metallicis libri V ... 8°, [Argentorati,] 1541. [H996]

__ De secretis naturæ, seu De quinta essentia liber unus ... 8°, Coloniæ, 1567. [H997]

__ Liber, qui codicillus, seu vade mecum inscribitur, in quo fontes alchimicæ artis & reconditioris philosophiæ traduntur ... 8°, Coloniæ, 1563. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.133 [H998]

__ Mercuriorum liber iam tandem subsidio manuscripti exemplaris perfectè editus. Item eiusdem Apertorium, Repertorium, Artis intellectivæ theorica & practica, Magia naturalis ... 8°, Coloniæ Agrippinæ, 1567. [H999]

__ Opera ea quæ ad adinventam ab ipso artem universalem, scientiarum artiumque omnium brevi compendio ... 8°, Argentorati, 1609. [H1000]

__ Raymundi Lullii Maioricani philosophi sui temporis doctissimi libelli aliquot chemici: nunc primùm, excepto Vade mecum, in lucem opera Doctoris Toxitæ editi ... 8°, Basileæ, 1572. (References by Newton to other works by Lull: in margins of p.7 'Ars magica p.378, 379', p.159 'Vide Lib. Merc. p.156 l.11 & p.179 l.16'; many signs of dog-earing). Tr/NQ.16.37 [H1001]

__ Tractatus brevis et eruditus, De conservatione vitæ: item Liber secretorum seu quintæ essentiæ ... 8°, Argentorati, 1616. [H1003]

La Lumière sortant par soy même des tenebres

, ou Véritable théorie de la pierre des philosophes ... [Variously attributed to M.-A. Crassellame and O. Tachenius.] 8°, Paris, 1687. (p.206 turned down and many other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.117 [H1034]

The Marrow of alchemy, being an experimental treatise, discovering the secret and most hidden mystery of the philosophers elixer ... By Eirenæus Philoponos Philalethes [i.e. G. Starkey]. 8°, London, 1654. (Many signs of dog-earing. See Duveen, Bibliotheca Alchemica et Chemica, 563.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison. [H1044]

Mayer, Michael. Lusus serius: or, Serious passe-time. A philosophicall discourse concerning the superiority of creatures under man. 12°,

London, 1654. [sur Michel Maier, cf. Atalanta fugiens] [H1045]

__ Secretioris naturæ secretorum scrutinium chymicum, per oculis et intellectui accuratè accommodata ... ingeniosissima emblemata ... 4°, Francofurti, 1687. (Newton added the references 'p.8, 82' in margin of p.111 and 'cap. 67' on p.146; many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.88

[H1046] __ Septimana philosophica, qua ænigmata aureola de omni naturæ genere ... 4°, Francofurti, 1620. [H1047]

__ Silentium post clamores, hoc est, Tractatus aplogeticus, quo causæ non solùm clamorum seu Reuelationum Fraternitatis Germanicæ de R.C. sed & silentii ... 8°, Francofurti, 1617. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.19.148(2) [H1048]

__ Symbola aureæ mensæ duodecim nationum ... 4°, Francofurti, 1617. (A few signs of dog-earing.) S.M. Edelstein Collection, Jewish National & University Library, Jerusalem [H1049]

__ Themis aurea; hoc est, De legibus Fraternitatis R.C. tractatus ... 8°, Francofurti, 1618. (In a note at the foot of p.160 Newton deciphered the last 7 lines of text, printed in code, and added the key he used.) Tr/NQ.10.148(4) [H1050]

__ Tractatus de volucri arborea, absque patre et matre, in Insulis Orcadum, forma anserculorum proueniente ... 8°, Francofurti, 1619. (p.136 turned down and a few other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.148(1) [H1051]

__ Verum inventum, hoc est, Munera Germaniæ; ab ipsa primitus reperta ... & reliquo orbi communicata ... 8°, Francofurti, 1619. Tr/NQ.10.1483 [H1052]

__ Viatorium, hoc est, De montibus planetarum septem seu metallorum ... 8°, Rothomagi, 1651. [H1119]

Morhof, Daniel Georg. De metallorum transmutatione ad ... J. Langelottum ... epistola. 8°, Hamburgi, 1673. (Several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.126 [H1130]

Musaeum Hermeticum omnes sopho-spagyricae artis discipulos fidelissime erudiens. 4°, Francofurti, 1625. (Imperfect, wants title-page and pp.1-35 (Lambspring's De lapide philosophorum

); pp.231, 353 turned down and several other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.115 [H1131]

Musæum Hermeticum reformatum et amplificatum

, omnes sopho-spagyricæ artis discipulos fidelissimè erudiens ... Continens tractatos chimicos XXI ... 4°, Francofurti, [1677-]1678. (pp.132, 150, 239 turned down, p.278 up, and several other signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.148 [H1137]

Mynsicht, Hadrianus. Thesaurus et armamentarium medico-chymicum ... Cui in fine adiunctum est Testamentum Hadrianeum de aureo philosophorum lapide. 8°, Rothomagi, 1651. (A few signs of dog-earing). Tr/NQ.8.68 [H1138]

Mystagogus, Cleidophorus [i.e. W. Yworth], Mercury's Caducean rod: or The great and wonderful office of the universal mercury, or God's Viceregent, displayed ... By Cleidophorus Mystagogus. 8°, London, 1702. Probably the book sent to Newton by the author in 1702: see NC, 7: 441, where the work referred to in Yworth's [or Yarworth's, as he is called there] undated letter is tentatively (and wrongly) identified as his The complete distiller ... 2nd ed., 1705, though Newton is only known to have owned the 1st ed., 1692 [H1760]. See notes to Keynes Ms. 65 in main catalogue, and Figala and Petzold, 'Alchemy in the Newtonian Circle' for clarification of the issue. Note by Newton on fly-leaf: 'Willis his search of causes p.3, 21. Sanguis naturæ p.10 & Epistle p.27. Philadelphia p.13' (page references to works quoted in the text); many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.131(1) [H1180]

Norton, Samuel. Alchymiæ complementum, et perfectio, seu Modus et processus argumentandi ... ab E. Deano auctior & perfectior editus ... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(7) [cf. l

'Enfant Hermaphrofite du Soleil et de la Lune .] [H1181]

__ Catholicon physicorum, seu Modus conficiendi tincturam physicam & alchymicam ... editus labore & industriâ E. Deani... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. (A few signs of dog-earing) Tr/NQ.16.101(2) [H1182]

__ Elixer, seu Medicina vitae, seu Modus conficiendi verum aurum et argentum ... editus industriâ, & operâ E. Deani ... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(3) [H1183]

__ Mercurius redivivus, seu Modus conficiendi lapidem philosophicum ... editus opera & studio E. Deani .. auctior & perfectior. 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(1) [H1184]

__ Metamorphosis lapidum ignobilium in gemmas quasdam pretiosas, seu Modus transformandi perlas parvas, et minutulas, in magnas & nobiles ... editus diligentia E. Deani ... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(5) [H1185]

__ Saturnus saturatus dissolutus, et coelo restitutus, seu Modus componendi lapidem philosophicum ... vero edente E. Deano, ... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(6) [H1186]

__ Tractatulus de antiquorum scriptorum considerationibus in alchymia ... editus studio, labore & industriâ E. Deani ... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(8) [H1187]

__ Venus vitriolata, in elixer conversa ... sivè Modus conficiend lapidem philosophicum ... editus studiis, & diligentiâ E. Deani ... 4°, Francofurti, 1630. Tr/NQ.16.101(4) [H1192] Novum lumen chymicum

. E naturæ fonte & manuali experientia depromptum: cui accessit Tractatus de sulphure ... [By M. Sendivogius.] 8°, Genevæ, 1639. (Annotations by Newton on pp.36, 97, 116; pp. 45, 47, 67, 69, 75, 79, 88 turned down and a few other signs of dog-earing.) British Library/C.113.aa.3.(1.) [H1208]

Opuscula quædem chemica. G. Riplei Medulla philosophiæ chemicæ [etc.] ... Omnia partim ex veteribus manuscriptis eruta partim restituta ... 8°, Francofurti, 1614. [H1238] Paracelsus

. Aurora thesaurusque philosophorum, Theophrasti Paracelsi, Germani philosophi, & Medici præ cunctis omnibus accuratissimi. Accessit Monarchia physica per G. Dorneum ... 8°, Basileæ, 1577. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.9.170(2) [H1239]

__ Congeries Paracelsicæ chemiæ de transmutationibus metallorum, ex omnibus quæ de his ab ipso scripta reperire licuit hactenus. Accessit genealogia mineralium, atq[ue] metallorum omnium, eiusdem autoris. G. Dorneo interprete. 8°, Francofurti, 1581. (Several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.9.170(1) [H1296]

Philadelphia, or Brotherly love to the studious in the hermetick art ... Written by Eyreneus Philoctetes. 12°, London, 1694. [The author is probably not, as Harrison tentatively conjectures, G. Starkey: not listed in Newman's bibliography of Starkey's pseudonymous publications, Gehennical Fire, 262-70.] [H1301]

Philosophiæ chymicæ IV. vetustissima scripta, I. Senioris Zadith F. Hamuellis Tabula chymica. II. Innominati philosophi Expositio tabulæ chymicæ. III. Hermetis Trismegisti Liber de compositione. IV. Anonymi veteris philosophi Consilium coniugii ... Omnia ex Arabico sermone Latina facta, & nunc primum in lucem producta. 8°, Francofurti, 1605. (Long index-note by Newton on fly-leaf headed 'Authores a Seniore citati' and listing 18 authors with page numbers for each, ranging from one reference to twenty (for 'Hermes'), also short references to other writers on pp.2-5, 47, 98, 114, 117-19, 124, 133, 207; several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.136 [H1302]

A Philosophical epistle, discovering the unrevealed mystery of the three fires of the Sophi. [Signed Cloidophorus Mystagogus, i.e. W. Yworth.] 8°, [c. 1702]. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.131(2) [H1309]

Philosophie naturelle de trois anciens philosophes renommez: Artephius

, Flamel, & Synesius, traitant de l'art occulte, & de la transmutation metallique. Dernière éd. [of Trois traitez de la philosophie naturelle ...]. 4°, Paris, 1682. (pp.21, 31 turned down and several other signs of

dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.93 [titre disponible sur le serveur Gallica de la bnf.] [H1310] __ [Another copy.] Tr/NQ.16.77(5) [H1311]

La philosophie naturelle restablie en sa pureté

. Où l'on void à découvert toute l'œconomie de la nature, & où se manifestent quantité d'erreurs de la philosophie ancienne ... [By J. d'Espagnet.] 8°, Paris, 1651. (A few signs of dog-earing) Tr./NQ.10.81 [H1378]

Reconditorium ac reclusorium opulentiæ sapientiæque numinis mundi magni, cui deditur in titulum Chymica vannus ... (With Commentatio de pharmaco catholico ...) [By J. de Monte Snyder.] (2 pts.) 4°, Amstelodami, 1666. (Many page and line references by Newton in margin of pt 2, pp.12, 13, 15, 19, 20, 29, 48, 66, 68, 72, 75; several signs of dog-earing in pt 2.) Tr/NQ.16.80 [H1397]

Rhenanus, Johannes Opera chymiatrica, quæ hactenus in lucem prodierunt omnia à plurimis ... 8°, Francofurti, 1668. Tr/NQ.8.90 [H1405] Ripley

, George. Opera omnia chemica, quotquot hactenus visa sunt ... 8°, Cassellis, 1649. (Notes by Newton, mainly references to alchemical books, on pp. 18, 101, 123, 171, 383, 401; several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.149 [H1407]

Ripley reviv'd: or, An exposition upon Sir George Ripley's hermetico-poetical works ... Written by Eirenæus Philalethes [i.e. G. Starkey] ... 8°, London, [1677]-1678. [H1445]

Sanguis naturæ, or, A manifest declaration of the sanguine and solar congealed liquor of nature. By Anonimus [i.e. C. Grummet]. 8°, London, 1696. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.172 [H1446]

__ [Another copy.] (Note in Newton's hand inserted: 'Sanguis Naturæ, at Sowles [the bookseller] a Quaker Widdow in White Hart Court at ye upper end of Lombard Street'; many signs of dog-earing.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison. [H1473]

Schroeder, Johann. Quercetanus redivivus, hoc est, Ars medica dogmatico-hermetica, ex scriptis J. Quercetani ... Ed. 2a. 3 vols. in 1. 4°, Francofurti, 1679. [

Fulcanelli considérait que seuls Quercetanus et Nicolas Valois avaient révélé le secret de « l'or alchimique ».] [H1478] Secrets reveal'd: or,

An open entrance to the shut-palace of the King

... by ... Anonymous, or Eyræneus Philaletha Cosmopolita [i.e. G. Starkey] ... 8°, London, 1669. (Heavily annotated and corrected throughout by Newton with some margins completely filled with notes; many signs of dog-earing. See Duveen, Bibliotheca Alchemica et Chemica, 470 and plate XII.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison (see entry under Wisconsin-Madison in main catalogue) [H1485] Sendivogius, Michael

. A new light of alchymie ... Also nine books of the nature of things, written by Paracelsus ... Also a chymicall dictionary ... Transl. out of the Latin ... by J. F[rench]. 3 pts. 4°, London, 1650. (Several signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.130 [H1553]

Starkey, George. Pyrotechny asserted and illustrated, to be the surest and safest means for art's triumph over nature's infirmities ... 8°, London, 1658. [H1608] Theatrum chemicum

, præcipuos selectorum auctorum tractatus de chemiæ et lapidis philosophici antiquitate, veritate, jure, præstantia, & operationibus, continens ... [Ed. by L. Zetzner etc.] 6 vols. 8°, Argentorati, 1659-61. (Numerous annotations, textual corrections and references by Newton in vols. 1, 3-6, with vols. 3 and 5 very copiously annotated; very many pages turned down: see Sotheran Catalogue 800 (1926: Item 12098), and catalogue of Hampton & Sons, Thame Park, Oxfordshire (1920: Item 978).) [H1619]

Le Tombeau de la pauvreté. Dans lequel il est traité clairement de la transmutation des metaux ... Par un philosophe inconnu [i.e. d'Atremont] ... 12°, Paris, 1673. (A few signs of dog-earing.)

Tr/NQ.16.109 [H1623]

Tractatus aliquot chemici singulares summum philosophorum arcanum continentes. 1. Liber de principiis naturæ, & artis chemicæ, incerti authoris. 2. Johannis Belye Angli tractatulus novus, & alius Bernhardi Comitis Trevirensis, ex Gallico versus. Cum fragmentis E. Kellæi, H. Aquilæ Thuringi, & J.I. Hollandi. 3. Fratris Ferrarii tractatus integer ... 4. Johannis Daustenii Angli Rosarium ... [Ed. by L. Combachius.] 8°, Geismariæ, 1647. (At the end of the preface (p.15), signed 'L.C.' Newton added 'is est Lud. Combachius. Vide Bibl. Chem. p.64' (a reference to Borel's Bibliotheca chimica [H246]); a few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.147 [H1641]

Tres tractatus de metallorum transmutatione. Quid singulis contineatur, sequens pagina indicat. Incognito auctore. Adjuncta est Appendix Medicamentorum Antipodagricorum & Calculifragi ... Nunc primum in lucem edi curavit M. Birrius. 8°, Amstelodami, 1668. [In fact by 'Eiren&ae;us Philalethes', i.e. G. Starkey: see Dobbs, Foundations, 131-2, and Newman, Gehennical Fire, 267 (entry 18 in his Starkey bibliography; Newman gives the publication date as 1669).] (Many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.10.144 [H1642]

Le Triomphe hermetique, ou La pierre philosophale victorieuse

... [By A.T. de Limojon de Saint-Didier.] 8°, Amsterdam, 1689. (Below the author's name, printed at the end of the book (p.153) as the anagram 'DIVES SICUT ARDENS, S***', Newton appended his solution 'S.E. Sanctus Didierus'; many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.123 [H1644]

A true light of alchymy. Containing, I. A correct edition of the Marrow of alchymy [by Eirenæus Philoponos Philalethes, i.e. G. Starkey] ... II. The errors of a late tract called, A short discourse of the quintessence of philosophers ... III. The method and materials pointed at, composing the Sophick Mercury ... 12°, London, 1709. Tr/NQ.16.95(2) [H1675]

Venette, Nicolas. Traité des pierres qui s'engendrent dans les terres & dans les animaux, où l'on parle exactement des causes qui les forment

dans les hommes ... 12°, Amsterdam, 1701. (A few signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.8.58 [H1685]

Vigani, Giovanni Francesco. Medulla chymiæ, variis experimentis aucta, multisq; figuris illustrata. 8°, Londini, 1683. (Annotations by Newton in margins of pp.8 & 9; a few signs of dog-earing.) Memorial Library, University of Wisconsin-Madison [H1718]

Webster, John. Metallographia: or, An history of metals ... 4°, London, 1671. (Many signs of dog-earing.) Tr/NQ.16.150 [H1760]

Yworth, William. Introitus apertus ad artem distillationis; or The whole art of distillation practically stated ... 8°, London, 1692.



Inventaire général et méthodique des manuscrits français de la Bibliothèque

nationale.

Inventaire général et méthodique des manuscrits français de la Bibliothèque nationale. II (1975). Léopold Delisle - revu le 27 mars 2004 Introduction

: nous avons sélectionné le chapitre X de l'Inventaire général et méthodique des manuscrits français de la Bibliothèque nationale, tome II établi par Léopold Victor Delisle [

éd. de Hildesheim ; New York : G. Olms, 1975

]. Il y a là 79 textes dont certains sont très connus et d'autres pas du tout ou même qui n'ont jamais été feuilletés par un homme de l'Art. On y trouvera les éditions originales des écrits du trio de Normandie [Grosparmy, Vicot et Valois], celle de Philalèthe et bien d'autres encore. D'autres listes peuvent être consultées sur le site levity.com . X. ALCHIMIE. 2019

. (Colbert.) Testament de Raymond Lulle. — Livre de faire les mercures et les elixirs des dits mercures (fol. 177 v°). — Le livre de la magnésie (fol. 246 v°).— XVe s. Papier. 19960

. (Séguier.) Epistola magistri Raymundi Lulii, missa regi Roberto, de accurtacione lapidis philosophorum. — Traité d'alchimie en provençal : « Sapias que los sains en lo miracle de la peyra... »(fol.7). — « Aquesta soma fezi je Bernai Peyre autrement lo grant Bernat... » (fol. 53). — XVIe s. Papier. 19969

. (Séguier.) Testament de Raimond Lulle, copié en 1559. — Fragments divers d'alchimie. 14802

. Le Testament de maistre Raymon Luile sur l'art et science de philosophie naturelle. — XVIe s. 2018

. (Colbert.) Raymond Lulle, Apertorium artis. — Epistre de l'abbrevialion de la pierre benoiste, de Raimond Lullier (fol. 29). — Traité responsif de Bernard de Trêves à Thomas de Boulogne, en 1385 (fol.39). —

Clavicule

de Raimond Lulle (fol. 75). — La date de 1533 est au fol. 72 v°. 2481

. Compendium ou abbrégé de la théorie de Raimond Lulle sur la practique de la pierre philosophale. — XVIIe s. 14801

. Physique de Raymond Lulle, dont l'intelligence est icy facilitée pour ceux qui n'ont pas grande entrée dans son art. — Considération sur l'estre divin fait en l'an 1645, par M. C. F. de La Ville, sur les principes de Raimond Lulle. — De l'analise. — Discours et questions par les principes de Raymond Lulle sur la divinité, fait l'an de Notre Seigneur 1647. 19968

. (Séguier.) Figures philosophiques de Raimond Lulle. — XVIIe s. 19978

. (Séguier.) Cy comence la vraie pratique de la noble science d'aikimie. Le désir désiré

... — XVes. A la fin, souscription falsifiée, portant que le livre a été écrit par Nicolas Flamel. 19962

. (Séguier.) La vraye pratique de la noble science d'alkymie. Le désir désiré ... — XVIIe s. 19963

. (Séguier.) Même traité, intitulé : le Livre de Nicolas Flamel, touchant la vraye science d'alchimie et médecine philosophale. — XVIIe s. 14799

. (Monteil.) Le livre des régimes ou Fleur de sapience de Nicolas Flamel, philosophe insigne, copié mot à mot sur son original, qu'il a écrit et relié de sa propre main, à Paris, ce 3e octobre 1743. 12246 . (Monteil.) Les deux livres de théorique du seigneur Nicolas de Grosparmy , seigneur et comte de Fiers. — Les cinq livres de Noël de Valois

, qui a laissé de grandes terres en Normandie l'an 1449, amy et compagnon de Grosparmy. — Pratique phisique et hermétique. — XVIIIe s. 12298, 12299

. La clef du secret des secrets; recueil de traités du magistère des sages, composés par les seigneurs de Grosparmy, de Vallois, avec le

sieur Nicolas Vicot, chapelain. — Milieu du XVIIe s. 14789

. La clef des secrets des secrets de philosophie. Ce présent livre est de messire Pierre Vicot, prêtre, serviteur domestique de Nicolas de Grosparmy, comte de Fiers, et de Noël Le Valois, gentilhomme, compagnon de Grosparmy. — XVIIe s. 19072

. (Séguier.) Abbrégé de Nicolas Grosparmy. A la fin, remarques touchant les mss. de M. le comte de Flairs. — XVIIe s. 2017

. (Philibert de La Mare.) La magnésie de Archistrant sur le fait de la grant pierre. —La trinité faisant mencion de la pierre des philozophes (fol, 20). — Le Liz (fol. 26 v°).

— La Fleur d'alchimie, par Jehan de Meun (fol. 37). — Opérations de science naturelle (fol. 4.8).—Lettres de frère Nicolas à frère Bernard sur l'art philosophical, traduites par Jehan Pilles, l'an 1457 (fol. 64).—Trésor de philosophie, par Bernard de Verdun (fol. 70). — Lettres de Jehan de Praxis à Jehan Marcel (fol. 89).—Traité du régime (fol. 94). — XVe s. Papier. 2012

. (Colbert.) Viatorium alchimie. — Traité de la pierre philosophale (fol. 15). — Miroir d'alchimie

, trad. de Roger Bacon par Jacques Girard de Tournus (fol. 34). — Traité d'Albert le Grand de la concordance des philosophes en la pierre (fol. 49). —Livre du maître Jupiter, par Roger Bacon (fol. 73). — Epître d'Arnaud de Villeneuve, en latin (fol. 89). — Commencement du XVIe s. 14797 . (Bigot.) Traités d'alchimie. Verbum dimissum

. — Le livre du conte de la Marche, lequel traicte de la pierre des philosophes (p. 70). — Recettes diverses. — Liber questionum Rainaldi (sic) de Villanova (p. 178). —Le prothocolle de philosophie moralle et naturelle, ou livre du saunier. — L'oeuvre composée par maistre Guillaume de Sens, chancelier de l'université de Paris. — XVIe s. 12300

. Enarration méthodique des trois médecins de Geber, dans lesquels le vray confection et consommation de la pierre des philosophes est

contenu. — XVIe s. 2020

. (Colbert.) Recolectoire de plusieurs traités de philosophie; extrait de Bernard de Trèves, Albert le Grand, Arnaud de Villeneuve, Raimond Lulle; compilation de Philippe de la Lende. — XVIe s. 19070

. (Séguier.) Le livre appelle Ymaige de vie, traict des secretz des philozophes sur la fleur de alkymie.— Verbum abreviatum fratris Raymundi Gauffrid de Leone Viridi (fol. 49). — XVIe s. 19964

. (Séguier.) La vraye science de philosophie, traité d'alchimie écrit en 1550. — L'œuvre d'une duchesse de Bretaigne, copié en 1551 sur un livre de Anthoine Noël, parisien. — Recettes diverses. — XVIe s. 1089

. (Baluze.) Le vray épilogue des principaulx autheurs qui ont escript en la philosophie naturelle pour l'augmentation des métaux, par D. Vecaire, philosophe ginevoys, auquel est adjousté la glorieuse marguerite d'Arnauld de Villeneufve, trad. par J. Gerasius, condomois. — 1560. 14798

. Rosaire des philosophes, deuxième partie de l'alchimie de la pierre des philosophes. — Poissons du Zodiaque inférieur, ou bien les solutions philosophales, avec les énigmes de toute la pierre. Epitome. Luca Rodargiro, autheur, Eutopiensi auctore. 1562 . — Recettes alchimiques; plusieurs en vers italiens. — XVIe s. 19071

. (Séguier.) Cristofori Parisiensis Medulla artis. Les œuvres de Christophe Parisien, très-excellent philosophe, corrigées de toute superfluité, traduites d'italien en françoys, au mois de janvier 1584, par E. A. D. M. 19957

. (S. Germain.) Discours d'autheur incertain sur la pierre des philosophes. Composé en 1590, durant le siège de Paris. — Copie du temps. 19069

. (S. Germain.) La vraye vérité de la pierre selon Hermès.—Mélanges d'alchimie. — L'efigie de la pierre, par maistre Jacque Tesson de Honneur (fol. 35 v°). — Fin du XVIe s. 19980

. (Séguier.) Recueil sur l'alchimie. — Fragmentum opusque imperfectum obtimum a domino Abatia.—L'œuvre des anciens sur la médecine de l'azoc ou electrum minéral (fol. 16). — La glorieuse marguerite de maître Arnauld de Villeneufve (fol. 40). — De la perfection de tout l'oeuvre ou magistère de Raymond Lulle (fol. 57).—Traité sommaire de la transmutation des métaux (fol. 96). — Recettes diverses. — Commencement du XVIIe s. 19959

. (Séguier.) Aulcune bonne auctorité de philosophie naturelle, par quoy on peult véritablement congnoistre de quoy est faicte et composée les œuvres d'argent vif cru des philosophes. — Règles sans lesquelles nul ne peut parvenir à la congnoissance du grand œuvre (fol. 17). — Aultre traicté de la pierre des philosophes, en rime, par huitain (fol. 25). — 1606. 17154

. (Séguier.) Mélanges d'alchimie. — Speculum sophici universalis, par Théophile Schireighart, 1617.—L'amphithéâtre de la sapience éternelle, par Henry Khunrath de Lipsicq. — XVIIe s. 25316

. (Barnabites.) Apologie du grand œuvre, dit vulgairement pierre philosophale. — 1634.. 19981 . (Séguier.) « L'entrée ouverte au palais clos du roy

. Moy anonime Philalètes, philosophe, estant parvenu aux secrets de médecine, de chymie et de physique, en l'année de la rédemption du genre humain 1645... » 19975

. (Séguier.) Le dernier testament de frère Basile Valentin, bénédictin, trouvé à Erfurt. — 1651. 19984

. (S. Germain.) De la médecine universelle; la manière de la tirer du végétable, de l'animal, etc., par J. M. S. nostre Elie, nobis ex frigida monarchia septentrionali missum, le 23 mars 1666, à Paris. 19074

. (Séguier.) Recueil de plusieurs secrets et pièces curieuses, exactement recherche, le tout approuvé pour estre bon et avoir esté esprouvé, par G.-D. R. A Paris, le 30 juillet 1666. 670

. (Colbert.) Interruption du sommeil cabalistique ou le dévoilement des tableaux de l'antiquité. La crisologie chimique. Du genre de l'or et sa généalogie, avec l'anatomie de l'eau, la généalogie et régénération du fils du soleil. — XVIIe s. 1331

. (A. Faure.) La profonde philosophie d'Albozan de Tarnate sur la pierre philosophale et secret de médecine. — XVIIe s. 2011

. (Béthune.) Sommaire instruction, touchant l'art de alkimie. — Le Code de vérité en l'art d'alkimie (fol. 4).

— Le livre du maistre Jupiter, par Roger Bacon (fol. 32). — Le Miroir d'alquemie

, traduit de Roger Bacon, par Jacques Girard de Tournus (fol. 42 v°). — Le trésor des trésors, rosier des philosophes (fol. SA). —Espitre de Regnault de Villeneufve sur l'alquemye (fol. 89). — Recettes d'alchimie (fol. 94). — XVIIe s. 2014

. (Colbert.) Pratique de Me Jan Saumières, œuvre véritable. — XVIIe s. 14790

. Annotations sur la recherche de l'oeuvre universel, traduites du latin d'Ortellius. — Recettes alchimiques.

— Extrait de Perrier, de M. Quenel, médecin. — XVIIe s. 14800

. (Monteil.) Les remonstrances de nature à l'alchymiste errant, autheur Jehan de Meung, en vers. — Petit traicté d'alchimie, intitulé : le Sommaire philosophique de Nicolas Flamel (fol. 44). — XVIIe s. 14807

. Le soleil sortant du puits, de Rhenanus.—XVIIe s. 19073

. (Gesvres.) La praticque de faire l'or potable pour la conservation et santé de la vie humaine. 19075

. (S. Germain.) Bibliothèque des philosophes, tome I. La table d'émeraude de Hermès Trismégiste. —

Opuscule de la philosophie naturelle des métaux

, par D. Zachaire, gentilhomme de Guyenne. — Philalèthe

, ou l'entrée ouverte du palais fermé du roy. — XVIIe s. 19955

. (S. Germain.) Livre de Philalette. — XVIIe s. 19961

. (Séguier.) Fragment d'un traité sur le grand œuvre. — XVIIe s. 19973

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. (Séguier.) Épître de frère Philippes Rouilhac, cordelier piedmontois, premier philosophe de son temps.

—Traité composé par le même en 1558 (fol. 8). — Extrait de la doctrine d'Isaac (fol. 115). — XVIIe s. 19976

. (De Fourcy, Gesvres.) De la nature de la terre :

Livre II, traictant de la terre et de ses vertus produisantes.

—Livre de la matière des philosophes chimiques.—XVIIe s. 19977

. (Séguier.) Expériences d'alchimie. — XVIIe s. 19979

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. (Monteil.) Recueil de traités alchimiques et de recettes, commençant par le Chemin aisé applani pour aller droit à la sacrée citadelle

d'Hermès. — Plusieurs des morceaux compris dans ce recueil sont placés sous le nom de Jean Pontanus, de Jacques Tesson et de Roger Bacon. — XVIIIe S. 13246

. L'ouverture du Trésor caché. — XVIIIe s. 14781

. (Monteil.) La Rivière de la première matière. — L'Arbre de vie, ou dialogue de Raymond Lulle (p. 57). — Œuvre philosophique, tiré de Castaigne (p. 100). — Coupelle et expériences (p. 125). — Œuvre des sages très-excellent (p. 137). — De la matière de la pierre et du feu (p. 207). — Annotations à examiner (p. 255). — Le chevalier inconnu (p. 277). — Extrait d'un certain écrit qui fait mention du livre de revelalione majestatis divinae (p. 323). — Ce que c'est que la pierre des philosophes (p. 339). — Le fils du macrocosme manifesté (p. 359). — XVIIIe s. Pour l'abbaye de Troarn. 14791-14793

. Recueil de plusieurs manuscrits sur le grand œuvre, traduits par un adepte sur les originaux qui se trouvent dans différentes bibliothèques des sçavants du Levant.

— Dans le tome I, l'Œuvre de Dieu manifestée par l'art, par Thémiste ; la Pratique du grand œuvre, par Salaciel (p. 371); la Nuit anéantie par le jour, par Esphenor (p. 667);

l'Art triomphant de la nature, par Dryathès (p. 979). — Dans le tome II, la Vérité déguisée par Onomin ; la Gymnosophie alchimique, par Telputh (p. 311) ; les Métamorphoses de l'art et de la nature, par Hakoston (p. 611) ; Origine des dieux philosophiques, par Nearcos (p. 937). — Dans le tome III, la Science talismanique, par Memnon ; les Effets de l'amour mutuel, par Jorasel (p. 307); l'Art de rendre l'or potable, par Lanster (p. 625); Composition de la médecine universelle, par Findrius (p. 933). — XVIIIe s. 14794

. L'art transmutatoire. Or commence le livre d'alchimie que pape Jean fit ouvrer en Avignon... — XVIIIe s. 14795

. Fragments du Philalette. — Différence des deux éditions de l' Introitus apertus

, latine et angloise. — Petit traité ou pratique de l'œuvre philosophique, attribué au vrai cosmopolite

. — Athanor, fourneau philosophique. — Autre fourneau physique. — Les douze portes

de George Riplex et son livre du mercure, traduction de R. Bascon, sr de Presle. — Petit recueil de lettres et répliques de lettres philosophiques. — Lettre d'un philosophe à un grand prince. — XVIIIe s. Pour l'abbaye de Troarn. 14796

. Traité de la pierre philosophale, tiré du Cosmopolite très-excellent. — La clavicule

de Raimond Lul, laquelle déclare tout ce qui est requis à l'oeuvre chimique. — XVIIIe s. 14803-14805

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. (Oratoire.) Recettes d'alchimie. — Commencement du XVIIIe s. 25326

. (Jacobins S. Jacques.) Œuvre posthume de De Locques, médecin spargirique du roi. 1746. Tome I. Nouv. 1683

. Livre second contenant la première clef de l'œuvre des philosophes. — Liv. III, contenant une abrégée répétition de tout ce qui est contenu dans le traitté des douze clefs

de la pierre précieuse des philosophes.—XVIIIe s. Nouv. 1834

. Le livre des secrets de l'antimoine, de Alexandre A. Suchten. — Second traité de l'antimoine vulgaire, du même (fol. 64). — Le grand elixir de Raymond Lulle et le vray or potable (fol. 110). — L'œuvre

universel ou proceddé philosophique qu'il faut entendre selon Suchten et Philalette (fol. 111). — Opération philosophique de M. de Presle (fol. 116). — XVIIIe s. Nouv. 4039

. — Méthode pour décomposer les minéraux et métaux et composer la pierre philosophale ; recueil fait par Trévisan, dit la Violette. — XVIIIe s. Nouv. 4114

. Abrégé d'Albert le Grand, de l'origine et naissance des métaux. — Le composé des composés

d'Albert le Grand, (p. 13). — L'appertoire de Raymond Lulle (p. 65). — XVIIIe s.

plan des études historiques d'Eugène Chevreul

Capture du 2004-10-13 — http://perso.club-internet.fr/hdelboy/plan_chevreul.html

E ugène C hevreul

Chevreul debout, à l'entrée de son laboratoire à l'atelier des Gobelins, ca. 1883 ____ 1)- biographie 2)- critique de l' Histoire de la Chimie de Ferdinand Hoefer (14 articles) 3)- critique d' Artéfius , à propos du Clavis Major Sapientiae 4)- critique de Cambriel 5)- considérations sur l' espèce minéralogique et chimique 6)- Résumé d'une histoire de la Matière - Atlas - Tableau

des connaissances humaines - la médecine selon Paracelse - 7)- critique d'une histoire de la magie - 8)- méthode a posteriori

de Newton et méthode a priori de Leibniz - 9)-

distributions des connaissances humaines du ressort de la philosophie naturelle - 10.

De l'Abstraction considérée relativement aux Beaux-Art et à la Littérature - 11. sur Isidore Geoffroy Saint Hilaire

[contient des extraits de l'Enchidion de Jean D'Espagnet et des Aphorismes Basiliens de Nicolaus Niger Hapellius] revu le 29 août 2004 Plan des quatorze sections : I. biographie d'Eugène Chevreul : 1. introduction - 2. notice historique de Berthelot - 3. article de L. Mangin - 4. Chevreul et les corps gras de Ch. Moureu - II. Etudes historiques [1 ère section] I. Introduction - II. 1 er article 1. Etendue de la chimie - 2. diverses classes de connaissances chimiques - 3. Notions qui peuvent paraître indépendantes de la chimie - Conclusion relative

à la manière de composer une histoire de la chimie - III. 2 ème article : Ière époque - Ière section - I. Chinois - II. Indiens (Indonésiens) - III. Égyptiens , Phéniciens, Hébreux - IIème section

- De 640 ans avant J.-C. au IIIe siècle après J.-C. - IV. Grecs, Romains - A. Partie théorique

- Systèmes des philosophes de la Grèce - B. Partie pratique - 1. Chimie minérale - 2. Chimie organique - IV. 3 ème article : Ière ÉPOQUE

. - 3ème SECTION. Du IIIe siècle au IXe siècle après J. C. - Firmicus - Zosime - Pélage - Olympiodore - Pseudo-Démocrite - Synésius - Marie - philosophe chrétien (anonyme) - lsis (à Horus) - Marcus Graecus - Thémiste - Turba - Notes - 1. Jamblique - 2. Proclus - 3. Egypte (sphinx - Osiris - Isis - Horus - scarabée -) - III. Etudes historiques [2 ème section] 4 ème article : Ière section - du IXe au XIIIe siècle [Geber , Razis , Avicenne , Alphidius , Morienus , Artephius , Senior , etc.] - 5 ème article : IIème section - du XIIIe au début du XVIe siècle [Albert le Grand , Roger Bacon , saint Thomas d'Aquin , Arnaud de Villeneuve , Raymond Lulle , Ortholain , Nicolas Flamel , Isaac Le Hollandais , Basile Valentin] - 6 ème article : IIIème époque : du XVIe au début du XIXe siècle [Paracelse - chémiatrie] - 7 ème article : chimie métallurgique [Agricola - Biringuccio - Cesalpin - Perez de Vargas] - chimie technique : [Palissy - Porta] - Alchimie : [Zachaire - Vigenère - Barnaud - Grosparmy - Valois - Vicot] - 8 ème article : IIIème époque comprenant le XVIIe siècle - Van Helmont - 9 ème article : système de Van Helmont [éléments , productions séminales , ferments , âmes ,

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